

Macbeth

William Shakespeare · 1606

First Folio (1623) text as edited by Standard Ebooks

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

29 scene lessons plus 2 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 28 class days of 90 minutes, 5 per unit (block schedule), 6 units
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

Liber et Libri · Lux et Libri LLC
Cover: Caspar David Friedrich, Wanderer above the Sea of Fog (c. 1818). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).

Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–29), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Macbeth survives only in the 1623 First Folio. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks edition, divided into the conventional 28 scenes (plus the cast list). Most scholars think the Hecate passages (Act III, Scene V and part of Act IV, Scene I) were added by another writer, probably Thomas Middleton. Cite act, scene and line from this edition.

Content note for teachers: Recurring violence (murders on and off stage, including a child), witchcraft, a reported suicide and a severed head; the play's treatment of 'manhood' and of Lady Macbeth draws on period gender ideas that deserve critical discussion. See the scene notes.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to AP via rigor levels). **Units:** 6. **Class days:** 28 × 90 minutes (29 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Macbeth suggest about ambition and its costs?
- What does Macbeth suggest about fate and free will?
- What does Macbeth suggest about guilt and conscience?
- What does Macbeth suggest about appearance versus reality?
- What does Macbeth suggest about masculinity, power and violence?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the play in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the scene quizzes.

- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Writing prompt each unit (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has four rigor levels (HS Sophomore through AP); each level offers three writing options (individual analytical, individual creative, group) on one rubric; the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary (word histories where verified)	We do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Unit	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Dramatis Personae (20-minute preview) and Act I, Scene I (20-minute preview) and Act I, Scene II Act I, Scene III Act I, Scene IV Act I, Scene V	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*ambition and its costs* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Act I, Scene VI (20-minute preview) and Act I, Scene VII *Socratic seminar on ambition and its costs* Act II, Scene I Act II, Scene II Act II, Scene III	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*fate and free will* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on ambition and its costs • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Act II, Scene IV Act III, Scene I Act III, Scene II Act III, Scene III Act III, Scene IV	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*guilt and conscience* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
4	Act III, Scene V (20-minute preview) and Act III, Scene VI Act IV, Scene I *Socratic seminar on fate and free will* Act IV, Scene II Act IV, Scene III	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*appearance versus reality* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on fate and free will • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
5	Act V, Scene I Act V, Scene II (20-minute preview) and Act V, Scene III	5 × 90 min	*masculinity, power and violence* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories,	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

	Act V, Scene IV (20-minute preview) and Act V, Scene V Act V, Scene VI (20-minute preview) and Act V, Scene VII Act V, Scene VIII	(450 min)	background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	
6	*Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)* *Final paper: peer review, revision and submission*	3 × 90 min (270 min)	*ambition and its costs* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework) • Final paper: peer review, revision and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per unit)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Macbeth

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about William Shakespeare's life or times connects to ambition and its costs in “Macbeth”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (ambition and its costs, fate and free will, guilt and conscience).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, the son of John Shakespeare, a glover and town official, and Mary Arden. He probably attended Stratford's grammar school, married Anne Hathaway in 1582, and had three children: Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith (Hamnet died aged eleven in 1596). By the early 1590s he was an actor and playwright in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, who built the Globe theatre in 1599 and became the King's Men when James VI of Scotland became James I of England in 1603. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays and the Sonnets, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. Seven years later his fellow actors John Heminges and Henry Condell published 36 of his plays in the First Folio (1623).

Historical and cultural context

Macbeth was written around 1606 for a company that now served a Scottish king. James I was fascinated by witchcraft (he wrote a treatise, Daemonologie, in 1597, and had taken part in witch trials in Scotland) and traced his descent from Banquo, whom the play makes noble. In November 1605 the Gunpowder Plot to blow up the king and Parliament was discovered; at the 1606 trial of the Jesuit Henry Garnet, "equivocation" (misleading by ambiguous speech) became notorious, and the Porter's joke about an "equivocator" in Act II, Scene III points to it. Shakespeare took his story from Raphael Holinshed's Chronicles (1587), changing much: the historical Macbeth ruled Scotland from 1040 to 1057 and killed Duncan I in battle, not in his bed.

Publication and reception, then and now

The play was first printed in the First Folio (1623), the only early text. It is Shakespeare's shortest tragedy, and most scholars think the version we have was adapted after his death, with the Hecate passages probably added by Thomas Middleton. The earliest surviving eyewitness account of a performance is the astrologer Simon Forman's description of a Macbeth at the Globe in April 1611.

Then: Little is recorded about first reactions. After the theatres reopened in 1660, William Davenant staged a version with added songs and flying witches that held the stage for decades; the actor David Garrick restored much of Shakespeare's text in 1744. Romantic critics such as Thomas De Quincey ("On the Knocking at the Gate in Macbeth," 1823) praised its psychological intensity.

Now: Macbeth is among the most performed and taught of all plays. Film versions range from Akira Kurosawa's Throne of Blood (1957) to Roman Polanski's (1971) and Joel Coen's The Tragedy of Macbeth (2021). Theatre superstition calls it "the Scottish play" and avoids saying its name backstage. Modern critics

debate its gender politics (Lady Macbeth's "unsex me here"), its view of fate and free will, and its politics of tyranny and succession.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Returning from a victorious battle, the Scottish general Macbeth meets three witches who greet him with titles, including "king hereafter." What Macbeth and his wife do with that prophecy, and what it does to them and to Scotland, is the play.

Main themes

- ambition: watch how wanting becomes doing, and what each crime demands next.
- fate and free will: the witches predict, but who decides?
- appearance and reality: "fair is foul": faces, words and prophecies that hide their meaning.
- guilt and conscience: blood, sleep and hands; how guilt shows itself.
- masculinity and power: what "being a man" means to each character.

Why it matters

Macbeth is the classic study of how a decent, admired person talks himself into doing evil, and of how leaders who seize power must keep using violence to hold it. Those patterns are visible in politics and in ordinary life, and the play's language about guilt has entered everyday English ("out, damned spot").

Spoilers · teacher only

Macbeth murders King Duncan in his sleep, urged by Lady Macbeth; Duncan's sons flee and Macbeth is crowned. He has Banquo murdered (Fleance escapes), sees Banquo's ghost, returns to the witches and receives riddling prophecies, and has Macduff's family slaughtered. Lady Macbeth sleepwalks and dies, probably by suicide. Malcolm's army, carrying branches from Birnam Wood, attacks Dunsinane; Macduff, "from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd," kills Macbeth, and Malcolm becomes king.

Content framing, teacher guidance: Keep it brief. Have the school counselor's contact ready and follow school protocol if a student discloses risk. The Lifeline offers call, text and chat, free and confidential, 24/7. The note names no character and no event, so it spoils nothing.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Say: Before we start, I want to tell you about some hard parts of this play. Shakespeare's Macbeth is about a brave soldier who hears a prophecy that he will be king and lets ambition and guilt lead him and his wife into terrible acts. The play includes murder, including the killing of a child, battles and many deaths, witches and ghosts, harsh and sexual language, a character overwhelmed by guilt, and characters who speak of wanting to die, along with a death that may be suicide. Shakespeare shows these as part of a tragedy: violence and ambition destroy the people who choose them, and despair is shown as a sign of what has been lost, not as an answer. In real life, hurting yourself is wrong and is never the answer. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide or self-harm, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org (the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or talk to a school counselor or a trusted adult. You don't have to handle it alone. Before we open Macbeth: Imagine someone tells you that you will definitely get something you want. Would you wait for it, or try to make it happen? Write for five minutes.
Prompt: Before we open Macbeth: Imagine someone tells you that you will definitely get something you want. Would you wait for it, or try to make it happen? Write for five minutes.

8–18 min · Key terms · We do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
tragedy (a play in which a great figure falls through his own choices); soliloquy (a speech alone on stage revealing thoughts); aside (a remark the audience hears but other characters do not); dramatic irony (the audience knows what a character does not); blank verse (unrhymed iambic pentameter); thane (a Scottish lord).

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).

About the author. William Shakespeare was baptized in Stratford-upon-Avon on 26 April 1564, the son of John Shakespeare, a glover and town official, and Mary Arden. He probably attended Stratford's grammar school, married Anne Hathaway in 1582, and had three children: Susanna and the twins Hamnet and Judith (Hamnet died aged eleven in 1596). By the early 1590s he was an actor and playwright in London; from 1594 he was a sharer in the Lord Chamberlain's Men, who built the Globe theatre in 1599 and became the King's Men when James VI of Scotland became James I of England in 1603. He wrote or co-wrote about 38 plays and the Sonnets, and died in Stratford on 23 April 1616. Seven years later his fellow actors John Heminges and Henry Condell published 36 of his plays in the First Folio (1623). The world of the book. Macbeth was written around 1606 for a company that now served a Scottish king. James I was fascinated by witchcraft (he wrote a treatise, Daemonologie, in 1597, and had taken part in witch trials in Scotland) and traced his descent from Banquo, whom the play makes noble. In November 1605 the Gunpowder Plot to blow up the king and Parliament was discovered; at the 1606 trial of the Jesuit Henry Garnet, "equivocation" (misleading by ambiguous speech) became notorious, and the Porter's joke about an "equivocator" in Act II, Scene III points to it. Shakespeare took his story from Raphael Holinshed's Chronicles (1587), changing much: the historical Macbeth ruled Scotland from 1040 to 1057 and killed Duncan I in battle, not in his bed. Publication and reception. The play was first printed in the First Folio (1623), the only early text. It is Shakespeare's shortest tragedy, and most scholars think the version we have was adapted after his death, with the Hecate passages probably added by Thomas Middleton. The earliest surviving eyewitness account of a performance is the astrologer Simon Forman's description of a Macbeth at the Globe in April 1611. Then: Little is recorded about first reactions. After the theatres reopened in 1660, William Davenant staged a version with added songs and flying witches that held the stage for decades; the actor David Garrick restored much of Shakespeare's text in 1744. Romantic critics such as Thomas De Quincey ("On the Knocking at the Gate in Macbeth," 1823) praised its psychological intensity. Now: Macbeth is among the most performed and taught of all plays. Film versions range from Akira Kurosawa's Throne of Blood (1957) to Roman Polanski's (1971) and Joel Coen's The Tragedy of Macbeth (2021). Theatre superstition calls it "the Scottish play" and avoids saying its name backstage. Modern critics debate its gender politics (Lady Macbeth's "unsex me here"), its view of fate and free will, and its politics of tyranny and succession.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" slowly and put it in my own words: The three witches chant together that fair is foul and foul is fair. Next, craft. I notice the chiasmus, a mirrored pattern that flips good and bad in a single line, like a spell. The strongest word is "foul": the word for ugly or evil is set equal to "fair," so values are turned upside down. Then, effect. What does the witches' chant tell us about the world of the play? My answer: The witches announce a world where appearances deceive and moral order is reversed; Macbeth, who seems a loyal hero, will become a murderer, and his first line will echo theirs.

> *Fair is foul, and foul is fair* *(Act I, Scene I, All)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" slowly and put it in my own words: The three witches chant together that fair is foul and foul is fair. Next, craft. I notice the chiasmus, a mirrored pattern that flips good and bad in a single line, like a spell. The strongest word is "foul": the word for ugly or evil is set equal to "fair," so values are turned upside down. Then, effect. What does the witches' chant tell us about the world of the play? My answer: The witches announce a world where appearances deceive and moral order is reversed; Macbeth, who seems a loyal hero, will become a murderer, and his first line will echo theirs.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Returning from a victorious battle, the Scottish general Macbeth meets three witches who greet him with titles, including "king hereafter." What Macbeth and his wife do with that prophecy, and what it does to them and to Scotland, is the play. Themes to track: ambition: watch how wanting becomes doing, and what each crime demands next. fate and free will: the witches predict, but who decides? appearance and reality: "fair is foul": faces, words and prophecies that hide their meaning. guilt and conscience: blood, sleep and hands; how guilt shows itself. masculinity and power: what "being a man" means to each character.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "fate and free will": Prediction: the witches will be right but in an unexpected way. Question: would Macbeth have killed anyone without them?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Macbeth: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page "fate and free will": Prediction: the witches will be right but in an unexpected way. Question: would Macbeth have killed anyone without them?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Macbeth still matter? Macbeth is the classic study of how a decent, admired person talks himself into doing evil, and of how leaders who seize power must keep using violence to hold it. Those patterns are visible in politics and in ordinary life, and the play's language about guilt has entered everyday English ("out, damned spot").
Anchor question: Why might Macbeth still be taught today?
Facilitation: Macbeth is the classic study of how a decent, admired person talks himself into doing evil, and of how leaders who seize power must keep using violence to hold it. Those patterns are visible in politics and in ordinary life, and the play's language about guilt has entered everyday English ("out, damned spot").

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Shakespeare wrote Macbeth around 1606, soon after King James I, who believed in witchcraft and claimed descent from Banquo, survived the Gunpowder Plot to blow up Parliament. How might that context shape a play about killing a king? Answer: Accept answers such as: James's interest in witches explains their prominence; showing regicide as monstrous flattered a king who had just escaped assassination; Banquo is shown as noble because he was James's ancestor.
Exit ticket: Shakespeare wrote Macbeth around 1606, soon after King James I, who believed in witchcraft and claimed descent from Banquo, survived the Gunpowder Plot to blow up Parliament. How might that context shape a play about killing a king?
Answer: Accept answers such as: James's interest in witches explains their prominence; showing regicide as monstrous flattered a king who had just escaped assassination; Banquo is shown as noble because he was James's ancestor.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Dramatis Personae.

Teacher notes · sources: Folger Shakespeare Library, "Shakespeare's life" and "Macbeth" (https://www.folger.edu/explore/shakespeares-works/macbeth/); Royal Shakespeare Company, "Macbeth: about the play" (https://www.rsc.org.uk/macbeth/about-the-play); British Library, "Macbeth, Holinshed and the Gunpowder Plot" (https://www.bl.uk/shakespeare/articles/macbeth-and-the-gunpowder-plot); Britannica, "Macbeth" (king of Scotland) (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Macbeth-king-of-Scotland); Simon Forman, Booke of Plaies (Bodleian MS Ashmole 208) (https://www.bodleian.ox.ac.uk/); Thomas De Quincey, "On the Knocking at the Gate in Macbeth" (1823) (https://www.gutenberg.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- The date "around 1606" is a scholarly inference (the Porter's equivocation joke, the Gunpowder Plot, a probable performance before King James); no record fixes it.
- The Middleton revision of the Hecate scenes is the majority view, not a certainty.
- Whether Lady Macbeth's death is suicide rests on Malcolm's report in the last scene ("by self and violent hands"); present it as reported.

Lesson 2: Dramatis Personae

Focus: the cast and world of the play

Objective: Students will identify at least 5 characters from the cast list and explain, in one sentence each, how each is related to the play's central family or court.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

The cast list sets up two kingdoms (Scotland and England), King Duncan and his sons Malcolm and Donalbain, the generals Macbeth and Banquo, the thanes (Macduff, Lennox, Ross and others), Lady Macbeth and Lady Macduff, Hecate and three Witches, and apparitions. The play moves between Scottish castles, a heath, a battlefield and the English court.

Background: Shakespeare wrote Macbeth around 1606, soon after James VI of Scotland became James I of England (1603). James claimed descent from Banquo, had written a book on witchcraft (Daemonologie, 1597) and had survived the Gunpowder Plot (1605). Shakespeare drew the story loosely from Holinshed's Chronicles (1587).

Significance: A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because....*
> **Prompt:** If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

> **8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)**
> Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
> *Shakespeare wrote Macbeth around 1606, soon after James VI of Scotland became James I of England (1603). James claimed descent from Banquo, had written a book on witchcraft (Daemonologie, 1597) and had survived the Gunpowder Plot (1605). Shakespeare drew the story loosely from Holinshed's Chronicles (1587). A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene. Characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Setting: "Scotland; England": a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather. Structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do.*

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the cast and world of the play. Key takeaway: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test.
- **Setting:** "Scotland; England": a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather.
- **Structure:** Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order.

Symbols and motifs

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 4) Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break.

- “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 5) The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil.
- “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae) Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate).

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation.
Evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 4)
Reasoning: Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context

Discussion questions

1. If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Which characters on the cast list are women? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff, the Gentlewoman, Hecate and the three Witches.
   Answer guidance: Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff, the Gentlewoman, Hecate and the three Witches.
2. Who is the king of Scotland at the start of the play? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Duncan
   Answer guidance: Duncan.
3. Which two countries does the play take place in? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Scotland and England
   Answer guidance: Scotland and England.
4. What are Malcolm and Donalbain to Duncan? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** His sons
   Answer guidance: His sons.

5. Which character is listed as general of the king's army? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Macbeth
   Answer guidance: Macbeth.
6. Which supernatural figure leads the Witches? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Hecate
   Answer guidance: Hecate.
7. Retell the most important events of "Dramatis Personae" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The cast list sets up two kingdoms (Scotland and England), King Duncan and his sons Malcolm and Donalbain, the generals Macbeth and Banquo, the thanes (Macduff, Lennox, Ross and others), Lady Macbeth and Lady Macduff, Hecate and three Witches, and apparitions. The play moves between Scottish castles, a heath, a battlefield and the English court.
   Answer guidance: The cast list sets up two kingdoms (Scotland and England), King Duncan and his sons Malcolm and Donalbain, the generals Macbeth and Banquo, the thanes (Macduff, Lennox, Ross and others), Lady Macbeth and Lady Macduff, Hecate and three Witches, and apparitions. The play moves between Scottish castles, a heath, a battlefield and the English court.
8. Who is on stage in "Dramatis Personae", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Dramatis Personae" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. In the passage that opens with "Duncan, king of Scotland Malcolm, his son Donalbain, his son Macbeth, general of the king's army Banquo, general of the king's army Macduff, nobleman of Scotland Lennox, nobleman…", who is speaking or being described, and what do they say or do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Literal paraphrase of the anchor passage.
    Answer guidance: Literal paraphrase of the anchor passage.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Shakespeare's first audience, under King James, have watched Banquo with special interest? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** James I claimed descent from Banquo; the play flatters that line.
   Answer guidance: James I claimed descent from Banquo; the play flatters that line.
2. What does "Dramatis Personae" suggest about the cast and world of the play? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene.
   Answer guidance: A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the

first scene. Evidence to accept: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 4): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Which pairs in the cast list are fathers and sons, and what might the play do with them? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Duncan with Malcolm and Donalbain, Banquo with Fleance, Siward with Young Siward, Macduff with his son; a guess about heirs or loyalty.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Duncan with Malcolm and Donalbain, Banquo with Fleance, Siward with Young Siward, Macduff with his son; a guess about heirs or loyalty. Evidence to accept: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 5): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the characterization in “Dramatis Personae” shape what we understand about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 4): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. On characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “Duncan, king of Scotland…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Dramatis Personae”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the list's turn from the king's household to the spirits (Hecate, the Witches, Apparitions); evidence: “Three Witches” listed apart from every rank.

   Answer guidance: Look for: the list's turn from the king's household to the spirits (Hecate, the Witches, Apparitions); evidence: “Three Witches” listed apart from every rank. Evidence to accept: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 4): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. As the opening scene, what does “Dramatis Personae” set up that the rest of Macbeth will need? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 5): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and

foil. On structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Dramatis Personae”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the cast and world of the play, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). On characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (If someone told you that you would one day be king or queen, what would you do with that knowledge?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 5): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does structure appear in “Dramatis Personae”, and how does it connect the cast and world of the play to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 4): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. On structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is a cast list a neutral document? What does the order of names suggest about who matters in this world? [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Rank and gender shape the order; kings and lords first, women and servants later.

   Answer guidance: Rank and gender shape the order; kings and lords first, women and servants later.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): A cast list is a map of power: who rules, who serves, who is family and who stands outside the human order (the Witches). Reading it first lets students track loyalty and betrayal from the first scene. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend

it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which entry in the cast list do you think will matter most to the play, and why? Judge by rank, kinship or the list's order. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** a named criterion (rank, kinship, placement) and an entry defended with it, such as the king heading the list or the Witches set apart.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 4): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. On characterization: The cast list already divides the world: a king and his sons, generals, thanes, the English allies, and at the bottom the women and the supernatural. Macbeth and Banquo share one title, "general of the king's army": they begin as equals, which makes their divergence the play's first test. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Dramatis Personae”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the cast and world of the play. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 5): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. On structure: Some roles (Porter, Old Man, the Doctors, the Gentlewoman) seem minor but carry key moments of commentary and witness; ask students to predict what they do. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Dramatis Personae”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Dramatis Personae”, with its focus on the cast and world of the play, to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 4): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the setting in “Dramatis Personae” effective in presenting the cast and world of the play, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Banquo, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 5): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. On setting: "Scotland; England": a divided map. England will be where the rightful heir and the forces of order gather. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Dramatis Personae” treats the cast and world of the play with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Three Witches” (Dramatis Personae): Listed among the "supernatural" roles; Shakespeare's text calls them "the weird sisters" (from the Old English wyrd, fate). Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 4): Macbeth's role is defined by service to the king, the bond he will break. Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Dramatis Personae" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the cast and world of the play? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. Useful evidence: "Banquo, general of the king's army" (Dramatis Personae, line 5): The identical title makes Banquo Macbeth's double and foil. Theme link: almost all named roles are men defined by military or noble rank; the three women with lines are Lady Macbeth, Lady Macduff and the Gentlewoman, plus Hecate and the Witches, whose power is outside the social order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does the cast list describe Seyton?

    A. As a household officer

    B. As a nobleman and a friend of Ross

    C. As a doctor at court

    D. As the king's younger son

    Key: A (As a household officer)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whose son is the character listed only as 'Boy'?

    A. Banquo's, as his second son

    B. Macduff's

    C. Duncan's, as his heir

    D. Siward's, as his page

    Key: B (Macduff's)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which two figures are listed as doctors?

    A. Two Scottish noblemen who serve the king

    B. Two of the Witches

    C. An English one and a Scotch one

    D. A porter and an old man

    Key: C (An English one and a Scotch one)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How many Witches does the cast list name?

    A. Two, with Hecate as a third

    B. Seven, one for each day

C. One for each act of the play

D. Three, listed together

Key: D (Three, listed together)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the summary: the cast list shows who rules and who is family, and it marks many sons by their _____.

   Key: parentage

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which humble figures appear near the end of the named roles?

   A. A soldier, a porter and an old man

   B. A bishop, a judge and a sailor from Norway

   C. A cook and a maid

   D. A farmer and his wife

   Key: A (A soldier, a porter and an old man)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who attends on Lady Macbeth?

   A. Two doctors who travel from England

   B. A gentlewoman

   C. The three Witches

   D. Lady Macduff and her boy

   Key: B (A gentlewoman)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the relationship between Siward and Young Siward?

   A. Two brothers who fight on opposite sides

   B. Master and servant

   C. Father and son

   D. Uncle and nephew

   Key: C (Father and son)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can a reader learn about Scotland's ruling world from the cast list?

   Sample answer: The list opens with Duncan, his two sons, then the generals Macbeth and Banquo and a long row of noblemen such as Macduff, Lennox and Ross. Power belongs to a king, his heirs and the lords who serve him, and the English Siward shows that another country will play a part.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which names in the cast list suggest that the play will include the supernatural?

    Sample answer: Alongside kings, lords and soldiers, the list names Hecate, three Witches and Apparitions. These figures belong to magic rather than to the court, so a reader expects the human story of power to be touched by forces that are not natural, and perhaps by prophecy or visions.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How many noblemen of Scotland does the cast list name?

    A. Six

    B. Two, Ross and Angus

    C. Ten

    D. None at all

    Key: A (Six)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does the cast list describe Banquo?

    A. As the king's eldest son and heir to the crown

    B. As a general of the king's army

    C. As an officer serving Macbeth

    D. As a doctor at the English court

    Key: B (As a general of the king's army)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which character's son is called Fleance?

    A. Macduff's, the youngest

    B. Malcolm's

    C. Banquo's

    D. Seyton's

    Key: C (Banquo's)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the cast list entry: "Gentlewoman _____ on Lady Macbeth"

    Key: attending

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What do the two doctors in the cast list suggest about the play's settings?

    A. The play takes place in a hospital ward

    B. Every scene is set at the royal court

    C. The king is already gravely ill at the start

    D. The action moves between two kingdoms

    Key: D (The action moves between two kingdoms)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which entry is described by age rather than by rank or kinship?

    A. An old man

    B. Malcolm, the king's son

    C. Seyton, an officer

    D. Ross, a nobleman

    Key: A (An old man)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why might it matter that Macbeth and Banquo share the same title?

    A. They have already fought each other over it

    B. They begin as equals in rank

    C. They are both sons of the king

    D. Duncan has already promised the crown to them

    Key: B (They begin as equals in rank)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which entries in the list stand outside the human ranks?

    A. Caithness and Menteith, two noblemen

    B. The two doctors

    C. The Witches and Apparitions

D. The porter and old man

Key: C (The Witches and Apparitions)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the order of the cast list reflect the society of the play?

    Sample answer: The list moves from the top of society downward: the king and his sons first, then the generals and the noblemen, then attendants, a porter, an old man and the women of the court, and finally unnamed lords, soldiers and messengers. It mirrors a world ordered by rank, where everyone has a place under the king.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What questions does the cast list raise before the play begins?

    Sample answer: A reader may wonder why a play about Scottish lords includes Witches, Hecate and Apparitions, why there are murderers in the court, and why doctors from both England and Scotland are needed. These puzzles hint that the play will mix politics, violence, sickness and the supernatural.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which title does the cast list give Macduff?

    A. Nobleman of Scotland
    B. General of the English forces in the north
    C. Earl of Northumberland
    D. Officer serving in the household

    Key: A (Nobleman of Scotland)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the cast list entry: "Young _____, his son"

    Key: Siward

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does listing an English doctor and a Scotch doctor suggest?

    A. The doctors are the play's main heroes
    B. Sickness will matter in both lands
    C. The king has fallen ill before the play
    D. Scotland has no doctors of its own

    Key: B (Sickness will matter in both lands)

24. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the entry 'Apparitions' most likely signal?

    A. A group of foreign soldiers will arrive
    B. Messengers bring news from abroad
    C. Visions will appear on stage
    D. The court holds a masked festival

    Key: C (Visions will appear on stage)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which pairing in the list sets two generations side by side?

    A. Lennox and Ross, two nobles of the court
    B. The two doctors
    C. The porter and the old man
    D. Banquo and Fleance

    Key: D (Banquo and Fleance)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why might a director note that Lady Macbeth has no first name in the list?

    A. She is defined by her marriage

    B. Her name will be revealed in the final act

    C. She is a minor figure in the play

    D. The printer forgot to include it

    Key: A (She is defined by her marriage)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What contrast does the cast list set up between its first and last named groups?

    A. Old age against childhood and youth

    B. Royal power against nameless servants

    C. Scotland against France

    D. Comedy against tragedy

    Key: B (Royal power against nameless servants)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which minor figure in the list belongs to the household rather than the court?

    A. An earl from the north

    B. Caithness, a nobleman

    C. A porter at the gate

    D. Menteith, a nobleman

    Key: C (A porter at the gate)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze what the cast list suggests about how power is passed on in Scotland.

    Sample answer: The king is listed with his two sons directly beneath him, so the crown seems meant to pass through Duncan's family. Yet the generals Macbeth and Banquo come next, and Banquo is given a son as well. A reader notices that several men have sons and households, which raises the question of whose line will rule after Duncan.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate how much a cast list can prepare an audience for a play.

    Sample answer: This list gives names, ranks, kinship and two countries, and it hints at magic through Hecate, the Witches and Apparitions. It cannot show motives, loyalties or how the characters change, which the play must reveal. A strong answer weighs its useful map of relationships against what it leaves unknown.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the most likely function of placing the supernatural figures near the end of the cast list?

    A. It sets them apart from the order of rank

    B. It shows that they are the least important roles

    C. It means they appear only in the last act

    D. It marks them as English characters

    Key: A (It sets them apart from the order of rank)

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: the human roles come with fathers, sons and households, but the supernatural figures are given no _____ at all.

    Key: ancestry

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which two figures most clearly share the same rank at the start?

    A. Malcolm and Fleance, the two eldest sons

    B. Macbeth and Banquo

    C. Seyton and Siward

    D. Lennox and the porter

    Key: B (Macbeth and Banquo)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the list's attention to sons (Malcolm, Donalbain, Fleance, Young Siward, Boy) invite a reader to watch?

    A. A bitter rivalry between the two doctors

    B. The education of young soldiers

    C. Questions of inheritance

    D. The marriage plans of the princes

    Key: C (Questions of inheritance)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What expectation does the list of unnamed attendants at the end create?

    A. Criminals will be tried and punished in a court scene

    B. The Witches will commit the crimes

    C. The English army will invade at once

    D. Violence may be ordered from within the court

    Key: D (Violence may be ordered from within the court)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the cast list balances the political and the supernatural.

    Sample answer: Most entries are political: a king, his heirs, two generals, noblemen, an earl and officers, all defined by title and service. Then Hecate, three Witches and Apparitions appear with no rank at all. The list sets a strict human hierarchy beside powers that stand outside it, which suggests that the play will ask how far the supernatural can shake the order of a kingdom.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the cast list's 'Scene: Scotland; England' suggest about the play's scope?

    Sample answer: The action is not confined to one court. Two kingdoms are named, and the list includes an English earl and an English doctor beside Scottish lords. A reader can expect events in Scotland to draw in England, perhaps through war, exile or alliance, so that a struggle over one crown involves a wider world.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How might a modern director use the cast list to plan the opening of the play?

    Sample answer: A director would notice that the court is large and orderly while the Witches, Hecate and Apparitions stand apart. Costumes, lighting or staging could separate the human ranks from the supernatural figures, and the long list of nobles suggests crowded court scenes. A strong answer ties two staging choices to details in the list.

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which entry most directly suggests that Macbeth's own household matters to the story?

    A. Seyton's, an officer

    B. Siward's, the English general

    C. The English doctor's

    D. Lennox's, a nobleman

    Key: A (Seyton's, an officer)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate whether the cast list reveals too much or too little about the play.

    Sample answer: It reveals relationships and ranks, two countries and a supernatural presence, which helps readers keep track of a large cast. It reveals nothing of what anyone does, so motives and outcomes stay hidden. A strong answer argues that the list prepares without spoiling and supports the claim with two entries.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 1, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 1
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Dramatis Personae develops the idea of the cast and world of the play. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Dramatis Personae” could deliver about the cast and world of the play. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the cast and world of the play in “Dramatis Personae”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Dramatis Personae (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the cast and world of the play. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Dramatis Personae” could deliver about the cast and world of the play.

Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the cast and world of the play in "Dramatis Personae": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Dramatis Personae suggests about the cast and world of the play. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Dramatis Personae" could deliver about the cast and world of the play. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the cast and world of the play in "Dramatis Personae": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Dramatis Personae to complicate the reader's understanding of the cast and world of the play. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Dramatis Personae" could deliver about the cast and world of the play. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the cast and world of the play in "Dramatis Personae": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Duncan, king of Scotland Malcolm, his son Donalbain, his son Macbeth, general of the king's army Banquo, general of the king's army Macduff, nobleman of Scotland Lennox, nobleman of Scotland Ross, nobleman of Scotland Menteith, nobleman of Scotland Angus, nobleman of Scotland Caithness, nobleman of Scotland Fleance, son to Banquo Siward, Earl of Northumberland, general of the English forces Young Siward, his son Seyton, an officer attending on Macbeth Boy, son to Macduff An English doctor A Scotch doctor A soldier A porter An old man Lady Macbeth Lady Macduff Gentlewoman attending on Lady Macbeth Hecate Three Witches Apparitions Lords, gentlemen, officers, soldiers, murderers, attendants, and messengers Scene: Scotland; England.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Dramatis Personae"?

A. The cast and world of the play

B. A disguised advance on the castle

C. The guilt that will not wash away

D. Suspicion spoken through irony

SAT key: 1. A (The cast and world of the play)

Lesson 3: Act I, Scene I

Focus: the Witches' riddling world

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act I, Scene I (the Witches' riddling world) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

In thunder and lightning on a deserted place, three Witches agree to meet again 'when the hurlyburly's done, when the battle's lost and won,' upon the heath, to meet Macbeth. Called away by their familiars, they chant 'Fair is foul, and foul is fair' and vanish into the fog and filthy air.

Background: Jacobean audiences took witchcraft seriously: the 1604 Witchcraft Act made conjuring spirits a capital crime. Storms were believed to signal disorder in nature and the state.

Significance: The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....
Prompt: Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Jacobean audiences took witchcraft seriously: the 1604 Witchcraft Act made conjuring spirits a capital crime. Storms were believed to signal disorder in nature and the state. The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech. Setting: A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins. Diction / vocabulary: Short rhyming lines in trochaic rhythm (stressed first syllables) set the witches apart from the blank verse of humans. FigurativeLanguage: Paradox ("When the battle's lost and won"; "Fair is foul") makes contradiction the witches' language. Watch for equivocation: "Fair is foul": watch for appearances and words that mean two things.

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how setting shapes the Witches' riddling world. Key takeaway: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Short rhyming lines in trochaic rhythm (stressed first syllables) set the witches apart from the blank verse of humans.
- **FigurativeLanguage:** Paradox ("When the battle's lost and won"; "Fair is foul") makes contradiction the witches' language.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems.

Symbols and motifs

- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": watch for appearances and words that mean two things.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, lines 32–33) The opening question: a world of storm and repetition.
- “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, lines 34–35) Paradox: every battle is lost by someone.
- “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, line 43) The play's motto: moral values inverted.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed.
Evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, line 43)
Reasoning: The witches' chant "Fair is foul, and foul is fair" collapses good and evil into each other, and their paradox "the battle's lost and won" warns that victory and defeat can be the same event.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context

Discussion questions

1. Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell?

2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What do the Witches say they will do when the hurlyburly is done? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Meet again, upon the heath, to meet with Macbeth.
   Answer guidance: Meet again, upon the heath, to meet with Macbeth.
2. What weather opens the play? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Thunder and lightning
   Answer guidance: Thunder and lightning.
3. Whom do the Witches plan to meet? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Macbeth
   Answer guidance: Macbeth.
4. How many Witches enter in the first scene? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Three
   Answer guidance: Three.
5. What paradox do the Witches chant? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Fair is foul, and foul is fair
   Answer guidance: Fair is foul, and foul is fair.
6. When will the Witches meet again? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** When the battle's lost and won
   Answer guidance: When the battle's lost and won.
7. Retell the most important events of “Act I, Scene I” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** In thunder and lightning on a deserted place, three Witches agree to meet again 'when the hurlyburly's done, when the battle's lost and won,' upon the heath, to meet Macbeth. Called away by their familiars, they chant 'Fair is foul, and foul is fair' and vanish into the fog and filthy air.
   Answer guidance: In thunder and lightning on a deserted place, three Witches agree to meet again 'when the hurlyburly's done, when the battle's lost and won,' upon the heath, to meet Macbeth. Called away by their familiars, they chant 'Fair is foul, and foul is fair' and vanish into the fog and filthy air.
8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene I”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when is “Act I, Scene I” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. In the passage that opens with “When shall we three meet again In thunder, lightning, or in rain?”, who is speaking or being described, and what do they say or do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Literal paraphrase of the anchor passage.
    Answer guidance: Literal paraphrase of the anchor passage.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Shakespeare open with the Witches instead of the battle or the king? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** It frames events as shaped by uncanny forces and sets the paradox before the hero appears.
   Answer guidance: It frames events as shaped by uncanny forces and sets the paradox before the hero appears.
2. What does “Act I, Scene I” suggest about the Witches' riddling world? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech.
   Answer guidance: The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech. Evidence to accept: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, lines 32–33): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of setting in “Act I, Scene I”. What does it reveal about the Witches' riddling world that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling. Evidence to accept: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, lines 34–35): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the foreshadowing in “Act I, Scene I” shape what we understand about the Witches' riddling world? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, lines 32–33): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “When shall we three…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor

passage.

Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, line 43): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the Witches name their target; evidence: “There to meet with Macbeth.”

   Answer guidance: Look for: the Witches name their target; evidence: “There to meet with Macbeth.”. Evidence to accept: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, lines 32–33): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Act I, Scene I” build on “Dramatis Personae”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, lines 34–35): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Act I, Scene I”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the Witches' riddling world, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, line 43): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Think of a time something that looked good turned out bad, or the reverse. What made it hard to tell?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, lines 34–35): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear in “Act I, Scene I”, and how does it connect the Witches' riddling world to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, lines 32–33): The opening question: a world of storm and

repetition. On diction / vocabulary: Short rhyming lines in trochaic rhythm (stressed first syllables) set the witches apart from the blank verse of humans. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. How would you stage the Witches today so that they still feel threatening? Defend your choice. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A staging choice justified by the scene's language and mood.
   Answer guidance: A staging choice justified by the scene's language and mood.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The short scene sets the play's key paradox ('Fair is foul, and foul is fair') and its atmosphere of inversion before any human appears; Macbeth will echo the line in his first speech. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, line 43): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act I, Scene I” acts most wisely in the matter of the Witches' riddling world, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, lines 32–33): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act I, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Witches' riddling world. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, lines 34–35): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write your own questions about “Act I, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where

appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, line 43): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act I, Scene I”, with its focus on the Witches' riddling world, to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, lines 32–33): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in “Act I, Scene I” effective in presenting the Witches' riddling world, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When the hurlyburly’s done, / When the battle’s lost and won” (Act I, Scene I, lines 34–35): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. On setting: A desert place in thunder and lightning: a world out of order before the story begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene I” treats the Witches' riddling world with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “Fair is foul, and foul is fair” (Act I, Scene I, line 43): The play's motto: moral values inverted. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: “When shall we three meet again / In thunder, lightning, or in rain” (Act I, Scene I, lines 32–33): The opening question: a world of storm and repetition. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Act I, Scene I" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Witches' riddling world? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The opening scene establishes a world where appearances deceive and moral categories are reversed. Useful evidence: "When the hurlyburly's done, / When the battle's lost and won" (Act I, Scene I, lines 34–35): Paradox: every battle is lost by someone. Theme link: the first scene announces that nothing will be what it seems. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does the first scene take place?

    A. In a desert place, far from people

    B. In the king's camp near Forres

    C. Inside Macbeth's castle hall

    D. On a ship off the western isles

    Key: A (In a desert place, far from people)

2. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What does the Third Witch's "Anon" mean?

    A. I refuse to go with you

    B. At once, I am coming

    C. Who is calling me?

    D. Let us wait until dawn

    Key: B (At once, I am coming)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] When do the Witches plan to meet again?

    A. At midnight on the next full moon

    B. Before the battle has begun

    C. When the hurlyburly's done

    D. After the king has been crowned

    Key: C (When the hurlyburly's done)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who calls the Witches away at the end of the scene?

    A. Soldiers coming back from the field of battle

    B. The king's own messengers

    C. A storm that drives them off

    D. Their spirits, Graymalkin and Paddock

Key: D (Their spirits, Graymalkin and Paddock)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the summary: the Witches answer one another in turn, so the scene sounds like a magic _____.

   Key: spell

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the Witches do with the air as they leave?

   A. Hover through the fog

   B. Call down rain on the battlefield

   C. Clear it with a wind

   D. Fill it with fire

   Key: A (Hover through the fog)

7. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What does 'hurlyburly' most likely mean here?

   A. A dance the Witches perform

   B. The noise and confusion of battle

   C. A feast held after a victory

   D. A storm at sea that sinks ships

   Key: B (The noise and confusion of battle)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do the Witches end the scene?

   A. They fall asleep on the heath

   B. They argue and split up

   C. They chant together and leave

   D. They greet Macbeth by name

   Key: C (They chant together and leave)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What mood does the first scene create, and how?

   Sample answer: The scene creates a dark, uneasy mood. It opens in a desert place with thunder and lightning, the Witches speak in short, chanting rhymes, and they plan to meet Macbeth when the battle is over. Their final words, about fog and filthy air, leave the audience unsettled and curious.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] What is gained by letting the audience meet the Witches before any human character?

    Sample answer: Opening with the Witches makes the supernatural the first thing the audience sees. Before we meet Macbeth, we learn that strange beings already know his name and plan to meet him, so his story seems watched or shaped from the start. It also sets a mood of storm and mystery for everything that follows.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the Witches' plan to meet after the battle suggest?

    A. They know the fighting will end today

    B. They will take part in the battle themselves

    C. They fear the soldiers

    D. They have lost track of time

    Key: A (They know the fighting will end today)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is paradoxical about 'the battle's lost and won'?

    A. It names the winner too early

B. It joins two opposite outcomes

C. It praises the side that lost

D. It describes two separate battles

Key: B (It joins two opposite outcomes)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What do the Witches' questions at the start show about them?

A. They are confused and have lost their way

B. They are afraid of the storm

C. They plan their actions in advance

D. They wait for orders

Key: C (They plan their actions in advance)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the stage direction at the opening establish before anyone speaks?

A. A crowded and noisy royal court in Forres

B. A quiet church

C. A peaceful camp

D. A wild, stormy world

Key: D (A wild, stormy world)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the sound of the Witches' lines, short and rhyming, set them apart from?

A. The speech of ordinary human characters

B. The marching songs of the soldiers in the camp

C. The prayers of the priests at court

D. The letters read aloud later on

Key: A (The speech of ordinary human characters)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What effect does 'Fair is foul, and foul is fair' have on the audience?

A. It promises the audience a happy ending to come

B. It warns that appearances may deceive

C. It explains the cause of the war

D. It describes the weather as pleasant

Key: B (It warns that appearances may deceive)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why is the setting called 'a desert place' important?

A. It is the site of Duncan's palace

B. It is crowded with the king's soldiers

C. It is lonely and far from order

D. It is a holy place of prayer

Key: C (It is lonely and far from order)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: the Witches' paradox warns that things may not be as they _____.

    Key: appear

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the first scene introduce the theme of appearance and reality?

    Sample answer: The Witches chant that fair is foul and foul is fair, and that the battle will be lost and won. Opposites are joined, so good may look evil and evil may look good. Even the setting, with fog and filthy air, hides things from view. The audience learns to doubt what seems true.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the planned meeting tell us about how the Witches choose their targets?

    Sample answer: The Witches choose a time, after the battle, and a place, upon the heath, to meet Macbeth in particular. They know his name before he has appeared. This suggests that they have a purpose for him and that he will matter to them, though the scene does not say what they want.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What rhythm marks the Witches' speech in this scene?

    A. Short, chanting rhymed lines
    B. Long unrhymed blank verse
    C. Plain prose like everyday talk
    D. Formal sonnets of fourteen lines

    Key: A (Short, chanting rhymed lines)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the opening question 'When shall we three meet again' suggest?

    A. This is the very first time that the three have met
    B. The Witches have met before and will again
    C. They are lost and cannot find each other
    D. They wait for orders from the king

    Key: B (The Witches have met before and will again)

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: the Third Witch says the meeting will happen before the _____ goes down.

    Key: sun

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Witches' calm planning during a war suggest?

    A. They are soldiers waiting for their orders
    B. They fear the outcome
    C. They stand apart from human struggle
    D. They support the king

    Key: C (They stand apart from human struggle)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene's brevity add to its effect?

    A. It explains every detail of the plot
    B. It gives Macbeth plenty of time to speak
    C. It shows that the Witches matter little
    D. It leaves the audience with questions

Key: D (It leaves the audience with questions)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the all-together chant at the end emphasize?

    A. The Witches act as one force

    B. The Witches disagree with each other

    C. The scene is a comic interlude

    D. Macbeth leads the Witches

    Key: A (The Witches act as one force)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does 'fog and filthy air' suggest beyond the weather?

    A. A sign that spring has finally come

    B. Moral confusion and corruption

    C. The smoke of a celebration

    D. A clean break with the past

    Key: B (Moral confusion and corruption)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does it matter that the scene comes before any human character speaks?

    A. It shows that humans will not speak in this play

    B. It means the Witches will narrate everything

    C. It frames the action as watched by dark powers

    D. It reveals the ending of the play before it happens

    Key: C (It frames the action as watched by dark powers)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how sound and rhythm shape the first scene.

    Sample answer: The Witches speak in short, rhymed lines with a heavy beat, such as When shall we three meet again and Fair is foul, and foul is fair. The chanting sounds like a spell, which sets them apart from ordinary speech. Thunder and lightning and the cries of their familiars add to a sound world of storm and magic.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the Witches' closing chant shapes the way the audience reads the rest of the play.

    Sample answer: The line joins opposites, saying that what looks good is bad and what looks bad is good. It warns the audience not to trust surfaces and suggests a world where moral order is turned upside down. Because it comes in the first scene, it works as a lens for reading the characters and events that follow.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the dramatic function of naming Macbeth before he appears?

    A. It links the hero to the Witches from the outset

    B. It shows that the three Witches are his loyal servants

    C. It proves that he has already met them

    D. It reveals that Macbeth is the king

    Key: A (It links the hero to the Witches from the outset)

32. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which device is most prominent in 'When the battle's lost and won'?

    A. Hyperbole

    B. Paradox

C. Simile

D. Apostrophe

Key: B (Paradox)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the setting 'A desert place' contribute to the scene's meaning?

A. A sign that the war is far away

B. A reminder of the court's wealth

C. A space outside human law and order

D. A hint that the Witches are lost and far from home

Key: C (A space outside human law and order)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the Witches' exact timing, before sunset, suggest about their power?

A. They control the outcome of every battle

B. They fear the dark

C. They follow the king's orders

D. They seem to know the future

Key: D (They seem to know the future)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene's ending, 'Exeunt' after a joint chant, shape expectations?

A. It leaves a riddle hanging over what follows

B. It closes the Witches' part in the play for good

C. It resolves the question of the battle

D. It shows the Witches have been defeated

Key: A (It leaves a riddle hanging over what follows)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why might the Witches' trochaic rhythm unsettle an audience used to blank verse?

A. It is too long and slow for anyone to follow easily

B. It sounds like an incantation, not speech

C. It copies the rhythm of royal speech

D. It sounds exactly like the soldiers' songs

Key: B (It sounds like an incantation, not speech)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the claim that the first scene is the play in miniature.

Sample answer: In thirteen lines the scene sets storm and disorder, names Macbeth as the Witches' target, and states the paradox that fair is foul. These elements suggest supernatural influence, moral inversion and a battle that is both lost and won. A strong answer agrees that the scene sets the play's key ideas but notes that it shows no human choices yet.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How might a director stage the first scene to shape the audience's view of the Witches?

Sample answer: A director could use thunder, flashes of light and fog to show a world out of order, and have the Witches

speak in a chant that sounds like a spell. Their familiars could be heard offstage. Choices such as making them eerie or almost comic would change how seriously the audience takes their plan to meet Macbeth.

39. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: the Witches speak in short lines that _____, unlike ordinary speech.

    Key: rhyme

40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the first scene connects the natural world and the moral world.

    Sample answer: The scene opens in thunder and lightning and ends in fog and filthy air, so the weather is wild and murky. The Witches' chant that fair is foul turns moral values upside down. By joining storm and moral confusion, the scene suggests that disorder in nature will mirror disorder in human choices.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 8, analysis 1, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 7, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene I develops the idea of the Witches' riddling world. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act I, Scene I” could deliver about the Witches' riddling world. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Witches' riddling world in “Act I, Scene I”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the Witches' riddling world. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act I, Scene I” could deliver about the Witches' riddling world. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Witches' riddling world in “Act I, Scene I”: each member takes one passage,

quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene I suggests about the Witches' riddling world. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene I" could deliver about the Witches' riddling world. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Witches' riddling world in "Act I, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act I, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the Witches' riddling world. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene I" could deliver about the Witches' riddling world. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Witches' riddling world in "Act I, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *When shall we three meet again In thunder, lightning, or in rain? When the hurlyburly's done, When the battle's lost and won. That will be ere the set of sun. Where the place? Upon the heath. There to meet with Macbeth. I come, Graymalkin! Paddock calls. Anon. Fair is foul, and foul is fair: Hover through the fog and filthy air.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene I"?

   A. Suspicion spoken through irony

   B. The tyrant's weakening grip

   C. The Witches' riddling world

   D. The last false confidence

SAT key: 1. C (The Witches' riddling world)

Lesson 4: Act I, Scene II

Focus: Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act I, Scene II” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (battlefield violence, sexual language): The Captain describes Macbeth cutting a rebel open 'from the nave to the chaps' and fixing his head on the battlements. Keep focus on what the praise says about Macbeth, not the gore. The Captain calls Fortune 'a rebel's whore' (fickle, unfaithful); gloss briefly.
Suggested language: “Why is Macbeth praised for this? What does that tell us about this world?”

Teacher only · spoilers

At a camp near Forres a bleeding Sergeant tells Duncan how 'brave Macbeth' cut the rebel Macdonwald open 'from the nave to the chaps' and, with Banquo, fought on against a fresh Norwegian attack. Ross reports the treachery of the Thane of Cawdor and the victory over Norway. Duncan orders Cawdor's execution and gives his title to Macbeth.

Background: Thanes were Scottish nobles holding land from the king. Rebellion (Macdonwald) and treason by a trusted noble (Cawdor) were real fears; the 1605 Gunpowder Plot was fresh in memory.

Significance: We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition because....
Prompt: Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.

8–13 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (5 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: disbursed — paid out (money); furbish — to polish and make (weapons) ready again; overcharged — loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge; cannons — large guns that fire heavy shot; vantage — an opportunity or advantage. "disbursed": Origin of "disburse": Old French desbourser. "overcharged": Origin of "overcharge": an English formation from over- + charge.
Words: disbursed: paid out (money) · furbish: to polish and make (weapons) ready again · overcharged: loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge · cannons: large guns that fire heavy shot · vantage: an opportunity or advantage

13–18 min · Background and context · I do (5 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Thanes were Scottish nobles holding land from the king. Rebellion (Macdonwald) and treason by a trusted noble (Cawdor) were real fears; the 1605 Gunpowder Plot was fresh in memory. We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor. Characterization: The bleeding Sergeant's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Irony: Duncan gives the traitor Cawdor's title to Macbeth, the next traitor. Imagery: Blood, already: the Sergeant's wounds and Macbeth's sword "which smoked with bloody execution." Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

18–25 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (7 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" slowly and put it in my own words: The wounded Sergeant tells Duncan that brave Macbeth well deserves that name for how he fought. Next, craft. I notice the interruption of his own sentence with a dash, as if he must stop to praise Macbeth. The strongest word is "brave": it is the reputation Macbeth begins with, which makes his fall greater. Then, effect. How does the Sergeant present Macbeth to Duncan? My answer: The Sergeant presents Macbeth to Duncan as a fearless, loyal warrior who carved his way through the rebels; the praise sets up the tragedy, since his courage in battle will become ruthless ambition.

> *For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name (Act I, Scene II, line 64)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" slowly and put it in my own words: The wounded Sergeant tells Duncan that brave Macbeth well deserves that name for how he fought. Next, craft. I notice the interruption of his own sentence with a dash, as if he must stop to praise Macbeth. The strongest word is "brave": it is the reputation Macbeth begins with, which makes his fall greater. Then, effect. How does the Sergeant present Macbeth to Duncan? My answer: The Sergeant presents Macbeth to Duncan as a fearless, loyal warrior who carved his way through the rebels; the praise sets up the tragedy, since his courage in battle will become ruthless ambition.

25–30 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (5 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Lost", "noble" and "won" stand out. Duncan's "lost" and "won" repeat the Witches' riddle, so the honour Macbeth gains already sounds as though it comes from their world. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition? Expected student answer: Duncan rewards Macbeth with what the traitor lost, so the line shows ambition's first prize arriving as a reward for loyal violence; the same title will soon tempt Macbeth toward more.

> *What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won* *(Act I, Scene II, line 123)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Lost", "noble" and "won" stand out. Duncan's "lost" and "won" repeat the Witches' riddle, so the honour Macbeth gains already sounds as though it comes from their world.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition?
Expected student answer: Duncan rewards Macbeth with what the traitor lost, so the line shows ambition's first prize arriving as a reward for loyal violence; the same title will soon tempt Macbeth toward more.

30–35 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. When the text says "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, line 64), it shows this directly. The Sergeant calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. When the text says "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, line 64), it shows this directly. The Sergeant calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.

35–40 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else? Ask: is it unsettling that the hero is introduced through such brutal violence?
Anchor question: Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?
Facilitation: Ask: is it unsettling that the hero is introduced through such brutal violence?

40–47 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. ("For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name", Act I, Scene II, line 64). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. ("For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name", Act I, Scene II, line 64). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

47–50 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Key takeaway: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.

Total: 50 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The bleeding Sergeant's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps."
- **Irony:** Duncan gives the traitor Cawdor's title to Macbeth, the next traitor.
- **Imagery:** Blood, already: the Sergeant's wounds and Macbeth's sword "which smoked with bloody execution."

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition:** Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour; watch how its meaning changes as the play goes on.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, line 64) The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic.
- "Till he unseam'd him from the nave to the chaps" (Act I, Scene II, line 70) Graphic violence praised as service.
- "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" (Act I, Scene II, line 123) Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won."

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king.
Evidence: "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, line 64)
Reasoning: The Sergeant calls him "brave Macbeth" who "unseam'd" the rebel "from the nave to the chaps," and Duncan's "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" echoes the witches, binding Macbeth to Cawdor's treachery.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
disbursed (verb)	paid out (money)	*That now Sweno, the Norways' king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme's inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.*	"disbursed": Origin of "disburse": Old French desbourser. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disburse#Etymology)
furbish (verb)	to polish and make (weapons) ready again	*Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm'd Compell'd these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish'd arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.*	
overcharged (adjective)	loaded with too much powder; here, packed with a double charge	*If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or*	"overcharged": Origin of "overcharge": an English formation from over- + charge. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/overcharge#Etymology)

		memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.	
cannons (noun)	large guns that fire heavy shot	*If I say sooth, I must report they were As cannons overcharged with double cracks, so they Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe: Except they meant to bathe in reeking wounds, Or memorize another Golgotha, I cannot tell.*	
vantage (noun)	an opportunity or advantage	*Mark, king of Scotland, mark: No sooner justice had with valour arm'd Compell'd these skipping kerns to trust their heels, But the Norweyan lord surveying vantage, With furbish'd arms and new supplies of men Began a fresh assault.*	
banners (noun)	flags carried by an army	*From Fife, great king; Where the Norweyan banners flout the sky And fan our people cold.*	
battlements (noun)	the notched wall along the top of a castle	*Till he unseam'd him from the nave to the chaps, / And fix'd his head upon our battlements.*	"battlements": Origin of "battlement": Old French bataillement. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/battlement#Etymology)
pronounce (verb)	to declare or say aloud	*No more that thane of Cawdor shall deceive Our bosom interest: go pronounce his present death, And with his former title greet Macbeth.*	
traitor (noun)	a person who betrays his country	*With terrible numbers, / Assisted by that most disloyal traitor*	

Discussion questions

1. Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Which two captains does the Sergeant compare to 'cannons overcharged with double cracks'? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Macbeth and Banquo.
   Answer guidance: Macbeth and Banquo.
2. Who reports Macbeth's deeds in battle at the start of the scene? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A wounded Sergeant
   Answer guidance: A wounded Sergeant.
3. What does Macbeth do to the rebel Macdonwald? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Cuts him open and fixes his head on the battlements
   Answer guidance: Cuts him open and fixes his head on the battlements.
4. Which noble has betrayed Scotland by helping Norway? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Thane of Cawdor
   Answer guidance: The Thane of Cawdor.
5. What does Duncan order for the Thane of Cawdor? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** His execution
   Answer guidance: His execution.
6. What reward does Duncan give Macbeth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The title Thane of Cawdor
   Answer guidance: The title Thane of Cawdor.
7. Retell the most important events of “Act I, Scene II” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** At a camp near Forres a bleeding Sergeant tells Duncan how 'brave Macbeth' cut the rebel Macdonwald open 'from the nave to the chaps' and, with Banquo, fought on against a fresh Norwegian attack. Ross reports the treachery of the Thane of Cawdor and the victory over Norway. Duncan orders Cawdor's execution and gives his title to Macbeth.
   Answer guidance: At a camp near Forres a bleeding Sergeant tells Duncan how 'brave Macbeth' cut the rebel Macdonwald open 'from the nave to the chaps' and, with Banquo, fought on against a fresh Norwegian attack. Ross reports the treachery of the Thane of Cawdor and the victory over Norway. Duncan orders Cawdor's execution and gives his title to Macbeth.
8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is “Act I, Scene II” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “That now Sweno, the Norways’ king, craves composition; Nor would we deign him burial of his men Till he disbursed at Saint Colme’s inch Ten thousand dollars to our general use.” What does “disbursed” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss

briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** disbursed: paid out (money).
Answer guidance: disbursed: paid out (money).

Inferential / analytical

1. Duncan says 'What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won.' What irony does this line carry for the audience? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Macbeth inherits Cawdor's title and also his treachery.
   Answer guidance: Macbeth inherits Cawdor's title and also his treachery.
2. What does “Act I, Scene II” suggest about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor.
   Answer guidance: We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor. Evidence to accept: “For brave Macbeth —well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, line 64): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of imagery in “Act I, Scene II”. What does it reveal about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, line 70): Graphic violence praised as service. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the characterization in “Act I, Scene II” shape what we understand about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, line 64): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. On characterization: The bleeding Sergeant's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “Doubtful it stood; As…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, line 123): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Duncan's decision to strip Cawdor's title and give it to Macbeth; evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won.”
   Answer guidance: Look for: Duncan's decision to strip Cawdor's title and give it to Macbeth; evidence:

"What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won.". Evidence to accept: "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, line 64): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Act I, Scene II" build on "Act I, Scene I"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: "Till he unseam'd him from the nave to the chaps" (Act I, Scene II, line 70): Graphic violence praised as service. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In "Act I, Scene II", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: "What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won" (Act I, Scene II, line 123): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." On characterization: The bleeding Sergeant's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Is someone who is very good at violence a hero? When does courage become something else?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "Till he unseam'd him from the nave to the chaps" (Act I, Scene II, line 70): Graphic violence praised as service. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does irony appear in "Act I, Scene II", and how does it connect Macbeth's reputation as a warrior to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: "For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name" (Act I, Scene II, line 64): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. On irony: Duncan gives the traitor Cawdor's title to Macbeth, the next traitor. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Duncan trusted Cawdor completely. Is trust a strength or a weakness in a ruler? Judge Duncan. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment about Duncan's trust with evidence from I.ii and I.iv.
   Answer guidance: A judgment about Duncan's trust with evidence from I.ii and I.iv.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): We hear of Macbeth before we see him: a loyal, almost superhuman killer. The scene's dramatic irony is that the title of a traitor passes to the next traitor. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, line 123): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in “Act I, Scene II” acts most wisely in the matter of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, line 64): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. On characterization: The bleeding Sergeant's report presents Macbeth as a ferocious hero who "unseam'd" a rebel "from the nave to the chaps." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, line 70): Graphic violence praised as service. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act I, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, line 123): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act I, Scene II”, with its focus on Macbeth's reputation as a warrior, to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2,

SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, line 64): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in “Act I, Scene II” effective in presenting Macbeth's reputation as a warrior, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, line 70): Graphic violence praised as service. On imagery: Blood, already: the Sergeant's wounds and Macbeth's sword "which smoked with bloody execution." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene II” treats Macbeth's reputation as a warrior with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won” (Act I, Scene II, line 123): Duncan's line echoes the witches' "lost and won." Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act I, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name” (Act I, Scene II, line 64): The play's first description of Macbeth: heroic. Theme link: Macbeth's violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act I, Scene II” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The play first presents Macbeth's violence as heroic, which prepares the shock of seeing it turned against the king. Useful evidence: “Till he unseam’d him from the nave to the chaps” (Act I, Scene II, line 70): Graphic violence praised as service. Theme link: Macbeth's

violence is first shown as loyalty; the same violence will serve ambition. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where is the king's camp in this scene?
   A. Near Forres
   B. On the heath by the sea
   C. Inside Inverness castle
   D. At the western isles

   Key: A (Near Forres)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who brings Duncan the first news of the battle?
   A. Banquo, fresh from the field
   B. A bleeding Sergeant
   C. Lennox, a nobleman of Scotland
   D. The three Witches

   Key: B (A bleeding Sergeant)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which rebel does Macbeth defeat in the Sergeant's report?
   A. Sweno, the Norwegian king
   B. The thane of Ross
   C. Macdonwald
   D. Donalbain, the younger prince

   Key: C (Macdonwald)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens just as the rebels begin to flee?
   A. The king arrives to lead the army
   B. The Witches appear
   C. A storm ends the fighting
   D. The Norwegian lord begins a fresh assault

   Key: D (The Norwegian lord begins a fresh assault)
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Ross's line: “Where the Norweyan banners _____ the sky And fan our people cold”

   Key: flout
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Duncan order for the wounded Sergeant?
   A. Surgeons to treat his wounds
   B. A rest in prison for his news

C. A reward of land in Fife

D. A new horse to return to battle

Key: A (Surgeons to treat his wounds)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] From where does Ross arrive with news?

   A. From England

   B. From Fife

   C. From the western isles

   D. From the heath near the sea

   Key: B (From Fife)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Duncan decide about the traitor who helped Norway?

   A. He is to be sent into exile

   B. He is to be forgiven freely

   C. He is to be put to death

   D. He is to be held for ransom

   Key: C (He is to be put to death)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How is Macbeth described before he ever appears on stage?

   Sample answer: The Sergeant calls him brave Macbeth and says he deserves that name. He describes Macbeth cutting his way through the enemy with a sword that smoked with bloody execution, splitting Macdonwald open and fixing his head on the battlements. Duncan answers, O valiant cousin! worthy gentleman! Macbeth is praised as a fierce, loyal hero.

10. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens to the title of thane of Cawdor in this scene, and why?

    Sample answer: Ross reports that the thane of Cawdor helped the king of Norway against Scotland. Duncan says Cawdor will no longer deceive him, orders his death, and tells Ross to greet Macbeth with the title instead. The title moves from a traitor to the general who has just saved the kingdom.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Sergeant compare the two armies to at first?

    A. Two spent swimmers clinging together

    B. Two eagles fighting in the sky

    C. Two ships that sink in a storm

    D. Two lions guarding the same cave at night

    Key: A (Two spent swimmers clinging together)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Where did the rebel Macdonwald get his soldiers?

    A. From the English court

    B. From the western isles

    C. From Norway's king

    D. From Cawdor's lands

    Key: B (From the western isles)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Duncan's line: “O valiant cousin! worthy _____!”

    Key: gentleman

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In “As sparrows eagles, or the hare the lion”, what is the Sergeant saying?

    A. Macbeth and Banquo fled like small animals

    B. The enemy was as strong as a lion in a rage

    C. The new attack did not frighten them at all

    D. Birds and beasts joined the battle

    Key: C (The new attack did not frighten them at all)

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Why does the Sergeant stop his report?

    A. Duncan tells him to be quiet

    B. Ross interrupts with better news

    C. He forgets what happened next

    D. He is faint from his wounds

    Key: D (He is faint from his wounds)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Lennox notice about Ross as he enters?

    A. The haste in his eyes

    B. The blood on his hands

    C. The crown he is carrying

    D. His fear of the king

    Key: A (The haste in his eyes)

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What must Sweno pay before he may bury his men?

    A. Half of his ships and men

    B. Ten thousand dollars

    C. His crown and his lands

    D. A hostage from his family

    Key: B (Ten thousand dollars)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Duncan mean by 'So well thy words become thee as thy wounds'?

    A. The Sergeant speaks too much for a wounded man

    B. The wounds are worse than the words suggest

    C. His report and his wounds alike show honour

    D. The Sergeant should stop speaking at once

    Key: C (His report and his wounds alike show honour)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the Sergeant's language make the battle vivid?

    Sample answer: He uses comparisons and violent images. The armies are like two spent swimmers that cling together and drown each other. Macbeth's sword smoked with bloody execution, he unseamed Macdonwald from the nave to the chaps, and he and Banquo were like cannons overcharged with double cracks. The images make the fighting loud, bloody and fierce.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this scene show about Duncan as a king?

    Sample answer: Duncan listens closely to the reports, praises his soldiers generously and cares for the wounded Sergeant by

sending for surgeons. He judges quickly, ordering the traitor's death and rewarding Macbeth with his title. He seems grateful and decisive, but the treason of a trusted lord shows that he can be deceived.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What image does the Sergeant use for Fortune in “fortune, on his damned quarrel smiling”?
    A. Fortune smiles on the rebel's cause at first
    B. Fortune weeps for the many men who have fallen
    C. Fortune sleeps through the whole battle
    D. Fortune fights beside the Scottish army

    Key: A (Fortune smiles on the rebel's cause at first)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What contrast does the Sergeant draw in his image of the sun and storms?
    A. Fine weather tends to follow any storm at sea
    B. Hope can give way at once to new danger
    C. The sun guided the army to victory
    D. Storms forced Norway to retreat

    Key: B (Hope can give way at once to new danger)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does 'Bellona's bridegroom' suggest about Macbeth?
    A. He is about to be married
    B. He is a priest of a pagan god
    C. He is a match for the goddess of war
    D. He is a sailor serving in the king's own fleet

    Key: C (He is a match for the goddess of war)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Duncan's line: “What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath _____”

    Key: won

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Why is Duncan's final line ironic for the audience?
    A. It shows that Macbeth has lost the war
    B. It reveals that Duncan is a traitor
    C. It suggests that Cawdor will be pardoned
    D. It echoes the Witches' 'lost and won'

    Key: D (It echoes the Witches' 'lost and won')

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the treason of Cawdor suggest about trust in this kingdom?
    A. Even honoured lords may betray the king
    B. Only foreigners are a danger to Scotland
    C. The king trusts nobody at his court
    D. Treason is rare and quickly forgiven

    Key: A (Even honoured lords may betray the king)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene's structure build Macbeth's reputation?
    A. Macbeth tells the story of his own deeds

B. Two separate reports praise him in turn

C. The Witches describe his fighting

D. Duncan sees the battle for himself

Key: B (Two separate reports praise him in turn)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “memorize another Golgotha” suggest about the battle?

A. It will be forgotten as soon as the fighting ends

B. It was fought in a holy place of peace

C. It was as deadly as the place of the crucifixion

D. It was a small and bloodless fight

Key: C (It was as deadly as the place of the crucifixion)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how violence is presented in this scene.

Sample answer: The scene praises violence as loyal service. Macbeth's sword smoked with bloody execution, he unseamed Macdonwald and fixed his head on the battlements, and he and Banquo seemed to bathe in reeking wounds. Duncan calls him valiant and worthy. Brutal acts are celebrated because they defend the king, which sets up a question about what that skill could do if turned to other ends.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze the role of the Sergeant as a messenger in the scene.

Sample answer: The Sergeant is wounded, so his report carries the weight of someone who has been in the fighting. His long similes and violent images make the battle vivid without showing it on stage. Duncan says his words and wounds both smack of honour. Through him the audience forms its first, heroic view of Macbeth.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the dramatic effect of reporting the battle instead of staging it?

A. Macbeth's legend grows before we meet him

B. The audience learns that the war was lost

C. The king is shown to be a coward

D. The battle seems small and unimportant

Key: A (Macbeth's legend grows before we meet him)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “Like valour’s minion” imply about Macbeth?

A. He is a servant of the rebels

B. He is courage's chosen favourite

C. He fights with no skill at all

D. He is too young to lead an army

Key: B (He is courage's chosen favourite)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which pairing in the scene sets up a contrast the audience will remember?

A. A wise king and a foolish prince

B. A brave rebel and a cowardly king

C. A disloyal thane and a loyal general

D. A Scottish lord and an English earl at war

Key: C (A disloyal thane and a loyal general)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Ross's line: “Till that Bellona’s _____, lapp’d in proof, Confronted him with self-comparisons”

    Key: bridegroom

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] How does Duncan's decision about Cawdor's title create dramatic irony?

    A. Duncan knows that Macbeth is plotting against him

    B. Cawdor will soon return to rescue the king

    C. The title goes to Banquo instead of Macbeth

    D. A traitor's title passes to a man the Witches have marked

    Key: D (A traitor's title passes to a man the Witches have marked)

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What tone does the scene's language mostly carry?

    A. Heroic and bloody

    B. Gentle and calm

    C. Comic and teasing

    D. Sad and regretful

    Key: A (Heroic and bloody)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate how the scene's praise of Macbeth prepares the audience for his later choices.

    Sample answer: The scene builds Macbeth up as brave, loyal and almost superhuman in battle. That reputation makes any fall more shocking, and it raises a question: a man so skilled at killing for the king could also kill for himself. A strong answer notes that the praise is all secondhand and that Duncan's line about lost and won hints at irony.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the imagery of blood and wounds works in the scene.

    Sample answer: Blood appears in the bleeding Sergeant, in Macbeth's sword that smoked with bloody execution and in the image of bathing in reeking wounds. Here blood is a mark of honour; Duncan says the Sergeant's wounds smack of honour. By linking blood with heroism, the scene sets up an image that can later be turned to show guilt instead.

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Ross's report add to the Sergeant's?

    A. A description of the Witches' meeting

    B. News of Norway's defeat and Cawdor's treason

    C. An account of how the young Malcolm was captured

    D. A warning that Macbeth has died

    Key: B (News of Norway's defeat and Cawdor's treason)

40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How do the Sergeant's and Ross's accounts differ in style and content?

    Sample answer: The Sergeant's report is long, wounded and full of similes, describing the fight against Macdonwald and the fresh Norwegian assault. Ross's report is quick and urgent, naming Cawdor's treason and the victory in Fife. Together they move from struggle to triumph and give Duncan the facts that lead to his judgment on Cawdor and his reward to Macbeth.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 9, inference 1, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 0, synthesis 0

HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 1, analysis 8, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 1

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene II develops the idea of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene II" could deliver about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Macbeth's reputation as a warrior in "Act I, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene II" could deliver about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Macbeth's reputation as a warrior in "Act I, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene II suggests about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene II" could deliver about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Macbeth's reputation as a warrior in "Act I, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes

it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act I, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene II" could deliver about Macbeth's reputation as a warrior. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Macbeth's reputation as a warrior in "Act I, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Doubtful it stood; As two spent swimmers, that do cling together And choke their art. The merciless Macdonwald— Worthy to be a rebel, for to that The multiplying villainies of nature Do swarm upon him— from the western isles Of kerns and gallowglasses is supplied; And fortune, on his damned quarrel smiling, Show'd like a rebel's whore: but all's too weak: For brave Macbeth—well he deserves that name— Disdaining fortune, with his brandish'd steel, Which smoked with bloody execution, Like valour's minion carved out his passage Till he faced the slave; Which ne'er shook hands, nor bade farewell to him, Till he unseam'd him from the nave to the chaps, And fix'd his head upon our battlements.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene II"?

   A. Insecurity on the throne

   B. A marriage drifting apart

   C. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

   D. The tyrant's weakening grip

SAT key: 1. C (Macbeth's reputation as a warrior)

Lesson 5: Act I, Scene III

Focus: the Witches' greetings and their pull

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in “Act I, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

On the heath the Witches hail Macbeth as Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor and 'king hereafter', and tell Banquo he will 'get kings, though thou be none.' They vanish. Ross and Angus arrive to tell Macbeth he is now Thane of Cawdor. Macbeth, startled, imagines murder ('horrible imaginings') and decides 'chance may crown me'; Banquo warns that 'instruments of darkness tell us truths' to betray us.

Background: Prophecy was a dangerous subject: predicting a monarch's death could be treason. Banquo's line about 'instruments of darkness' reflects the period's belief that the devil tells half-truths to trap souls.

Significance: The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....*
> **Prompt:** If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: prologues — opening speeches or events that come before the main action; shipman — a sailor; enkindle — to stir up or set on fire (a desire); treasons — acts of betraying one's king or country; soliciting — urging or tempting someone to act. “soliciting”: Origin of “solicit”: Old French soliciter; earlier Latin sollicitō (“stir”).*
> **Words:** prologues: opening speeches or events that come before the main action · shipman: a sailor · enkindle: to stir up or set on fire (a desire) · treasons: acts of betraying one's king or country · soliciting: urging or tempting someone to act

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Prophecy was a dangerous subject: predicting a monarch's death could be treason. Banquo's line about 'instruments of darkness' reflects the period's belief that the devil tells half-truths to trap souls. The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will. Characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Dramatic irony: The audience knows Macbeth is Cawdor before he does; the prophecy's first part comes true at once. Diction / vocabulary: Macbeth's first line echoes the witches: "So foul and fair a day I have not seen." Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "So foul and fair a day I have not seen" slowly and put it in my own words: Returning from battle, Macbeth says he has never seen so foul and fair a day. Next, craft. I notice his words repeat the witches' "fair" and "foul" before he has even met them. The strongest word is "foul": the word links him to the witches' upside-down world. Then, effect. Why does Macbeth's first line echo the witches? My answer: Without knowing it, Macbeth speaks the witches' language; Shakespeare hints that he is already connected to the evil that will tempt him moments later.

> *So foul and fair a day I have not seen (Act I, Scene III, line 164)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "So foul and fair a day I have not seen" slowly and put it in my own words: Returning from battle, Macbeth says he has never seen so foul and fair a day. Next, craft. I notice his words repeat the witches' "fair" and "foul" before he has even met them. The strongest word is "foul": the word links him to the witches' upside-down world. Then, effect. Why does Macbeth's first line echo the witches? My answer: Without knowing it, Macbeth speaks the witches' language; Shakespeare hints that he is already connected to the evil that will tempt him moments later.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Yield", "suggestion" and "horrid image" stand out. Macbeth speaks as if a thought has pushed itself on him, yet he calls the image horrid, so he sees the murder in his own mind and fears it. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected student answer: No Witch tells him to kill; the murderous "suggestion" is Macbeth's own, so the line shows that fate only names the crown and his free choice supplies the crime.

> *why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair* (Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Yield", "suggestion" and "horrid image" stand out. Macbeth speaks as if a thought has pushed itself on him, yet he calls the image horrid, so he sees the murder in his own mind and fears it.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected student answer: No Witch tells him to kill; the murderous "suggestion" is Macbeth's own, so the line shows that fate only names the crown and his free choice supplies the crime.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Witches' greetings and their pull? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of the Witches' greetings and their pull. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. When the text says "why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair" (Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270), it shows this directly. Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Witches' greetings and their pull? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of the Witches' greetings and their pull. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. When the text says "why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair" (Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270), it shows this directly. Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not? Have students compare Banquo's and Macbeth's responses line by line.
Anchor question: If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?
Facilitation: Have students compare Banquo's and Macbeth's responses line by line.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Witches' greetings and their pull? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. ("why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair", Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Witches' greetings and their pull? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. ("why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair", Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the Witches' greetings and their pull. Key takeaway: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder.
- **Dramatic irony:** The audience knows Macbeth is Cawdor before he does; the prophecy's first part comes true at once.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Macbeth's first line echoes the witches: "So foul and fair a day I have not seen."

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "So foul and fair a day I have not seen" (Act I, Scene III, line 164) Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them.
- "oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths" (Act I, Scene III, lines 257–258) Banquo's warning.
- "why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair" (Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270) Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea.
Evidence: "why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair" (Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270)
Reasoning: Banquo warns that "the instruments of darkness tell us truths" to win us "to our harm," while Macbeth asks why he yields "to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair": the "suggestion" of murder comes from within.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
prologues (noun)	opening speeches or events that come before the main action	*Two truths are told, As happy prologues to the swelling act Of the imperial theme.—I thank you, gentlemen.*	
shipman (noun)	a sailor	*I myself have all the other, And the very ports they blow, All the quarters that they know I' the shipman's card.*	
enkindle (verb)	to stir up or set on fire (a desire)	*That trusted home Might yet enkindle you unto the crown, Besides the thane of Cawdor.*	
treasons (noun)	acts of betraying one's king or country	*Whether he was combined With those of Norway, or did line the rebel With hidden help and vantage, or that with both He labour'd in his country's wreck, I know not; But treasons capital, confess'd and proved, Have overthrown him.*	

soliciting (noun)	urging or tempting someone to act	*This supernatural soliciting Cannot be ill, cannot be good: if ill, Why hath it given me earnest of success, Commencing in a truth?*	"soliciting": Origin of "solicit": Old French soliciter; earlier Latin sollicitō ("stir"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/solicit#Etymology)
selfsame (adjective)	exactly the same	*To the selfsame tune and words.*	
chestnuts (noun)	the nuts of the chestnut tree	*A sailor's wife had chestnuts in her lap, And munch'd, and munch'd, and munch'd: —"Give me," quoth I: "Aroint thee, witch!" the rump-fed ronyon cries.*	
smother (verb)	to stifle or suffocate	*Present fears Are less than horrible imaginings: My thought, whose murder yet is but fantastical, Shakes so my single state of man that function Is smother'd in surmise, and nothing is But what is not.*	
prediction (noun)	a statement of what will happen in the future	*My noble partner You greet with present grace and great prediction Of noble having and of royal hope, That he seems rapt withal: to me you speak not.*	
corporal (adjective)	bodily; of the body	*Into the air; and what seem'd corporal melted As breath into the wind.*	"corporal": Origin: Old French corporal; earlier Latin corporālis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/corporal#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth say makes his 'seated heart knock at my ribs'? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The 'horrid image' (suggestion) of murdering the king.
   Answer guidance: The 'horrid image' (suggestion) of murdering the king.

2. What three titles do the Witches give Macbeth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor, and king hereafter

   Answer guidance: Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor, and king hereafter.
3. What do the Witches predict for Banquo? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He will father kings but not be one

   Answer guidance: He will father kings but not be one.
4. Who brings news that Macbeth is Thane of Cawdor? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Ross and Angus

   Answer guidance: Ross and Angus.
5. How does Banquo warn Macbeth about the Witches? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Evil powers tell small truths to betray us in greater things

   Answer guidance: Evil powers tell small truths to betray us in greater things.
6. What does Macbeth say chance may do? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Crown him without his doing anything

   Answer guidance: Crown him without his doing anything.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act I, Scene III" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** On the heath the Witches hail Macbeth as Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor and 'king hereafter', and tell Banquo he will 'get kings, though thou be none.' They vanish. Ross and Angus arrive to tell Macbeth he is now Thane of Cawdor. Macbeth, startled, imagines murder ('horrible imaginings') and decides 'chance may crown me'; Banquo warns that 'instruments of darkness tell us truths' to betray us.

   Answer guidance: On the heath the Witches hail Macbeth as Thane of Glamis, Thane of Cawdor and 'king hereafter', and tell Banquo he will 'get kings, though thou be none.' They vanish. Ross and Angus arrive to tell Macbeth he is now Thane of Cawdor. Macbeth, startled, imagines murder ('horrible imaginings') and decides 'chance may crown me'; Banquo warns that 'instruments of darkness tell us truths' to betray us.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act I, Scene III" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Two truths are told, As happy prologues to the swelling act Of the imperial theme.—I thank you, gentlemen." What does "prologues" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** prologues: opening speeches or events that come before the main action.

    Answer guidance: prologues: opening speeches or events that come before the main action.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth's first line is 'So foul and fair a day I have not seen.' What does the echo of the Witches suggest? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** He is already linked to their inverted world before meeting them.
   Answer guidance: He is already linked to their inverted world before meeting them.
2. Why does Macbeth react with fear while Banquo reacts with curiosity? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** Macbeth's fear suggests the thought of murder was already present.
   Answer guidance: Macbeth's fear suggests the thought of murder was already present.
3. What does “Act I, Scene III” suggest about the Witches' greetings and their pull? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will.
   Answer guidance: The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will. Evidence to accept: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, line 164): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. Find one example of foreshadowing in “Act I, Scene III”. What does it reveal about the Witches' greetings and their pull that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
   Answer guidance: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events. Evidence to accept: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, lines 257–258): Banquo's warning. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
5. How does the characterization in “Act I, Scene III” shape what we understand about the Witches' greetings and their pull? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, line 164): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. On characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that opens with “So foul and fair…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Ross's news that Macbeth is Thane of Cawdor, which makes the first prophecy true and starts his thoughts of murder;

evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion”.

Answer guidance: Look for: Ross's news that Macbeth is Thane of Cawdor, which makes the first prophecy true and starts his thoughts of murder; evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion”. Evidence to accept: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, line 164): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

8. How does “Act I, Scene III” build on “Act I, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, lines 257–258): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. In “Act I, Scene III”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the Witches' greetings and their pull, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. On characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Go back to the bell-ringer question (If a fortune teller's first prediction came true, would you trust the second? Why or why not?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

    Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, lines 257–258): Banquo's warning. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Do the Witches cause Macbeth's crimes, or only reveal what he already wants? Take a position using this scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position on fate versus free will.

   Answer guidance: A defended position on fate versus free will.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The scene splits two responses to the same temptation: Banquo is wary, Macbeth is already thinking of murder. Whether the prophecy causes the crime or reveals a desire already there is the play's central question about fate and free will. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own

imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, lines 257–258): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in “Act I, Scene III” acts most wisely in the matter of the Witches' greetings and their pull, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. On characterization: Macbeth "starts" at the prophecy; Banquo is wary ("instruments of darkness"). Macbeth's asides reveal that he is already imagining murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Witches' greetings and their pull. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, line 164): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act I, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, lines 257–258): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act I, Scene III”, with its focus on the Witches' greetings and their pull, to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the foreshadowing in “Act I, Scene III” effective in presenting the Witches' greetings and their pull, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, line 164): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act I, Scene III” treats the Witches' greetings and their pull with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “oftentimes, to win us to our harm, / The instruments of darkness tell us truths” (Act I, Scene III, lines 257–258): Banquo's warning. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act I, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “why do I yield to that suggestion / Whose horrid image doth unfix my hair” (Act I, Scene III, lines 269–270): Macbeth's aside: the murder is his own thought. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act I, Scene III” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Witches' greetings and their pull? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The prophecy does not tell Macbeth to murder; his own imagination supplies the idea. Useful evidence: “So foul and fair a day I have not seen” (Act I, Scene III, line 164): Macbeth's first words echo the witches, linking him to them. Theme link: the prophecy makes no demand; Macbeth's "horrible imaginings" supply the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where do the Witches meet Macbeth and Banquo?
   A. On a heath near Forres
   B. In the king's camp at night
   C. At the gates of Inverness
   D. In a church by the sea

   Key: A (On a heath near Forres)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What are Macbeth's first words in the play?
   A. Speak, if you can: what are you?
   B. So foul and fair a day I have not seen
   C. Stay, you imperfect speakers, tell me more
   D. Let us toward the king

   Key: B (So foul and fair a day I have not seen)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Banquo ask the Witches about what they are?
   A. Whether they serve the king of Norway
   B. Whether they are sisters
   C. Whether they live or are something else
   D. Whether they have seen the battle

   Key: C (Whether they live or are something else)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say about the thane of Cawdor before Ross arrives?
   A. He died bravely in the battle against Norway
   B. He has fled to England
   C. He is Macbeth's enemy
   D. He still lives and prospers

   Key: D (He still lives and prospers)
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Second Witch's answer: “Killing _____”

   Key: swine
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens when Macbeth demands more answers?
   A. The Witches vanish
   B. The Witches attack him
   C. Banquo sends them away
   D. Ross arrives and they flee

   Key: A (The Witches vanish)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to Angus, what has overthrown the old thane of Cawdor?
   A. A wound he took in the battle with Norway
   B. Treasons, confessed and proved
   C. A sudden fever

D. The Witches' curse

Key: B (Treasons, confessed and proved)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Banquo notice about the Witches' appearance?

   A. They wear tall crowns of gold and of silver

   B. They are dressed as soldiers

   C. They have beards though they seem women

   D. They look young and beautiful

   Key: C (They have beards though they seem women)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How do Macbeth and Banquo react differently to the Witches?

   Sample answer: Macbeth starts and seems to fear the prophecies, then becomes rapt in thought and demands to know more. Banquo questions the Witches boldly, says he neither begs nor fears their favours, and later warns that the instruments of darkness may tell small truths to win people to their harm. Macbeth is drawn in; Banquo stays wary.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What do Macbeth's asides reveal once the second greeting proves true?

    Sample answer: In his asides, Macbeth says two truths have been told, as if the crown were the next step. He wonders whether the Witches' words are good or ill, and admits that a horrid image makes his hair stand on end and his heart knock at his ribs. He then says that if chance will make him king, chance may crown him without his stir.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What has the First Witch done to the sailor's wife's husband?

    A. Planned to toss his ship in storms

    B. Given him a map of the sea and its ports

    C. Saved him from a shipwreck

    D. Turned him into a rat

    Key: A (Planned to toss his ship in storms)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth know about the thane of Glamis title?

    A. It was given to him by Duncan

    B. It came to him by Sinel's death

    C. It belongs to Banquo instead

    D. It was taken from a rebel

    Key: B (It came to him by Sinel's death)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Banquo's line: “The earth hath _____, as the water has”

    Key: bubbles

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth mean by “why do you dress me In borrow’d robes?”

    A. His clothes are torn from the battle

    B. He wants a set of fine new robes from the king himself

    C. The title belongs to another living man

    D. Ross has brought him a costume

    Key: C (The title belongs to another living man)

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Banquo ask after the Witches vanish?

    A. If the Witches will come back tomorrow

    B. If Macbeth has seen them before

    C. If the king has sent them

    D. If they have eaten on the insane root

    Key: D (If they have eaten on the insane root)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does “The greatest is behind” reveal about Macbeth's thinking?

    A. He is already looking toward the crown

    B. He fears losing his new title

    C. He wants to return to the battle

    D. He regrets meeting the Witches

    Key: A (He is already looking toward the crown)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Banquo compare Macbeth's new honours to?

    A. Bright stars shining in a clear winter sky

    B. Strange garments that do not yet fit

    C. Heavy chains on a prisoner

    D. Gold coins in a purse

    Key: B (Strange garments that do not yet fit)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Macbeth excuse his distraction to the others?

    A. He says he is sick and weak from the wounds he took in battle

    B. He blames the noise of the storm

    C. He says his dull brain was full of things forgotten

    D. He says he is tired of Ross

    Key: C (He says his dull brain was full of things forgotten)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Explain Banquo's warning about the instruments of darkness.

    Sample answer: Banquo says that the instruments of darkness often tell us truths to win us to our harm, winning trust with honest trifles in order to betray us in deepest consequence. He means the Witches may have told a small truth, Cawdor, to lead Macbeth toward something dangerous. It shows his caution and acts as a warning to the audience.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does one prophecy coming true change Macbeth's view of the others?

    Sample answer: Ross greets Macbeth as thane of Cawdor, which is exactly what the Second Witch said moments earlier. One prophecy has come true at once, so Macbeth begins to believe the third, that he will be king. His asides show that the news turns the Witches' words from a puzzle into a temptation.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What do the Witches' riddles for Banquo have in common?

    A. Each joins two opposite ideas

    B. Each names a future battle

    C. Each praises Macbeth above him

    D. Each warns him of a danger

Key: A (Each joins two opposite ideas)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why is Macbeth's first line significant?

    A. It shows that he has met the Witches somewhere before

    B. It echoes the Witches' 'Fair is foul'

    C. It proves he is a poet at heart

    D. It praises the weather after war

    Key: B (It echoes the Witches' 'Fair is foul')

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Banquo's line: “Look, how our partner’s _____”

    Key: rapt

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What paradox does Macbeth state in “This supernatural soliciting Cannot be ill, cannot be good”?

    A. The Witches are neither male nor female

    B. Glamis and Cawdor are the same place

    C. The prophecy seems both good and bad at once

    D. Banquo is both friend and enemy

    Key: C (The prophecy seems both good and bad at once)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does “Present fears Are less than horrible imaginings” suggest?

    A. He fears the next battle more than anything else he can name

    B. He imagines the Witches will return

    C. He is afraid of Ross and Angus

    D. His own thoughts frighten him more than real danger

    Key: D (His own thoughts frighten him more than real danger)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the First Witch's curse on the sailor show about the Witches' power?

    A. They can torment but not destroy

    B. They can kill anyone they choose

    C. They have no power over the sea

    D. They obey the sailor's wife

    Key: A (They can torment but not destroy)

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's aside 'Come what come may' suggest about his state of mind?

    A. He has decided to act at once

    B. He tries to leave the future to time

    C. He plans to tell Banquo everything

    D. He wants to forget the Witches

    Key: B (He tries to leave the future to time)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “nothing is But what is not” express?

    A. Nothing in the world can be trusted

B. The Witches were not really there on the heath at all

C. Imagined things feel more real than the present

D. Macbeth has lost all memory

Key: C (Imagined things feel more real than the present)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the scene uses asides to reveal Macbeth's mind.

    Sample answer: While Ross, Angus and Banquo talk, Macbeth speaks asides that only the audience hears. He says two truths are told as happy prologues to the imperial theme, admits that a horrid image makes his heart knock at his ribs, and wonders if chance will crown him without his stir. The asides show a hidden inner life of ambition and fear behind his polite words.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how the scene contrasts Macbeth and Banquo.

    Sample answer: Both hear prophecies, but Macbeth starts, becomes rapt and turns to private thoughts of the crown, while Banquo speaks openly, says he neither begs nor fears the Witches, and warns that the instruments of darkness tell truths to betray us. Banquo's honest questions highlight the secret and troubled direction of Macbeth's mind.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of the Witches' charm ending just as Macbeth arrives?

    A. It suggests a trap set for him

    B. It shows the Witches fear him

    C. It marks the end of their power

    D. It means the meeting is chance

    Key: A (It suggests a trap set for him)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Macbeth's 'horrid image' speech complicate the idea that the prophecy alone drives him?

    A. The Witches have ordered him plainly to kill the king

    B. The murderous thought comes from his own mind

    C. Banquo suggests the crime to him

    D. Ross reveals Duncan's weakness

    Key: B (The murderous thought comes from his own mind)

33. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Banquo's line: “What, can the devil speak _____?”

    Key: true

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “Two truths are told, As happy prologues to the swelling act Of the imperial theme” suggest about how Macbeth sees events?

    A. As a song in honour of Duncan

    B. As a battle that is not yet won

    C. As a play building toward kingship

    D. As a dream he will soon forget

    Key: C (As a play building toward kingship)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the image of “the seeds of time” suggest about Banquo's view of prophecy?

    A. Time stands still on the heath

B. The past cannot be changed at all

C. The Witches plant crops in spring

D. The future grows from present causes

Key: D (The future grows from present causes)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which shift in Macbeth's asides is most important?

A. From hope of the crown to fear of his own thoughts

B. From love of Banquo to a sudden, open hatred of him

C. From fear of Ross to trust in Angus

D. From doubt about Glamis to certainty

Key: A (From hope of the crown to fear of his own thoughts)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the Witches cause Macbeth's thoughts in this scene.

Sample answer: The Witches only greet him with titles; they make no demand. Yet Macbeth starts as if he fears words that sound so fair, and soon speaks of a horrid image and a thought whose murder is but fantastical. A strong answer argues that the Witches provoke the idea but the murderous thought comes from Macbeth, while noting Banquo's warning about being betrayed by truths.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the clothing imagery in the scene.

Sample answer: Macbeth asks why they dress him in borrowed robes when the thane of Cawdor lives, and Banquo says new honours are like strange garments that do not fit until worn for a while. The images suggest that titles are like clothes that can be put on, and they hint that Macbeth's honours may not belong to him naturally.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which of the Witches' greetings to Banquo plays on happiness?

A. Lesser than Macbeth, and greater

B. Not so happy, yet much happier

C. Thrice to thine and thrice to mine

D. Hail to thee, thane of Glamis

Key: B (Not so happy, yet much happier)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene balance the supernatural and the political?

Sample answer: It opens with the Witches' charms and curses on a heath, then moves to the court's world when Ross and Angus bring the king's news about Cawdor's treason. The two worlds meet when the political news confirms a prophecy. A strong answer shows how Macbeth's asides join the supernatural promise to ambitions about the crown.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 1, analysis 8, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene III develops the idea of the Witches' greetings and their pull. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene III" could deliver about the Witches' greetings and their pull. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Witches' greetings and their pull in "Act I, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the Witches' greetings and their pull. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene III" could deliver about the Witches' greetings and their pull. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Witches' greetings and their pull in "Act I, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene III suggests about the Witches' greetings and their pull. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene III" could deliver about the Witches' greetings and their pull. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Witches' greetings and their pull in "Act I, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses foreshadowing in Act I, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the Witches' greetings and their pull. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene III" could deliver about the Witches' greetings and their pull. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the Witches' greetings and their pull in "Act I, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *So foul and fair a day I have not seen. How far is't call'd to Forres? What are these So wither'd and so wild in their attire, That look not like the inhabitants o' the earth, And yet are on't? Live you? or are you aught That man may question? You seem to understand me, By each at once her chappy finger laying Upon her skinny lips: you should be women, And yet your beards forbid me to interpret That you are so. Speak, if you can: what are you? All hail, Macbeth! hail to thee, thane of Glamis! All hail, Macbeth, hail to thee, thane of Cawdor! All hail, Macbeth, thou shalt be king hereafter!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene III"?

   A. Hecate and the machinery of fate

   B. The Witches' greetings and their pull

   C. The last false confidence

   D. Lady Macbeth's resolve

SAT key: 1. B (The Witches' greetings and their pull)

Lesson 6: Act I, Scene IV

Focus: the hidden mind behind a loyal face

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act I, Scene IV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Malcolm reports that Cawdor died nobly, confessing his treason. Duncan reflects 'There's no art to find the mind's construction in the face' just as Macbeth enters. He thanks Macbeth and Banquo, then names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland, his heir. Macbeth, aside, sees Malcolm as a step he must 'o'erleap' and asks the stars to hide his 'black and deep desires.' Duncan will visit Macbeth's castle at Inverness.

Background: Scottish kingship was not strictly hereditary at this time; naming Malcolm Prince of Cumberland made him heir and closed Macbeth's lawful path to the throne.

Significance: Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....*
> **Prompt:** Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: harbinger — a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming; peerless — without equal; recompense — reward or repayment; ingratitude — failure to show thanks; overtake — to catch up with.*
> *“recompense”: Origin: Old French recompense. “ingratitude”: Origin: Old French ingratitude; earlier Late Latin ingrātitūdō.*
> **Words:** harbinger: a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming · peerless: without equal · recompense: reward or repayment · ingratitude: failure to show thanks · overtake: to catch up with

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Scottish kingship was not strictly hereditary at this time; naming Malcolm Prince of Cumberland made him heir and closed Macbeth's lawful path to the throne. Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime. Dramatic irony: Duncan says of Cawdor, "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face," just as Macbeth enters. Characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Imagery: "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires." Watch for darkness and light: Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" slowly and put it in my own words: Speaking of the traitor Cawdor, Duncan says there is no art to find the mind's construction in the face. Next, craft. I notice the irony: he says this just before Macbeth, the next traitor, enters. The strongest word is "face": it names the surface that hides a person's real thoughts. Then, effect. What does Duncan say about reading people's faces? My answer: Duncan says there is no art to read people's faces, because he trusted the traitor Cawdor; he is fatally wrong again, since he is about to give the same trust to Macbeth, who will murder him.

> *There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face (Act I, Scene IV, lines 310–311)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" slowly and put it in my own words: Speaking of the traitor Cawdor, Duncan says there is no art to find the mind's construction in the face. Next, craft. I notice the irony: he says this just before Macbeth, the next traitor, enters. The strongest word is "face": it names the surface that hides a person's real thoughts. Then, effect. What does Duncan say about reading people's faces? My answer: Duncan says there is no art to read people's faces, because he trusted the traitor Cawdor; he is fatally wrong again, since he is about to give the same trust to Macbeth, who will murder him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Stars", "fires" and "black and deep desires" stand out. Macbeth asks the light itself to go out so that no one, not even heaven, can see the wish he is hiding. Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality? Expected student answer: Macbeth has just knelt to Duncan as a loyal subject, and here he asks the stars to hide what he really wants, so the line sets a loyal face against a hidden, disloyal mind.

> *Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires (Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Stars", "fires" and "black and deep desires" stand out. Macbeth asks the light itself to go out so that no one, not even heaven, can see the wish he is hiding.
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality?
Expected student answer: Macbeth has just knelt to Duncan as a loyal subject, and here he asks the stars to hide what he really wants, so the line sets a loyal face against a hidden, disloyal mind.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. When the text says "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires" (Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356), it shows this directly. Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires."
Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. When the text says "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires" (Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356), it shows this directly. Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example. Ask: is Duncan naive, or is trust a virtue the play wants us to value?
Anchor question: Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.
Facilitation: Ask: is Duncan naive, or is trust a virtue the play wants us to value?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. ("Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires", Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. ("Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires", Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Key takeaway: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Duncan says of Cawdor, "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face," just as Macbeth enters.
- **Characterization:** Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap."
- **Imagery:** "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires."

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** the loyal face hides the disloyal mind.

Symbols and motifs

- **darkness and light:** Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" (Act I, Scene IV, lines 310–311) Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters.
- "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires" (Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356) Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery.
- "that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o'erleap" (Act I, Scene IV, line 354) Malcolm as an obstacle.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face.
Evidence: "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires" (Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356)
Reasoning: Duncan says "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" moments before praising Macbeth, whose aside begs "Stars, hide your fires."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
harbinger (noun)	a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming	*The rest is labour, which is not used for you: I'll be myself the harbinger and make joyful The hearing of my wife with your approach; So humbly take my leave.*	
peerless (adjective)	without equal	*Let's after him, Whose care is gone before to bid us welcome: It is a peerless kinsman.*	
recompense (noun)	reward or repayment	*The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To overtake thee.*	"recompense": Origin: Old French recompense. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/recompense#Etymology)
ingratitude (noun)	failure to show thanks	*The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To overtake thee.*	"ingratitude": Origin: Old French ingratitude; earlier Late Latin ingrātitūdō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ingratitude#Etymology)
overtake (verb)	to catch up with	*The sin of my ingratitude even now Was heavy on me: thou art so far before That swiftest wing of recompense is slow To overtake thee.*	
kinsman (noun)	a male relative	*Let's after him, Whose care is gone before to bid us welcome: It is a peerless kinsman.*	

highness (noun)	a title of respect used to address a king	*Your highness' part Is to receive our duties; and our duties Are to your throne and state children and servants, Which do but what they should, by doing every thing Safe toward your love and honour.*	
hereafter (adverb)	later; at some future time	*We will establish our estate upon / Our eldest, Malcolm, whom we name hereafter*	

Discussion questions

1. Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Complete Duncan's line about the old Cawdor: 'He was a gentleman on whom I built…' [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** '…an absolute trust.'
   Answer guidance: '…an absolute trust.'.
2. How did the old Thane of Cawdor die, according to Malcolm? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Nobly, confessing his treasons
   Answer guidance: Nobly, confessing his treasons.
3. What title does Duncan give Malcolm? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Prince of Cumberland
   Answer guidance: Prince of Cumberland.
4. Why is Malcolm's new title a problem for Macbeth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It makes Malcolm the heir and blocks Macbeth's path
   Answer guidance: It makes Malcolm the heir and blocks Macbeth's path.
5. What does Macbeth ask the stars to do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Hide their fires so no one sees his dark desires
   Answer guidance: Hide their fires so no one sees his dark desires.
6. Where will Duncan go next? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To Macbeth's castle at Inverness
   Answer guidance: To Macbeth's castle at Inverness.

7. Retell the most important events of “Act I, Scene IV” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Malcolm reports that Cawdor died nobly, confessing his treason. Duncan reflects 'There's no art to find the mind's construction in the face' just as Macbeth enters. He thanks Macbeth and Banquo, then names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland, his heir. Macbeth, aside, sees Malcolm as a step he must 'o'erleap' and asks the stars to hide his 'black and deep desires.' Duncan will visit Macbeth's castle at…

   Answer guidance: Malcolm reports that Cawdor died nobly, confessing his treason. Duncan reflects 'There's no art to find the mind's construction in the face' just as Macbeth enters. He thanks Macbeth and Banquo, then names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland, his heir. Macbeth, aside, sees Malcolm as a step he must 'o'erleap' and asks the stars to hide his 'black and deep desires.' Duncan will visit Macbeth's castle at…
8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene IV”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is “Act I, Scene IV” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “The rest is labour, which is not used for you: I’ll be myself the harbinger and make joyful The hearing of my wife with your approach; So humbly take my leave.” What does “harbinger” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** harbinger: a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming.

    Answer guidance: harbinger: a messenger sent ahead to announce someone's coming.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is it ironic that Macbeth enters right after Duncan's line about reading faces? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Duncan is about to trust another hidden traitor.

   Answer guidance: Duncan is about to trust another hidden traitor.
2. What does “Act I, Scene IV” suggest about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime.

   Answer guidance: Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime. Evidence to accept: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, lines 310–311): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of irony in “Act I, Scene IV”. What does it reveal about the hidden mind behind a loyal face that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

Answer guidance: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true. Evidence to accept: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the imagery in “Act I, Scene IV” shape what we understand about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, lines 310–311): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. On imagery: "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “Is execution done on…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, line 354): Malcolm as an obstacle. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland, a step Macbeth must now “o'erleap”; evidence: “Stars, hide your fires”.
   Answer guidance: Look for: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland, a step Macbeth must now “o'erleap”; evidence: “Stars, hide your fires”. Evidence to accept: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, lines 310–311): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Act I, Scene IV” build on “Act I, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Act I, Scene IV”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the hidden mind behind a loyal face, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, line 354): Malcolm as an obstacle. On characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Can you tell what someone is really thinking from their face? Give an example.?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires” (Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does characterization appear in “Act I, Scene IV”, and how does it connect the hidden mind behind a loyal face to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, lines 310–311): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. On characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Was naming an heir at this moment a wise political move by Duncan? Argue from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Evaluation of Duncan's timing and judgment.
   Answer guidance: Evaluation of Duncan's timing and judgment.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Dramatic irony peaks: Duncan says faces cannot be read at the moment a new traitor walks in. Macbeth's 'Stars, hide your fires' begins the play's imagery of darkness covering crime. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o’erleap” (Act I, Scene IV, line 354): Malcolm as an obstacle. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act I, Scene IV” acts most wisely in the matter of the hidden mind behind a loyal face, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: “There’s no art / To find the mind’s construction in the face” (Act I, Scene IV, lines 310–311): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. On characterization: Duncan names Malcolm Prince of Cumberland (heir); Macbeth's aside calls it a step he must "o'erleap." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Act I, Scene IV". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires" (Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Act I, Scene IV": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: "that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o'erleap" (Act I, Scene IV, line 354): Malcolm as an obstacle. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Act I, Scene IV", with its focus on the hidden mind behind a loyal face, to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" (Act I, Scene IV, lines 310–311): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in "Act I, Scene IV" effective in presenting the hidden mind behind a loyal face, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires" (Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act I, Scene IV" treats the hidden mind behind a loyal face with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: "that is a step / On which I must fall down, or else o'erleap" (Act I, Scene IV, line 354): Malcolm as an obstacle. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act I, Scene V" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: "There's no art / To find the mind's construction in the face" (Act I, Scene IV, lines 310–311): Duncan's lesson about Cawdor, ironic as Macbeth enters. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Act I, Scene IV" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the hidden mind behind a loyal face? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene shows Macbeth already hiding murderous thoughts behind a loyal face. Useful evidence: "Stars, hide your fires; / Let not light see my black and deep desires" (Act I, Scene IV, lines 355–356): Macbeth's aside: darkness imagery. Theme link: the loyal face hides the disloyal mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Act I, Scene IV take place?
   A. The palace at Forres
   B. A lonely heath far from any town
   C. Macbeth's castle
   D. A camp by the sea

   Key: A (The palace at Forres)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who reports how the old thane of Cawdor died?
   A. Lennox
   B. Malcolm
   C. Ross
   D. Donalbain

   Key: B (Malcolm)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How did the old thane of Cawdor face his death?
   A. He fought the guards and tried to flee

B. He cursed the king

C. He confessed and repented

D. He blamed Macbeth

Key: C (He confessed and repented)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Duncan name Prince of Cumberland?

   A. Macbeth, his worthiest cousin

   B. Banquo, his general

   C. Donalbain, his younger son

   D. Malcolm, his eldest son

   Key: D (Malcolm, his eldest son)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Duncan's line: “It is a _____ to me”

   Key: banquet

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who enters with Macbeth to meet the king?

   A. Banquo, Ross and Angus

   B. The three Witches, unseen

   C. Lady Macbeth and her women

   D. The old thane of Cawdor

   Key: A (Banquo, Ross and Angus)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Macbeth leave ahead of the king?

   A. To rest after the long and bloody battle

   B. To tell his wife of the king's coming

   C. To fight the Norwegians again

   D. To find the Witches

   Key: B (To tell his wife of the king's coming)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Duncan greet Macbeth when he enters?

   A. Welcome, thane of Glamis and of Cawdor both!

   B. Hail, king that shalt be!

   C. O worthiest cousin!

   D. Where have you been?

   Key: C (O worthiest cousin!)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] What makes Macbeth's entrance at this moment so pointed?

   Sample answer: Duncan says there is no art to find the mind's construction in the face and that he built an absolute trust on the traitor Cawdor. At that moment Macbeth, the new Cawdor, walks in, and Duncan greets him warmly. The audience knows from Macbeth's asides that he has had dark thoughts, so Duncan is again trusting a face he cannot read.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What wish does Macbeth express in his aside after the royal announcement?

    Sample answer: In an aside, Macbeth calls it a step on which he must fall down or else o'erleap, because it lies in his way. He begs the stars to stop shining so that light will not see his black and deep desires. He sees Malcolm as an obstacle and wants his wishes kept secret, even from himself.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Malcolm mean by "Nothing in his life Became him like the leaving it"?
    A. Cawdor died more nobly than he lived
    B. Cawdor's life was full of honour
    C. Cawdor refused to die quietly
    D. Cawdor left Scotland before dying

    Key: A (Cawdor died more nobly than he lived)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Duncan mean by "There's no art To find the mind's construction in the face"?
    A. Painters cannot capture a true likeness of any face
    B. You cannot read a person's thoughts in their face
    C. Faces show every secret plainly
    D. Only artists understand people

    Key: B (You cannot read a person's thoughts in their face)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What image does Duncan use for rewarding Macbeth?
    A. Building him a great castle of stone
    B. Crowning him with laurel leaves
    C. Planting him and making him grow
    D. Lighting a lamp in his honour

    Key: C (Planting him and making him grow)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Banquo's reply: "There if I grow, The _____ is your own"

    Key: harvest

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Macbeth describe his service to Duncan?
    A. A debt that Duncan must now repay him in full
    B. A burden he hopes to give up
    C. Work done for honour and gold
    D. Loyalty that pays itself in the doing

    Key: D (Loyalty that pays itself in the doing)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Duncan compare signs of nobleness to?
    A. Stars shining on all deservers
    B. Seeds planted in a field in spring
    C. Gold in a chest
    D. Flags over a castle

    Key: A (Stars shining on all deservers)

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Duncan show his feelings toward Banquo?
    A. He gives him a title of his own
    B. He embraces him and holds him to his heart
    C. He sends him away to Fife

D. He ignores him in favour of his cousin Macbeth

Key: B (He embraces him and holds him to his heart)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Duncan say about Macbeth after he leaves?

A. He is too ambitious

B. He rides too slowly

C. It is a peerless kinsman

D. He must be watched

Key: C (It is a peerless kinsman)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Duncan's naming of Malcolm as Prince of Cumberland change for Macbeth?

Sample answer: Duncan declares that his eldest son will inherit the throne. This means the crown will not simply come to Macbeth by chance. Macbeth's aside calls the title a step he must fall down on or o'erleap, so the news turns the hope from the Witches into something that would require action.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Duncan's language of thanks show about him as a king?

Sample answer: Duncan says he cannot repay Macbeth enough, that more is his due than all can pay. He promises to plant him and make him grow, embraces Banquo, and says signs of nobleness will shine like stars on all deservers. He even honours Macbeth by choosing to be his guest.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Why does Duncan's comment about Cawdor's face create dramatic irony?

A. The next man he trusts is entering as he speaks

B. He has just learned that Banquo is a secret traitor

C. He suspects Macbeth of plotting

D. He is speaking of his own son

Key: A (The next man he trusts is entering as he speaks)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “Stars, hide your fires; Let not light see my black and deep desires” show?

A. Macbeth fears that night will fall soon

B. Macbeth wants his wishes kept in darkness

C. Macbeth prays to the stars for luck

D. Macbeth loves the light of the stars

Key: B (Macbeth wants his wishes kept in darkness)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “The eye wink at the hand” suggest?

A. He plans to signal to his wife

B. He is too tired to stay awake

C. He wants not to see what his hand will do

D. He hopes that Duncan will not notice him leaving early

Key: C (He wants not to see what his hand will do)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Duncan's line: “My plenteous joys, Wanton in _____, seek to hide themselves In drops of sorrow”

    Key: fulness

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macbeth's public speech contrast with his aside?

    A. His speech is angry, his aside calm

    B. He praises Malcolm in both

    C. He refuses the king in public

    D. Loyal words hide dark desires

    Key: D (Loyal words hide dark desires)

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Duncan's 'My plenteous joys... seek to hide themselves In drops of sorrow' describe?

    A. Tears of happiness

    B. Grief for the dead in battle

    C. Fear of the coming night

    D. Anger at Cawdor's treason

    Key: A (Tears of happiness)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the growth imagery suggest about Duncan's kingship?

    A. He wants to own more farmland

    B. He sees himself as nurturing his subjects

    C. He fears that his subjects will grow too strong for him

    D. He prefers peace to war

    Key: B (He sees himself as nurturing his subjects)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What makes Duncan's last line about Macbeth ironic?

    A. He forgets Macbeth's name

    B. He praises Banquo instead

    C. He calls him peerless after his dark aside

    D. He knows Macbeth's thoughts

    Key: C (He calls him peerless after his dark aside)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze how the scene links Cawdor and Macbeth.

    Sample answer: Malcolm describes Cawdor's noble death, and Duncan says he built an absolute trust on a man whose face hid treason. Macbeth, who has just been given Cawdor's title, enters at once and receives the same trust. The audience has heard his dark asides, so the scene suggests that the title of traitor may pass along with the land.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the light and dark imagery in Macbeth's aside.

    Sample answer: Macbeth calls on the stars to hide their fires so that light will not see his black and deep desires, and asks the eye to wink at the hand. Light stands for truth and goodness, darkness for hidden wishes. He wants his desires to work in darkness, even unseen by his own eyes, which shows guilt before any act.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the dramatic function of Malcolm's account of Cawdor's death?

    A. It sets a model of repentance against Macbeth's path

B. It shows Malcolm as cruel and cold

C. It reveals Cawdor was innocent

D. It explains at last why the king of Norway attacked Scotland

Key: A (It sets a model of repentance against Macbeth's path)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Duncan's naming of Malcolm turn the prophecy into a problem for Macbeth?

A. Malcolm will marry Lady Macbeth

B. Succession now blocks the way to the crown

C. Macbeth is named heir instead

D. Duncan decides to give up the throne at once

Key: B (Succession now blocks the way to the crown)

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which word best describes Macbeth's language to Duncan?

A. Openly defiant

B. Plain and blunt

C. Formally dutiful

D. Comically flattering

Key: C (Formally dutiful)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Duncan's line: "I have begun to _____ thee, and will labour To make thee full of growing"

Key: plant

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Banquo's reply 'The harvest is your own' show by contrast with Macbeth?

A. He wants the crown for himself

B. He mocks the king's promise

C. He refuses to be thanked

D. He returns any reward to the king

Key: D (He returns any reward to the king)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the couplet "yet let that be, Which the eye fears, when it is done, to see" end the aside?

A. With a wish that the deed be done anyway

B. With a firm decision not to act at all, whatever happens

C. With a prayer for forgiveness

D. With a plan to flee Scotland

Key: A (With a wish that the deed be done anyway)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Duncan's judgment as a king in this scene.

Sample answer: Duncan admits he misjudged Cawdor and says faces cannot reveal minds, yet he immediately trusts Macbeth with lavish praise and a royal visit. He names an heir publicly, which is prudent, but his generosity makes him vulnerable. A strong answer weighs his virtues as a grateful ruler against his failure to learn from Cawdor.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze how the scene uses the gap between what characters say and what the audience knows.

Sample answer: Duncan praises Macbeth as worthiest cousin and peerless kinsman; Macbeth speaks of loyalty that pays itself. Yet in his aside he calls Malcolm a step to o'erleap and asks the stars to hide his black desires. The audience hears both, so every warm word becomes ironic and the scene builds suspense about what Macbeth will do.

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the timing of Duncan's visit to Inverness add to the scene?
    A. It removes Duncan from danger
    B. It brings the king into Macbeth's home
    C. It sends Macbeth into exile
    D. It delays the next meeting with the Witches

    Key: B (It brings the king into Macbeth's home)

40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Compare the images of growth and darkness in the scene.
    Sample answer: Duncan speaks of planting Macbeth and making him full of growing, and Banquo replies that the harvest is the king's. Macbeth, in contrast, speaks of hiding desires from light. Growth suggests natural, shared reward; darkness suggests secret, selfish desire. The contrast sets the king's order against Macbeth's hidden wishes.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 1, analysis 8, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 1

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene IV develops the idea of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act I, Scene IV” could deliver about the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the hidden mind behind a loyal face in “Act I, Scene IV”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene IV" could deliver about the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the hidden mind behind a loyal face in "Act I, Scene IV": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene IV suggests about the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene IV" could deliver about the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the hidden mind behind a loyal face in "Act I, Scene IV": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act I, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene IV" could deliver about the hidden mind behind a loyal face. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the hidden mind behind a loyal face in "Act I, Scene IV": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Is execution done on Cawdor? Are not Those in commission yet return'd? My liege, They are not yet come back. But I have spoke With one that saw him die: who did report That very frankly he confess'd his treasons, Implored your highness' pardon and set forth A deep repentance: nothing in his life Became him like the leaving it; he died As one that had been studied in his death To throw away the dearest thing he owed, As 'twere a careless trifle. There's no art To find the mind's construction in the face: He was a gentleman on whom I built An absolute trust.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene IV"?

A. The murder of the innocent

B. Lady Macbeth's resolve

C. The last false confidence

D. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

SAT key: 1. D (The hidden mind behind a loyal face)

Lesson 7: Act I, Scene V

Focus: Lady Macbeth's resolve

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act I, Scene V” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter about the prophecies and fears his nature is 'too full o' the milk of human kindness.' Hearing that Duncan will stay the night, she calls on spirits to 'unsex me here' and fill her with cruelty, and asks thick night to hide her knife. Macbeth arrives; she tells him to 'look like the innocent flower, but be the serpent under't' and to leave the business to her.

Background: Early modern ideas of gender linked women with pity and nursing and men with violence; Lady Macbeth's invocation deliberately reverses those expectations. Calling on spirits echoed what the witchcraft laws punished.

Significance: Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because....*
> **Prompt:** Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary · We do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context.
> *Today's words: chastise — to drive off by scolding; to punish with words; murdering — that kill; deadly; beguile — to deceive; to fool; dispatch — prompt handling or management of a task; substances — bodies or forms.*
> **Words:** chastise: to drive off by scolding; to punish with words · murdering: that kill; deadly · beguile: to deceive; to fool · dispatch: prompt handling or management of a task · substances: bodies or forms

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Early modern ideas of gender linked women with pity and nursing and men with violence; Lady Macbeth's invocation deliberately reverses those expectations. Calling on spirits echoed what the witchcraft laws punished. Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan. Characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Imagery: Milk vs. gall, light vs. "thick night": the imagery of nurturing turned to poison. Soliloquy: Her speeches reveal resolve and fear of her own pity. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way" slowly and put it in my own words: Reading his letter, Lady Macbeth fears Macbeth is too full of the milk of human kindness to take the quickest path to the crown. Next, craft. I notice the image of milk, nourishment associated with mothers and gentleness. The strongest word is "kindness": it means natural human feeling, which she sees as weakness. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth fear about her husband's nature? My answer: She believes Macbeth is too gentle to murder; she resolves to push him, and later calls on spirits to "unsex" her, rejecting her own nurturing nature.

> *It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way* (Act I, Scene V, lines 369–370)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way" slowly and put it in my own words: Reading his letter, Lady Macbeth fears Macbeth is too full of the milk of human kindness to take the quickest path to the crown. Next, craft. I notice the image of milk, nourishment associated with mothers and gentleness. The strongest word is "kindness": it means natural human feeling, which she sees as weakness. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth fear about her husband's nature? My answer: She believes Macbeth is too gentle to murder; she resolves to push him, and later calls on spirits to "unsex" her, rejecting her own nurturing nature.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Innocent flower" and "serpent" stand out. The flower is the welcoming face and the serpent the danger hidden beneath it, so Lady Macbeth teaches her husband to deceive. Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected student answer: Lady Macbeth takes charge by teaching the deception, so the line shows her power coming from cunning and control, the qualities she has asked the spirits to give her in place of tenderness.

> *look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under't (Act I, Scene V, lines 427–428)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Innocent flower" and "serpent" stand out. The flower is the welcoming face and the serpent the danger hidden beneath it, so Lady Macbeth teaches her husband to deceive.
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected student answer: Lady Macbeth takes charge by teaching the deception, so the line shows her power coming from cunning and control, the qualities she has asked the spirits to give her in place of tenderness.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. When the text says "Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here" (Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398), it shows this directly. She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. When the text says "Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here" (Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398), it shows this directly. She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want? Ask: does Lady Macbeth really lack pity? Look for cracks later (II.ii).
Anchor question: Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?
Facilitation: Ask: does Lady Macbeth really lack pity? Look for cracks later (II.ii).

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. ("Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here", Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. ("Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here", Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Lady Macbeth's resolve. Key takeaway: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here."
- **Imagery:** Milk vs. gall, light vs. "thick night": the imagery of nurturing turned to poison.
- **Soliloquy:** Her speeches reveal resolve and fear of her own pity.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way" (Act I, Scene V, lines 369–370) Her judgment of her husband.
- "Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here" (Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398) Her invocation.
- "look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under't" (Act I, Scene V, lines 427–428) Appearance and reality.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity.
Evidence: "Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here" (Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398)
Reasoning: She fears her husband is "too full o' the milk of human kindness" and calls on spirits to "unsex me here," linking kindness to womanhood and cruelty to power.

Vocabulary

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context
chastise (verb)	to drive off by scolding; to punish with words	*Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown'd withal.*
murdering (adjective)	that kill; deadly	*Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature's mischief!*
beguile (verb)	to deceive; to fool	*To beguile the time, Look like the time; bear welcome in your eye, Your hand, your tongue: look like the innocent flower, But be the serpent under't.*
dispatch (noun)	prompt handling or management of a task	*He that's coming Must be provided for: and you shall put This night's great business into my dispatch; Which shall to all our nights and days to come Give solely sovereign sway and masterdom.*
substances (noun)	bodies or forms	*Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature's mischief!*
transported (verb)	carried away by strong feeling	*Thy letters have transported me beyond This ignorant present, and I feel now The future in the instant.*
ambition (noun)	a strong desire for power or success	*To catch the nearest way: thou wouldst be great; / Art not without ambition, but without*
impedes (verb)	gets in the way of; hinders	

		Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown'd withal.
sightless (adjective)	invisible	*Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature's mischief!*
metaphysical (adjective)	supernatural; beyond the physical world	*Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown'd withal.*

Discussion questions

1. Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. How does Lady Macbeth learn about the prophecies? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** From Macbeth's letter, which she reads aloud.
   Answer guidance: From Macbeth's letter, which she reads aloud.
2. What does Lady Macbeth fear about her husband's nature? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It is too full of the milk of human kindness
   Answer guidance: It is too full of the milk of human kindness.
3. What does Lady Macbeth ask the spirits to do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Unsex her and fill her with cruelty
   Answer guidance: Unsex her and fill her with cruelty.
4. What news does the messenger bring? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The king comes here tonight
   Answer guidance: The king comes here tonight.
5. What advice does she give Macbeth about his face? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Look like the innocent flower but be the serpent under it
   Answer guidance: Look like the innocent flower but be the serpent under it.

6. What does she ask the night to do? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Hide her knife so it cannot see the wound it makes

   Answer guidance: Hide her knife so it cannot see the wound it makes.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act I, Scene V" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter about the prophecies and fears his nature is 'too full o' the milk of human kindness.' Hearing that Duncan will stay the night, she calls on spirits to 'unsex me here' and fill her with cruelty, and asks thick night to hide her knife. Macbeth arrives; she tells him to 'look like the innocent flower, but be the serpent under't' and to leave the business to her.

   Answer guidance: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter about the prophecies and fears his nature is 'too full o' the milk of human kindness.' Hearing that Duncan will stay the night, she calls on spirits to 'unsex me here' and fill her with cruelty, and asks thick night to hide her knife. Macbeth arrives; she tells him to 'look like the innocent flower, but be the serpent under't' and to leave the business to her.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act I, Scene V" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Hie thee hither, That I may pour my spirits in thine ear; And chastise with the valour of my tongue All that impedes thee from the golden round, Which fate and metaphysical aid doth seem To have thee crown'd withal." What does "chastise" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** chastise: to drive off by scolding; to punish with words.

    Answer guidance: chastise: to drive off by scolding; to punish with words.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Lady Macbeth connect kindness with milk, and cruelty with being 'unsexed'? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** She links tenderness with womanhood and thinks murder requires abandoning it.

   Answer guidance: She links tenderness with womanhood and thinks murder requires abandoning it.
2. What does "Act I, Scene V" suggest about Lady Macbeth's resolve? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan.

   Answer guidance: Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan. Evidence to accept: "It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way" (Act I, Scene V, lines 369–370): Her judgment of her husband. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of imagery in “Act I, Scene V”. What does it reveal about Lady Macbeth's resolve that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398): Her invocation. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the characterization in “Act I, Scene V” shape what we understand about Lady Macbeth's resolve? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, lines 369–370): Her judgment of her husband. On characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “The raven himself is…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, lines 427–428): Appearance and reality. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Lady Macbeth reads the letter and resolves that Duncan must die tonight; evidence: “look like the innocent flower, But be the serpent under't”.
   Answer guidance: Look for: Lady Macbeth reads the letter and resolves that Duncan must die tonight; evidence: “look like the innocent flower, But be the serpent under't”. Evidence to accept: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, lines 369–370): Her judgment of her husband. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Act I, Scene V” build on “Act I, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398): Her invocation. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Act I, Scene V”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about Lady Macbeth's resolve, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must

destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, lines 427–428): Appearance and reality. On characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Is it ever right to hide your true feelings to get something you want?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398): Her invocation. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear in “Act I, Scene V”, and how does it connect Lady Macbeth's resolve to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, lines 369–370): Her judgment of her husband. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Lady Macbeth more ambitious than Macbeth, or simply more decisive? Use both I.v and I.vii. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A comparative judgment with evidence.
   Answer guidance: A comparative judgment with evidence.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Lady Macbeth's soliloquy is one of the play's great speeches: she sees ambition as requiring the suppression of feeling and of gender itself. Her flower and serpent image restates 'fair is foul' as a plan. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, lines 427–428): Appearance and reality. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act I, Scene V” acts most wisely in the matter of Lady Macbeth's resolve, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must

destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, lines 369–370): Her judgment of her husband. On characterization: Lady Macbeth reads Macbeth's letter, fears his nature is "too full o' the milk of human kindness," and calls on spirits to "unsex me here." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act I, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Lady Macbeth's resolve. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398): Her invocation. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act I, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under’t” (Act I, Scene V, lines 427–428): Appearance and reality. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act I, Scene V”, with its focus on Lady Macbeth's resolve, to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “It is too full o’ the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way” (Act I, Scene V, lines 369–370): Her judgment of her husband. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in “Act I, Scene V” effective in presenting Lady Macbeth's resolve, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: “Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here” (Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398): Her invocation. On imagery: Milk vs. gall, light vs. "thick night": the imagery of nurturing turned to poison. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene V” treats Lady Macbeth's resolve with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner

circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: "look like the innocent flower, / But be the serpent under't" (Act I, Scene V, lines 427–428): Appearance and reality. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act I, Scene VI" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: "It is too full o' the milk of human kindness / To catch the nearest way" (Act I, Scene V, lines 369–370): Her judgment of her husband. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Act I, Scene V" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Lady Macbeth's resolve? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth believes that to seize power she must destroy her own capacity for pity. Useful evidence: "Come, you spirits / That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here" (Act I, Scene V, lines 397–398): Her invocation. Theme link: she rejects femininity to gain power, defining manhood as ruthlessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is Lady Macbeth doing when the scene opens?

   A. Reading a letter

   B. Praying alone in the castle chapel

   C. Greeting the king

   D. Talking to the Witches

   Key: A (Reading a letter)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who wrote the letter Lady Macbeth reads?

   A. King Duncan, from Forres

   B. Macbeth, her husband

   C. Banquo, his friend

D. The three Witches

Key: B (Macbeth, her husband)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth fear about her husband's nature?

A. It is too proud to listen

B. It is too lazy

C. It is too kind

D. It is too cruel

Key: C (It is too kind)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the line: "_____ thou art, and Cawdor; and shalt be What thou art promised"

Key: Glamis

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Lady Macbeth first think the Messenger must be mad?

A. The king is known to be ill and far away

B. She does not know who Duncan is

C. The Messenger is drunk

D. Macbeth would have sent word first

Key: D (Macbeth would have sent word first)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What bird does Lady Macbeth say croaks Duncan's entrance?

A. The raven

B. The martlet

C. The owl

D. The crow

Key: A (The raven)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] When does Macbeth say Duncan plans to leave?

A. After a week

B. Tomorrow

C. Tonight

D. In the spring

Key: B (Tomorrow)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth tell Macbeth to leave to her?

A. The welcome feast

B. The letter

C. All the rest

D. The battle

Key: C (All the rest)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Lady Macbeth ask the spirits to do for her?

Sample answer: She calls on the spirits that tend on mortal thoughts to unsex her and fill her from the crown to the toe with

direst cruelty. She asks them to make her blood thick and stop up remorse, so that no pity can shake her fell purpose. She wants to be hard enough to do what must be done.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What advice does Lady Macbeth give her husband about how to behave?

    Sample answer: She tells him his face is like a book where men may read strange matters. To deceive others he must look like the time, bear welcome in his eye, hand and tongue, and look like the innocent flower but be the serpent under it. She wants him to hide his thoughts behind a friendly face.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth call his wife in the letter?

    A. My dearest partner of greatness
    B. My lady and my queen to be
    C. My only friend in the world
    D. My loyal servant and wife

    Key: A (My dearest partner of greatness)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why is Lady Macbeth surprised by the Messenger's news?

    A. She thought that the king was already dead
    B. Macbeth has not told her himself
    C. She did not know Duncan existed
    D. She expected Banquo instead

    Key: B (Macbeth has not told her himself)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the reply: "Thou'rt _____ to say it"

    Key: mad

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does "the golden round" refer to?

    A. A gold coin
    B. The sun
    C. The crown
    D. A ring

    Key: C (The crown)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Lady Macbeth mean by "Your face, my thane, is as a book"?

    A. He reads too much at night
    B. He has written a book
    C. He looks wise and learned
    D. His feelings are easy to read

    Key: D (His feelings are easy to read)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How did the first rider arrive, according to the Messenger?

    A. Almost dead for breath
    B. Wounded from the battle and bleeding
    C. With the king beside him
    D. Late, after the guests

    Key: A (Almost dead for breath)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does “O, never Shall sun that morrow see!” reveal?

    A. She expects a storm to come tomorrow and hide the sun

    B. She means Duncan will not live to leave

    C. She wants Duncan to stay longer

    D. She fears the dark

    Key: B (She means Duncan will not live to leave)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Lady Macbeth greet Macbeth when he enters?

    A. With tears of fear and worry for him

    B. With anger at his lateness

    C. With his titles, old and promised

    D. With news of the Witches

    Key: C (With his titles, old and promised)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Lady Macbeth think her husband needs her help?

    Sample answer: She says he is too full of the milk of human kindness to catch the nearest way. He is not without ambition, but he lacks the illness that should go with it and wants to win without playing false. She plans to pour her spirits in his ear and chastise with the valour of her tongue anything that stops him from the crown.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How do the scene's images of darkness connect to Lady Macbeth's plans?

    Sample answer: She calls on thick night to wrap itself in the dunnest smoke of hell so that her keen knife will not see the wound it makes and heaven cannot peep through the blanket of the dark to cry Hold. Darkness will hide the deed from her own eyes and from heaven. The images show that she knows the act is wrong and wants it covered.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What contradiction does Lady Macbeth find in her husband's desires?

    A. He wants greatness without wrongdoing

    B. He wants peace but loves only war and battle

    C. He hates Duncan but serves him

    D. He fears her but obeys her

    Key: A (He wants greatness without wrongdoing)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “unsex me here” suggest about her view of gender?

    A. She wishes to become a soldier in the king's army

    B. She links pity with women and wants it gone

    C. She wants to look like a man

    D. She rejects her marriage

    Key: B (She links pity with women and wants it gone)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “take my milk for gall” imply?

    A. Give her medicine for an illness she has suffered

    B. Feed the king's guests

    C. Turn nurture into bitterness

    D. Pour wine for the feast

Key: C (Turn nurture into bitterness)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the order: “Give him _____; He brings great news”

    Key: tending

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the raven image work in the scene?

    A. As a sign of spring and a happy welcome to the guests

    B. As a messenger from Banquo

    C. As a pet of the castle

    D. As an omen of death

    Key: D (As an omen of death)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's reply 'We will speak further' suggest?

    A. He has not yet agreed

    B. He has already planned every single part of the deed

    C. He is angry with her

    D. He wants Duncan to stay

    Key: A (He has not yet agreed)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does “I feel now The future in the instant” show?

    A. She is afraid of what tomorrow will bring to the castle

    B. She already lives as if the prophecy is fulfilled

    C. She wishes time would stop

    D. She regrets her husband's success

    Key: B (She already lives as if the prophecy is fulfilled)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “To alter favour ever is to fear” warn Macbeth about?

    A. Favour from the king will soon be taken from him

    B. Fear makes men brave

    C. A changed face betrays fear

    D. Kings change their minds

    Key: C (A changed face betrays fear)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how Lady Macbeth's soliloquy reveals her character.

    Sample answer: Her speech is a series of commands to dark powers: Come, you spirits, unsex me here; make thick my blood; Come, thick night. She asks to be filled with direst cruelty and to lose remorse. The imperatives show will and determination, but asking for help to suppress pity also shows that she knows she has natural feelings to overcome.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the theme of appearance and reality in this scene.

    Sample answer: Lady Macbeth tells Macbeth to look like the time, bear welcome in his eye, and look like the innocent flower but be the serpent under it. She also wants night to hide the deed from heaven. The scene shows that the plan depends on a gap between a welcoming surface and a hidden purpose, echoing the Witches' fair is foul.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the letter shape the scene's structure?

    A. It lets her react before Macbeth arrives

    B. It reveals the full plan that he has already made

C. It ends the scene

D. It replaces Macbeth's entrance

Key: A (It lets her react before Macbeth arrives)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which of her words most clearly echoes the Witches?

A. The raven himself is hoarse

B. All-hail hereafter

C. Give him tending

D. We will speak further

Key: B (All-hail hereafter)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Lady Macbeth's request that heaven not 'cry Hold, hold!' suggest?

A. She believes that heaven will reward her for acting

B. She hopes Duncan will call out

C. She expects heaven would forbid the act

D. She wants a witness

Key: C (She expects heaven would forbid the act)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete her line: “Hie thee hither, That I may pour my _____ in thine ear”

Key: spirits

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do “fate and metaphysical aid” figure in her thinking?

A. As enemies who must be defeated first

B. As things she does not believe in

C. As good reasons to wait

D. As forces that seem to promise the crown

Key: D (As forces that seem to promise the crown)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is the effect of Lady Macbeth's ending lines, 'Leave all the rest to me'?

A. She takes control of the plan

B. She gives up on her husband and his ambitions

C. She invites Duncan to rest

D. She apologizes for her speech

Key: A (She takes control of the plan)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Lady Macbeth is stronger than her husband in this scene.

Sample answer: She acts at once on the letter, calls for cruelty, plans the night and tells him to leave all the rest to her, while Macbeth only says We will speak further. Yet her need to be unsexed and to have remorse stopped up suggests that her strength is willed rather than natural. A strong answer weighs her resolve against these signs of struggle.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how imagery of the body works in her soliloquy.

Sample answer: She asks to be filled from the crown to the toe with cruelty, to have her blood made thick, and to have her

milk taken for gall. The body becomes a container to be emptied of pity and filled with poison. These images show her trying to change her own nature to match her purpose.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which shift in the scene matters most?

    A. From joy at the letter to grief for the dead of the battle

    B. From hoping for the crown to planning for tonight

    C. From fear of Duncan to love of him

    D. From doubt of the Witches to scorn

    Key: B (From hoping for the crown to planning for tonight)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare how Macbeth and his wife respond to the prophecy so far.

    Sample answer: Macbeth's letter shares the news with his dearest partner of greatness, and in earlier asides he hoped chance might crown him without his stir. Lady Macbeth at once decides on the nearest way and fears only his kindness. A strong answer shows her moving straight to action while he hesitates, noting his We will speak further.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene V develops the idea of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act I, Scene V” could deliver about Lady Macbeth's resolve. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Lady Macbeth's resolve in “Act I, Scene V”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene V" could deliver about Lady Macbeth's resolve. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Lady Macbeth's resolve in "Act I, Scene V": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene V suggests about Lady Macbeth's resolve. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene V" could deliver about Lady Macbeth's resolve. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Lady Macbeth's resolve in "Act I, Scene V": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act I, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of Lady Macbeth's resolve. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene V" could deliver about Lady Macbeth's resolve. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Lady Macbeth's resolve in "Act I, Scene V": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *He that's coming Must be provided for: and you shall put This night's great business into my dispatch; Which shall to all our nights and days to come Give solely sovereign sway and masterdom.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "dispatch" most nearly mean?

   A. invisible

   B. supernatural; beyond the physical world

   C. prompt handling or management of a task

   D. gets in the way of; hinders

2. *The raven himself is hoarse That croaks the fatal entrance of Duncan Under my battlements. Come, you spirits That tend on mortal thoughts, unsex me here, And fill me from the crown to the toe top-full Of direst cruelty! make thick my blood; Stop up the access and passage to remorse, That no compunctious visitings of nature Shake my fell purpose, nor keep peace between The effect and it! Come to my woman's breasts, And take my milk for gall, you murdering ministers, Wherever in your sightless substances You wait on nature's mischief! Come, thick night, And pall thee in the dunnest smoke of hell, That my keen knife see not the wound it makes, Nor heaven peep through the blanket of the dark, To cry "Hold, hold!"*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene V"?

A. Lady Macbeth's resolve

B. A disguised advance on the castle

C. The apparitions and false security

D. Suspicion spoken through irony

SAT key: 1. C (prompt handling or management of a task); 2. A (Lady Macbeth's resolve)

Lesson 8: Act I, Scene VI

Focus: dramatic irony at the castle gate

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act I, Scene VI (dramatic irony at the castle gate) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Duncan and Banquo arrive at Inverness and praise the castle's pleasant seat and sweet air, where the martlet nests. Lady Macbeth welcomes the king with elaborate courtesy, saying all she and her household have is his. Duncan asks to be taken to his host, whom he loves highly.

Background: Hospitality was a sacred duty: killing a guest under one's roof violated religious and social law, which makes the coming murder doubly monstrous to the audience.

Significance: The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....
Prompt: When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a welcoming home that is a death-trap.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Hospitality was a sacred duty: killing a guest under one's roof violated religious and social law, which makes the coming murder doubly monstrous to the audience. The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows. Dramatic irony: Duncan praises the castle's "pleasant seat" and sweet air; the audience knows it is a trap. Imagery: The martlet nesting in the castle's walls: an image of peace and trust. Characterization: Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes dramatic irony at the castle gate. Key takeaway: a welcoming home that is a death-trap.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Duncan praises the castle's "pleasant seat" and sweet air; the audience knows it is a trap.
- **Imagery:** The martlet nesting in the castle's walls: an image of peace and trust.
- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** a welcoming home that is a death-trap.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.
- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": watch for appearances and words that mean two things.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, lines 439–440) Duncan's innocence.
- “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, line 443) Banquo's image of nature and holiness.
- “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, lines 456–457) Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes.
Evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, line 443)
Reasoning: He says "this castle hath a pleasant seat," and Banquo describes "the temple-haunting martlet" nesting there, images of peace in the place of murder.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

purveyor (noun)	an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging	*We coursed him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us.*	
recommends (verb)	presents (itself) pleasantly	*This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself Unto our gentle senses.*	"recommends": Origin of "recommend": Old French recommender. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/recommend#Etymology)
sometime (adverb)	sometimes; at times	*The love that follows us sometime is our trouble, Which still we thank as love.*	"sometime": Origin: an English formation from some + time. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/sometime#Etymology)
hostess (noun)	a woman who receives and entertains guests	*Fair and noble hostess, We are your guest to-night.*	"hostess": Origin: Middle French hostesse; earlier Old French ostesce. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/hostess#Etymology)
coursed (verb)	chased; followed closely	*We coursed him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us.*	

Discussion questions

1. When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Whom does Duncan ask to be taken to at the end of the scene? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** His host, Macbeth: 'Conduct me to mine host: we love him highly.'
   Answer guidance: His host, Macbeth: 'Conduct me to mine host: we love him highly.'.
2. How does Duncan describe the castle? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It has a pleasant seat and sweet air
   Answer guidance: It has a pleasant seat and sweet air.

3. Which bird does Banquo say nests at the castle? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The martlet
   Answer guidance: The martlet.
4. Who welcomes Duncan at the gate? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Lady Macbeth
   Answer guidance: Lady Macbeth.
5. What does Lady Macbeth say about her household? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Everything they have is the king's to command
   Answer guidance: Everything they have is the king's to command.
6. Why is this scene full of dramatic irony? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The audience knows of the murder plan that the king does not
   Answer guidance: The audience knows of the murder plan that the king does not.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act I, Scene VI" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Duncan and Banquo arrive at Inverness and praise the castle's pleasant seat and sweet air, where the martlet nests. Lady Macbeth welcomes the king with elaborate courtesy, saying all she and her household have is his. Duncan asks to be taken to his host, whom he loves highly.
   Answer guidance: Duncan and Banquo arrive at Inverness and praise the castle's pleasant seat and sweet air, where the martlet nests. Lady Macbeth welcomes the king with elaborate courtesy, saying all she and her household have is his. Duncan asks to be taken to his host, whom he loves highly.
8. Who is on stage in "Act I, Scene VI", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act I, Scene VI" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "We coursed him at the heels, and had a purpose To be his purveyor: but he rides well; And his great love, sharp as his spur, hath holp him To his home before us." What does "purveyor" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** purveyor: an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging.
    Answer guidance: purveyor: an officer who rides ahead to arrange food and lodging.

Inferential / analytical

1. How does the martlet image contrast with the raven Lady Macbeth mentioned in Scene V? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Peaceful, trusting nature versus an omen of death; the same castle seen two ways.
   Answer guidance: Peaceful, trusting nature versus an omen of death; the same castle seen two ways.

2. What does “Act I, Scene VI” suggest about dramatic irony at the castle gate? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows.

   Answer guidance: The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows. Evidence to accept: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, lines 439–440): Duncan's innocence. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of irony in “Act I, Scene VI”. What does it reveal about dramatic irony at the castle gate that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true. Evidence to accept: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, line 443): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the setting in “Act I, Scene VI” shape what we understand about dramatic irony at the castle gate? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, lines 439–440): Duncan's innocence. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “This castle hath a…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, lines 456–457): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene VI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Duncan praises the castle and greets Lady Macbeth as an honoured hostess, unaware of the plot; evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat”.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Duncan praises the castle and greets Lady Macbeth as an honoured hostess, unaware of the plot; evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat”. Evidence to accept: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, lines 439–440): Duncan's innocence. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Act I, Scene VI” build on “Act I, Scene V”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, line 443): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a

death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Act I, Scene VI”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about dramatic irony at the castle gate, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, lines 456–457): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (When you know something a character does not, how does it change the way you watch them?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “The temple-haunting martlet” (Act I, Scene VI, line 443): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does imagery appear in “Act I, Scene VI”, and how does it connect dramatic irony at the castle gate to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself” (Act I, Scene VI, lines 439–440): Duncan's innocence. On imagery: The martlet nesting in the castle's walls: an image of peace and trust. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should a director make Lady Macbeth's welcome sound sincere or forced? Defend your choice. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A staging decision justified by the text.

   Answer guidance: A staging decision justified by the text.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The gentle imagery of birds and sweet air contrasts with Lady Macbeth's raven in I.v, and the guest's trust heightens the horror of the plan the audience already knows. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: “All our service / In every point twice done and then done double” (Act I, Scene VI, lines 456–457): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in "Act I, Scene VI" acts most wisely in the matter of dramatic irony at the castle gate, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: "This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself" (Act I, Scene VI, lines 439–440): Duncan's innocence. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's elaborate courtesy hides her intent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Act I, Scene VI". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of dramatic irony at the castle gate. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: "The temple-haunting martlet" (Act I, Scene VI, line 443): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Act I, Scene VI": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: "All our service / In every point twice done and then done double" (Act I, Scene VI, lines 456–457): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Act I, Scene VI", with its focus on dramatic irony at the castle gate, to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: "This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself" (Act I, Scene VI, lines 439–440): Duncan's innocence. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in "Act I, Scene VI" effective in presenting dramatic irony at the castle gate, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: "The temple-haunting martlet" (Act I, Scene VI, line 443): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a

death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act I, Scene VI" treats dramatic irony at the castle gate with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: "All our service / In every point twice done and then done double" (Act I, Scene VI, lines 456–457): Lady Macbeth's hollow courtesy. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Act I, Scene VII" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: "This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air / Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself" (Act I, Scene VI, lines 439–440): Duncan's innocence. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Act I, Scene VI" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about dramatic irony at the castle gate? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Duncan's arrival is built on dramatic irony: the more he praises the castle, the more horrifying his trust becomes. Useful evidence: "The temple-haunting martlet" (Act I, Scene VI, line 443): Banquo's image of nature and holiness. Theme link: a welcoming home that is a death-trap. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Act I, Scene VI take place?
   A. Before Macbeth's castle
   B. Inside the palace at Forres
   C. On the heath
   D. In the king's camp near the sea

   Key: A (Before Macbeth's castle)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who arrives with Duncan at the castle?

   A. Only a few guards and a servant

   B. His sons, Banquo and other lords

   C. The Witches of the heath

   D. Macbeth and his wife

   Key: B (His sons, Banquo and other lords)

3. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What time of day do the torches suggest for the king's arrival?

   A. Early morning, just after sunrise

   B. Noon, in full daylight

   C. Evening, as night falls

   D. Midnight, in a storm

   Key: C (Evening, as night falls)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Duncan ask about soon after the welcome at the gate?

   A. Whether supper is ready for his men

   B. Where Banquo is

   C. When he may leave

   D. Where the thane of Cawdor is

   Key: D (Where the thane of Cawdor is)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Duncan's greeting: “See, see, our honour’d _____!”

   Key: hostess

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Duncan say he will continue to show Macbeth?

   A. His graces and favour

   B. His anger at the long delay

   C. A cold suspicion

   D. A royal distance

   Key: A (His graces and favour)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Duncan ask Lady Macbeth to do at the end?

   A. Show him to his room for the night

   B. Lead him to her husband

   C. Bring wine for his men

   D. Call for music

   Key: B (Lead him to her husband)

8. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What mood does Duncan's arrival have on the surface?

   A. Tense and suspicious of everyone

   B. Angry and cold

   C. Gracious and pleasant

   D. Sad and mournful

   Key: C (Gracious and pleasant)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Lady Macbeth welcome Duncan?
   Sample answer: She speaks with elaborate courtesy. She says that all their service, twice done and then done double, would be poor compared to the honours the king has given their house, and that they remain his hermits, praying for him. She tells him that everything they own is held ready to return to him.
10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Why does the calm of this scene feel uneasy to the audience?
    Sample answer: Duncan and Banquo praise the castle's sweet air and the nesting martlets, and Duncan thanks his gracious hostess. But the audience has just heard Lady Macbeth call on spirits and thick night and plan this night's great business. The pleasant words sound ironic because we know what the hosts intend.
11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Banquo call the martlet?
    A. This guest of summer
    B. A bird of evil omen that croaks
    C. The king's own bird
    D. A lonely winter bird

    Key: A (This guest of summer)
12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Banquo say about places where martlets breed?
    A. The walls are falling into ruin
    B. The air is delicate
    C. The people are kind
    D. The ground is rich

    Key: B (The air is delicate)
13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Duncan's line: “The love that follows us sometime is our _____”
    Key: trouble
14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Why is the martlet imagery ironic here?
    A. It shows that the castle is poor and old
    B. It warns Duncan to leave
    C. It suggests peace in a house of danger
    D. It praises Banquo's eyesight

    Key: C (It suggests peace in a house of danger)
15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Lady Macbeth mean by calling her household 'your hermits'?
    A. They live alone in the woods
    B. They refuse to serve him
    C. They have no money left
    D. They will pray for the king

    Key: D (They will pray for the king)
16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Duncan speak about love that causes inconvenience?
    A. He says such love should still be thanked

B. He says that it should be avoided by all wise kings

C. He says it leads to war

D. He says it is a sign of guilt

Key: A (He says such love should still be thanked)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What do the stage directions 'Hautboys and torches' suggest?

A. A sudden alarm at night

B. A formal, festive arrival

C. A slow funeral march

D. A coming battle

Key: B (A formal, festive arrival)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Where does Banquo say the martlets have built their nests?

A. In the trees of the castle garden

B. Under the bridge

C. On every jutty, frieze and buttress

D. Inside the chapel

Key: C (On every jutty, frieze and buttress)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the description of the castle suggest about how Duncan sees Macbeth's home?

Sample answer: Duncan says the castle has a pleasant seat and the air sweetly recommends itself to the senses, and Banquo adds that the martlets have built nests everywhere, which means the air is delicate. To them it seems a peaceful, healthy, welcoming place, which matches their trust in their hosts.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Lady Macbeth's language show her skill at deception?

Sample answer: Her speech is formal and elaborate, full of phrases about service twice done and then done double and about honours deep and broad. She sounds humble and grateful, exactly as she told Macbeth to look like the innocent flower. Because we have heard her soliloquy, her courtesy shows how well she can perform.

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Lady Macbeth describe the honours Duncan has given her house?

A. Deep and broad, heaped on older ones

B. Small and soon forgotten by the court

C. Unwanted by the family

D. Borrowed from Banquo

Key: A (Deep and broad, heaped on older ones)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the martlet image contrast with an image from the previous scene?

A. It echoes the serpent under the flower

B. It answers the hoarse raven

C. It repeats the thick night

D. It matches the golden round

Key: B (It answers the hoarse raven)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What tone does “temple-haunting martlet” lend to the castle?

    A. Dark and threatening to guests

    B. Comic and light

    C. Holy and peaceful

    D. Bitter and angry

    Key: C (Holy and peaceful)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Lady Macbeth's line: “We rest your _____”

    Key: hermits

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What makes Lady Macbeth's speech about 'service... twice done' ironic?

    A. She has done no work at all to prepare

    B. She means it as a joke

    C. She speaks only of Banquo

    D. Her real service is a plan against him

    Key: D (Her real service is a plan against him)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why might Shakespeare give the scene's praise of nature to Duncan and Banquo?

    A. They are the characters who trust

    B. They are secretly plotting with the Witches

    C. They are tired of fighting

    D. They both love writing poetry

    Key: A (They are the characters who trust)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Duncan's teasing about love that is 'our trouble' show?

    A. His suspicion that the hosts mean harm

    B. His ease and warmth as a guest

    C. His anger at being kept waiting

    D. His wish to be alone

    Key: B (His ease and warmth as a guest)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is notable about Macbeth's absence from the welcome?

    A. He is out hunting with Banquo's son

    B. He is still at the battle

    C. The host avoids greeting his king

    D. He is asleep

    Key: C (The host avoids greeting his king)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how setting creates irony in this scene.

    Sample answer: The castle is described as pleasant, with sweet air and martlets nesting in every corner, signs of peace and health. The audience, though, knows that Lady Macbeth has called for thick night and planned the king's fate here. The gentle setting contrasts with the hidden purpose, so the beauty itself becomes a kind of deception.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze Lady Macbeth's role as hostess in this scene.
    Sample answer: She greets Duncan with exaggerated humility, saying their service twice done and then done double would still be poor next to his honours, and that all they own is his. She plays the gracious hostess, following her own advice to look like the innocent flower. The performance shows how fully she can hide her intentions.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the main dramatic function of this short scene?
    A. A pause of calm before the storm
    B. A turning point in the war with Norway
    C. A scene that reveals the plot
    D. A comic interlude

    Key: A (A pause of calm before the storm)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Banquo's language here differ from his wariness on the heath?
    A. It is more suspicious of his friend
    B. It is relaxed and admiring
    C. It is sharp and angry
    D. It is nervous and brief

    Key: B (It is relaxed and admiring)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Duncan's plan to be Macbeth's 'purveyor' reveal?
    A. He meant to bring food and wine for the whole army
    B. He planned to buy the castle
    C. He wanted to arrive first and prepare the way
    D. He hoped to spy on Macbeth

    Key: C (He wanted to arrive first and prepare the way)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the line: “Your servants ever Have theirs, themselves and what is theirs, in _____”
    Key: compt

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Which phrase best captures the scene's dramatic irony?
    A. Hautboys and torches at the gate
    B. Give me your hand
    C. By your leave
    D. Fair and noble hostess

    Key: D (Fair and noble hostess)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does Duncan's line 'we love him highly' add?
    A. Trust at its height just before danger
    B. Doubt about whether his host is truly loyal
    C. Anger at Macbeth's absence
    D. A promise of a new title

    Key: A (Trust at its height just before danger)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate whether the scene's calm makes the coming events more powerful.

Sample answer: The scene shows Duncan at ease, praising sweet air, joking about trouble and love, and taking his hostess's hand. Because the audience knows the hosts' intentions, the calm becomes almost unbearable. A strong answer argues that the contrast heightens tension, and notes how Macbeth's absence from the greeting adds unease.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how bird imagery runs through Act I, Scenes V and VI.

    Sample answer: Lady Macbeth speaks of the raven, hoarse from croaking Duncan's fatal entrance under her battlements. Banquo then admires the temple-haunting martlet, a guest of summer whose nests show the air is delicate. The raven signals death and the martlet peace, and setting them side by side shows the gap between how the castle seems and what it holds.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the formal style of the dialogue suggest about the court?

    A. Everyone at court is honest and plain

    B. Courtesy can mask real intentions

    C. The king prefers jokes

    D. Nobles avoid speaking to women

    Key: B (Courtesy can mask real intentions)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the scene connect to the theme of appearance and reality?

    Sample answer: Everything in the scene looks good: pleasant air, nesting birds, a gracious hostess and a grateful king. Yet the audience knows that the hostess has called for cruelty and darkness. The scene stages the idea that fair is foul, showing appearances that hide the opposite of what they seem.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 2, inference 0, analysis 8, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene VI develops the idea of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act I, Scene VI” could deliver about dramatic irony at the castle gate. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for dramatic irony at the castle gate in “Act I, Scene VI”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene VI" could deliver about dramatic irony at the castle gate. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for dramatic irony at the castle gate in "Act I, Scene VI": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene VI suggests about dramatic irony at the castle gate. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene VI" could deliver about dramatic irony at the castle gate. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for dramatic irony at the castle gate in "Act I, Scene VI": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act I, Scene VI to complicate the reader's understanding of dramatic irony at the castle gate. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene VI" could deliver about dramatic irony at the castle gate. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for dramatic irony at the castle gate in "Act I, Scene VI": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *This castle hath a pleasant seat; the air Nimbly and sweetly recommends itself Unto our gentle senses. This guest of summer, The temple-haunting martlet, does approve, By his loved mansionry, that the heaven's*

breath Smells wooingly here: no jutty, frieze, Buttress, nor coign of vantage, but this bird Hath made his pendent bed and procreant cradle: Where they most breed and haunt, I have observed, The air is delicate.

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene VI"?

A. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

B. Defiance and despair

C. Suspicion spoken through irony

D. The army reveals itself

SAT key: 1. A (Dramatic irony at the castle gate)

Lesson 9: Act I, Scene VII

Focus: the decision to murder

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Act I, Scene VII" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (violence against an infant (image), alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Lady Macbeth says she would have dashed out her nursing baby's brains rather than break such an oath. It is a rhetorical image, not an event; discuss why she chooses it. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…ewest gloss, Not cast aside so soon. Was the hope drunk Wherein you dress'd yourself? hath it s…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Suggested language: "Why does she choose the most shocking image she can?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Alone during the feast, Macbeth weighs the murder ('If it were done when 'tis done'): Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest and a virtuous ruler, and 'bloody instructions' return to plague the inventor; he has only 'vaulting ambition.' He tells Lady Macbeth they will proceed no further. She attacks his manhood, says she would have dashed out her nursing baby's brains had she sworn to, and lays out the plan to drug the chamberlains and blame them. Macbeth agrees: 'False face must hide what the false heart doth know.'

Background: The soliloquy draws on Christian ideas of judgment ('the life to come') and on the belief that a king's murder upset the whole order of nature and heaven.

Significance: This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because....
Prompt: Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: she defines manhood as the will to murder.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: chalice — a ceremonial drinking cup; daggers — short knives used as weapons; ingredients — the parts that are mixed together to make something; fitness — suitability; readiness; compose — to make up; to form. "ingredients": Origin of "ingredient": Middle French ingredient; earlier Latin ingrediens. "compose": Origin: Old French composer ("to compose"); earlier Latin componere ("to put together").
Words: chalice: a ceremonial drinking cup · daggers: short knives used as weapons · ingredients: the parts that are mixed together to make something · fitness: suitability; readiness · compose: to make up; to form

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The soliloquy draws on Christian ideas of judgment ('the life to come') and on the belief that a king's murder upset the whole order of nature and heaven. This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible. Soliloquy: "If it were done when 'tis done": Macbeth reasons against the murder: Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest, and virtuous; the only spur is "vaulting ambition." Characterization: Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath. Imagery: Pity "like a naked new-born babe"; ambition as a rider vaulting over the saddle. Watch for blood: Blood begins as a sign of valour; watch how its meaning changes as the play goes on.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "When you durst do it, then you were a man" slowly and put it in my own words: When Macbeth wants to abandon the plan, Lady Macbeth tells him that when he dared to do it, then he was a man. Next, craft. I notice she defines manhood as daring to kill, twisting the meaning of the word. The strongest word is "durst": it is the past of "dare," so courage becomes willingness to murder. Then, effect. How does Lady Macbeth attack Macbeth's manhood? My answer: She shames Macbeth into the murder by questioning his manhood; her taunt overcomes his doubts, showing her power over him at this stage.

> *When you durst do it, then you were a man* *(Act I, Scene VII, line 533)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "When you durst do it, then you were a man" slowly and put it in my own words: When Macbeth wants to abandon the plan, Lady Macbeth tells him that when he dared to do it, then he was a man. Next, craft. I notice she defines manhood as daring to kill, twisting the meaning of the word. The strongest word is "durst": it is the past of "dare," so courage becomes willingness to murder. Then, effect. How does Lady Macbeth attack Macbeth's manhood? My answer: She shames Macbeth into the murder by questioning his manhood; her taunt overcomes his doubts, showing her power over him at this stage.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Spur", "prick" and "vaulting ambition" stand out. Macbeth pictures himself as a rider with no spur, driven only by an ambition that leaps too high and may fall on the other side. Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected student answer: Macbeth admits he has no good reason, only ambition, and this weakness is what Lady Macbeth attacks when she says he would be "so much more the man" if he dared.

> *I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition (Act I, Scene VII, lines 503–505)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Spur", "prick" and "vaulting ambition" stand out. Macbeth pictures himself as a rider with no spur, driven only by an ambition that leaps too high and may fall on the other side.
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected student answer: Macbeth admits he has no good reason, only ambition, and this weakness is what Lady Macbeth attacks when she says he would be "so much more the man" if he dared.

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene VII develops the idea of the decision to murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. When the text says "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, line 533), it shows this directly. In soliloquy he finds "no spur … but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.
Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act I, Scene VII develops the idea of the decision to murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. When the text says "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, line 533), it shows this directly. In soliloquy he finds "no spur … but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you? Ask: who is more responsible for the murder, Macbeth or Lady Macbeth?
Anchor question: Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?
Facilitation: Ask: who is more responsible for the murder, Macbeth or Lady Macbeth?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. ("When you durst do it, then you were a man", Act I, Scene VII, line 533). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the decision to murder? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. ("When you durst do it, then you were a man", Act I, Scene VII, line 533). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how soliloquy shapes the decision to murder. Key takeaway: she defines manhood as the will to murder.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** "If it were done when 'tis done": Macbeth reasons against the murder: Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest, and virtuous; the only spur is "vaulting ambition."
- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath.
- **Imagery:** Pity "like a naked new-born babe"; ambition as a rider vaulting over the saddle.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** she defines manhood as the will to murder.

Symbols and motifs

- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour; watch how its meaning changes as the play goes on.
- **sleep:** Sleep stands for innocence and rest; notice who can sleep and who cannot.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition" (Act I, Scene VII, lines 503–505) Macbeth admits his only motive.
- "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, line 533) Lady Macbeth's attack.
- "We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we'll not fail" (Act I, Scene VII, lines 545–547) Her resolve.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood.
Evidence: "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, line 533)
Reasoning: In soliloquy he finds "no spur ... but only / Vaulting ambition," but she tells him "When you durst do it, then you were a man," and he yields.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
chalice (noun)	a ceremonial drinking cup	*But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*	
daggers (noun)	short knives used as weapons	*Will it not be received, When we have mark'd with blood those sleepy two Of his own chamber and used their very daggers, That they have done't?*	
ingredients (noun)	the parts that are mixed together to make something	*But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*	"ingredients": Origin of "ingredient": Middle French ingredient; earlier Latin ingrediens. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ingredient#Etymology)
fitness (noun)	suitability; readiness	*Nor time nor place Did then adhere, and yet you would make both: They have made themselves, and that their fitness now Does unmake you.*	
compose (verb)	to make up; to form	*Bring forth men-children only; For thy undaunted mettle should compose Nothing but males.*	"compose": Origin: Old French composer ("to compose"); earlier Latin componere ("to put together"). (Liber et Libri origin

			note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/compose#Etymology)
ornament (noun)	the thing that gives honor or beauty; here, the crown	*Wouldst thou have that Which thou esteem'st the ornament of life, And live a coward in thine own esteem, Letting "I dare not" wait upon "I would,"*	"ornament": Origin: Old French ornement; earlier Latin ornamentum ("equipment"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ornament#Etymology)
enterprise (noun)	a bold or risky undertaking	*What beast was't, then, That made you break this enterprise to me?*	"enterprise": Origin: Middle French entreprise. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/enterprise#Etymology)
inventor (noun)	the person who first devised something	*But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips.*	
undaunted (adjective)	fearless; not discouraged	*Bring forth men-children only; For thy undaunted mettle should compose Nothing but males.*	
sticking (adjective)	clinging to; refusing to come off (like blood)	*But screw your courage to the sticking-place, And we'll not fail.*	

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Lady Macbeth tell Macbeth to 'screw' to the sticking-place? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** His courage.
   Answer guidance: His courage.
2. Which relationships does Macbeth say make the murder doubly wrong? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He is Duncan's

kinsman, subject and host

Answer guidance: He is Duncan's kinsman, subject and host.

3. What is the only spur Macbeth says he has? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Vaulting ambition

   Answer guidance: Vaulting ambition.

4. What does Macbeth first tell Lady Macbeth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** We will proceed no further in this business

   Answer guidance: We will proceed no further in this business.

5. How does Lady Macbeth attack Macbeth's resolve? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** She calls him a coward and questions his manhood

   Answer guidance: She calls him a coward and questions his manhood.

6. What is the plan for blaming the murder? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Drug the chamberlains and mark them with blood

   Answer guidance: Drug the chamberlains and mark them with blood.

7. Retell the most important events of “Act I, Scene VII” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Alone during the feast, Macbeth weighs the murder ('If it were done when 'tis done'): Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest and a virtuous ruler, and 'bloody instructions' return to plague the inventor; he has only 'vaulting ambition.' He tells Lady Macbeth they will proceed no further. She attacks his manhood, says she would have dashed out her nursing baby's brains had she sworn to, and lays…

   Answer guidance: Alone during the feast, Macbeth weighs the murder ('If it were done when 'tis done'): Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest and a virtuous ruler, and 'bloody instructions' return to plague the inventor; he has only 'vaulting ambition.' He tells Lady Macbeth they will proceed no further. She attacks his manhood, says she would have dashed out her nursing baby's brains had she sworn to, and lays…

8. Who is on stage in “Act I, Scene VII”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when is “Act I, Scene VII” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison’d chalice To our…” What does “chalice” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** chalice: a ceremonial drinking cup.

    Answer guidance: chalice: a ceremonial drinking cup.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth imagines Duncan's virtues pleading 'like angels, trumpet-tongued.' What does this image show about his conscience? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** He feels the murder as a cosmic, damnable act that heaven will expose.
   Answer guidance: He feels the murder as a cosmic, damnable act that heaven will expose.
2. Why does Lady Macbeth's argument about manhood work when Macbeth's moral reasons were stronger? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** She ties his identity and her love to the deed.
   Answer guidance: She ties his identity and her love to the deed.
3. What does “Act I, Scene VII” suggest about the decision to murder? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible.
   Answer guidance: This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible. Evidence to accept: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, lines 503–505): Macbeth admits his only motive. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. Find one example of imagery in “Act I, Scene VII”. What does it reveal about the decision to murder that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, line 533): Lady Macbeth's attack. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
5. How does the conflict in “Act I, Scene VII” shape what we understand about the decision to murder? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, lines 503–505): Macbeth admits his only motive. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that opens with “If it were done…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, lines 545–547): Her resolve. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. What causes the main turn in “Act I, Scene VII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Macbeth decides to “proceed no further”, then Lady Macbeth's challenge reverses him; evidence: “I am settled”.
   Answer guidance: Look for: Macbeth decides to “proceed no further”, then Lady Macbeth's challenge

reverses him; evidence: “I am settled”. Evidence to accept: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, lines 503–505): Macbeth admits his only motive. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

8. How does “Act I, Scene VII” build on “Act I, Scene VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, line 533): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. In “Act I, Scene VII”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the decision to murder, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, lines 545–547): Her resolve. On characterization: Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Have you ever been talked into something you had decided not to do? What arguments worked on you?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
    Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, line 533): Lady Macbeth's attack. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Who bears more responsibility for Duncan's murder, Macbeth or Lady Macbeth? Use evidence from I.v and I.vii. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A reasoned judgment of shared responsibility.
   Answer guidance: A reasoned judgment of shared responsibility.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): This is the hinge of Act I: Macbeth's conscience reasons clearly against the deed, and Lady Macbeth defeats reason by redefining courage and manhood. The scene sets up the play's question of who is responsible. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “When you durst do it, then you

were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, line 533): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in "Act I, Scene VII" acts most wisely in the matter of the decision to murder, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: "We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we'll not fail" (Act I, Scene VII, lines 545–547): Her resolve. On characterization: Lady Macbeth attacks his manhood and says she would have dashed her baby's brains out rather than break such an oath. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Act I, Scene VII". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the decision to murder. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: "I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition" (Act I, Scene VII, lines 503–505): Macbeth admits his only motive. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Act I, Scene VII": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: "When you durst do it, then you were a man" (Act I, Scene VII, line 533): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Act I, Scene VII", with its focus on the decision to murder, to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: "We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we'll not fail" (Act I, Scene VII, lines 545–547): Her resolve. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in "Act I, Scene VII" effective in presenting the decision to murder, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria

and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, lines 503–505): Macbeth admits his only motive. On imagery: Pity "like a naked new-born babe"; ambition as a rider vaulting over the saddle. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act I, Scene VII” treats the decision to murder with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “When you durst do it, then you were a man” (Act I, Scene VII, line 533): Lady Macbeth's attack. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “We fail! / But screw your courage to the sticking-place, / And we’ll not fail” (Act I, Scene VII, lines 545–547): Her resolve. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act I, Scene VII” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the decision to murder? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's decision to murder comes not from reasoning but from his wife's challenge to his manhood. Useful evidence: “I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition” (Act I, Scene VII, lines 503–505): Macbeth admits his only motive. Theme link: she defines manhood as the will to murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where is Macbeth when he speaks his soliloquy in this scene?

   A. Outside the supper, alone

B. At the table beside the king

C. On the heath with Banquo

D. In the palace at Forres

Key: A (Outside the supper, alone)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the servants carry across the stage as the scene opens?

A. Weapons for the guards at the door

B. Dishes for the king's supper

C. Torches for the hall

D. Letters for Macbeth

Key: B (Dishes for the king's supper)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What news does Lady Macbeth bring when she finds her husband?

A. The guards have discovered the plan

B. Banquo has left

C. Duncan has almost finished supper

D. The Witches are here

Key: C (Duncan has almost finished supper)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say he has bought from all sorts of people?

A. Horses and weapons for a new war

B. Land in Fife

C. Gifts for Duncan

D. Golden opinions

Key: D (Golden opinions)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Lady Macbeth's line: “Which thou esteem’st the _____ of life”

Key: ornament

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth say the drunk chamberlains' memory will become?

A. A fume

B. A clear record

C. A prayer

D. A song

Key: A (A fume)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Lady Macbeth plan to make drunk?

A. Malcolm and Donalbain

B. Duncan's two chamberlains

C. Banquo and Fleance

D. The porter at the gate

Key: B (Duncan's two chamberlains)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who will be blamed for the deed, according to the plan?

    A. The three Witches

    B. The Norwegians

    C. The sleepy guards

    D. Malcolm, the heir

    Key: C (The sleepy guards)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Macbeth decide at first not to go ahead?

    Sample answer: He tells his wife they will proceed no further because Duncan has honoured him of late and he has bought golden opinions from all sorts of people, which he wants to enjoy in their newest gloss. In his soliloquy he also fears judgment here, remembers that Duncan is his kinsman, king and guest, and admits his only spur is vaulting ambition.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Lady Macbeth persuade Macbeth to change his mind?

    Sample answer: She mocks his love and courage, asking if his hope was drunk and calling him a coward who lets I dare not wait upon I would. She says he was a man when he dared to do it. She claims she would have broken even the strongest promise rather than break an oath like his, and then gives a clear plan with the drunk chamberlains to take the blame.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does “If it were done when ’tis done” show about Macbeth's wish?

    A. He wants the act to end with no consequences

    B. He wants Duncan to leave at once

    C. He wants to finish his supper with the guests

    D. He wants the Witches to return

    Key: A (He wants the act to end with no consequences)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth fear in “Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor”?

    A. His teachers will punish him for disobedience

    B. Violence will come back on him

    C. Duncan will teach others

    D. The guards will learn the plan

    Key: B (Violence will come back on him)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “Bring forth men-_____ only”

    Key: children

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth say about Duncan's virtues?

    A. They make him weak and easy to defeat

    B. They are false and only for show

    C. They will plead like angels against the deed

    D. They will soon be forgotten

    Key: C (They will plead like angels against the deed)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Lady Macbeth compare Macbeth to in 'the poor cat i' the adage'?

    A. One who hunts at night in the dark of the castle

B. One who sleeps all day

C. One who fights fiercely

D. One who wants something but fears to act

Key: D (One who wants something but fears to act)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Macbeth answer her taunt about courage?

A. I dare do all that may become a man

B. I will prove my courage to you in battle

C. I fear nothing at all

D. Leave me alone tonight

Key: A (I dare do all that may become a man)

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What question shows Macbeth's last doubt?

A. What will the Witches say when they hear of it?

B. If we should fail?

C. Where is Banquo?

D. When does Duncan sleep?

Key: B (If we should fail?)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth mean by “False face must hide what the false heart doth know”?

A. He wants to wear a mask at the feast tonight

B. His face is too honest

C. They must hide their guilt behind calm faces

D. He doubts his wife's heart

Key: C (They must hide their guilt behind calm faces)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macbeth's soliloquy show his conscience at work?

Sample answer: He imagines the consequences: even-handed justice will return the poisoned chalice to his own lips. He lists the double trust that should protect Duncan, as kinsman, subject and host, and imagines Duncan's virtues pleading like angels and pity like a naked new-born babe blowing the deed into every eye. His mind sees clearly that the act is wrong.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What plan does Lady Macbeth lay out?

Sample answer: When Duncan is asleep after his hard journey, she will ply his two chamberlains with wine until their memory is a fume and they lie in swinish sleep. Then the unguarded king will be at the Macbeths' mercy, and the drunk officers, marked with blood and with their own daggers used, will bear the guilt. The couple will then roar with grief to avoid suspicion.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “We’ld jump the life to come” suggest?

A. He would risk judgment after death

B. He would leave Scotland forever

C. He would skip the rest of the feast tonight

D. He would abandon his wife

Key: A (He would risk judgment after death)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the image of "pity, like a naked new-born babe" add to the soliloquy?

    A. A child is about to be born to the Macbeths

    B. Innocence becomes a powerful force against the deed

    C. Pity is weak and easy to ignore

    D. Heaven is unaware of what happens on earth

    Key: B (Innocence becomes a powerful force against the deed)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does "Vaulting ambition, which o'erleaps itself And falls on the other" work as an image?

    A. A soldier who climbs a castle wall

    B. A bird that flies into a storm

    C. A rider who jumps too far and falls

    D. A runner who wins a race against a stronger man

    Key: C (A rider who jumps too far and falls)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Lady Macbeth's question: "Was the hope _____ Wherein you dress'd yourself?"

    Key: drunk

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What view of manhood does Lady Macbeth use against her husband?

    A. A man should obey his king in everything

    B. A man should be gentle

    C. Men must share their fears

    D. Daring to act is what makes a man

    Key: D (Daring to act is what makes a man)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Macbeth define manhood in reply?

    A. By limits: doing only what becomes a man

    B. By strength in battle against enemies

    C. By wealth and land

    D. By obedience to his wife

    Key: A (By limits: doing only what becomes a man)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does "Bring forth men-children only" reveal about Macbeth's reaction?

    A. He wants to start a family at once

    B. He admires her fierce resolve

    C. He mocks her softness

    D. He fears for his children

    Key: B (He admires her fierce resolve)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What turns Macbeth from refusal to agreement?

    A. A new message from the Witches

    B. Duncan's insult

C. Her taunts and her practical plan

D. Banquo's advice to be patient and wait

Key: C (Her taunts and her practical plan)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the structure of Macbeth's 'If it were done' soliloquy.

Sample answer: The speech moves from a wish that the act could be quick and final, to fear of judgment here, to the moral reasons of double trust, to visions of Duncan's virtues and pity spreading the deed to every eye. It ends with the admission that only vaulting ambition drives him. The structure shows his reason building the case against his own desire.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how Lady Macbeth uses language to manipulate her husband.

Sample answer: She uses questions that sting, like Was the hope drunk Wherein you dress'd yourself? She links his love to his courage, compares him to the poor cat in the adage, and argues that he was a man when he dared. A shocking vow about her own child shows her commitment. When he asks If we should fail? she answers with confidence and a plan.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the opening stage direction contribute to the scene?

A. A feast continues while murder is planned

B. The king leaves the castle in anger

C. Banquo enters with the Witches

D. The guards discover the plot against the king

Key: A (A feast continues while murder is planned)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which argument in the soliloquy is most practical rather than moral?

A. Duncan's virtues plead like angels

B. Bloody instructions return to plague the inventor

C. Pity strides the blast like a babe

D. He is Duncan's kinsman and subject

Key: B (Bloody instructions return to plague the inventor)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Lady Macbeth's 'We fail!' function?

A. It admits that they will surely fail

B. It mocks Duncan's guards

C. It dismisses failure as unthinkable

D. It ends the conversation

Key: C (It dismisses failure as unthinkable)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's couplet: “Away, and mock the time with fairest _____”

Key: show

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the closing couplet echo?

A. Duncan's praise of the castle

B. Banquo's martlet

C. The Sergeant's report of Macbeth in the battle

D. Lady Macbeth's 'look like the innocent flower'

Key: D (Lady Macbeth's 'look like the innocent flower')

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is significant about Macbeth's word “settled” at the end?

A. He commits body and will to the deed

B. He decides to stay at the castle

C. He settles a debt

D. He gives up his plans and leaves for the battle

Key: A (He commits body and will to the deed)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Who is more to blame for the decision reached at the end of Act I, and why?

Sample answer: Macbeth's soliloquy shows he knows the deed is wrong and that only ambition drives him, and he first refuses. Lady Macbeth shames him, questions his manhood and offers a plan, and he then agrees. A strong answer weighs her pressure against his knowledge and his final choice, I am settled, and argues a position with evidence.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the role of gender in the argument between Macbeth and his wife.

Sample answer: Lady Macbeth says that when he dared, he was a man, and that to be more than he was would make him more a man. Macbeth answers that he dares do all that may become a man; who dares more is none. She then describes a vow so violent it goes against a mother's nature. Each defines manhood differently, and her version wins.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's question about the guards' daggers reveal?

A. He refuses to take part in it

B. He is now thinking through the plan

C. He suspects his wife of a trick against him

D. He wants the guards spared

Key: B (He is now thinking through the plan)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene reverse Macbeth's opening decision?

Sample answer: Macbeth begins with reasons not to act and tells his wife they will proceed no further. By the end he says he is settled and bends up each corporal agent to this terrible feat. Between these points Lady Macbeth attacks his courage and gives a plan. A strong answer traces the stages of the reversal and the arguments that cause it.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act I, Scene VII develops the idea of the decision to murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene VII" could deliver about the decision to murder. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the decision to murder in "Act I, Scene VII": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act I, Scene VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the decision to murder. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene VII" could deliver about the decision to murder. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the decision to murder in "Act I, Scene VII": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act I, Scene VII suggests about the decision to murder. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene VII" could deliver about the decision to murder. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the decision to murder in "Act I, Scene VII": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act I, Scene VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the decision to murder. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act I, Scene VII" could deliver about the decision to murder. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the decision to murder in "Act I, Scene VII": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Nor time nor place Did then adhere, and yet you would make both: They have made themselves, and that their fitness now Does unmake you.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "fitness" most nearly mean?

   A. clinging to; refusing to come off (like blood)

   B. the person who first devised something

   C. fearless; not discouraged

   D. suitability; readiness

2. *If it were done when 'tis done, then 'twere well It were done quickly: if the assassination Could trammel up the consequence, and catch With his surcease success; that but this blow Might be the be-all and the end-all here, But here, upon this bank and shoal of time, We'ld jump the life to come. But in these cases We still have judgment here; that we but teach Bloody instructions, which, being taught, return To plague the inventor: this even-handed justice Commends the ingredients of our poison'd chalice To our own lips. He's here in double trust; First, as I am his kinsman and his subject, Strong both against the deed; then, as his host, Who should against his murderer shut the door, Not bear the knife myself. Besides, this Duncan Hath borne his faculties so meek, hath been So clear in his great office, that his virtues Will plead like angels, trumpet-tongued, against The deep damnation of his taking-off; And pity, like a naked new-born babe, Striding the blast, or heaven's cherubim, horsed Upon the sightless couriers of the air, Shall blow the horrid deed in every eye, That tears shall drown the wind. I have no spur To prick the sides of my intent, but only Vaulting ambition, which o'erleaps itself And falls on the other.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act I, Scene VII"?

   A. The guilt that will not wash away

   B. The decision to murder

   C. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

   D. The apparitions and false security

SAT key: 1. D (suitability; readiness); 2. B (The decision to murder)

Lesson 10: Act II, Scene I

Focus: the dagger of the mind

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act II, Scene I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…Banquo and Fleance. Go bid thy mistress, when my drink is ready, She strike upon the bell. Get…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Suggested language: “What does this detail add to the scene?”

Teacher only · spoilers

After midnight Banquo, unable to sleep, tells Fleance of 'cursed thoughts' and gives Macbeth a diamond from the king for Lady Macbeth. Banquo mentions dreaming of the Witches; Macbeth claims he does not think of them and hints at future honor if Banquo will 'cleave to my consent'; Banquo agrees only if he keeps his allegiance clear. Alone, Macbeth sees a dagger in the air leading him to Duncan, wonders if it is 'a dagger of the mind', and goes when the bell rings: 'Hear it not, Duncan; for it is a knell.'

Background: Plays at the Globe were performed in daylight, so night had to be created by words: references to darkness, torches and the bell signal the hour.

Significance: The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, and the play keeps asking whether what Macbeth sees is real.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: dudgeon — the handle of a dagger; allegiance — loyalty owed to a ruler; husbandry — thrift; careful saving; palpable — able to be touched or felt; augment — to increase. “allegiance”: Origin: Anglo-Norman alegaunce. “husbandry”: Origin: an English formation from husband + -ry. “palpable”: Origin: Middle French palpable; earlier Latin palpābilis. “augment”: Origin: Middle French augmenter; earlier Old French augmenter.
Words: dudgeon: the handle of a dagger · allegiance: loyalty owed to a ruler · husbandry: thrift; careful saving · palpable: able to be touched or felt · augment: to increase

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Plays at the Globe were performed in daylight, so night had to be created by words: references to darkness, torches and the bell signal the hour. The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, and the play keeps asking whether what Macbeth sees is real. Soliloquy: The dagger speech: Macbeth sees a dagger "of the mind," then real blood on it; he cannot tell imagination from reality. Dialogue: Banquo admits dreaming of the weird sisters; Macbeth lies ("I think not of them") and hints at reward for support. Imagery: Night, witchcraft, Tarquin's "ravishing strides": the world of the murder. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” slowly and put it in my own words: Alone before the murder, Macbeth sees a dagger floating in the air, its handle toward his hand. Next, craft. I notice the question he asks himself, which shows he cannot tell what is real. The strongest word is “dagger”: it is the weapon he is about to use, now appearing as a vision. Then, effect. What does the dagger vision show about Macbeth's mind? My answer: His mind is already guilty and disturbed; the dagger leads him toward Duncan's room, as if his imagination is pulling him into the crime.

> *Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand* (Act II, Scene I, lines 615–616)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” slowly and put it in my own words: Alone before the murder, Macbeth sees a dagger floating in the air, its handle toward his hand. Next, craft. I notice the question he asks himself, which shows he cannot tell what is real. The strongest word is “dagger”: it is the weapon he is about to use, now appearing as a vision. Then, effect. What does the dagger vision show about Macbeth's mind? My answer: His mind is already guilty and disturbed; the dagger leads him toward Duncan's room, as if his imagination is pulling him into the crime.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Dagger of the mind", "false creation" and "heat-oppressed" stand out. Macbeth tells himself the dagger is not real, only the product of a fevered, overheated brain. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected student answer: The dagger appears before any murder, so the line shows guilt at work in advance: Macbeth's conscience pictures the deed before his hand does it.

> *A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain* (Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Dagger of the mind", "false creation" and "heat-oppressed" stand out. Macbeth tells himself the dagger is not real, only the product of a fevered, overheated brain.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected student answer: The dagger appears before any murder, so the line shows guilt at work in advance: Macbeth's conscience pictures the deed before his hand does it.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for soliloquy, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of the dagger of the mind. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. When the text says "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621), it shows this directly. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done."
Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, dialogue (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of the dagger of the mind. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. When the text says "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621), it shows this directly. He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there? Ask: should a production show the dagger? Argue from the text.
Anchor question: Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?
Facilitation: Ask: should a production show the dagger? Argue from the text.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. ("A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain", Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the dagger of the mind? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. ("A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain", Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how soliloquy shapes the dagger of the mind. Key takeaway: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** The dagger speech: Macbeth sees a dagger "of the mind," then real blood on it; he cannot tell imagination from reality.
- **Dialogue:** Banquo admits dreaming of the weird sisters; Macbeth lies ("I think not of them") and hints at reward for support.
- **Imagery:** Night, witchcraft, Tarquin's "ravishing strides": the world of the murder.

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, lines 615–616) The hallucination.
- "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621) He knows it is imaginary.
- "I go, and it is done; the bell invites me" (Act II, Scene I, line 644) Decision.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills.
Evidence: "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621)
Reasoning: He calls it "a dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain," knowing his imagination is creating the weapon, yet he follows it: "I go, and it is done."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
dudgeon (noun)	the handle of a dagger	*Mine eyes are made the fools o' the other senses, Or else worth all the rest; I see thee still, And on thy blade and dudgeon gouts of blood, Which was not so before.*	
allegiance (noun)	loyalty owed to a ruler	*So I lose none In seeking to augment it, but still keep My bosom franchised and allegiance clear, I shall be counsell'd.*	"allegiance": Origin: Anglo-Norman alegaunce. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/allegiance#Etymology)
husbandry (noun)	thrift; careful saving	*There's husbandry in heaven; Their candles are all out.*	"husbandry": Origin: an English formation from husband + -ry. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/husbandry#Etymology)
palpable (adjective)	able to be touched or felt	*I see thee yet, in form as palpable As this which now I draw.*	"palpable": Origin: Middle French palpable; earlier Latin palpābilis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/palpable#Etymology)

augment (verb)	to increase	*So I lose none In seeking to augment it, but still keep My bosom franchised and allegiance clear, I shall be counsell'd.*	"augment": Origin: Middle French augmenter; earlier Old French augmenter. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/augment#Etymology)
whereabout (noun)	the place where someone is	*Thou sure and firm-set earth, Hear not my steps, which way they walk, for fear Thy very stones prate of my whereabout, And take the present horror from the time, Which now suits with it.*	
largess (noun)	generous gifts of money	*The king's a-bed: He hath been in unusual pleasure, and Sent forth great largess to your offices.*	
measureless (adjective)	without limit	*This diamond he greets your wife withal, By the name of most kind hostess; and shut up In measureless content.*	
invites (verb)	calls (someone) to come	*I go, and it is done; the bell invites me.*	
summons (noun)	a call to come or act	*A heavy summons lies like lead upon me, And yet I would not sleep: merciful powers, Restrain in me the cursed thoughts that nature Gives way to in repose!*	

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth say the bell is to Duncan? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A knell that summons him to heaven or to hell. **Answer guidance:** A knell that summons him to heaven or to hell.

2. Why can Banquo not sleep? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He is troubled by cursed thoughts

   Answer guidance: He is troubled by cursed thoughts.
3. What gift does Banquo pass on from Duncan to Lady Macbeth? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A diamond

   Answer guidance: A diamond.
4. What does Macbeth see before him? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A dagger leading him toward Duncan's chamber

   Answer guidance: A dagger leading him toward Duncan's chamber.
5. Under what condition will Banquo support Macbeth? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** If he loses no honor and keeps his allegiance clear

   Answer guidance: If he loses no honor and keeps his allegiance clear.
6. What signal tells Macbeth to act? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A bell

   Answer guidance: A bell.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act II, Scene I" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** After midnight Banquo, unable to sleep, tells Fleance of 'cursed thoughts' and gives Macbeth a diamond from the king for Lady Macbeth. Banquo mentions dreaming of the Witches; Macbeth claims he does not think of them and hints at future honor if Banquo will 'cleave to my consent'; Banquo agrees only if he keeps his allegiance clear. Alone, Macbeth sees a dagger in the air leading him to Duncan,…

   Answer guidance: After midnight Banquo, unable to sleep, tells Fleance of 'cursed thoughts' and gives Macbeth a diamond from the king for Lady Macbeth. Banquo mentions dreaming of the Witches; Macbeth claims he does not think of them and hints at future honor if Banquo will 'cleave to my consent'; Banquo agrees only if he keeps his allegiance clear. Alone, Macbeth sees a dagger in the air leading him to Duncan,…
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act II, Scene I" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Mine eyes are made the fools o' the other senses, Or else worth all the rest; I see thee still, And on thy blade and dudgeon gouts of blood, Which was not so before." What does "dudgeon" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** dudgeon: the handle of a dagger.

    Answer guidance: dudgeon: the handle of a dagger.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth ask 'Is this a dagger which I see before me'? What does his uncertainty reveal? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** His mind is overheated by guilt; he cannot tell imagination from reality.
   Answer guidance: His mind is overheated by guilt; he cannot tell imagination from reality.
2. What does “Act II, Scene I” suggest about the dagger of the mind? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, and the play keeps asking whether what Macbeth sees is real.
   Answer guidance: The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, and the play keeps asking whether what Macbeth sees is real. Evidence to accept: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, lines 615–616): The hallucination. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of imagery in “Act II, Scene I”. What does it reveal about the dagger of the mind that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621): He knows it is imaginary. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the characterization in “Act II, Scene I” shape what we understand about the dagger of the mind? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, lines 615–616): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “The curtain’d sleep; witchcraft…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, line 644): Decision. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the bell that sends Macbeth to the murder after the dagger vision; evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me.”
   Answer guidance: Look for: the bell that sends Macbeth to the murder after the dagger vision; evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me.”. Evidence to accept: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, lines 615–616): The hallucination. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Act II, Scene I” build on “Act I, Scene VII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621): He knows it is imaginary. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Act II, Scene I”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the dagger of the mind, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, line 644): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Have you ever been so anxious or guilty that you imagined something that was not there?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621): He knows it is imaginary. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does setting appear in “Act II, Scene I”, and how does it connect the dagger of the mind to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, lines 615–616): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should the dagger be shown on stage, or left invisible? Which choice better serves the play? [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A staging argument tied to the open question of the supernatural.
   Answer guidance: A staging argument tied to the open question of the supernatural.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The dagger soliloquy dramatizes a mind dividing against itself; whether the dagger is supernatural or hallucinated is left open, and the play keeps asking whether what Macbeth sees is real. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain

why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, line 644): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in “Act II, Scene I” acts most wisely in the matter of the dagger of the mind, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, lines 615–616): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the dagger of the mind. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain” (Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621): He knows it is imaginary. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act II, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “I go, and it is done; the bell invites me” (Act II, Scene I, line 644): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act II, Scene I”, with its focus on the dagger of the mind, to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: “Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand” (Act II, Scene I, lines 615–616): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in "Act II, Scene I" effective in presenting the dagger of the mind, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621): He knows it is imaginary. On imagery: Night, witchcraft, Tarquin's "ravishing strides": the world of the murder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how "Act II, Scene I" treats the dagger of the mind with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: "I go, and it is done; the bell invites me" (Act II, Scene I, line 644): Decision. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Act II, Scene II" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: "Is this a dagger which I see before me, / The handle toward my hand" (Act II, Scene I, lines 615–616): The hallucination. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Act II, Scene I" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the dagger of the mind? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The dagger speech shows that Macbeth's conscience is already tormenting him before he kills. Useful evidence: "A dagger of the mind, a false creation, / Proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain" (Act II, Scene I, lines 620–621): He knows it is imaginary. Theme link: guilt begins before the deed; his mind projects the act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is with Banquo at the start of the scene?
   A. His son Fleance
   B. Macduff, on his way to the king
   C. Lady Macbeth
   D. A porter carrying the keys

   Key: A (His son Fleance)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has happened to the moon?
   A. It is shining full and bright over the castle
   B. It has gone down
   C. It is hidden by storms
   D. It has just risen

   Key: B (It has gone down)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Banquo hand to Fleance before Macbeth enters?
   A. A letter from the king
   B. A torch
   C. His sword
   D. A purse

   Key: C (His sword)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has Banquo dreamt about?
   A. A battle with Norway
   B. His dead father
   C. A storm at sea
   D. The three weird sisters

   Key: D (The three weird sisters)
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Banquo's question: “How goes the night, _____?”

   Key: boy
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth tell the servant to do?
   A. Tell his mistress to strike the bell
   B. Fetch Banquo back to the chamber
   C. Wake the king and his sons
   D. Bring him a torch and his cloak

   Key: A (Tell his mistress to strike the bell)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What appears on the vision's blade after a moment?
   A. Words in fire
   B. Gouts of blood
   C. A tiny crown
   D. Nothing at all

   Key: B (Gouts of blood)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth draw while he speaks to the vision?

   A. A map of the castle and its rooms

   B. A heavy curtain

   C. His own dagger

   D. A sealed letter

   Key: C (His own dagger)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What does Macbeth see in his soliloquy, and how does he explain it?

   Sample answer: He sees a dagger before him with its handle toward his hand, but he cannot grasp it. He wonders whether it is a dagger of the mind, a false creation from his heat-oppressed brain. When blood appears on the blade he decides there is no such thing: it is the bloody business he is planning that informs his eyes.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why can't Banquo sleep at the start of the scene?

    Sample answer: He says a heavy summons lies like lead upon him, yet he does not want to sleep. He asks merciful powers to hold back the wicked thoughts that nature lets in during repose. He later admits he dreamt of the weird sisters. Their words seem to trouble him, and he fears what dreams may bring.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Banquo mean by "There's husbandry in heaven; Their candles are all out"?

    A. Heaven is saving its light; no stars shine

    B. The servants have put the castle's candles out

    C. Heaven is angry with the king

    D. The night will soon end

    Key: A (Heaven is saving its light; no stars shine)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Banquo call for his sword when he hears someone?

    A. He wants to give it to Fleance as a gift

    B. He is uneasy in the dark

    C. He plans to attack Macbeth

    D. He has been ordered to guard the king

    Key: B (He is uneasy in the dark)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Macbeth respond when Banquo mentions the weird sisters?

    A. He admits he dreams of them every night

    B. He laughs at Banquo

    C. He says he does not think of them

    D. He asks Banquo to leave

    Key: C (He says he does not think of them)

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: "Mine eyes are made the _____ o' the other senses"

    Key: fools

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth offer Banquo if he will cleave to his consent?

    A. A share of the king's gold and land

    B. A place at court

    C. Protection from the Witches

    D. It shall make honour for him

    Key: D (It shall make honour for him)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What condition does Banquo set in reply?

    A. He must keep his allegiance clear

    B. He must be paid in land before he agrees to help

    C. He must be named heir

    D. He must speak to the king first

    Key: A (He must keep his allegiance clear)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does “Whiles I threat, he lives” show Macbeth realizing?

    A. Threats will frighten the king off

    B. Talking delays the deed

    C. Duncan is already awake

    D. Words can kill

    Key: B (Talking delays the deed)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth ask the earth not to hear?

    A. His prayers

    B. The bell

    C. His steps

    D. The wolf

    Key: C (His steps)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the conversation between Banquo and Macbeth show a difference between them?

    Sample answer: Banquo openly says he dreamt of the weird sisters and that they showed Macbeth some truth. Macbeth claims he thinks not of them but hints at a future talk and promises honour if Banquo cleaves to his consent. Banquo agrees only if he can keep his bosom franchised and allegiance clear. Banquo protects his honour; Macbeth hides his purpose.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the setting of night add to the scene?

    Sample answer: The moon is down, no stars shine, and Banquo carries a torch. Macbeth says that over half the world nature seems dead and wicked dreams abuse the curtained sleep, while witchcraft and withered murder move like a ghost. The darkness hides deeds and fills the scene with fear and guilt.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's failure to grasp the vision suggest about his mind?

    A. Guilt and resolve are working on his senses

    B. He has been bewitched by Banquo's dream of the sisters

    C. He is calm and certain

D. He has given up the plan

Key: A (Guilt and resolve are working on his senses)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “Thou marshall’st me the way that I was going” imply?

A. The dagger forces him to act against his own will and wishes

B. The vision leads him where he already meant to go

C. He has lost his way in the dark

D. Banquo has guided him to the room

Key: B (The vision leads him where he already meant to go)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Banquo's prayer against 'cursed thoughts' suggest?

A. He suspects Fleance of a plot

B. He has decided to betray the king

C. He too is tempted but resists

D. He has no thoughts of the Witches

Key: C (He too is tempted but resists)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Banquo's line: “There’s _____ in heaven; Their candles are all out”

Key: husbandry

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the allusion to “Tarquin’s ravishing strides” add to Macbeth's speech?

A. A hero who saves a kingdom from its foreign enemies

B. A god of sleep and dreams

C. A king who was wise and just

D. A famous crime that makes his own seem monstrous

Key: D (A famous crime that makes his own seem monstrous)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of personifying murder as moving “like a ghost”?

A. It makes the deed seem silent and inhuman

B. It shows that the king is already dead in his chamber

C. It makes the scene comic

D. It shows that Banquo is watching

Key: A (It makes the deed seem silent and inhuman)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does Macbeth want the stones not to “prate” of his whereabout?

A. He wants to walk quietly to his own bed for the night

B. He fears even nature might betray him

C. He enjoys the silence

D. He is looking for Banquo

Key: B (He fears even nature might betray him)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the closing couplet's 'knell' imply?

    A. The bell calls Macbeth and his household to prayer

    B. The bell announces morning

    C. The bell rings for Duncan's death

    D. The bell warns the guards

    Key: C (The bell rings for Duncan's death)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the dagger soliloquy as a turning point.

    Sample answer: Macbeth sees a dagger he cannot clutch, decides it is a dagger of the mind, and then sees blood on it. He describes a night of witchcraft and withered murder and asks the earth not to hear his steps. When the bell rings he says I go, and it is done. The speech moves from doubt and hallucination to action.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how Banquo and Macbeth handle the subject of the Witches differently.

    Sample answer: Banquo admits he dreamt of the weird sisters and that they showed Macbeth some truth. Macbeth lies, saying he thinks not of them, and then fishes for Banquo's support with a promise of honour. Banquo agrees only if he keeps his allegiance clear. Banquo's honesty sharpens our sense of Macbeth's secrecy.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What dramatic purpose does Fleance serve in this opening?

    A. He reminds us that Banquo has a son

    B. He warns Macbeth about the king's guards

    C. He carries Duncan's gift

    D. He rings the bell

    Key: A (He reminds us that Banquo has a son)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “Being unprepared, Our will became the servant to defect” accomplish?

    A. An open admission of his whole plan to Banquo

    B. A polite excuse that hides his real thoughts

    C. An insult to Duncan's men

    D. A request for more time

    Key: B (A polite excuse that hides his real thoughts)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the dagger soliloquy blur the line between the inner and outer world?

    A. Banquo also sees the dagger and tells his son about it

    B. The Witches speak aloud

    C. A vision seems as real as a drawn blade

    D. The bell is imaginary

    Key: C (A vision seems as real as a drawn blade)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Banquo's line: “He hath been in unusual _____”

    Key: pleasure

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of the rhyming couplet that ends the scene?

    A. It makes the scene playful

    B. It shows Macbeth's doubt

C. It introduces a new speaker

D. It gives a grim sense of finality

Key: D (It gives a grim sense of finality)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth's reference to “Pale Hecate’s offerings” link the night to?

A. Witchcraft and the powers of darkness

B. Christian prayer and holy light

C. The battle with Norway

D. Duncan's gifts

Key: A (Witchcraft and the powers of darkness)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the dagger is a supernatural sign or a product of Macbeth's mind.

Sample answer: Macbeth himself asks whether it is a dagger of the mind, a false creation proceeding from the heat-oppressed brain, and then says there is no such thing. Yet the Witches and Hecate are real forces in the play, and he speaks of witchcraft celebrating. A strong answer weighs the text's evidence and takes a position.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how sound is used in the scene.

Sample answer: The scene is mostly silent and dark: no clock is heard, Banquo starts at footsteps, and Macbeth begs the stones not to prate of his whereabouts. The wolf's howl is murder's watch. Then a bell rings, which Macbeth turns into a knell for Duncan. Sound marks fear and decision in the darkness.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which line best shows Macbeth moving from thought to action?

A. I see thee still

B. I go, and it is done

C. There's no such thing

D. Come, let me clutch thee

Key: B (I go, and it is done)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Banquo's reply to Macbeth's offer of honour matter to the rest of the scene?

Sample answer: When Macbeth suggests that cleaving to his consent will bring honour, Banquo answers that he will listen only so long as seeking more costs him nothing of his good name and his duty to the king stays unstained. This tells Macbeth that Banquo will not join a crime, so Macbeth must act alone. It also sets Banquo as a moral contrast for the dagger soliloquy that follows.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene I develops the idea of the dagger of the mind. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act II, Scene I" could deliver about the dagger of the mind. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the dagger of the mind in "Act II, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the dagger of the mind. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act II, Scene I" could deliver about the dagger of the mind. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the dagger of the mind in "Act II, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene I suggests about the dagger of the mind. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act II, Scene I" could deliver about the dagger of the mind. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the dagger of the mind in "Act II, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act II, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the dagger of

the mind. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act II, Scene I" could deliver about the dagger of the mind. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the dagger of the mind in "Act II, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *I see thee yet, in form as palpable As this which now I draw.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "palpable" most nearly mean?

   A. able to be touched or felt

   B. calls (someone) to come

   C. without limit

   D. a call to come or act

2. *The curtain'd sleep; witchcraft celebrates Pale Hecate's offerings, and wither'd murder, Alarum'd by his sentinel, the wolf, Whose howl's his watch, thus with his stealthy pace, With Tarquin's ravishing strides, towards his design Moves like a ghost. Thou sure and firm-set earth, Hear not my steps, which way they walk, for fear Thy very stones prate of my whereabout, And take the present horror from the time, Which now suits with it. Whiles I threat, he lives: Words to the heat of deeds too cold breath gives. A bell rings. I go, and it is done; the bell invites me. Hear it not, Duncan; for it is a knell That summons thee to heaven or to hell.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene I"?

   A. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

   B. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

   C. Insecurity on the throne

   D. The dagger of the mind

SAT key: 1. A (able to be touched or felt); 2. D (The dagger of the mind)

Lesson 11: Act II, Scene II

Focus: the murder and its first guilt

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Act II, Scene II" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (murder, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Duncan's murder happens offstage; the scene shows blood and guilt. Allow students to discuss the aftermath without dwelling on the act. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…me. Enter Lady Macbeth. That which hath made them drunk hath made me bold; What hath quench'd t…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Suggested language: "What does each character notice first, and why?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Lady Macbeth waits, saying she would have killed Duncan herself had he not resembled her father as he slept. Macbeth returns from the murder with bloody hands, haunted that he could not say 'Amen' and that a voice cried 'Macbeth does murder sleep.' He has carried the daggers away; he refuses to return, so she takes them back and smears the grooms with blood. Knocking sounds at the gate; Macbeth says all great Neptune's ocean could not wash the blood from his hand, and wishes the knocking could wake Duncan.

Background: The murder happens offstage; Shakespeare shows its aftermath rather than the act. Blood, sleep and hands become the play's key image clusters.

Significance: The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line is a confident claim the play will put to the test.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: surfeited — overfed; here, drunk; nightgown — a dressing gown worn over night clothes; resembled — looked like; nourisher — something that feeds and sustains; watchers — people who stay awake. “surfeited”: Origin of “surfeit”: Anglo-Norman surfet. “resembled”: Origin of “resemble”: Anglo-Norman resembler.
Words: surfeited: overfed; here, drunk · nightgown: a dressing gown worn over night clothes · resembled: looked like · nourisher: something that feeds and sustains · watchers: people who stay awake

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The murder happens offstage; Shakespeare shows its aftermath rather than the act. Blood, sleep and hands become the play's key image clusters. The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line is a confident claim the play will put to the test. Dialogue: Short, broken lines between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth after the murder show panic. Imagery: Blood on hands; "Macbeth does murder sleep"; "all great Neptune's ocean." Characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” slowly and put it in my own words: After the murder, Macbeth says he heard a voice cry that Macbeth has murdered sleep. Next, craft. I notice "sleep" repeated, and personified as a victim. The strongest word is “murder”: Macbeth uses it of sleep itself, so he has killed peace of mind. Then, effect. What does the voice crying "Sleep no more!" mean? My answer: The voice crying "Sleep no more!" means that Macbeth's guilt will deny him rest, and the loss of sleep becomes his punishment.

> *Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep* (Act II, Scene II, lines 692–693)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” slowly and put it in my own words: After the murder, Macbeth says he heard a voice cry that Macbeth has murdered sleep. Next, craft. I notice "sleep" repeated, and personified as a victim. The strongest word is “murder”: Macbeth uses it of sleep itself, so he has killed peace of mind. Then, effect. What does the voice crying "Sleep no more!" mean? My answer: The voice crying "Sleep no more!" means that Macbeth's guilt will deny him rest, and the loss of sleep becomes his punishment.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Great Neptune's ocean", "blood" and "clean" stand out. Macbeth imagines the whole sea unable to wash one hand, so the hyperbole measures how large his guilt feels. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected student answer: The line shows guilt as a stain nothing can remove; Macbeth believes no water will make him clean, while his wife thinks a little will.

> *Will all great Neptune's ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand* (Act II, Scene II, lines 721–722)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Great Neptune's ocean", "blood" and "clean" stand out. Macbeth imagines the whole sea unable to wash one hand, so the hyperbole measures how large his guilt feels.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected student answer: The line shows guilt as a stain nothing can remove; Macbeth believes no water will make him clean, while his wife thinks a little will.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dialogue, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the murder and its first guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. When the text says "A little water clears us of this deed" (Act II, Scene II, line 729), it shows this directly. He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," as if guilt washes off easily.
Task: Annotate the scene for dialogue, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the murder and its first guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. When the text says "A little water clears us of this deed" (Act II, Scene II, line 729), it shows this directly. He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," as if guilt washes off easily.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong? Ask: why can't Macbeth say "Amen"? What does that show about him?
Anchor question: Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?
Facilitation: Ask: why can't Macbeth say "Amen"? What does that show about him?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. ("A little water clears us of this deed", Act II, Scene II, line 729). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder and its first guilt? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. ("A little water clears us of this deed", Act II, Scene II, line 729). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dialogue shapes the murder and its first guilt. Key takeaway: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dialogue:** Short, broken lines between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth after the murder show panic.
- **Imagery:** Blood on hands; "Macbeth does murder sleep"; "all great Neptune's ocean."
- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror.

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Methought I heard a voice cry "Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep" (Act II, Scene II, lines 692–693) Sleep as innocence destroyed.
- "Will all great Neptune's ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand" (Act II, Scene II, lines 721–722) Hyperbole of guilt.
- "A little water clears us of this deed" (Act II, Scene II, line 729) Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse.
Evidence: "A little water clears us of this deed" (Act II, Scene II, line 729)
Reasoning: He asks whether "all great Neptune's ocean" can wash his hands clean, while she says "A little water clears us of this deed," as if guilt washes off easily.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
surfeited (adjective)	overfed; here, drunk	*He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg'd their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die.*	"surfeited": Origin of "surfeit": Anglo-Norman surfet. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/surfeit#Etymology)
nightgown (noun)	a dressing gown worn over night clothes	*Get on your nightgown, lest occasion call us, And show us to be watchers.*	
resembled (verb)	looked like	*Had he not resembled My father as he slept, I had done't.*	"resembled": Origin of "resemble": Anglo-Norman resembler. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/resemble#Etymology)
nourisher (noun)	something that feeds and sustains	*Macbeth does murder sleep," the innocent sleep, Sleep that knits up the ravell'd sleave of care, The death of each day's life, sore labour's bath, Balm of hurt minds, great nature's second course, Chief nourisher in life's feast—*	
watchers (noun)	people who stay awake	*Get on your nightgown, lest occasion call us, And show us to be watchers.*	

multitudinous (adjective)	vast; made up of countless waves	*No, this my hand will rather The multitudinous seas incarnadine, Making the green one red.*	
constancy (noun)	firmness of purpose	*Your constancy Hath left you unattended.*	
knocking (noun)	repeated striking on a door	*I hear a knocking At the south entry: retire we to our chamber: A little water clears us of this deed: How easy is it, then!*	

Discussion questions

1. Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Who carries the daggers back to Duncan's chamber? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Lady Macbeth.
   Answer guidance: Lady Macbeth.
2. Why did Lady Macbeth not kill Duncan herself? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He looked like her father as he slept
   Answer guidance: He looked like her father as he slept.
3. What word could Macbeth not say? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Amen
   Answer guidance: Amen.
4. What sound does Lady Macbeth hear at the south entry? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Knocking
   Answer guidance: Knocking.
5. What mistake does Macbeth make with the daggers? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He brings them away with him
   Answer guidance: He brings them away with him.
6. What does Lady Macbeth say will clear them of the deed? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A little water
   Answer guidance: A little water.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act II, Scene II" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:**

Lady Macbeth waits, saying she would have killed Duncan herself had he not resembled her father as he slept. Macbeth returns from the murder with bloody hands, haunted that he could not say 'Amen' and that a voice cried 'Macbeth does murder sleep.' He has carried the daggers away; he refuses to return, so she takes them back and smears the grooms with blood. Knocking sounds at the gate; Macbeth…

Answer guidance: Lady Macbeth waits, saying she would have killed Duncan herself had he not resembled her father as he slept. Macbeth returns from the murder with bloody hands, haunted that he could not say 'Amen' and that a voice cried 'Macbeth does murder sleep.' He has carried the daggers away; he refuses to return, so she takes them back and smears the grooms with blood. Knocking sounds at the gate; Macbeth…

8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when is "Act II, Scene II" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: "He is about it: The doors are open; and the surfeited grooms Do mock their charge with snores: I have drugg'd their possets, That death and nature do contend about them, Whether they live or die." What does "surfeited" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** surfeited: overfed; here, drunk.

    Answer guidance: surfeited: overfed; here, drunk.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth says his hand would rather turn the green sea red ('the multitudinous seas incarnadine'). How does this answer Lady Macbeth's 'A little water clears us'? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** He knows the guilt is spiritual and limitless; she treats it as a stain.

   Answer guidance: He knows the guilt is spiritual and limitless; she treats it as a stain.

2. What does "Act II, Scene II" suggest about the murder and its first guilt? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line is a confident claim the play will put to the test.

   Answer guidance: The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line is a confident claim the play will put to the test. Evidence to accept: "Methought I heard a voice cry "Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep" (Act II, Scene II, lines 692–693): Sleep as innocence destroyed. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of imagery in "Act II, Scene II". What does it reveal about the murder and its first guilt that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

Evidence to accept: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, lines 721–722): Hyperbole of guilt. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the symbolism in “Act II, Scene II” shape what we understand about the murder and its first guilt? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, lines 692–693): Sleep as innocence destroyed. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “But wherefore could not…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, line 729): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Macbeth returns having done the murder and brings the daggers with him; evidence: “I have done the deed.”
   Answer guidance: Look for: Macbeth returns having done the murder and brings the daggers with him; evidence: “I have done the deed.”. Evidence to accept: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, lines 692–693): Sleep as innocence destroyed. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Act II, Scene II” build on “Act II, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, lines 721–722): Hyperbole of guilt. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Act II, Scene II”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the murder and its first guilt, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, line 729): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why do people often feel guilt most strongly right after doing something wrong?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, lines 721–722): Hyperbole of guilt. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does characterization appear in “Act II, Scene II”, and how does it connect the murder and its first guilt to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, lines 692–693): Sleep as innocence destroyed. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Why might Shakespeare keep the murder offstage? Evaluate the effect compared with showing it. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Judgment about offstage violence and the audience's imagination.
   Answer guidance: Judgment about offstage violence and the audience's imagination.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The scene reverses positions: Macbeth falls apart and Lady Macbeth stays controlled ('A little water clears us of this deed'). Her line is a confident claim the play will put to the test. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, line 729): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act II, Scene II” acts most wisely in the matter of the murder and its first guilt, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, lines 692–693): Sleep as innocence destroyed. On characterization: Lady Macbeth's control ("A little water clears us of this deed") versus Macbeth's horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the murder and its first guilt. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, lines 721–722): Hyperbole of guilt. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write your own questions about “Act II, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, line 729): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect “Act II, Scene II”, with its focus on the murder and its first guilt, to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, lines 692–693): Sleep as innocence destroyed. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the imagery in “Act II, Scene II” effective in presenting the murder and its first guilt, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, lines 721–722): Hyperbole of guilt. On imagery: Blood on hands; "Macbeth does murder sleep"; "all great Neptune's ocean." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene II” treats the murder and its first guilt with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with

Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “A little water clears us of this deed” (Act II, Scene II, line 729): Lady Macbeth's confidence, ironic. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act II, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Methought I heard a voice cry “Sleep no more! / Macbeth does murder sleep” (Act II, Scene II, lines 692–693): Sleep as innocence destroyed. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act II, Scene II” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the murder and its first guilt? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The scene contrasts Macbeth's overwhelming guilt with Lady Macbeth's practical denial, a contrast the play will reverse. Useful evidence: “Will all great Neptune’s ocean wash this blood / Clean from my hand” (Act II, Scene II, lines 721–722): Hyperbole of guilt. Theme link: Macbeth cannot say "Amen"; he will "sleep no more." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has Lady Macbeth done to the grooms' drinks?

   A. Drugged their possets

   B. Poured their wine away

   C. Added extra water

   D. Taken their cups

   Key: A (Drugged their possets)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which bird does Lady Macbeth hear shriek?

   A. The raven

   B. The owl

   C. The martlet

   D. The crow

Key: B (The owl)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What are Macbeth's first words when he returns?
   A. Who lies in the second chamber, my love?
   B. Where is Banquo?
   C. I have done the deed
   D. Hide the daggers

   Key: C (I have done the deed)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Lady Macbeth's line: "That which hath made them drunk hath made me _____"

   Key: bold

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who sleeps in the second chamber?
   A. Malcolm
   B. Banquo
   C. Fleance
   D. Donalbain

   Key: D (Donalbain)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth call the sight of his hands?
   A. A sorry sight
   B. A noble sight
   C. A bad dream
   D. A cruel trick

   Key: A (A sorry sight)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth call the blood on her husband's hand?
   A. A badge of honour
   B. This filthy witness
   C. A trick of the light
   D. A sign from heaven

   Key: B (This filthy witness)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth tell Macbeth to put on?
   A. His armour
   B. His crown
   C. His nightgown
   D. His riding cloak

   Key: C (His nightgown)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Macbeth behave right after the deed?
   Sample answer: He is shaken and confused. He keeps asking about noises, stares at his bloody hands and calls them a sorry sight, and describes the two sleepers who woke and prayed. He is horrified that he could not join their prayer, and he hears voices about sleep. He refuses to go back and says he is afraid to think what he has done.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Lady Macbeth try to steady her husband?
    Sample answer: She tells him to consider it not so deeply, warns that thinking this way will make them mad, and calls his

thoughts brainsick. She orders him to wash the filthy witness from his hand and to smear the grooms with blood. When he will not go, she calls him infirm of purpose and does the task herself, then tells him to put on his nightgown.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Lady Macbeth mean by calling the owl "the fatal bellman"?
    A. It sounds like a death bell for Duncan
    B. It wakes the whole household every morning
    C. It warns that guests are coming
    D. It is a pet she keeps

    Key: A (It sounds like a death bell for Duncan)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does "The attempt and not the deed Confounds us" show she fears?
    A. Success will bring guilt
    B. Failing would ruin them
    C. The Witches lied to them
    D. Banquo knows the plan

    Key: B (Failing would ruin them)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: "As they had seen me with these _____'s hands"

    Key: hangman

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What do the two sleepers Macbeth overheard do after waking?
    A. Run to raise the alarm in the castle
    B. Call for the guards
    C. Say their prayers and sleep again
    D. Leave the castle

    Key: C (Say their prayers and sleep again)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Lady Macbeth mean by "the sleeping and the dead Are but as pictures"?
    A. They will come back to haunt them both before the dawn
    B. Painters should record the night
    C. They look peaceful
    D. They cannot harm anyone, so fear is childish

    Key: D (They cannot harm anyone, so fear is childish)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth say about looking at what he has done?
    A. He dares not look on it again
    B. He wants to see it once more to be sure
    C. He has forgotten it already
    D. He feels proud of it

    Key: A (He dares not look on it again)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Lady Macbeth mean by "I'll gild the faces of the grooms withal"?

    A. She will cover them with gold

    B. She will smear them with blood

    C. She will paint them to look asleep

    D. She will wake them

    Key: B (She will smear them with blood)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth mean by "Wake Duncan with thy knocking! I would thou couldst!"?

    A. He wants the guests to hurry inside

    B. He is angry at the porter for the noise

    C. He wishes the deed could be undone

    D. He hopes Duncan is still asleep

    Key: C (He wishes the deed could be undone)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How do the sounds in the scene build tension?

    Sample answer: Lady Macbeth starts at the owl's shriek and the crickets; Macbeth hears a noise, voices crying Murder and God bless us, and a voice crying Sleep no more. Then knocking begins at the south entry and grows louder. Each sound threatens discovery and shows how jumpy and guilty the couple feel.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the failed prayer show about Macbeth's state after the deed?

    Sample answer: When the sleepers said God bless us, Macbeth wanted to answer Amen because he had most need of blessing, but the word stuck in his throat. He feels cut off from prayer and from God's mercy. It is the first sign that the deed has separated him from grace and from ordinary comfort.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Lady Macbeth's admission that Duncan resembled her father reveal?

    A. She too has limits she cannot cross

    B. She hated her father deeply all her life

    C. She wanted Macbeth to fail

    D. She is not afraid at all

    Key: A (She too has limits she cannot cross)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the short, broken dialogue after Macbeth enters create effect?

    A. It shows that they are calm and in control

    B. It captures panic and fear

    C. It is a comic exchange

    D. It slows the action

    Key: B (It captures panic and fear)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Lady Macbeth's "Infirm of purpose!" reveal about how she sees him?

    A. As too violent for her to control

B. As wise and careful

C. As weak at the moment of need

D. As loyal to the king

Key: C (As weak at the moment of need)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Lady Macbeth's line: "'tis the eye of childhood That fears a painted _____"

Key: devil

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What hyperbole does Macbeth use in "this my hand will rather The multitudinous seas incarnadine"?

A. The sea will wash his hand clean again

B. His hand will drown in the sea

C. The sea is calm and green

D. His bloody hand would turn the oceans red

Key: D (His bloody hand would turn the oceans red)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Lady Macbeth's 'A little water clears us' contrast with Macbeth's view?

A. She thinks the guilt washes off; he fears it cannot

B. She thinks the guilt will last forever; he does not care

C. They agree that they must confess

D. They refuse to speak of blood

Key: A (She thinks the guilt washes off; he fears it cannot)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does "To know my deed, 'twere best not know myself" suggest?

A. He cannot remember anything of the night at all

B. He must lose himself to live with what he did

C. He wants to confess to everyone

D. He plans to leave Scotland

Key: B (He must lose himself to live with what he did)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does "My hands are of your colour; but I shame To wear a heart so white" imply?

A. She is innocent of the deed from the start

B. She is ashamed of her actions

C. She shares the guilt but mocks his fear

D. She wants to wash her hands

Key: C (She shares the guilt but mocks his fear)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how blood imagery develops in this scene.

Sample answer: Macbeth looks at his hands and calls them a sorry sight; Lady Macbeth calls the blood a filthy witness and plans to gild the grooms' faces with it. Macbeth then imagines that all great Neptune's ocean cannot wash his hand clean, and that the hand would turn the green sea red. Blood has become the mark of guilt, no longer of honour as in Act I.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how the scene reverses the couple's roles from Act I, Scene VII.

    Sample answer: In Act I it was Macbeth who wavered and his wife who pushed. Now Macbeth is overwhelmed by fear and hears voices, while Lady Macbeth stays practical, carries the daggers back and plans their cover. Yet her admission that Duncan looked like her father hints that her strength has limits, so the reversal is not complete.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of keeping the killing offstage?

    A. The audience imagines it through the couple's reactions

    B. The scene loses all of its tension and becomes calm

    C. It shows that the deed was not done

    D. It turns the focus to Banquo

    Key: A (The audience imagines it through the couple's reactions)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does Lady Macbeth's “These deeds must not be thought After these ways; so, it will make us mad” foreshadow?

    A. That they will be caught at dawn

    B. That reflection itself may break them

    C. That Macbeth will leave her

    D. That the Witches will return

    Key: B (That reflection itself may break them)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which shift in Macbeth's language marks his inner state most clearly?

    A. From poetry to a long, stunned silence

    B. From fear to joy

    C. From plain questions to vast images of the sea

    D. From doubt to calm prayer

    Key: C (From plain questions to vast images of the sea)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “How is’t with me, when every noise _____ me?”

    Key: appals

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What makes “Making the green one red” effective after the Latinate “multitudinous seas incarnadine”?

    A. It changes the subject to the weather outside the castle

    B. It mocks his own fear

    C. It names a new color

    D. Plain words restate the grand image starkly

    Key: D (Plain words restate the grand image starkly)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the knocking at the end begin to suggest?

    A. The outside world pressing in on the deed

    B. A storm coming to the castle in the night

    C. The Witches' return

    D. Banquo's escape

Key: A (The outside world pressing in on the deed)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate how the scene presents the psychological cost of the deed.

    Sample answer: Macbeth cannot say Amen, hears that he has murdered sleep, fears every noise and believes the ocean cannot clean his hands. Lady Macbeth seems controlled, yet admits she could not do it herself because Duncan looked like her father. A strong answer argues that the scene shows guilt beginning at once and weighs the different ways it appears in each of them.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the role of sleep in this scene.

    Sample answer: Macbeth hears a voice crying that he has murdered sleep, and he describes sleep as the balm of hurt minds and chief nourisher in life's feast. The grooms are drugged into a deathlike sleep, and Lady Macbeth compares the sleeping and the dead to pictures. Sleep stands for innocence and peace, which Macbeth has destroyed for himself.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which detail most suggests that Lady Macbeth's control is partly a performance?

    A. She drugs the grooms' possets with care and skill

    B. She could not do it herself because of a likeness

    C. She hears the owl shriek and the crickets cry

    D. She takes the daggers back to the sleeping grooms

    Key: B (She could not do it herself because of a likeness)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does this scene connect to Macbeth's dagger soliloquy in the previous scene?

    Sample answer: Before the deed he saw a dagger of the mind with gouts of blood; now he carries real bloody daggers back by mistake and cannot look at what he has done. The imagined horror has become real. In both scenes his senses are disturbed, but now the voices and the knocking come after the act, as guilt rather than temptation.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 3, inference 7, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene II develops the idea of the murder and its first guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act II, Scene II” could deliver about the murder and its first guilt. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the murder and its first guilt in “Act II, Scene II”: each member takes one passage, quotes it,

and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the murder and its first guilt. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act II, Scene II" could deliver about the murder and its first guilt. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the murder and its first guilt in "Act II, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene II suggests about the murder and its first guilt. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act II, Scene II" could deliver about the murder and its first guilt. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the murder and its first guilt in "Act II, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act II, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the murder and its first guilt. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act II, Scene II" could deliver about the murder and its first guilt. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the murder and its first guilt in "Act II, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Get on your nightgown, lest occasion call us, And show us to be watchers.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "watchers" most nearly mean?

   A. people who stay awake

   B. repeated striking on a door

   C. firmness of purpose

   D. vast; made up of countless waves

2. *But wherefore could not I pronounce "Amen"? I had most need of blessing, and "Amen" Stuck in my throat. These deeds must not be thought After these ways; so, it will make us mad. Methought I heard a voice cry "Sleep no more! Macbeth does murder sleep," the innocent sleep, Sleep that knits up the ravell'd sleave of care, The death of each day's life, sore labour's bath, Balm of hurt minds, great nature's second course, Chief nourisher in life's feast— What do you mean? Still it cried "Sleep no more!" to all the house: "Glamis hath murder'd sleep, and therefore Cawdor Shall sleep no more; Macbeth shall sleep no more."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene II"?

   A. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   B. A royal banquet thrown into turmoil

   C. Life as a tale told by an idiot

   D. The murder and its first guilt

SAT key: 1. A (people who stay awake); 2. D (The murder and its first guilt)

Lesson 12: Act II, Scene III

Focus: the discovery of the murder

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act II, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide (joke), sexual innuendo, alcohol, murder (discovered), violence): The Porter jokes about 'a farmer, that hanged himself on the expectation of plenty' and about drink, which 'provokes the desire, but it takes away the performance' (lechery). Gloss the innuendo briefly; do not have students perform it. Then Duncan's body is discovered and Macbeth kills the grooms. Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Suggested language: “Why might Shakespeare put a comic scene right after the murder?”

Teacher only · spoilers

A drunken Porter imagines himself porter of hell gate, joking about a farmer, an 'equivocator' and a tailor, before opening to Macduff and Lennox. Lennox describes an unruly night of storms and screams. Macduff discovers Duncan's body ('Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!'). Macbeth reveals he has killed the chamberlains, claiming fury and love; Lady Macbeth faints. Banquo vows to fight 'treasonous malice.' Malcolm and Donalbain secretly flee to England and Ireland, fearing 'daggers in men's smiles.'

Background: The Porter's 'equivocator' is widely read as an allusion to the Jesuit Henry Garnet, executed in 1606 after the Gunpowder Plot, who defended misleading answers under oath.

Significance: Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....
Prompt: Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: primrose — pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure); napkins — handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat); bonfire — a large outdoor fire; masterpiece — a supreme piece of work; sacrilegious — violating something holy. "napkins": Origin of "napkin": an English formation from nape + -kin.
Words: primrose: pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure) · napkins: handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat) · bonfire: a large outdoor fire · masterpiece: a supreme piece of work · sacrilegious: violating something holy

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Porter's 'equivocator' is widely read as an allusion to the Jesuit Henry Garnet, executed in 1606 after the Gunpowder Plot, who defended misleading answers under oath. Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them. Characterization: The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary. Dramatic irony: Macbeth plays the shocked host; Lady Macbeth faints (real or feigned?). Plot: Macduff discovers the body; Macbeth kills the grooms; Malcolm and Donalbain flee. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale" slowly and put it in my own words: The drunken Porter imagines welcoming an equivocator to hell, someone who could swear on both sides of the scales. Next, craft. I notice the comic tone, which follows the murder with a joke about lying. The strongest word is "equivocator": it means someone who speaks double meanings to deceive. Then, effect. What is the Porter joking about when he describes an equivocator? My answer: The Porter is joking about an equivocator, someone who swears to both sides and lies under oath; the joke links to the Gunpowder Plot trials and to the play's deceptive language, since the witches equivocate with Macbeth.

> *an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale* (Act II, Scene III)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale" slowly and put it in my own words: The drunken Porter imagines welcoming an equivocator to hell, someone who could swear on both sides of the scales. Next, craft. I notice the comic tone, which follows the murder with a joke about lying. The strongest word is "equivocator": it means someone who speaks double meanings to deceive. Then, effect. What is the Porter joking about when he describes an equivocator? My answer: The Porter is joking about an equivocator, someone who swears to both sides and lies under oath; the joke links to the Gunpowder Plot trials and to the play's deceptive language, since the witches equivocate with Macbeth.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Knocking", "porter" and "hell-gate" stand out. The Porter jokes that he guards the gate of hell, which is truer than he knows, since a murder has just been done inside. Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality? Expected student answer: The Porter plays a comic part, but his joke names the castle's real nature: what looks like a host's home is now a hell, so the line sets a cheerful surface against a dark truth.

> *Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate (Act II, Scene III, line 739)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Knocking", "porter" and "hell-gate" stand out. The Porter jokes that he guards the gate of hell, which is truer than he knows, since a murder has just been done inside.
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality?
Expected student answer: The Porter plays a comic part, but his joke names the castle's real nature: what looks like a host's home is now a hell, so the line sets a cheerful surface against a dark truth.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of the discovery of the murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. When the text says "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, line 739), it shows this directly. He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of the discovery of the murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. When the text says "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, line 739), it shows this directly. He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event? Ask: why place comedy right after the murder? Try reading De Quincey's idea that the knocking returns us to the human world.
Anchor question: Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?
Facilitation: Ask: why place comedy right after the murder? Try reading De Quincey's idea that the knocking returns us to the human world.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. ("Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate", Act II, Scene III, line 739). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the discovery of the murder? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. ("Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate", Act II, Scene III, line 739). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the discovery of the murder. Key takeaway: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary.
- **Dramatic irony:** Macbeth plays the shocked host; Lady Macbeth faints (real or feigned?).
- **Plot:** Macduff discovers the body; Macbeth kills the grooms; Malcolm and Donalbain flee.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour; watch how its meaning changes as the play goes on.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, line 739) The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder.
- "an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale" (Act II, Scene III) The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious.
- "O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee" (Act II, Scene III, lines 778–779) Macduff's discovery.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell.
Evidence: "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, line 739)
Reasoning: He imagines himself "porter of hell-gate," admitting "an equivocator," which fits the castle where a murder has just been committed and where words will keep hiding truth.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
primrose (adjective)	pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure)	*I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.*	
napkins (noun)	handkerchiefs (to wipe off sweat)	*Here's a farmer, that hanged himself on the expectation of plenty: come in time; have napkins enow about you; here you'll sweat for't.*	"napkins": Origin of "napkin": an English formation from nape + -kin. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/napkin#Etymology)
bonfire (noun)	a large outdoor fire	*I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire.*	
masterpiece (noun)	a supreme piece of work	*Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!*	
sacrilegious (adjective)	violating something holy	*Most sacrilegious murder hath broke ope The Lord's anointed temple, and stole thence The life o' the building!*	
prithee (interjection)	please (from "I pray thee")	*Dear Duff, I prithee, contradict thyself, And say it is not so.*	

provoke (verb)	to bring on; to cause	*What three things does drink especially provoke?*	
readiness (noun)	the state of being dressed and armed	*Let's briefly put on manly readiness, And meet i' the hall together.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Lennox report about the night? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Chimneys blown down, lamentings heard in the air, strange screams of death; an unruly night.
   Answer guidance: Chimneys blown down, lamentings heard in the air, strange screams of death; an unruly night.
2. Whom does the Porter pretend to be? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The porter of hell gate
   Answer guidance: The porter of hell gate.
3. Who discovers Duncan's body? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Macduff
   Answer guidance: Macduff.
4. What has Macbeth done to the chamberlains? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Killed them, claiming fury
   Answer guidance: Killed them, claiming fury.
5. Where do Malcolm and Donalbain flee? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** England and Ireland
   Answer guidance: England and Ireland.
6. What does Donalbain say there are in men's smiles? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Daggers
   Answer guidance: Daggers.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act II, Scene III" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A drunken Porter imagines himself porter of hell gate, joking about a farmer, an 'equivocator' and a tailor, before opening to Macduff and Lennox. Lennox describes an unruly night of storms and screams. Macduff discovers Duncan's body

('Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!'). Macbeth reveals he has killed the chamberlains, claiming fury and love; Lady Macbeth faints. Banquo vows to fight…

Answer guidance: A drunken Porter imagines himself porter of hell gate, joking about a farmer, an 'equivocator' and a tailor, before opening to Macduff and Lennox. Lennox describes an unruly night of storms and screams. Macduff discovers Duncan's body ('Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!'). Macbeth reveals he has killed the chamberlains, claiming fury and love; Lady Macbeth faints. Banquo vows to fight…

8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when is "Act II, Scene III" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: "I'll devil-porter it no further: I had thought to have let in some of all professions that go the primrose way to the everlasting bonfire." What does "primrose" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** primrose: pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure).

    Answer guidance: primrose: pleasant and easy (the primrose way is the easy path of pleasure).

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Lady Macbeth faint at the moment Macbeth explains killing the grooms? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Real shock or a deliberate distraction; the text allows both.

   Answer guidance: Real shock or a deliberate distraction; the text allows both.

2. What does "Act II, Scene III" suggest about the discovery of the murder? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them.

   Answer guidance: Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them. Evidence to accept: "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, line 739): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of irony in "Act II, Scene III". What does it reveal about the discovery of the murder that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true. Evidence to accept: "an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale" (Act II, Scene III): The

Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the tone / mood in “Act II, Scene III” shape what we understand about the discovery of the murder? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, line 739): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “The night has been…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, lines 778–779): Macduff's discovery. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act II, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Macduff discovers Duncan's body; evidence: “O horror, horror, horror!”
   Answer guidance: Look for: Macduff discovers Duncan's body; evidence: “O horror, horror, horror!”. Evidence to accept: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, line 739): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Act II, Scene III” build on “Act II, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III): The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Act II, Scene III”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the discovery of the murder, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, lines 778–779): Macduff's discovery. On characterization: The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why might a writer place a joke right after a terrible event?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?

[DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III): The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does plot appear in “Act II, Scene III”, and how does it connect the discovery of the murder to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** key events and the causes linking them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, line 739): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. On plot: Macduff discovers the body; Macbeth kills the grooms; Malcolm and Donalbain flee. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Do Malcolm and Donalbain act wisely or cowardly by fleeing? Defend your answer. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** An evaluation of the princes' choice and its consequences.

    Answer guidance: An evaluation of the princes' choice and its consequences.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Comic relief deepens the horror: the castle has become hell's gate. Macbeth's killing of the grooms removes witnesses and makes his own guilt more visible; the princes' flight lets suspicion fall on them. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, lines 778–779): Macduff's discovery. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in “Act II, Scene III” acts most wisely in the matter of the discovery of the murder, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, line 739): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. On characterization: The Porter imagines himself the gatekeeper of hell, admitting an "equivocator" among others: comic relief that is also commentary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act II, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the discovery of the murder. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III): The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write your own questions about “Act II, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, lines 778–779): Macduff's discovery. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect “Act II, Scene III”, with its focus on the discovery of the murder, to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “Here’s a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate” (Act II, Scene III, line 739): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the irony in “Act II, Scene III” effective in presenting the discovery of the murder, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale” (Act II, Scene III): The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act II, Scene III” treats the discovery of the murder with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: “O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart / Cannot conceive nor name thee” (Act II, Scene III, lines 778–779): Macduff's discovery. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act II, Scene IV" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: "Here's a knocking indeed! If a man were porter of hell-gate" (Act II, Scene III, line 739): The drunken Porter pretends the castle gate is the gate of hell, comic relief right after the murder. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Act II, Scene III" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the discovery of the murder? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Porter's comedy turns Macbeth's castle into hell. Useful evidence: "an equivocator, that could swear in both the scales against either scale" (Act II, Scene III): The Porter's "equivocator" points to the 1606 Gunpowder Plot trial, where lying by double meanings was notorious. Theme link: Macbeth's eloquent grief is a performance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Porter say kept him up until the second cock?
   A. Drinking and carousing
   B. Guarding the king's door
   C. Saying prayers
   D. Mending the gate

   Key: A (Drinking and carousing)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who arrives at the gate with Macduff?
   A. Ross, the thane of Ross
   B. Lennox
   C. Angus
   D. Malcolm

   Key: B (Lennox)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why has Macduff come so early?
   A. He wants to leave the castle before dawn

B. He heard a scream in the night

C. The king told him to call on him early

D. He is looking for Banquo

Key: C (The king told him to call on him early)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Macbeth's reply: “The labour we delight in _____ pain”

Key: physics

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Macbeth sum up the night when Lennox describes it?

A. It was a calm night

B. I slept well

C. I heard nothing

D. 'Twas a rough night

Key: D ('Twas a rough night)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth do after Macbeth explains his actions?

A. She calls for help and is carried out

B. She accuses the two princes of the deed at once

C. She runs to the chamber

D. She leaves for England

Key: A (She calls for help and is carried out)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who suggests that everyone meet in the hall to question the deed?

A. Lady Macbeth

B. Banquo

C. Malcolm

D. The Porter

Key: B (Banquo)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do Malcolm and Donalbain decide at the end of the scene?

A. To stay and avenge their father at once

B. To accuse Macbeth publicly

C. To flee in different directions

D. To hide in the castle

Key: C (To flee in different directions)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Macbeth say to explain killing the chamberlains?

Sample answer: He says no one can be wise, amazed, temperate and furious, loyal and neutral in a moment. His violent love outran reason: he saw Duncan's silver skin laced with his golden blood and the grooms steeped in the colours of their trade, and no one who loved the king could hold back. He presents the killing as loyal fury.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why do Malcolm and Donalbain decide not to stay?

Sample answer: They fear that whoever killed their father may kill them next. Malcolm says that showing unfelt sorrow is easy for a false man, and the brothers agree that the nearer in blood, the nearer they are to danger. They decide that separating will keep them safer and that it is wise to steal away without leave-taking.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What role does the Porter pretend to play as he answers the knocking?

    A. A gatekeeper of hell admitting sinners

    B. A king receiving his guests at a feast

    C. A judge in a court of law

    D. A soldier on guard duty

    Key: A (A gatekeeper of hell admitting sinners)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What kind of sinner does the Porter mock as swearing in both the scales?

    A. A thief who steals the silver from the church

    B. One who swears to both sides and lies

    C. A soldier who runs from battle

    D. A drunk who sleeps all day

    Key: B (One who swears to both sides and lies)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Porter's line: "Faith, here's an _____, that could swear in both the scales against either scale"

    Key: equivocator

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macduff mean by "Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!"?

    A. A great painting has been ruined

    B. Everyone is confused about the time

    C. Chaos has done its worst work

    D. The castle is badly built

    Key: C (Chaos has done its worst work)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macduff compare the king's body to in "The Lord's anointed temple"?

    A. A ship wrecked at sea in a storm

    B. A fallen tree

    C. A burning house

    D. A sacred building broken into

    Key: D (A sacred building broken into)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Macduff not tell Lady Macbeth what has happened?

    A. He thinks the news would be too terrible for her

    B. He already suspects her of the deed and will not say

    C. He does not see her come in at all

    D. She already knows, so he need not tell her

    Key: A (He thinks the news would be too terrible for her)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is Lady Macbeth's first reaction to the news, “What, in our house?”, concerned with?

    A. Who did the deed

    B. Where the deed happened

    C. How Duncan died

    D. When it happened

    Key: B (Where the deed happened)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Banquo declare he will fight against?

    A. Malcolm and his brother

    B. The Witches

    C. Hidden treason

    D. The English

    Key: C (Hidden treason)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the Porter's scene change the mood, and why might Shakespeare include it?

    Sample answer: After the terror of the previous scene, the Porter's drunken joking about keeping the door of hell brings dark comedy. Yet his jokes are about hell, sin and an equivocator who lies to both sides, which fits what has just happened in the castle. The scene relieves tension while reminding the audience that the castle has become a kind of hell.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macbeth perform grief after the discovery?

    Sample answer: He says that if he had died an hour before he would have lived a blessed time, that renown and grace are dead and only the lees of life's wine remain. He tells the princes the fountain of their blood is stopped. His speech is grand and polished, which may sound sincere to the others but rings hollow to the audience.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What makes the Porter's 'hell-gate' joke ironic?

    A. He does not know the castle now hides a crime

    B. He knows exactly what Macbeth has done in the night

    C. He is a real devil

    D. He has not been to hell

    Key: A (He does not know the castle now hides a crime)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's “There’s nothing serious in mortality” speech suggest?

    A. He is joking about Duncan to the princes

    B. His words may hold more truth than he intends

    C. He wants to die at once

    D. He has no feelings at all

    Key: B (His words may hold more truth than he intends)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth's image “His silver skin laced with his golden blood” do?

    A. Shows that Duncan was wearing armour in his bed

    B. Describes a painting

    C. Turns the body into something precious and royal

D. Hides the horror of the scene

Key: C (Turns the body into something precious and royal)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “The expedition my violent love Outrun the pauser, _____”

Key: reason

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why might Lady Macbeth call for help at that particular moment?

A. Because she has just learned the truth from Lennox

B. To accuse Banquo of the deed

C. Because the bell is too loud

D. To draw attention from her husband's speech

Key: D (To draw attention from her husband's speech)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Malcolm mean by 'To show an unfelt sorrow is an office Which the false man does easy'?

A. Faked grief is easy for liars

B. Real grief is hard to hide

C. Servants grieve more than lords

D. Sorrow is a duty for kings

Key: A (Faked grief is easy for liars)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Banquo's 'In the great hand of God I stand' set him apart?

A. He claims to be a king

B. He places his trust in heaven, not in plots

C. He blames God for the deed

D. He refuses to fight

Key: B (He places his trust in heaven, not in plots)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What irony lies in Macbeth's call to 'put on manly readiness'?

A. He has no armour of his own

B. He wants to leave the castle before anyone sees him

C. He uses the language of honour to hide guilt

D. He suspects Banquo

Key: C (He uses the language of honour to hide guilt)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the Porter scene connects to the play's themes.

Sample answer: The Porter pretends to keep the door of hell, admitting sinners such as an equivocator who swore in both the scales and could not equivocate to heaven. The castle has truly become a place of damnation, and Macbeth is about to equivocate himself. The comedy echoes fair is foul and appearance versus reality while the audience waits for the discovery.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how Macbeth's explanation for killing the grooms could raise suspicion.

Sample answer: His speech is elaborate and poetic, with images of silver skin and golden blood and of daggers unmannerly

breeched with gore. He insists that no man could be loyal and neutral in a moment. Its very polish, and the fact that the grooms can no longer speak, may make listeners wonder, and Macduff asks him directly why he did so.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What dramatic purpose does the Porter's delay in opening the gate serve?

    A. It stretches the suspense before discovery

    B. It shows the castle is poorly run

    C. It lets Banquo escape

    D. It introduces a new plot

    Key: A (It stretches the suspense before discovery)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does “Shake off this downy sleep, death’s counterfeit” develop the sleep motif?

    A. Sleep is a gift that heals the wounded in body and mind

    B. Sleep imitates death while real death is near

    C. Sleep is a crime against the king

    D. Sleep cannot come to Macduff

    Key: B (Sleep imitates death while real death is near)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which response to the news is most restrained?

    A. Macbeth's long lament

    B. Macduff's cry of horror

    C. Banquo's 'Too cruel any where'

    D. Lady Macbeth's faint

    Key: C (Banquo's 'Too cruel any where')

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Donalbain's line: “Our tears are not yet _____”

    Key: brew’d

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macduff's question 'Wherefore did you so?' introduce?

    A. A plan to crown Malcolm at Scone at once

    B. An attack on Banquo

    C. A joke about the Porter

    D. The first open doubt about Macbeth

    Key: D (The first open doubt about Macbeth)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “there’s warrant in that theft Which steals itself, when there’s no mercy left” justify?

    A. Fleeing without permission

    B. Stealing gold from the dead king

    C. Killing the guards

    D. Lying to Macduff

    Key: A (Fleeing without permission)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate how convincingly Macbeth plays the innocent host in this scene.

Sample answer: He speaks little before the discovery, answers Macduff and Lennox politely, and then offers a grand lament and a passionate defence of killing the grooms. Yet Macduff questions him, Lady Macbeth's sudden call for help may be a distraction, and the princes flee. A strong answer weighs his performance against the signs that others doubt it.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the scene uses images of disorder in nature.
Sample answer: Lennox describes chimneys blown down, strange screams of death, an obscure bird clamouring all night and the earth feverous and shaking. Macduff calls the deed a breach that confusion made its masterpiece. Nature itself seems disturbed by the killing of a king, linking political disorder to disorder in the natural world.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which detail best shows the princes' sense of danger?

A. The night has been unruly

B. The near in blood, the nearer bloody

C. Confusion now hath made his masterpiece

D. Look to the lady

Key: B (The near in blood, the nearer bloody)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the flight of Malcolm and Donalbain shape what may happen next?
Sample answer: By fleeing to England and Ireland the princes protect themselves, but their absence leaves the throne open and could make them look guilty. Malcolm reasons that the murderous shaft has not yet landed, so the safest course is to avoid its aim. A strong answer explains both the wisdom of the choice and the opportunity it gives Macbeth.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 2, inference 8, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 2

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene III develops the idea of the discovery of the murder. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act II, Scene III” could deliver about the discovery of the murder. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the discovery of the murder in “Act II, Scene III”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the discovery of

the murder. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act II, Scene III" could deliver about the discovery of the murder. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the discovery of the murder in "Act II, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene III suggests about the discovery of the murder. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act II, Scene III" could deliver about the discovery of the murder. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the discovery of the murder in "Act II, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act II, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of the discovery of the murder. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act II, Scene III" could deliver about the discovery of the murder. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the discovery of the murder in "Act II, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Confusion now hath made his masterpiece!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "masterpiece" most nearly mean?

   A. to bring on; to cause

   B. the state of being dressed and armed

C. a supreme piece of work

D. please (from "I pray thee")

2. *The night has been unruly: where we lay, Our chimneys were blown down; and, as they say, Lamentings heard i' the air; strange screams of death, And prophesying with accents terrible Of dire combustion and confused events New hatch'd to the woeful time: the obscure bird Clamour'd the livelong night: some say, the earth Was feverous and did shake. 'Twas a rough night. My young remembrance cannot parallel A fellow to it. Reenter Macduff. O horror, horror, horror! Tongue nor heart Cannot conceive nor name thee! What's the matter? Confusion now hath made his masterpiece! Most sacrilegious murder hath broke ope The Lord's anointed temple, and stole thence The life o' the building! What is't you say? the life? Mean you his majesty? Approach the chamber, and destroy your sight With a new Gorgon: do not bid me speak; See, and then speak yourselves. Exeunt Macbeth and Lennox. Awake, awake! Ring the alarum-bell. Murder and treason! Banquo and Donalbain! Malcolm! awake! Shake off this downy sleep, death's counterfeit, And look on death itself! up, up, and see The great doom's image! Malcolm! Banquo! As from your graves rise up, and walk like sprites, To countenance this horror! Ring the bell. Bell rings.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene III"?

A. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief

B. The dagger of the mind

C. Lady Macbeth's resolve

D. The discovery of the murder

SAT key: 1. C (a supreme piece of work); 2. D (The discovery of the murder)

Lesson 13: Act II, Scene IV

Focus: nature's revolt against the crime

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act II, Scene IV” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Ross and an Old Man describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by a 'mousing owl', and Duncan's horses breaking loose and eating each other. Macduff reports that the princes are suspected of bribing the grooms, that Macbeth has been named king and has gone to Scone to be invested, and that Duncan's body has been carried to Colmekill. Macduff will not go to Scone but home to Fife.

Background: The idea of a 'great chain of being' held that a king's murder disordered nature; Holinshed's chronicle supplied the omens of the horses and the darkness.

Significance: The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: storehouse — a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place; trifled — made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison; predecessors — people who held a position earlier; invested — formally given the office and crown of king; mousing — that hunts mice. “trifled”: Origin of “trifle”: possibly Old French trufle (“mockery”).
Words: storehouse: a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place · trifled: made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison · predecessors: people who held a position earlier · invested: formally given the office and crown of king · mousing: that hunts mice

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The idea of a 'great chain of being' held that a king's murder disordered nature; Holinshed's chronicle supplied the omens of the horses and the darkness. The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance. Setting: An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other. Imagery: Nature in revolt mirrors the moral disorder. Characterization: Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" slowly and put it in my own words: Ross says that by the clock it is day, yet dark night strangles the sun. Next, craft. I notice the violent verb "strangles," applied to night killing daylight. The strongest word is "strangles": it makes the darkness a murderer, echoing Duncan's death. Then, effect. What does Ross notice about the unnatural darkness? My answer: Ross notices that the unnatural darkness covers the day after the king's murder; nature itself seems disordered, which shows that the crime has upset the whole order of the world.

> *by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp* (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" slowly and put it in my own words: Ross says that by the clock it is day, yet dark night strangles the sun. Next, craft. I notice the violent verb "strangles," applied to night killing daylight. The strongest word is "strangles": it makes the darkness a murderer, echoing Duncan's death. Then, effect. What does Ross notice about the unnatural darkness? My answer: Ross notices that the unnatural darkness covers the day after the king's murder; nature itself seems disordered, which shows that the crime has upset the whole order of the world.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Falcon", "towering" and "mousing owl" stand out. A small owl that hunts mice kills a high-flying falcon, an unnatural reversal that pictures a lesser man killing a king. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected student answer: The Old Man reports an omen in nature, so the line suggests that the murder has upset the whole order of the world, not only one family.

> *A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd (Act II, Scene IV, lines 898–899)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Falcon", "towering" and "mousing owl" stand out. A small owl that hunts mice kills a high-flying falcon, an unnatural reversal that pictures a lesser man killing a king.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected student answer: The Old Man reports an omen in nature, so the line suggests that the murder has upset the whole order of the world, not only one family.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for setting, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of nature's revolt against the crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. When the text says "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892), it shows this directly. Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.
Task: Annotate the scene for setting, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of nature's revolt against the crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. When the text says "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892), it shows this directly. Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does? Ask: would a modern audience believe these signs? How should a production stage them?
Anchor question: Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does?
Facilitation: Ask: would a modern audience believe these signs? How should a production stage them?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. ("by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp", Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. ("by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp", Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes nature's revolt against the crime. Key takeaway: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other.
- **Imagery:** Nature in revolt mirrors the moral disorder.
- **Characterization:** Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the cosmic order reacts to a human crime.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour; watch how its meaning changes as the play goes on.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892) Darkness by day.
- "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 898–899) Symbol of regicide.
- "Tis said they eat each other" (Act II, Scene IV, line 905) Duncan's horses.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe.
Evidence: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892)
Reasoning: Ross sees that "dark night strangles the travelling lamp" by day, and a falcon is killed by "a mousing owl," a lower creature overthrowing a higher, just as Macbeth killed his king.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
storehouse (noun)	a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place	*Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones.*	
trifled (verb)	made (earlier experiences) seem trivial by comparison	*Threescore and ten I can remember well: Within the volume of which time I have seen Hours dreadful and things strange; but this sore night Hath trifled former knowings.*	"trifled": Origin of "trifle": possibly Old French trufle ("mockery"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/trifle#Etymology)
predecessors (noun)	people who held a position earlier	*Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones.*	
invested (verb)	formally given the office and crown of king	*He is already named, and gone to Scone To be invested.*	
mousing (adjective)	that hunts mice	*On Tuesday last, A falcon, towering in her pride of place, Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd.*	
benison (noun)	a blessing	*God's benison go with you; and with those That would make good of bad, and friends of foes!*	
minions (noun)		*And Duncan's horses—a thing most strange and certain— Beauteous and*	

	darlings; the finest of their kind	*swift, the minions of their race, Turn'd wild in nature, broke their stalls, flung out, Contending 'gainst obedience, as they would make War with mankind.*	
towering (adjective)	soaring high	*On Tuesday last, A falcon, towering in her pride of place, Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd.*	
sovereignty (noun)	the power and rank of a king	*Then 'tis most like The sovereignty will fall upon Macbeth.*	
unnatural (adjective)	against the order of nature	*'Tis unnatural, Even like the deed that's done.*	"unnatural": Origin: an English formation from un- + natural. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unnatural#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What strange thing has happened to the daylight? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Dark night strangles the travelling lamp: it is dark by day.
   Answer guidance: Dark night strangles the travelling lamp: it is dark by day.
2. What killed the falcon? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A mousing owl
   Answer guidance: A mousing owl.
3. What did Duncan's horses do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Broke loose and ate each other
   Answer guidance: Broke loose and ate each other.
4. Who is suspected of the murder now? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Malcolm and Donalbain, who fled
   Answer guidance: Malcolm and Donalbain, who fled.

5. Where has Macbeth gone to be crowned? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Scone
   Answer guidance: Scone.
6. Where will Macduff go instead? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Home to Fife
   Answer guidance: Home to Fife.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act II, Scene IV" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Ross and an Old Man describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by a 'mousing owl', and Duncan's horses breaking loose and eating each other. Macduff reports that the princes are suspected of bribing the grooms, that Macbeth has been named king and has gone to Scone to be invested, and that Duncan's body has been carried to Colmekill. Macduff will not go to Scone but home to Fife.
   Answer guidance: Ross and an Old Man describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by a 'mousing owl', and Duncan's horses breaking loose and eating each other. Macduff reports that the princes are suspected of bribing the grooms, that Macbeth has been named king and has gone to Scone to be invested, and that Duncan's body has been carried to Colmekill. Macduff will not go to Scone but home to Fife.
8. Who is on stage in "Act II, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act II, Scene IV" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Carried to Colmekill, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors, And guardian of their bones." What does "storehouse" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** storehouse: a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place.
    Answer guidance: storehouse: a place where things are kept; here, a royal burial place.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does the owl killing the falcon symbolize? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** A lower creature killing a higher one: Macbeth killing his king.
   Answer guidance: A lower creature killing a higher one: Macbeth killing his king.
2. What does "Act II, Scene IV" suggest about nature's revolt against the crime? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance.
   Answer guidance: The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance. Evidence to accept: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night

strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892): Darkness by day. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of imagery in "Act II, Scene IV". What does it reveal about nature's revolt against the crime that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 898–899): Symbol of regicide. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the symbolism in "Act II, Scene IV" shape what we understand about nature's revolt against the crime? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892): Darkness by day. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with "Threescore and ten I…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "Tis said they eat each other" (Act II, Scene IV, line 905): Duncan's horses. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Act II, Scene IV", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Macduff's report that Macbeth is named king and the sons are suspected; evidence: "He is already named, and gone to Scone To be invested."

   Answer guidance: Look for: Macduff's report that Macbeth is named king and the sons are suspected; evidence: "He is already named, and gone to Scone To be invested.". Evidence to accept: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892): Darkness by day. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Act II, Scene IV" build on "Act II, Scene III"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 898–899): Symbol of regicide. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In "Act II, Scene IV", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about nature's revolt against the crime, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that

builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “Tis said they eat each other” (Act II, Scene IV, line 905): Duncan's horses. On characterization: Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Do you think the natural world reflects human events? Why do stories so often say it does?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, lines 898–899): Symbol of regicide. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does setting appear in “Act II, Scene IV”, and how does it connect nature's revolt against the crime to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892): Darkness by day. On setting: An Old Man and Ross describe unnatural events: darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl, Duncan's horses eating each other. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Macduff's decision not to attend the coronation is small but important. How brave is it? Explain. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment about quiet resistance.

   Answer guidance: A judgment about quiet resistance.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The omens turn the murder into a cosmic crime. Macduff's quiet refusal to attend the coronation is the first sign of resistance. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “Tis said they eat each other” (Act II, Scene IV, line 905): Duncan's horses. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in “Act II, Scene IV” acts most wisely in the matter of nature's revolt against the crime, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an

explicit criterion and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892): Darkness by day. On characterization: Macduff refuses to attend the coronation at Scone: the first sign of resistance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Act II, Scene IV". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of nature's revolt against the crime. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 898–899): Symbol of regicide. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Act II, Scene IV": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "Tis said they eat each other" (Act II, Scene IV, line 905): Duncan's horses. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Act II, Scene IV", with its focus on nature's revolt against the crime, to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "by the clock, 'tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892): Darkness by day. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in "Act II, Scene IV" effective in presenting nature's revolt against the crime, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: "A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd" (Act II, Scene IV, lines 898–899): Symbol of regicide. On imagery: Nature in revolt mirrors the moral disorder. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act II, Scene IV” treats nature's revolt against the crime with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “Tis said they eat each other” (Act II, Scene IV, line 905): Duncan's horses. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “by the clock, ’tis day, / And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp” (Act II, Scene IV, lines 891–892): Darkness by day. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act II, Scene IV” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about nature's revolt against the crime? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The unnatural events after Duncan's murder show that the crime has disturbed the order of the universe. Useful evidence: “A falcon, towering in her pride of place, / Was by a mousing owl hawk’d at and kill’d” (Act II, Scene IV, lines 898–899): Symbol of regicide. Theme link: the cosmic order reacts to a human crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who talks with Ross at the start of the scene?
   A. An old Man
   B. Banquo
   C. Lady Macduff
   D. A Doctor

   Key: A (An old Man)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How long can the old Man remember?
   A. Twenty years

B. Seventy years

C. A hundred years

D. Ten years

Key: B (Seventy years)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who joins Ross and the old Man?

A. Malcolm

B. Lennox

C. Macduff

D. Seyton

Key: C (Macduff)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Macduff's answer: "They were _____"

Key: suborn'd

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Ross ask Macduff about the deed?

A. Where the king's sons are

B. When the crowning will be

C. What the old Man has seen

D. Who did this bloody deed

Key: D (Who did this bloody deed)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Ross exclaim when he hears the princes have fled?

A. 'Gainst nature still!

B. Alas, the day!

C. Why, see you not?

D. Well, I will thither

Key: A ('Gainst nature still!)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Macduff blame for the deed when Ross asks?

A. The Witches on the heath

B. The grooms Macbeth has slain

C. Banquo and Fleance

D. The Norwegians

Key: B (The grooms Macbeth has slain)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What blessing does the old Man give at the end?

A. A wish that Macbeth may have a long and happy reign

B. A prayer for rain

C. God's benison on those who make good of bad

D. A curse on the princes

Key: C (God's benison on those who make good of bad)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What strange events do Ross and the old Man describe?

Sample answer: They describe a world gone wrong. By the clock it is day, yet darkness covers the earth. On Tuesday a falcon

was killed by a mousing owl, and Duncan's fine horses broke out of their stalls, turned wild and, it is said, ate each other. The old Man says it is unnatural, like the deed that has been done.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is it important that Macduff chooses not to go to Scone?

    Sample answer: Ross plans to see Macbeth invested at Scone, but Macduff says he will go home to Fife instead. Staying away from the coronation is a quiet sign that he does not fully accept the new king or the official story. His parting wish, that old robes may not sit easier than new, hints at his doubts.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Ross mean by "dark night strangles the travelling lamp"?

    A. Darkness has blotted out the sun

    B. Thieves stole a lantern

    C. A storm put out every torch in the castle

    D. The moon has vanished

    Key: A (Darkness has blotted out the sun)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the falcon killed by an owl symbolize?

    A. A hunter catching his prey on the heath at dawn

    B. A lesser creature destroying a greater one

    C. A storm at sea sinking a ship

    D. A bird returning home

    Key: B (A lesser creature destroying a greater one)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the old Man's line: "'Tis _____, Even like the deed that's done"

    Key: unnatural

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Ross say on hearing that the grooms were blamed?

    A. Farewell, father

    B. I will to Fife

    C. Alas, the day!

    D. See you not?

    Key: C (Alas, the day!)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Ross mean by "Thriftless ambition, that wilt ravin up Thine own life's means!"?

    A. Ambition that saves money

    B. A plan for a new war against Norway and its king

    C. A hope for peace

    D. Ambition that destroys its own source

    Key: D (Ambition that destroys its own source)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What has happened to Macbeth by the end of the scene?

    A. He has been named king

    B. He has been arrested

    C. He has fled the country

D. He has fallen ill

Key: A (He has been named king)

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Where does Ross decide to go?

A. To Fife

B. To Scone

C. To England

D. To Ireland

Key: B (To Scone)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Macduff answer Ross's 'How goes the world, sir, now?'

A. All is well, cousin

B. I do not know

C. Why, see you not?

D. Ask the king

Key: C (Why, see you not?)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the scene link the murder to disorder in nature?

Sample answer: Ross says the heavens seem troubled with man's act, so day is dark. The old Man compares the falcon killed by an owl and the horses that turned wild and ate each other to the unnatural deed. These signs suggest that killing a king breaks the order of nature itself, so the whole world reacts.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macduff's report show about how the official story is spreading?

Sample answer: Macduff says the grooms Macbeth slew did the deed, that they were bribed, and that the princes' flight puts suspicion on them. He also reports that Macbeth has already been named and gone to Scone. The story everyone repeats protects Macbeth, but Macduff's tone and his choice to go home to Fife suggest he has doubts.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the old Man's long memory add to the scene?

A. A sense that this night is beyond all past experience

B. Comic relief after the horror of the murder scene

C. A clue to the killer

D. A link to the Witches

Key: A (A sense that this night is beyond all past experience)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the image of Duncan's horses 'Contending 'gainst obedience' suggest?

A. The horses were badly trained

B. Rebellion has spread even to animals

C. The stable caught fire

D. The horses fled to England with the princes in the night

Key: B (Rebellion has spread even to animals)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about Macduff saying the grooms were 'suborn'd'?

A. Macduff himself bribed them

B. The grooms were innocent and asleep

C. The true briber is the man now being crowned

D. The princes paid them openly

Key: C (The true briber is the man now being crowned)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macduff's line: "Lest our old robes sit easier than our _____!"

Key: new

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macduff's clothing image echo from earlier scenes?

A. The serpent under the flower

B. The dagger of the mind

C. The milk of human kindness

D. Borrowed robes and ill-fitting garments

Key: D (Borrowed robes and ill-fitting garments)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why might Shakespeare use an anonymous old Man here?

A. He speaks for ordinary people's view of events

B. He is the play's narrator

C. He is a disguised Witch sent to watch over the action

D. He will become king

Key: A (He speaks for ordinary people's view of events)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the scene suggest about who controls the story of the murder?

A. Everyone in Scotland now knows the truth of the deed

B. Macbeth's version is now the official one

C. The princes control it

D. No one speaks of it

Key: B (Macbeth's version is now the official one)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the tone of Macduff's replies differ from Ross's?

A. Long and cheerful

B. Angry and loud

C. Brief and guarded

D. Joyful and warm

Key: C (Brief and guarded)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the scene works as a choral commentary on Act II.

Sample answer: Ross and the old Man step outside the castle to describe darkness by day, a falcon killed by an owl and horses that ate each other. Like a chorus they comment on the deed rather than act. Macduff then gives the official story and the news of Macbeth's crowning, so the scene closes Act II by showing both nature's verdict and the public's acceptance.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze the significance of Macduff's decision to go to Fife.

Sample answer: When Ross asks if he will go to Scone, Macduff says No, cousin, I'll to Fife. He wishes Ross may see things

well done there and adds Lest our old robes sit easier than our new. By staying away he quietly refuses to honour the new king, and the clothing image suggests that the new reign may not fit as well as the old.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which image works as a symbol of the natural order of power reversed?

    A. A mousing owl killing a towering falcon

    B. A clock showing day

    C. Ross greeting Macduff

    D. Duncan's body being carried away

    Key: A (A mousing owl killing a towering falcon)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Ross's question “Is't night's predominance, or the day's shame” suggest?

    A. The night is simply long in the depth of winter months

    B. The darkness may be heaven's response to guilt

    C. Ross is afraid of the dark

    D. The sun has set early

    Key: B (The darkness may be heaven's response to guilt)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] How does Ross's 'Thriftless ambition' comment carry dramatic irony?

    A. It praises Macbeth for his careful thrift with money

    B. It blames the Witches

    C. It fits Macbeth better than the princes

    D. It refers to Banquo

    Key: C (It fits Macbeth better than the princes)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macduff's line: “Carried to _____, The sacred storehouse of his predecessors”

    Key: Colmekill

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the scene's quick move from omens to politics suggest?

    A. The omens were false

    B. The old Man is the true heir and will be the new king

    C. Macduff will be crowned

    D. The world goes on as power changes hands

    Key: D (The world goes on as power changes hands)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which detail best shows Macduff's quiet resistance?

    A. His choice to go home rather than to Scone

    B. His praise for Macbeth

    C. His grief for the grooms

    D. His long description of the horses that ate each other

    Key: A (His choice to go home rather than to Scone)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the old Man's closing blessing as an ending to Act II.

    Sample answer: He asks God's benison for Ross and for those who would make good of bad and friends of foes. It is a gentle hope after scenes of horror, yet the audience knows the new king made bad of good. A strong answer weighs its hope against its irony and considers whether it hints at future efforts to restore order.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the scene connect the political and the natural worlds?

    Sample answer: Ross says the heavens are troubled by man's act, and the darkness by day, the owl killing the falcon and the horses' rebellion all mirror the murder of a king. Then Macduff reports the political results: suspicion on the princes, Macbeth named king, Duncan buried at Colmekill. A strong answer shows how each natural sign matches a political event.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Ross decide to attend the coronation despite the omens?

    A. He believes Macbeth is innocent beyond doubt

    B. He goes along with events for now

    C. He hopes to find the princes

    D. He wants to arrest Macbeth

    Key: B (He goes along with events for now)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Ross and Macduff as responses to the new reign.

    Sample answer: Ross describes the omens with wonder and goes to Scone, accepting the crowning for now. Macduff answers briefly, repeats the official story without enthusiasm and goes home to Fife, warning that old robes may sit easier than new. A strong answer contrasts Ross's compliance with Macduff's guarded distance.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act II, Scene IV develops the idea of nature's revolt against the crime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act II, Scene IV” could deliver about nature's revolt against the crime. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for nature's revolt against the crime in “Act II, Scene IV”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act II, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of nature's revolt against the crime. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act II, Scene IV” could deliver about nature's revolt against the crime. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for nature's revolt against the crime in “Act II, Scene IV”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act II, Scene IV suggests about nature's revolt against the crime. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act II, Scene IV” could deliver about nature's revolt against the crime. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for nature's revolt against the crime in “Act II, Scene IV”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act II, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of nature's revolt against the crime. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act II, Scene IV” could deliver about nature's revolt against the crime. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for nature's revolt against the crime in “Act II, Scene IV”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Threescore and ten I can remember well: Within the volume of which time I have seen Hours dreadful and things strange; but this sore night Hath trifled former knowings. Ah, good father, Thou seest, the heavens, as*

troubled with man's act, Threaten his bloody stage: by the clock, 'tis day, And yet dark night strangles the travelling lamp: Is't night's predominance, or the day's shame, That darkness does the face of earth entomb, When living light should kiss it? 'Tis unnatural, Even like the deed that's done. On Tuesday last, A falcon, towering in her pride of place, Was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd. And Duncan's horses—a thing most strange and certain— Beauteous and swift, the minions of their race, Turn'd wild in nature, broke their stalls, flung out, Contending 'gainst obedience, as they would make War with mankind. 'Tis said they eat each other. They did so, to the amazement of mine eyes That look'd upon't. Here comes the good Macduff.

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act II, Scene IV"?

A. A marriage drifting apart

B. Nature's revolt against the crime

C. The discovery of the murder

D. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

SAT key: 1. B (Nature's revolt against the crime)

Lesson 14: Act III, Scene I

Focus: insecurity on the throne

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act III, Scene I” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Banquo suspects Macbeth 'play'dst most foully' for the crown but hopes the prophecy for his own line will also come true. Macbeth, now king, invites Banquo to the feast and learns he will ride out with Fleance. Alone, Macbeth says 'To be thus is nothing; but to be safely thus': Banquo's royal nature and the prophecy of his heirs torment him, since he holds a 'fruitless crown.' He persuades two murderers that Banquo is their enemy and hires them to kill Banquo and Fleance.

Background: Because James I claimed descent from Banquo, Shakespeare makes Banquo noble, departing from Holinshed, where Banquo helps kill Duncan.

Significance: Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition because....
Prompt: Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: buffets — blows; hard knocks; predominant — strongest; ruling over the rest; parricide — the murder of one's father; disasters — misfortunes; rebuked — checked; held back. “parricide”: Origin: possibly Middle French parricide; earlier Latin parricīda. “disasters”: Origin of “disaster”: Middle French desastre; earlier Latin astrum (“star”).
Words: buffets: blows; hard knocks · predominant: strongest; ruling over the rest · parricide: the murder of one's father · disasters: misfortunes · rebuked: checked; held back

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Because James I claimed descent from Banquo, Shakespeare makes Banquo noble, departing from Holinshed, where Banquo helps kill Duncan. Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him. Soliloquy: "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus": Macbeth fears Banquo and his heirs. Characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Imagery: "Fruitless crown" and "barren sceptre": he has no heir. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus" slowly and put it in my own words: Macbeth says that being king is nothing unless he is safely king. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "thus" and "safely thus." The strongest word is "safely": it shows his new anxiety about keeping power. Then, effect. Why is being king not enough for Macbeth? My answer: Being king is not enough for Macbeth because he is not safe; his crown brings fear, not peace, so he decides to kill Banquo, whose descendants the witches said would be kings.

> *To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus* (Act III, Scene I, line 991)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus" slowly and put it in my own words: Macbeth says that being king is nothing unless he is safely king. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between "thus" and "safely thus." The strongest word is "safely": it shows his new anxiety about keeping power. Then, effect. Why is being king not enough for Macbeth? My answer: Being king is not enough for Macbeth because he is not safe; his crown brings fear, not peace, so he decides to kill Banquo, whose descendants the witches said would be kings.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Fruitless crown" and "barren sceptre" stand out. Macbeth sees his crown as a plant that bears no fruit, because he has no heir to inherit it. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition? Expected student answer: Macbeth has gained the throne, but the line shows that ambition fulfilled brings no peace: the crown will pass to Banquo's sons, so he is driven toward a new crime.

> *Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe* (Act III, Scene I, lines 1003–1004)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Fruitless crown" and "barren sceptre" stand out. Macbeth sees his crown as a plant that bears no fruit, because he has no heir to inherit it.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition?
Expected student answer: Macbeth has gained the throne, but the line shows that ambition fulfilled brings no peace: the crown will pass to Banquo's sons, so he is driven toward a new crime.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of insecurity on the throne. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. When the text says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus" (Act III, Scene I, line 991), it shows this directly. He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.
Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of insecurity on the throne. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. When the text says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus" (Act III, Scene I, line 991), it shows this directly. He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy? Compare how Macbeth persuades the murderers with how Lady Macbeth persuaded him.
Anchor question: Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?
Facilitation: Compare how Macbeth persuades the murderers with how Lady Macbeth persuaded him.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. ("To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus", Act III, Scene I, line 991). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about insecurity on the throne? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. ("To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus", Act III, Scene I, line 991). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how soliloquy shapes insecurity on the throne. Key takeaway: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus": Macbeth fears Banquo and his heirs.
- **Characterization:** Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood.
- **Imagery:** "Fruitless crown" and "barren sceptre": he has no heir.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition:** ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, line 991) Kingship without security means nothing.
- “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, lines 1003–1004) Childlessness.
- “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, line 1038) Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder.
Evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, line 991)
Reasoning: He says "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus," and sees his "fruitless crown" passing to Banquo's line.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
buffets (noun)	blows; hard knocks	*I am one, my liege, Whom the vile blows and buffets of the world Have so incensed that I am reckless what I do to spite the world.*	

predominant (adjective)	strongest; ruling over the rest	*Do you find Your patience so predominant in your nature That you can let this go?*	
parricide (noun)	the murder of one's father	*We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.*	"parricide": Origin: possibly Middle French parricide; earlier Latin parricīda. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/parricide#Etymology)
disasters (noun)	misfortunes	*And I another So weary with disasters, tugg'd with fortune, That I would set my life on any chance, To mend it, or be rid on't.*	"disasters": Origin of "disaster": Middle French desastre; earlier Latin astrum ("star"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disaster#Etymology)
rebuked (verb)	checked; held back	*There is none but he Whose being I do fear: and, under him, My Genius is rebuked; as, it is said, Mark Antony's was by Caesar.*	
confessing (verb)	admitting (a crime)	*We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.*	
oracles (noun)	people or spirits who give prophecies	*If there come truth from them— As upon thee, Macbeth, their speeches shine— Why, by the verities on thee made good, May they not be my oracles as well, And set me up in hope?*	"oracles": Origin of "oracle": Old French oracle; earlier Latin ōrāculum. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/oracle#Etymology)
cousins (noun)	kinsmen; relatives (here, Duncan's sons)	*We hear, our bloody cousins are bestow'd In England and in Ireland, not confessing Their cruel parricide, filling their hearers With strange invention: but of that to-morrow, When therewithal we shall have cause of state Craving us jointly.*	
manhood (noun)	adulthood as a man	*Now, if you have a station in the file, / Not i' the worst rank of manhood, say't;*	
gracious (adjective)	kind and good	*For Banquo's issue have I filed my mind; / For them the gracious Duncan have I murder'd;*	

Discussion questions

1. Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?

2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Complete Macbeth's line: 'To be thus is nothing…' [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** '…but to be safely thus.'
   Answer guidance: '…but to be safely thus.'.
2. What does Banquo suspect? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** That Macbeth played most foully for the crown
   Answer guidance: That Macbeth played most foully for the crown.
3. What does Macbeth ask about Banquo's afternoon? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Whether he rides, how far, and whether Fleance goes with him
   Answer guidance: Whether he rides, how far, and whether Fleance goes with him.
4. What does Macbeth call his crown? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A fruitless crown
   Answer guidance: A fruitless crown.
5. Whom does Macbeth hire the murderers to kill? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Banquo and Fleance
   Answer guidance: Banquo and Fleance.
6. How does Macbeth persuade the murderers? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He tells them Banquo caused their misfortunes
   Answer guidance: He tells them Banquo caused their misfortunes.
7. Retell the most important events of “Act III, Scene I” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Banquo suspects Macbeth 'play'dst most foully' for the crown but hopes the prophecy for his own line will also come true. Macbeth, now king, invites Banquo to the feast and learns he will ride out with Fleance. Alone, Macbeth says 'To be thus is nothing; but to be safely thus': Banquo's royal nature and the prophecy of his heirs torment him, since he holds a 'fruitless crown.' He persuades two…
   Answer guidance: Banquo suspects Macbeth 'play'dst most foully' for the crown but hopes the prophecy for his own line will also come true. Macbeth, now king, invites Banquo to the feast and learns he will ride out with Fleance. Alone, Macbeth says 'To be thus is nothing; but to be safely thus': Banquo's royal nature and the prophecy of his heirs torment him, since he holds a 'fruitless crown.' He persuades two…
8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene I”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the

teacher summary.

Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when is "Act III, Scene I" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

    Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: "I am one, my liege, Whom the vile blows and buffets of the world Have so incensed that I am reckless what I do to spite the world." What does "buffets" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** buffets: blows; hard knocks.

    Answer guidance: buffets: blows; hard knocks.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth not tell Lady Macbeth about the plan to kill Banquo? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** He is growing independent in crime and isolated from her.

    Answer guidance: He is growing independent in crime and isolated from her.

2. What does "Act III, Scene I" suggest about insecurity on the throne? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him.

    Answer guidance: Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him. Evidence to accept: "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus" (Act III, Scene I, line 991): Kingship without security means nothing. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of characterization in "Act III, Scene I". What does it reveal about insecurity on the throne that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them. Evidence to accept: "Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe" (Act III, Scene I, lines 1003–1004): Childlessness. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the irony in "Act III, Scene I" shape what we understand about insecurity on the throne? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: "To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus" (Act III, Scene I, line 991): Kingship without security means nothing. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with "Thou hast it now…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, line 1038): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Macbeth's choice to have Banquo and Fleance killed; evidence: “Banquo, thy soul’s flight”.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Macbeth's choice to have Banquo and Fleance killed; evidence: “Banquo, thy soul’s flight”. Evidence to accept: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, line 991): Kingship without security means nothing. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Act III, Scene I” build on “Act II, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, lines 1003–1004): Childlessness. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Act III, Scene I”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about insecurity on the throne, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, line 1038): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. On characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Once someone gets what they wanted, why are they sometimes still unhappy?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, lines 1003–1004): Childlessness. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does imagery appear in “Act III, Scene I”, and how does it connect insecurity on the throne to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, line 991): Kingship without security means nothing. On imagery: "Fruitless crown" and "barren sceptre": he has no heir. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Banquo partly guilty for keeping silent about his suspicions? Argue for or against. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment about complicity through silence.

   Answer guidance: A judgment about complicity through silence.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Getting the crown has not ended Macbeth's ambition; it has turned it into fear. He now plots without his wife, manipulating the murderers as she manipulated him. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, line 1038): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act III, Scene I” acts most wisely in the matter of insecurity on the throne, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, line 991): Kingship without security means nothing. On characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of insecurity on the throne. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, lines 1003–1004): Childlessness. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write your own questions about “Act III, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, line 1038): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act III, Scene I”, with its focus on insecurity on the throne, to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, line 991): Kingship without security means nothing. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in “Act III, Scene I” effective in presenting insecurity on the throne, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, lines 1003–1004): Childlessness. On characterization: Macbeth hires murderers by manipulating them, using Lady Macbeth's tactic of attacking manhood. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act III, Scene I” treats insecurity on the throne with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Ay, in the catalogue ye go for men” (Act III, Scene I, line 1038): Macbeth manipulates the murderers about their manhood. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “To be thus is nothing; / But to be safely thus” (Act III, Scene I, line 991): Kingship without security means nothing. Theme link: ambition fulfilled breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act III, Scene I” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about insecurity on the throne? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's crown brings fear, not satisfaction, and fear drives him to new murder. Useful evidence: “Upon my head they placed a fruitless crown, / And put a barren sceptre in my gripe” (Act III, Scene I, lines 1003–1004): Childlessness. Theme link: ambition fulfilled

breeds insecurity and more crime. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does this scene take place?
   A. The palace at Forres
   B. Macbeth's castle at Inverness
   C. A heath near the battlefield
   D. Macduff's castle in Fife

   Key: A (The palace at Forres)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth call Banquo when he enters?
   A. Our noble partner
   B. Our chief guest
   C. Our worthy thane
   D. Our dearest friend

   Key: B (Our chief guest)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What event is planned for tonight?
   A. A royal hunt in the forest
   B. A crowning at Scone
   C. A solemn supper
   D. A battle with Norway

   Key: C (A solemn supper)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Macbeth's line: "Let every man be master of his time Till _____ at night"

   Key: seven
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Macbeth say the princes are now?
   A. Hiding in the woods near Forres
   B. In Norway with the rebels
   C. At Colmekill with their father
   D. In England and in Ireland

   Key: D (In England and in Ireland)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say the princes are filling their hearers with?
   A. Strange invention

B. Fear of the Witches

C. Hope for the future

D. Tales of Norway's army

Key: A (Strange invention)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where are the murderers waiting when Macbeth asks for them?

   A. In the great hall by the fire

   B. Without the palace gate

   C. In the stables with the horses

   D. Inside the king's own chamber

   Key: B (Without the palace gate)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the First Murderer answer when Macbeth asks if they will let this go?

   A. We shall, my lord

   B. True, my lord

   C. We are men, my liege

   D. You made it known to us

   Key: C (We are men, my liege)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Macbeth fear Banquo, according to his soliloquy?

   Sample answer: Macbeth says Banquo has a royal nature, daring and wisdom that guides his valour to act in safety. Banquo once scolded the Witches and made them speak to him, and they called him father to a line of kings. Macbeth feels his own Genius is rebuked by Banquo, so he sees Banquo as the one man he truly fears.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Macbeth plan to keep his part in the killing hidden?

    Sample answer: Macbeth tells the murderers he could openly sweep Banquo away with barefaced power but must not, because he shares friends with Banquo whose love he needs to keep. So he masks the business from the common eye, has it done away from the palace that night, and plans to mourn the fall of the man he himself struck down.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Banquo promise when Macbeth invites him to supper?

    A. His duties are knit to the king by an unbreakable tie

    B. He will come to supper only if Fleance is also invited

    C. He will bring news from England by nightfall

    D. He will arrive early to help the servants

    Key: A (His duties are knit to the king by an unbreakable tie)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Banquo mean by “I must become a borrower of the night For a dark hour or twain”?

    A. He must ask Macbeth for a loan of money

    B. He will ride on after dark for an hour or two

    C. He plans to sleep through the afternoon

    D. He will take a fresh horse from the king's own stable

Key: B (He will ride on after dark for an hour or two)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Macbeth want to be alone until supper?

    A. To pray for Duncan's soul

    B. To write secret letters to his allies in England

    C. To make the company sweeter when they meet again

    D. To rest after the long ride

    Key: C (To make the company sweeter when they meet again)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth mean by “To be thus is nothing”?

    A. Kingship is a great honour

    B. He wishes he had stayed a thane and not become king

    C. He is too tired to rule

    D. Being king means little unless he is secure

    Key: D (Being king means little unless he is secure)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “mine eternal _____ Given to the common enemy of man”

    Key: jewel

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth compare men to when he talks to the murderers?

    A. Different kinds of dogs

    B. Different kinds of horses

    C. Soldiers in an army

    D. Trees in a forest

    Key: A (Different kinds of dogs)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is Macbeth's point in listing hounds, greyhounds and curs?

    A. He wants the murderers to hunt with dogs

    B. Only some men deserve to be called brave

    C. Dogs are better than men

    D. All men are equal in the end

    Key: B (Only some men deserve to be called brave)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Macbeth say he cannot kill Banquo openly?

    A. Banquo's army is stronger than his own forces

    B. The Witches told him not to

    C. They share friends whose love he must keep

    D. Lady Macbeth forbade it

    Key: C (They share friends whose love he must keep)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the Second Murderer describe himself, and why does it matter?

    Sample answer: He says the vile blows of the world have made him so angry that he is reckless what he does to spite the

world. The First Murderer adds that he is so weary with disaster that he would risk his life on any chance. Their bitterness makes them easy for Macbeth to use, since they have nothing left to lose.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How has Macbeth changed since he killed Duncan, based on this scene?

    Sample answer: Before Duncan's murder he hesitated and needed his wife's push. Now he plans a new killing alone, without telling Lady Macbeth, and coolly manipulates hired men. He talks of his mind as defiled for the sake of Banquo's heirs and calls fate to fight him to the end, showing a man growing harder and more isolated.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth's reference to Mark Antony and Caesar suggest?

    A. He feels overshadowed by Banquo as Antony was by Caesar
    B. He hopes to defeat Banquo in open battle, as Caesar did
    C. He plans to flee to Rome and join the army
    D. He admires Antony's skill as a public speaker

    Key: A (He feels overshadowed by Banquo as Antony was by Caesar)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “a barren sceptre in my gripe” reveal about Macbeth's fear?

    A. He is losing his strength as a ruler
    B. He will have no son to inherit the throne
    C. He has no money left in the treasury to pay his army
    D. He dislikes the weight of the crown

    Key: B (He will have no son to inherit the throne)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth mean by “come fate into the list, And champion me to the utterance!”?

    A. He asks fate to be his loyal champion
    B. He gives up and accepts his fate
    C. He challenges fate to fight him to the death
    D. He prays that fate will spare Banquo

    Key: C (He challenges fate to fight him to the death)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about Macbeth's manner with Banquo early in the scene?

    A. He is openly cold and threatening toward his old friend
    B. He refuses to speak to Banquo
    C. He asks Banquo to forgive him
    D. He is warm and courteous while plotting his death

    Key: D (He is warm and courteous while plotting his death)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “For Banquo’s issue have I _____ my mind”

    Key: filed

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macbeth manipulate the murderers' sense of manhood?

    A. He suggests they are not real men unless they act

    B. He offers them noble titles and land in Fife

    C. He threatens to imprison their families

    D. He shows them a letter from the Witches

    Key: A (He suggests they are not real men unless they act)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “Who wear our health but sickly in his life” reveal?

    A. Macbeth is truly sick with a fever caught on the heath

    B. Macbeth feels unwell while Banquo lives

    C. Banquo has poisoned Macbeth

    D. The murderers are ill

    Key: B (Macbeth feels unwell while Banquo lives)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Macbeth insist that Fleance must die too?

    A. Fleance saw the murder of Duncan

    B. Fleance is a soldier in Malcolm's army

    C. Fleance's line threatens to inherit the crown

    D. Fleance insulted the queen at dinner

    Key: C (Fleance's line threatens to inherit the crown)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how Macbeth's soliloquy shows his obsession with the future.

    Sample answer: Macbeth calls his crown fruitless and his sceptre barren because the Witches promised the throne to Banquo's children. He feels he has defiled his mind, murdered Duncan and given his soul to the devil only to make the seed of Banquo kings. His fear is not just of Banquo but of a future he cannot control.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the scene's closing couplet.

    Sample answer: Macbeth ends with It is concluded. Banquo, thy soul's flight, If it find heaven, must find it out tonight. The rhyme gives a sense of finality, and the image of the soul's flight to heaven turns murder into a grim farewell. It echoes his line before killing Duncan and shows how the pattern of crime is repeating.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth's phrase “the common enemy of man” refer to?

    A. The devil, to whom he has given his soul

    B. Banquo, his rival for the throne

    C. The English army that Siward is gathering to invade

    D. Death, which comes to every man

    Key: A (The devil, to whom he has given his soul)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the dogs speech work as a persuasive strategy?

    A. It frightens them with images of wild beasts

    B. It flatters the men into proving their worth

    C. It reminds them of their duty to God

D. It promises them dogs as a reward

Key: B (It flatters the men into proving their worth)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the scene suggest about Macbeth's relationship with his wife now?

A. He relies on her advice for every decision he makes

B. He openly blames her for Duncan's death

C. He plans alone, without sharing his secrets

D. He sends her away from the palace

Key: C (He plans alone, without sharing his secrets)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: "To leave no rubs nor _____ in the work"

Key: botches

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Macbeth's phrase "Acquaint you with the perfect spy o' the time" add tension?

A. Macbeth will spy on the murderers himself

B. The murderers will watch the clock

C. Banquo has a spy among them

D. A third observer will guide the murder

Key: D (A third observer will guide the murder)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Which irony is strongest in Macbeth's urging Banquo not to fail the feast?

A. Banquo will in a sense attend, though not alive

B. Macbeth plans to poison the food at supper

C. Banquo has already decided to stay away

D. The feast has been cancelled already

Key: A (Banquo will in a sense attend, though not alive)

37. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Banquo's opening soliloquy reveal about his own ambition?

A. He has no interest in the prophecies at all

B. He hopes the prophecy for his heirs will come true

C. He plans to kill Macbeth that very night

D. He will report Macbeth to the thanes

Key: B (He hopes the prophecy for his heirs will come true)

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate how this scene positions Banquo morally.

Sample answer: Banquo suspects foul play but keeps quiet and even lets himself hope that the prophecies about his heirs may come true. He pledges duty to the new king. A strong answer weighs whether his silence makes him complicit or simply cautious, and notes that his hope gives Macbeth a reason to fear him.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does this scene mirror and differ from the planning of Duncan's murder?

Sample answer: Again Macbeth plans a killing of someone who trusts him, uses others to do the deed, and ends with a

rhyming couplet about heaven. But this time he plans alone, persuades hired murderers himself and feels no hesitation. A strong answer shows how the echo highlights his change from a tempted man to a hardened tyrant.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate Macbeth's claim that the murderers' misfortunes came from Banquo.

    Sample answer: Macbeth says he proved in a previous meeting that Banquo held them under fortune and that they wrongly blamed him. The audience never sees proof. A strong answer argues that he invents a convenient enemy to channel their anger, shows how he uses their poverty and bitterness, and links this to his growing reliance on deception.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 2, inference 7, analysis 1, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene I develops the idea of insecurity on the throne. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act III, Scene I” could deliver about insecurity on the throne. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for insecurity on the throne in “Act III, Scene I”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of insecurity on the throne. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act III, Scene I” could deliver about insecurity on the throne. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for insecurity on the throne in “Act III, Scene I”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene I suggests about insecurity on the throne. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene I" could deliver about insecurity on the throne. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for insecurity on the throne in "Act III, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act III, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of insecurity on the throne. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene I" could deliver about insecurity on the throne. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for insecurity on the throne in "Act III, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Thou hast it now: king, Cawdor, Glamis, all, As the weird women promised, and, I fear, Thou play'dst most foully for't: yet it was said It should not stand in thy posterity, But that myself should be the root and father Of many kings. If there come truth from them— As upon thee, Macbeth, their speeches shine— Why, by the verities on thee made good, May they not be my oracles as well, And set me up in hope? But hush! no more.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene I"?

   A. Insecurity on the throne

   B. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

   C. The Witches' greetings and their pull

   D. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

SAT key: 1. A (Insecurity on the throne)

Lesson 15: Act III, Scene II

Focus: a marriage drifting apart

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act III, Scene II” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Lady Macbeth admits 'Nought's had, all's spent, where our desire is got without content.' She urges Macbeth to stop brooding. He says they have 'scotch'd the snake, not kill'd it,' that terrible dreams shake them nightly, and that Duncan in his grave sleeps well. 'O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!' He hints at 'a deed of dreadful note' but tells her to 'be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck,' and calls on 'seeling night' to hide it.

Background: To 'seel' was a falconer's term for stitching shut a young hawk's eyes to tame it; Macbeth asks night to blind the day.

Significance: The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can a shared secret change a relationship? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: How can a shared secret change a relationship?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: applaud — to praise; cloister — a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly; yawning — drowsy; pitiful — full of pity; compassionate; invisible — that cannot be seen. “applaud”: Origin: Latin applaudere.
Words: applaud: to praise · cloister: a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly · yawning: drowsy · pitiful: full of pity; compassionate · invisible: that cannot be seen

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
To 'seel' was a falconer's term for stitching shut a young hawk's eyes to tame it; Macbeth asks night to blind the day. The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime. Characterization: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Imagery: "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!" and invocations of night. Structure: The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content" slowly and put it in my own words: Lady Macbeth says nothing is gained and everything is spent when desire is achieved without contentment. Next, craft. I notice the balanced, rhyming phrasing that sounds like a sad proverb. The strongest word is "content": it means peace of mind, which their crime has destroyed. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth realize about their success? My answer: She realizes their ambition has brought only unhappiness; the line shows her early regret, though she hides it from Macbeth.

> *Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content (Act III, Scene II, lines 1103–1104)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content" slowly and put it in my own words: Lady Macbeth says nothing is gained and everything is spent when desire is achieved without contentment. Next, craft. I notice the balanced, rhyming phrasing that sounds like a sad proverb. The strongest word is "content": it means peace of mind, which their crime has destroyed. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth realize about their success? My answer: She realizes their ambition has brought only unhappiness; the line shows her early regret, though she hides it from Macbeth.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Innocent", "knowledge" and "dearest chuck" stand out. The tender name sits beside a decision to keep her out of his plans, so Macbeth shields her and shuts her out at once. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected student answer: Macbeth now plans a killing without telling his wife, so the line shows his guilt isolating him; the partner who once led him is no longer told what he does.

> *Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck (Act III, Scene II, line 1148)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Innocent", "knowledge" and "dearest chuck" stand out. The tender name sits beside a decision to keep her out of his plans, so Macbeth shields her and shuts her out at once.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected student answer: Macbeth now plans a killing without telling his wife, so the line shows his guilt isolating him; the partner who once led him is no longer told what he does.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of a marriage drifting apart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. When the text says "Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck" (Act III, Scene II, line 1148), it shows this directly. She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of a marriage drifting apart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. When the text says "Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck" (Act III, Scene II, line 1148), it shows this directly. She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How can a shared secret change a relationship? Ask: is Macbeth protecting his wife or isolating her?
Anchor question: How can a shared secret change a relationship?
Facilitation: Ask: is Macbeth protecting his wife or isolating her?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck", Act III, Scene II, line 1148). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a marriage drifting apart? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck", Act III, Scene II, line 1148). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes a marriage drifting apart. Key takeaway: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy.
- **Imagery:** "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!" and invocations of night.
- **Structure:** The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows.

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content" (Act III, Scene II, lines 1103–1104) Lady Macbeth's despair.
- "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife" (Act III, Scene II, line 1138) Torment.
- "Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck" (Act III, Scene II, line 1148) He shuts her out.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide.
Evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, line 1148)
Reasoning: She admits "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content," and he keeps her "innocent of the knowledge" of Banquo's murder.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
applaud (verb)	to praise	*Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck, Till thou applaud the deed.*	“applaud”: Origin: Latin applaudere. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/applaud#Etymology)
cloister (noun)	a covered walkway; here, dark enclosed places where bats fly	*There’s comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister’d flight, ere to black Hecate’s summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night’s yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.*	
yawning (adjective)	drowsy	*There’s comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister’d flight, ere to black Hecate’s summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night’s yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.*	
pitiful (adjective)	full of pity; compassionate	*Come, seeling night, Scarf up the tender eye of pitiful day; And with thy bloody and invisible hand Cancel and tear to pieces that great bond Which keeps me pale!*	
invisible (adjective)	that cannot be seen	*Come, seeling night, Scarf up the tender eye of pitiful day; And with thy bloody and invisible hand Cancel and tear to pieces that great bond Which keeps me pale!*	
leisure (noun)	a convenient time	*Say to the king, I would attend his leisure For a few words.*	
assailable (adjective)	able to be attacked	*There’s comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister’d flight, ere to black Hecate’s summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night’s yawning*	

		peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note.	
thickens (verb)	grows dim	*Light thickens; and the crow Makes wing to the rooky wood: Good things of day begin to droop and drowse; Whiles night's black agents to their preys do rouse.*	
scorpions (noun)	stinging creatures (an image of torment)	*O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!*	
doubtful (adjective)	full of fear and uncertainty	*Nought's had, all's spent, Where our desire is got without content: 'Tis safer to be that which we destroy Than by destruction dwell in doubtful joy.*	"doubtful": Origin: an English formation from doubt + -ful. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/doubtful#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. How can a shared secret change a relationship?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth call his wife in this scene that shows tenderness? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** 'Dear wife' and 'dearest chuck.'
   Answer guidance: 'Dear wife' and 'dearest chuck.'.
2. What does Lady Macbeth mean by 'Nought's had, all's spent'? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** They have gained nothing that brings content
   Answer guidance: They have gained nothing that brings content.
3. What does Macbeth say they have done to the snake? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Scotched it, not killed it
   Answer guidance: Scotched it, not killed it.
4. What is Macbeth's mind full of? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Scorpions
   Answer guidance: Scorpions.

5. Who does Macbeth say sleeps well? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Duncan in his grave
   Answer guidance: Duncan in his grave.
6. When does Macbeth say the deed of dreadful note will be done? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Before the bat and beetle finish their night flight
   Answer guidance: Before the bat and beetle finish their night flight.
7. Retell the most important events of “Act III, Scene II” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Lady Macbeth admits 'Nought's had, all's spent, where our desire is got without content.' She urges Macbeth to stop brooding. He says they have 'scotch'd the snake, not kill'd it,' that terrible dreams shake them nightly, and that Duncan in his grave sleeps well. 'O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!' He hints at 'a deed of dreadful note' but tells her to 'be innocent of the knowledge,…
   Answer guidance: Lady Macbeth admits 'Nought's had, all's spent, where our desire is got without content.' She urges Macbeth to stop brooding. He says they have 'scotch'd the snake, not kill'd it,' that terrible dreams shake them nightly, and that Duncan in his grave sleeps well. 'O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!' He hints at 'a deed of dreadful note' but tells her to 'be innocent of the knowledge,…
8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is “Act III, Scene II” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck, Till thou applaud the deed.” What does “applaud” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** applaud: to praise.
    Answer guidance: applaud: to praise.

Inferential / analytical

1. Lady Macbeth says 'what's done is done' here; in V.i she says 'What's done cannot be undone.' How has the meaning changed? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Here she tries to control regret; later the same idea becomes despair.
   Answer guidance: Here she tries to control regret; later the same idea becomes despair.
2. What does “Act III, Scene II” suggest about a marriage drifting apart? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime.
   Answer guidance: The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime. Evidence to accept:

"Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content" (Act III, Scene II, lines 1103–1104): Lady Macbeth's despair. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of imagery in "Act III, Scene II". What does it reveal about a marriage drifting apart that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife" (Act III, Scene II, line 1138): Torment. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the characterization in "Act III, Scene II" shape what we understand about a marriage drifting apart? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content" (Act III, Scene II, lines 1103–1104): Lady Macbeth's despair. On characterization: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with "O, full of scorpions…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck" (Act III, Scene II, line 1148): He shuts her out. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act III, Scene II", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Macbeth keeps his new plot from his wife; evidence: "Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck".
   Answer guidance: Look for: Macbeth keeps his new plot from his wife; evidence: "Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck". Evidence to accept: "Nought's had, all's spent, / Where our desire is got without content" (Act III, Scene II, lines 1103–1104): Lady Macbeth's despair. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does "Act III, Scene II" build on "Act III, Scene I"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife" (Act III, Scene II, line 1138): Torment. On structure: The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In "Act III, Scene II", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about a marriage drifting apart, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the

marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, line 1148): He shuts her out. On characterization: Macbeth keeps Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (How can a shared secret change a relationship?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, line 1138): Torment. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does tone / mood appear in “Act III, Scene II”, and how does it connect a marriage drifting apart to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, lines 1103–1104): Lady Macbeth's despair. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Macbeth protecting his wife by keeping her ignorant, or shutting her out? Argue your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment about the marriage with evidence.
   Answer guidance: A judgment about the marriage with evidence.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The couple's roles have reversed since Act I: she now counsels calm, he plans alone. The imagery of snakes, scorpions and night shows a mind poisoned by its own crime. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, line 1148): He shuts her out. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act III, Scene II” acts most wisely in the matter of a marriage drifting apart, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, lines 1103–1104): Lady Macbeth's despair. On characterization: Macbeth keeps

Lady Macbeth out of his plan ("Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck"); she now seems uneasy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a marriage drifting apart. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, line 1138): Torment. On structure: The marriage reverses: he now leads; she follows. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act III, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, line 1148): He shuts her out. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act III, Scene II”, with its focus on a marriage drifting apart, to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, lines 1103–1104): Lady Macbeth's despair. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in “Act III, Scene II” effective in presenting a marriage drifting apart, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, line 1138): Torment. On imagery: "O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife!" and invocations of night. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene II” treats a marriage drifting apart with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck” (Act III, Scene II, line 1148): He shuts her out. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “Nought’s had, all’s spent, / Where our desire is got without content” (Act III, Scene II, lines 1103–1104): Lady Macbeth's despair. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act III, Scene II” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a marriage drifting apart? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Success has left both Macbeths miserable, and the marriage begins to divide. Useful evidence: “O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife” (Act III, Scene II, line 1138): Torment. Theme link: both are unhappy: "Nought's had, all's spent." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth first ask the Servant?
   A. Whether Banquo has gone from court
   B. Whether the king has eaten his supper yet
   C. Whether the guests have arrived at the gate
   D. Whether Macduff has returned from Fife

   Key: A (Whether Banquo has gone from court)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] When does the Servant say Banquo will return?
   A. Tomorrow
   B. Tonight
   C. Next week
   D. Not at all

   Key: B (Tonight)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth ask the Servant to tell the king?

   A. She is too ill to attend the feast

   B. Banquo has left for England

   C. She wants a few words with him

   D. The guests are waiting in the hall

   Key: C (She wants a few words with him)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Lady Macbeth's line: "Things without all _____ Should be without regard"

   Key: remedy

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macbeth notice about Macbeth when he enters?

   A. He is laughing loudly with his guests

   B. He is dressed in armour as if ready for battle

   C. He is writing a letter to Malcolm

   D. He keeps to himself with gloomy thoughts

   Key: D (He keeps to himself with gloomy thoughts)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Lady Macbeth want Macbeth to act at the feast?

   A. Bright and jovial

   B. Stern and silent with every guest

   C. Tired and quiet so he may leave

   D. Angry with Banquo in front of all

   Key: A (Bright and jovial)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How should Lady Macbeth treat the chief guest at the feast?

   A. Ignore him at the table

   B. Honour him with eye and tongue

   C. Seat him far from the king

   D. Ask him to leave early tonight

   Key: B (Honour him with eye and tongue)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do Macbeth and Lady Macbeth both complain of?

   A. Hunger and cold in the palace

   B. Too many guests at the court

   C. Terrible dreams and restless nights

   D. Bad news from the army fighting in Norway

   Key: C (Terrible dreams and restless nights)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this scene show about how Macbeth and Lady Macbeth feel now that they rule?

   Sample answer: Neither is happy. She says that when desire is gained without contentment, nothing is truly won, and it would be safer to be the murdered man. He says terrible dreams shake them nightly and he envies the dead, who are at peace. Their crime has brought power but taken away rest and peace of mind.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Macbeth handle the new plan differently in this scene?

Sample answer: Macbeth speaks to Lady Macbeth with affection but keeps his plan secret. When she asks what is to be done, he tells her only that a deed of dreadful note will happen and that she will praise it later. Earlier she pushed him to act, but now he takes charge alone and leaves her out of his plans.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] According to Lady Macbeth's private couplet, who is better off?

    A. The murdered man is better off than the uneasy murderers

    B. It is safer to kill everyone who opposes the crown

    C. Duncan was safer as king than Macbeth will be

    D. They should destroy the evidence of their crime

    Key: A (The murdered man is better off than the uneasy murderers)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Lady Macbeth tell Macbeth to do with his thoughts of the dead?

    A. Write them down so he can confess to a priest

    B. Let them go, since what is past can't be fixed

    C. Share them with Banquo, who will understand

    D. Hold onto them so he will not forget his crime

    Key: B (Let them go, since what is past can't be fixed)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth mean by “let the frame of things disjoint”?

    A. He wants the castle walls rebuilt before the feast

    B. He fears an earthquake will strike Scotland tonight

    C. He would let the universe fall apart sooner than live in fear

    D. He hopes the guests will leave before supper

    Key: C (He would let the universe fall apart sooner than live in fear)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does Macbeth say the dead are better off?

    A. They no longer have to pay taxes

    B. They have gone to heaven as heroes of the war

    C. They can watch over the living

    D. They are at peace and beyond harm

    Key: D (They are at peace and beyond harm)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Lady Macbeth's line: “Gentle my lord, sleek o’er your rugged _____”

    Key: looks

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth mean by “make our faces vizards to our hearts”?

    A. Their faces must mask their true feelings

    B. They must wear real masks at the feast tonight

    C. Their faces show what is in their hearts

    D. They must hide in the palace from guests

    Key: A (Their faces must mask their true feelings)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does Lady Macbeth suggest by saying nature's copy is not eterne in Banquo and Fleance?

    A. They are copies of Duncan

    B. They will not live forever

    C. They are related to the king

    D. They have been cursed by the Witches

    Key: B (They will not live forever)

18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about the guest the couple agree to flatter?

    A. Malcolm, who has returned from England

    B. Lennox, who knows the truth already

    C. He is the man Macbeth plans to kill

    D. The Witches, who will attend in secret

    Key: C (He is the man Macbeth plans to kill)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Explain Macbeth's description of the dead Duncan.

    Sample answer: Macbeth says that after life's fitful fever Duncan sleeps well. Treason has done its worst, and nothing can touch him further: not steel, poison, malice at home or armies from abroad. Macbeth almost envies him, because the murdered king has a peace that the living killer can no longer find.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Lady Macbeth try to calm her husband in this scene?

    Sample answer: She asks why he keeps alone with his sorriest fancies and tells him that things without remedy should be without regard. She urges him to smooth his rugged looks and be bright and jovial among the guests. She tries to make him put the past behind him, but she cannot ease his fears.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Lady Macbeth's private couplet differ from what she says to her husband?

    A. Alone she admits unhappiness, but to him she urges calm

    B. Alone she is cheerful, but to him she is anxious

    C. Alone she plans Banquo's murder, but hides it from him

    D. Alone she blames him, but to him she offers praise

    Key: A (Alone she admits unhappiness, but to him she urges calm)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth's phrase “torture of the mind” reveal about his guilt?

    A. He is being held prisoner by his enemies

    B. His guilt has become a mental punishment

    C. He has been injured in battle

    D. He has lost his memory of the crime

    Key: B (His guilt has become a mental punishment)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “Malice domestic, foreign levy” list?

    A. Taxes Macbeth plans to raise in Scotland

    B. Poisons used to kill Duncan in his bed

    C. Dangers a king faces at home and abroad

D. Crimes committed by the princes in England

Key: C (Dangers a king faces at home and abroad)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “lave our honours in these flattering streams” suggest?

A. They should bathe before the feast tonight

B. They are honoured by Banquo's flattery

C. They must swim the river to escape

D. They must wash their honour in flattery to keep it

Key: D (They must wash their honour in flattery to keep it)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “After life’s fitful _____ he sleeps well”

Key: fever

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How has the balance of power between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth shifted?

A. Macbeth now acts without her and she follows

B. Lady Macbeth now plans all the murders herself

C. They now share every plan openly

D. Macbeth now asks her permission for everything

Key: A (Macbeth now acts without her and she follows)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth's wish to avoid eating 'our meal in fear' reveal?

A. He fears that Banquo has tampered with his food

B. Fear has spoiled even ordinary life

C. He is too ill to eat at the feast

D. He hates the food served at court

Key: B (Fear has spoiled even ordinary life)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Lady Macbeth's 'You must leave this' show about her role?

A. She orders him to leave the palace

B. She plans to leave Scotland herself

C. She tries to steer him away from dark thoughts

D. She refuses to speak to him again

Key: C (She tries to steer him away from dark thoughts)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the theme of sleep and rest in this scene.

Sample answer: Macbeth complains that terrible dreams shake them nightly, so they lie on the torture of the mind in restless ecstasy. He says the dead Duncan sleeps well after life's fitful fever. The murderers have lost the rest that their victim now enjoys, continuing the idea from Act II that Macbeth has murdered sleep.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how Lady Macbeth's couplet in this scene reveals her state of mind.

Sample answer: Alone, she says that nothing is gained when desire is reached without contentment, and that it is safer to be

the one destroyed than to live in doubtful joy. The rhymed, balanced lines sound calm, yet they admit deep unhappiness. Her ambition has been fulfilled, but she already feels its emptiness.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the antithesis in "Nought's had, all's spent" capture her situation?
    A. Total cost set against nothing of value gained
    B. A list of the treasures taken from Duncan's castle
    C. A comparison of two different kingdoms
    D. A contrast between Banquo and Macduff

    Key: A (Total cost set against nothing of value gained)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the scene's movement from couplet to dialogue reveal?
    A. Her public confidence gives way to private doubt
    B. Her private doubt gives way to public confidence
    C. Macbeth's doubt gives way to his wife's despair
    D. Each character loses hope by the end

    Key: B (Her private doubt gives way to public confidence)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth's "Things bad begun make strong themselves by ill" reveal?
    A. He thinks bad beginnings lead to good endings
    B. He regrets his crimes and wants to repent
    C. He believes more evil is needed to secure past evil
    D. He fears Lady Macbeth will betray him

    Key: C (He believes more evil is needed to secure past evil)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: "And make our faces _____ to our hearts"

    Key: vizards

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does this scene invert the dynamic of Act I, Scene VII?
    A. Lady Macbeth still leads and he follows
    B. Banquo now guides the pair of them
    C. The Witches now guide the couple
    D. Macbeth now leads and his wife is uncertain

    Key: D (Macbeth now leads and his wife is uncertain)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth's envy of the dead suggest about his kingship?
    A. The crown has brought him no peace at all
    B. He wants to give the crown to Malcolm
    C. He plans to give the crown to Fleance
    D. He believes Duncan was a poor king

    Key: A (The crown has brought him no peace at all)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate how this scene shows the growing distance between the two partners in crime.

    Sample answer: Lady Macbeth must send a servant to ask for a few words with her husband. When he arrives he is affectionate but will not share his plan, telling her only that a dreadful deed will happen. A strong answer traces how he has moved from depending on her to acting alone, and how she seems pushed aside.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the role of disguise and false faces in this scene.

    Sample answer: Macbeth tells his wife they must flatter Banquo and make their faces vizards to their hearts, disguising what they are. Lady Macbeth urges him to smooth his rugged looks and seem jovial. A strong answer links this to her earlier advice to look like the innocent flower and argues that their power now depends on constant pretence.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's request that the world 'disjoint' reveal about his priorities?

    A. He wants to rebuild Scotland after the war

    B. He would sacrifice everything for his own peace

    C. He cares deeply for the welfare of his subjects

    D. He hopes to restore order in the kingdom

    Key: B (He would sacrifice everything for his own peace)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Compare the couplets of Lady Macbeth and Macbeth in this scene.

    Sample answer: Her lines say that winning without peace is worthless and that it is safer to be the victim than to live in uncertain joy. His closing couplet says that things bad begun make strong themselves by ill. A strong answer contrasts her weary regret with his resolve to go deeper into crime.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 8, analysis 1, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene II develops the idea of a marriage drifting apart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act III, Scene II” could deliver about a marriage drifting apart. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a marriage drifting apart in “Act III, Scene II”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of a marriage drifting apart. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene II" could deliver about a marriage drifting apart. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a marriage drifting apart in "Act III, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene II suggests about a marriage drifting apart. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene II" could deliver about a marriage drifting apart. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a marriage drifting apart in "Act III, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act III, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of a marriage drifting apart. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene II" could deliver about a marriage drifting apart. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a marriage drifting apart in "Act III, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Come, seeling night, Scarf up the tender eye of pitiful day; And with thy bloody and invisible hand Cancel and tear to pieces that great bond Which keeps me pale!*

As used in the text, what does the word "pitiful" most nearly mean?

A. stinging creatures (an image of torment)

B. grows dim

C. full of pity; compassionate

D. full of fear and uncertainty

2. *O, full of scorpions is my mind, dear wife! Thou know'st that Banquo, and his Fleance, lives. But in them nature's copy's not eterne. There's comfort yet; they are assailable; Then be thou jocund: ere the bat hath flown His cloister'd flight, ere to black Hecate's summons The shard-borne beetle with his drowsy hums Hath rung night's yawning peal, there shall be done A deed of dreadful note. What's to be done? Be innocent of the knowledge, dearest chuck, Till thou applaud the deed. Come, seeling night, Scarf up the tender eye of pitiful day; And with thy bloody and invisible hand Cancel and tear to pieces that great bond Which keeps me pale! Light thickens; and the crow Makes wing to the rooky wood: Good things of day begin to droop and drowse; Whiles night's black agents to their preys do rouse. Thou marvell'st at my words: but hold thee still: Things bad begun make strong themselves by ill. So, prithee, go with me.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene II"?

A. Defiance and despair

B. A marriage drifting apart

C. Life as a tale told by an idiot

D. The last false confidence

SAT key: 1. C (full of pity; compassionate); 2. B (A marriage drifting apart)

Lesson 16: Act III, Scene III

Focus: Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in "Act III, Scene III" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (murder, violence): Banquo is murdered on stage; Fleance escapes. Keep the focus on Macbeth's fear of Banquo's line, not on the violence.
Suggested language: "Why does Macbeth want Fleance dead too?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At dusk a mysterious Third Murderer joins the first two. Banquo and Fleance approach on foot from the palace gate with a torch. The murderers attack and kill Banquo, who cries to Fleance to fly and avenge him. The light is struck out and Fleance escapes. The murderers go to report how much is done.

Background: The identity of the Third Murderer is never explained; some productions make him Macbeth himself, Ross or Seyton, showing Macbeth's distrust even of his hired men.

Significance: Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Four key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: delivers — reports; tells; mistrust — suspicion; streaks — thin lines (of light); expectation — the list of guests who are expected. "delivers": Origin of "deliver": Old French delivrer. "mistrust": Origin: an English formation from mis- + trust.
Words: delivers: reports; tells · mistrust: suspicion · streaks: thin lines (of light) · expectation: the list of guests who are expected

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The identity of the Third Murderer is never explained; some productions make him Macbeth himself, Ross or Seyton, showing Macbeth's distrust even of his hired men. Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail. Plot: Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes. Imagery: Dusk, a torch put out. Irony: The prophecy about Banquo's heirs survives in Fleance. Watch for darkness and light: Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" slowly and put it in my own words: The First Murderer says the west still glimmers with streaks of day. Next, craft. I notice the gentle, poetic description from a hired killer. The strongest word is "glimmers": it shows the last light before darkness, as Banquo's life is about to end. Then, effect. Why does the murderer describe the fading light? My answer: The fading light marks Banquo's death; the beauty of the line contrasts with the violence to come.

> *The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day* (Act III, Scene III, line 1168)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" slowly and put it in my own words: The First Murderer says the west still glimmers with streaks of day. Next, craft. I notice the gentle, poetic description from a hired killer. The strongest word is "glimmers": it shows the last light before darkness, as Banquo's life is about to end. Then, effect. Why does the murderer describe the fading light? My answer: The fading light marks Banquo's death; the beauty of the line contrasts with the violence to come.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Treachery" and "fly" stand out. Banquo names the betrayal and spends his last words urging his son to escape, so his first thought is Fleance's safety. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected student answer: Macbeth hired the murderers to stop Banquo's line, but Banquo's cry lets Fleance escape, so the line shows the plan to defeat the prophecy failing.

> *O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly* (Act III, Scene III, line 1187)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Treachery" and "fly" stand out. Banquo names the betrayal and spends his last words urging his son to escape, so his first thought is Fleance's safety.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected student answer: Macbeth hired the murderers to stop Banquo's line, but Banquo's cry lets Fleance escape, so the line shows the plan to defeat the prophecy failing.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for plot, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. When the text says "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, line 1187), it shows this directly. Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair."
Task: Annotate the scene for plot, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. When the text says "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, line 1187), it shows this directly. Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved? Ask: who is the third murderer? Discuss the theories, and why Shakespeare may have left it open.
Anchor question: Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?
Facilitation: Ask: who is the third murderer? Discuss the theories, and why Shakespeare may have left it open.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. ("O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly", Act III, Scene III, line 1187). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. ("O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly", Act III, Scene III, line 1187). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Key takeaway: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes.
- **Imagery:** Dusk, a torch put out.
- **Irony:** The prophecy about Banquo's heirs survives in Fleance.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails.

Symbols and motifs

- **darkness and light:** Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, line 1168) Twilight setting.
- “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, line 1187) Banquo's last words.
- “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, lines 1192–1193) The murderers' failure.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold.
> **Evidence:** “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, line 1187)
> **Reasoning:** Banquo's dying cry "Fly, good Fleance, fly" saves his son, and the murderers admit they "have lost / Best half of our affair."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
delivers (verb)	reports; tells	*He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just.*	“delivers”: Origin of “deliver”: Old French delivrer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/deliver#Etymology)
mistrust (noun)	suspicion		“mistrust”: Origin: an English formation from mis- + trust. (Liber et Libri origin

		He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just.	note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mistrust#Etymology)
streaks (noun)	thin lines (of light)	*The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day: Now spurs the lated traveller apace To gain the timely inn; and near approaches The subject of our watch.*	
expectation (noun)	the list of guests who are expected	*Then 'tis he: the rest That are within the note of expectation Already are i' the court.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What happens to the light at the moment of the attack? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The torch is struck out ('Who did strike out the light?').
   Answer guidance: The torch is struck out ('Who did strike out the light?').
2. Who joins the first two murderers? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A Third Murderer
   Answer guidance: A Third Murderer.
3. What time of day is it? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Dusk, as the last light fades
   Answer guidance: Dusk, as the last light fades.
4. What does Banquo tell Fleance? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Fly, good Fleance, fly
   Answer guidance: Fly, good Fleance, fly.
5. What happens to Fleance? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He escapes
   Answer guidance: He escapes.
6. What does the Third Murderer say about the result? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** There's but one down; the son is fled
   Answer guidance: There's but one down; the son is fled.

7. Retell the most important events of "Act III, Scene III" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** At dusk a mysterious Third Murderer joins the first two. Banquo and Fleance approach on foot from the palace gate with a torch. The murderers attack and kill Banquo, who cries to Fleance to fly and avenge him. The light is struck out and Fleance escapes. The murderers go to report how much is done.
   Answer guidance: At dusk a mysterious Third Murderer joins the first two. Banquo and Fleance approach on foot from the palace gate with a torch. The murderers attack and kill Banquo, who cries to Fleance to fly and avenge him. The light is struck out and Fleance escapes. The murderers go to report how much is done.
8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act III, Scene III" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "He needs not our mistrust, since he delivers Our offices and what we have to do To the direction just." What does "delivers" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** delivers: reports; tells.
    Answer guidance: delivers: reports; tells.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why might Macbeth have sent a Third Murderer without telling the others? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** He no longer trusts anyone, even his own agents.
   Answer guidance: He no longer trusts anyone, even his own agents.
2. What does "Act III, Scene III" suggest about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail.
   Answer guidance: Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail. Evidence to accept: "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" (Act III, Scene III, line 1168): Twilight setting. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of setting in "Act III, Scene III". What does it reveal about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling. Evidence to accept: "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, line 1187): Banquo's last words. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the irony in “Act III, Scene III” shape what we understand about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, line 1168): Twilight setting. On irony: The prophecy about Banquo's heirs survives in Fleance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “Then stand with us.”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, lines 1192–1193): The murderers' failure. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Fleance's escape; evidence: “Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly!”
   Answer guidance: Look for: Fleance's escape; evidence: “Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly!”. Evidence to accept: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, line 1168): Twilight setting. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Act III, Scene III” build on “Act III, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, line 1187): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Act III, Scene III”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, lines 1192–1193): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why do you think some stories leave a mystery unsolved?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “O, treachery! Fly, good

Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, line 1187): Banquo's last words. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does plot appear in "Act III, Scene III", and how does it connect Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** key events and the causes linking them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" (Act III, Scene III, line 1168): Twilight setting. On plot: Three murderers (a third appears unexplained) kill Banquo; Fleance escapes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Whom would you cast as the Third Murderer in a production, and why? Defend with clues from the play. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A justified interpretive staging choice.
    Answer guidance: A justified interpretive staging choice.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Fleance's escape keeps the Witches' prophecy for Banquo's line alive and marks the first time Macbeth's plans fail. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: "We have lost / Best half of our affair" (Act III, Scene III, lines 1192–1193): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in "Act III, Scene III" acts most wisely in the matter of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: "The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day" (Act III, Scene III, line 1168): Twilight setting. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Act III, Scene III". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, line 1187): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act III, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, lines 1192–1193): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act III, Scene III”, with its focus on Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape, to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III, Scene III, line 1168): Twilight setting. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in “Act III, Scene III” effective in presenting Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly” (Act III, Scene III, line 1187): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene III” treats Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “We have lost / Best half of our affair” (Act III, Scene III, lines 1192–1193): The murderers' failure. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act III, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: “The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day” (Act III,

Scene III, line 1168): Twilight setting. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Act III, Scene III" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Fleance's escape shows that Macbeth cannot control the future the witches foretold. Useful evidence: "O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly" (Act III, Scene III, line 1187): Banquo's last words. Theme link: Macbeth's attempt to defeat prophecy fails. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does this scene take place?

    A. A park near the palace

    B. Inside the banquet hall at Forres

    C. On the heath where the Witches met

    D. At the gate of Macduff's castle

    Key: A (A park near the palace)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Banquo say about the weather?

    A. The wind is rising from the sea

    B. It will be rain tonight

    C. The night is clear and full of stars

    D. Snow has begun to fall on the hills

    Key: B (It will be rain tonight)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the First Murderer reply to Banquo's remark about the weather?

    A. Then 'tis he

    B. Was't not the way?

    C. Let it come down

    D. Away, away

    Key: C (Let it come down)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Banquo call out when he is attacked?

   A. Help, the king!

   B. Murder, murder!

   C. Guards, to me!

   D. O, treachery!

   Key: D (O, treachery!)

5. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why do Banquo and Fleance walk the last part of the way?

   A. Riders usually walk from here to the gate

   B. Their horses have gone lame on the long road home

   C. They want to surprise the king at supper

   D. The road to the castle is flooded

   Key: A (Riders usually walk from here to the gate)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the murderers plan to do after the attack?

   A. Chase the escaped boy into the dark forest

   B. Go and report how much is done

   C. Hide the body in the river

   D. Flee the country by sea

   Key: B (Go and report how much is done)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the First Murderer say just before the attack?

   A. Hold, enough

   B. Strike now

   C. Stand to't

   D. Away with him

   Key: C (Stand to't)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the summary: Banquo's young son escapes into the _____ while his father is attacked.

   Key: darkness

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How do the murderers feel about the outcome of the attack?

   Sample answer: They are worried. The Second Murderer says they have lost the best half of their work, because the boy got away. They know Macbeth wanted both killed, so their mission is only partly done. They leave to tell him how much was accomplished, unsure how he will take the news.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is it surprising that the First Murderer accepts the newcomer?

    Sample answer: At first the First Murderer asks who told the newcomer to join them. The Second Murderer says they need not mistrust him, because he repeats their orders exactly as Macbeth gave them. The surprise shows that Macbeth does not fully trust his own hired killers and has sent someone to watch them.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the First Murderer's description of the 'lated traveller' create?

    A. A calm, ordinary picture just before violence

B. A sense of joy at the coming of a peaceful night

C. A clue that Banquo has been warned

D. A reminder that the king is travelling

Key: A (A calm, ordinary picture just before violence)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the Second Murderer say they need not mistrust the newcomer?

A. He is a cousin of the First Murderer

B. He knows their orders exactly

C. He carries a letter from the queen

D. He brings more money from the king

Key: B (He knows their orders exactly)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How do the murderers know Banquo is near?

A. A servant runs ahead of the riders to warn them

B. They see his banner on the hill

C. They hear horses and a call for light

D. The Witches tell them he is coming

Key: C (They hear horses and a call for light)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Banquo's last cry to Fleance show about him?

A. He blames Fleance for the attack

B. He hopes his son will run and fetch the king's guards

C. He wants Fleance to fight beside him

D. His first thought is for his son's safety

Key: D (His first thought is for his son's safety)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does Banquo mean by “Thou mayst revenge”?

A. Fleance may live to pay back the killers

B. Fleance should stay and fight the murderers now

C. Fleance must forgive the king

D. Fleance should take the crown at once

Key: A (Fleance may live to pay back the killers)

16. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: the only light in the scene comes from a single _____.

Key: torch

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why is the escape of the boy a problem for Macbeth?

A. The boy saw the king hire the killers

B. Banquo's line may still become kings

C. The boy has the king's sword

D. The boy will tell Lady Macbeth

Key: B (Banquo's line may still become kings)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of the scene's short, broken lines?

    A. They slow the action down to a calm pace

    B. They show that the murderers are well-educated men

    C. They create speed and confusion in the attack

    D. They make the scene sound like a song

    Key: C (They create speed and confusion in the attack)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What do the killers' remarks about the horses and the walk to the gate reveal?

    Sample answer: The killers know that riders usually leave their horses to go about almost a mile and walk from this spot to the palace gate. This local knowledge explains why they wait in the park, and it shows how carefully the ambush was planned, so that Banquo and his son arrive on foot, carrying only a torch.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the setting help create tension in this scene?

    Sample answer: The scene happens in a park near the palace as night falls, with only a little light left in the west. Travellers hurry to the inn, horses are heard, and Banquo and Fleance arrive carrying a torch. The growing darkness, the waiting killers and the single light make the audience feel the danger approaching.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about Banquo's remark “It will be rain tonight”?

    A. A storm of blows, not rain, is about to fall

    B. It is already raining heavily

    C. Banquo is a known weather prophet

    D. The murderers are afraid of rain

    Key: A (A storm of blows, not rain, is about to fall)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “Let it come down” suggest in this context?

    A. The murderer tells Banquo to get down from his tired horse

    B. The murderer turns the rain remark into a signal to strike

    C. The murderer wants to wait until it rains

    D. The murderer is afraid and wants to leave

    Key: B (The murderer turns the rain remark into a signal to strike)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the escape of Fleance suggest about Macbeth's control of events?

    A. He controls everything that happens

    B. He planned for Fleance to escape

    C. His plans can no longer fully succeed

    D. He no longer cares about the prophecy

    Key: C (His plans can no longer fully succeed)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Banquo's death fulfil from earlier scenes?

    A. The Witches' warning to Banquo on the heath

    B. Duncan's last wish

    C. Lady Macbeth's request

    D. Macbeth's plan, but not completely

Key: D (Macbeth's plan, but not completely)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the scene's darkness connect to imagery from Act III, Scene II?

    A. Night's black agents now rouse to their prey

    B. The bright day returns at last

    C. Duncan's ghost appears in the light

    D. The Witches dance in the park

    Key: A (Night's black agents now rouse to their prey)

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: the killers succeed against Banquo but fail to kill his _____.

    Key: son

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the murderers' report of 'how much is done' set up?

    A. A full victory that will calm the king's fears tonight

    B. A partly failed plot reported to an anxious king

    C. A plan to kill the king next

    D. A celebration at the feast

    Key: B (A partly failed plot reported to an anxious king)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does this brief scene shift the play's direction?

    A. It ends Macbeth's troubles for good

    B. It brings Malcolm back to Scotland

    C. Macbeth's first failure opens a path for the prophecy

    D. It reunites Banquo and Macbeth

    Key: C (Macbeth's first failure opens a path for the prophecy)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze Banquo's final words.

    Sample answer: Banquo cries O, treachery, then urges his son to run and adds that he may revenge, before calling his attacker slave. Even while dying he thinks first of his son's escape and the future. His words keep alive the prophecy about his heirs and set up Fleance as a threat to Macbeth.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the scene stages Macbeth's growing paranoia without showing him.

    Sample answer: Macbeth never appears, yet his mind is everywhere. He has sent an extra man to watch the hired killers, given them exact directions and timed the attack. The killers' doubts about the newcomer show that Macbeth trusts no one. His careful planning still fails when the boy escapes, showing the limits of control.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the First Murderer's speech about the west change the scene's register?

    A. Lyrical description gives a brief calm before violence

    B. Comic prose relieves the play's tension

    C. Formal verse marks the start of a royal procession

    D. Rapid dialogue speeds up the plot at once

    Key: A (Lyrical description gives a brief calm before violence)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the extinguished torch symbolize in the attack?

    A. It signals the start of the king's feast in the great hall

    B. Darkness lets the boy escape and the line survive

    C. It shows the killers wanted to be seen

    D. It wakes the sleeping guards at the palace

    Key: B (Darkness lets the boy escape and the line survive)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the unnamed newcomer mirror Macbeth's own methods?

    A. He refuses to take part in the killing

    B. He openly confronts Banquo before the attack

    C. He works for Macbeth by watching and reporting

    D. He betrays Macbeth to the other killers

    Key: C (He works for Macbeth by watching and reporting)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does Shakespeare keep the murder of Banquo brief?

    A. The actor playing Banquo had another role

    B. The scene is less important than others

    C. Banquo's death is not shown on stage

    D. It shows how quickly violence now happens

    Key: D (It shows how quickly violence now happens)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which earlier image does 'A light, a light!' most recall?

    A. Macbeth's wish that stars hide their fires

    B. Duncan's praise of the castle's pleasant air and seat

    C. The sergeant's report of the battle

    D. The Porter's joke about the gate

    Key: A (Macbeth's wish that stars hide their fires)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the scene complicate the idea that Macbeth controls fate?

    A. The Witches appear to stop him

    B. The prophecy survives despite his plans

    C. Banquo agrees to give up his heirs

    D. Fleance is killed as planned

    Key: B (The prophecy survives despite his plans)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Evaluate the irony in the murderers' failure.

    Sample answer: Macbeth hired the killers so that Banquo's line would not inherit, yet the son, the most important target, escapes. The light that guided Banquo is put out, and the darkness that should have helped the killers lets the boy flee. A strong answer shows how the failure keeps the prophecy alive and undermines Macbeth's attempt to defeat fate.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate how this scene uses suspense.

    Sample answer: The audience knows Banquo is the target, so every sound builds tension: horses, a voice calling for light, a torch, a remark about rain. The killers argue about the newcomer and about the route. A strong answer shows how waiting, darkness and short lines build suspense, and how the sudden attack and the boy's escape release it.

39. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: when Banquo dies, the killers have done only _____ of their task.
    Key: half
40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Compare Banquo's death with Duncan's murder.
    Sample answer: Duncan was killed offstage in his sleep by Macbeth himself, while Banquo is attacked onstage by hired killers. Duncan's sons fled, while Banquo's son escapes during the attack. A strong answer shows how the change from personal crime to hired violence reflects Macbeth's growing distance from his crimes and his growing danger.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 9, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene III develops the idea of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act III, Scene III” could deliver about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape in “Act III, Scene III”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act III, Scene III” could deliver about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape in “Act III, Scene III”: each member takes one

passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene III suggests about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene III" could deliver about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape in "Act III, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act III, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene III" could deliver about Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape in "Act III, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Then 'tis he: the rest That are within the note of expectation Already are i' the court.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "expectation" most nearly mean?

   A. reports; tells

   B. thin lines (of light)

   C. suspicion

   D. the list of guests who are expected

2. *Then stand with us. The west yet glimmers with some streaks of day: Now spurs the lated traveller apace To gain the timely inn; and near approaches The subject of our watch. Hark! I hear horses. Within. Give us a light there, ho! Then 'tis he: the rest That are within the note of expectation Already are i' the court. His horses go about. Almost a mile: but he does usually, So all men do, from hence to the palace gate Make it their walk. A light, a light! Enter Banquo, and Fleance with a torch. 'Tis he. Stand to't. It will be rain to-night. Let it come down. They set upon Banquo. O, treachery! Fly, good Fleance, fly, fly, fly! Thou mayst revenge. O slave! Dies.*

Fleance escapes. Who did strike out the light? Was't not the way? There's but one down; the son is fled. We have lost Best half of our affair. Well, let's away, and say how much is done.

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene III"?

A. The army reveals itself

B. Dramatic irony at the castle gate

C. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

D. The apparitions and false security

SAT key: 1. D (the list of guests who are expected); 2. C (Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape)

Lesson 17: Act III, Scene IV

Focus: a royal banquet thrown into turmoil

Objective: Students will analyze how symbolism develops in "Act III, Scene IV" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…l sit i' the midst: Be large in mirth; anon we'll drink a measure The table round. Approaching…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At the state banquet a Murderer tells Macbeth that Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped. When Macbeth wishes Banquo were present, Banquo's ghost sits in his place, seen only by Macbeth, who cries 'Thou canst not say I did it.' Lady Macbeth explains it as a fit he has had since youth and scolds him ('Are you a man?'). The ghost returns; the feast breaks up in disorder. Afterwards Macbeth says 'blood will have blood,' notes that Macduff refused to come, and resolves to visit the Witches: 'I am in blood stepp'd in so far…'

Background: Elizabethan audiences debated whether ghosts were spirits of the dead or devils in disguise; the play never settles whether this ghost is real.

Significance: The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: choughs — birds of the crow family; enrages — makes (someone) furious; grandam — a grandmother; nonpareil — someone without equal; displaced — driven out. “displaced”: Origin of “displace”: Middle French desplacer.
Words: choughs: birds of the crow family · enrages: makes (someone) furious · grandam: a grandmother · nonpareil: someone without equal · displaced: driven out

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Elizabethan audiences debated whether ghosts were spirits of the dead or devils in disguise; the play never settles whether this ghost is real. The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control. Dramatic irony: Macbeth wishes Banquo were present; the ghost takes his seat. Characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him. Imagery: "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood." Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” slowly and put it in my own words: Seeing Banquo's ghost at the feast, Macbeth cries that the ghost cannot say he did it, and tells it not to shake its bloody hair at him. Next, craft. I notice that his denial actually reveals his guilt. The strongest word is “gory”: it describes the ghost's bloody hair, a sign of murder. Then, effect. What does Macbeth say to Banquo's ghost? My answer: Macbeth tells Banquo's ghost that he cannot say Macbeth did it and must not shake his bloody hair at him; his outburst before the lords exposes his guilt and the feast falls apart.

> *Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me* *(Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” slowly and put it in my own words: Seeing Banquo's ghost at the feast, Macbeth cries that the ghost cannot say he did it, and tells it not to shake its bloody hair at him. Next, craft. I notice that his denial actually reveals his guilt. The strongest word is “gory”: it describes the ghost's bloody hair, a sign of murder. Then, effect. What does Macbeth say to Banquo's ghost? My answer: Macbeth tells Banquo's ghost that he cannot say Macbeth did it and must not shake his bloody hair at him; his outburst before the lords exposes his guilt and the feast falls apart.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Blood will have blood" stands out. The repeated word makes violence sound like a law that demands payment, so Macbeth expects his crimes to be avenged. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected student answer: Macbeth has just seen the Ghost, and the line shows guilt turning into a belief that blood must be paid for with blood, so his conscience speaks as dread.

> *It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood (Act III, Scene IV, line 1341)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Blood will have blood" stands out. The repeated word makes violence sound like a law that demands payment, so Macbeth expects his crimes to be avenged.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected student answer: Macbeth has just seen the Ghost, and the line shows guilt turning into a belief that blood must be paid for with blood, so his conscience speaks as dread.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. When the text says "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257), it shows this directly. He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.
Task: Annotate the scene for dramatic irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. When the text says "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257), it shows this directly. He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong? Ask: should the ghost be visible to the audience? What changes if not?
Anchor question: What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?
Facilitation: Ask: should the ghost be visible to the audience? What changes if not?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. ("Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me", Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. ("Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me", Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dramatic irony shapes a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. Key takeaway: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dramatic irony:** Macbeth wishes Banquo were present; the ghost takes his seat.
- **Characterization:** Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him.
- **Imagery:** "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood."

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour; watch how its meaning changes as the play goes on.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257) Macbeth to the ghost.
- "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood" (Act III, Scene IV, line 1341) Violence breeds violence.
- "I am in blood / Stepp'd in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o'er" (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1356–1358) Macbeth chooses to go on.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back.
Evidence: "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257)
Reasoning: He tells the ghost "never shake / Thy gory locks at me," and afterward says he is "in blood / Stepp'd in so far" that turning back would be as hard as going on.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
choughs (noun)	birds of the crow family	*It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood: Stones have been known to move and trees to speak; Augurs and understood relations have By magot-pies and choughs and rooks brought forth The secret'st man of blood.*	
enrages (verb)	makes (someone) furious	*I pray you, speak not; he grows worse and worse; Question enrages him.*	
grandam (noun)	a grandmother	*O, these flaws and starts, Impostors to true fear, would well become A woman's story at a winter's fire, Authorized by her grandam.*	
nonpareil (noun)	someone without equal	*Thou art the best o' the cut-throats: yet he's good That did the like for Fleance: if thou didst it, Thou art the nonpareil.*	
displaced (verb)	driven out	*You have displaced the mirth, broke the good meeting, With most admired disorder.*	"displaced": Origin of "displace": Middle French desplacer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/displace#Etymology)
	early		

betimes (adverb)		*I will to-morrow, And betimes I will, to the weird sisters: More shall they speak; for now I am bent to know, By the worst means, the worst.*	
monuments (noun)	tombs	*If charnel-houses and our graves must send Those that we bury back, our monuments Shall be the maws of kites.*	"monuments": Origin of "monument": Old French monument; earlier Latin monumentum ("memorial"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/monument#Etymology)
admired (adjective)	causing wonder; astonishing	*You have displaced the mirth, broke the good meeting, With most admired disorder.*	

Discussion questions

1. What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Complete Macbeth's words to the ghost: 'Thou canst not say…' [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** '…I did it: never shake thy gory locks at me.'
   Answer guidance: '…I did it: never shake thy gory locks at me.'.
2. What news does the Murderer bring? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped
   Answer guidance: Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped.
3. Who can see Banquo's ghost? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Only Macbeth
   Answer guidance: Only Macbeth.
4. How does Lady Macbeth explain Macbeth's behavior? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He has had such fits since his youth
   Answer guidance: He has had such fits since his youth.
5. What does Macbeth say blood will have? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** More blood: murder calls for murder
   Answer guidance: More blood: murder calls for murder.

6. Which thane refused to come at Macbeth's bidding? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Macduff
   Answer guidance: Macduff.
7. Retell the most important events of “Act III, Scene IV” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** At the state banquet a Murderer tells Macbeth that Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped. When Macbeth wishes Banquo were present, Banquo's ghost sits in his place, seen only by Macbeth, who cries 'Thou canst not say I did it.' Lady Macbeth explains it as a fit he has had since youth and scolds him ('Are you a man?'). The ghost returns; the feast breaks up in disorder. Afterwards Macbeth says 'blood…
   Answer guidance: At the state banquet a Murderer tells Macbeth that Banquo is dead but Fleance escaped. When Macbeth wishes Banquo were present, Banquo's ghost sits in his place, seen only by Macbeth, who cries 'Thou canst not say I did it.' Lady Macbeth explains it as a fit he has had since youth and scolds him ('Are you a man?'). The ghost returns; the feast breaks up in disorder. Afterwards Macbeth says 'blood…
8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene IV”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is “Act III, Scene IV” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood: Stones have been known to move and trees to speak; Augurs and understood relations have By magot-pies and choughs and rooks brought forth The secret’st man of blood.” What does “choughs” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** choughs: birds of the crow family.
    Answer guidance: choughs: birds of the crow family.

Inferential / analytical

1. 'I am in blood stepp'd in so far that, should I wade no more, returning were as tedious as go o'er.' What does this image show about Macbeth's choices now? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** He feels going back is as hard as going on; he chooses more violence.
   Answer guidance: He feels going back is as hard as going on; he chooses more violence.
2. What does “Act III, Scene IV” suggest about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control.
   Answer guidance: The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control. Evidence to accept:

"Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257): Macbeth to the ghost. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of symbolism in "Act III, Scene IV". What does it reveal about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
   Answer guidance: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas. Evidence to accept: "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood" (Act III, Scene IV, line 1341): Violence breeds violence. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the characterization in "Act III, Scene IV" shape what we understand about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257): Macbeth to the ghost. On characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with "Which of you have…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "I am in blood / Stepp'd in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o'er" (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1356–1358): Macbeth chooses to go on. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act III, Scene IV", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the Ghost's appearance at the feast and Macbeth's public breakdown; evidence: "Never shake Thy gory locks at me."
   Answer guidance: Look for: the Ghost's appearance at the feast and Macbeth's public breakdown; evidence: "Never shake Thy gory locks at me.". Evidence to accept: "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257): Macbeth to the ghost. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does "Act III, Scene IV" build on "Act III, Scene III"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood" (Act III, Scene IV, line 1341): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In "Act III, Scene IV", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into

public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1356–1358): Macbeth chooses to go on. On characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (What do you think happens to people who cannot stop thinking about something they did wrong?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, line 1341): Violence breeds violence. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does irony appear in “Act III, Scene IV”, and how does it connect a royal banquet thrown into turmoil to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257): Macbeth to the ghost. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should the ghost be played by an actor or left empty? Which choice better shows Macbeth's mind? [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A staging argument tied to the question of the supernatural.
   Answer guidance: A staging argument tied to the question of the supernatural.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The banquet, a symbol of social order and kingship, collapses. Macbeth's public breakdown exposes him to the thanes and marks Lady Macbeth's last scene of control. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1356–1358): Macbeth chooses to go on. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act III, Scene IV” acts most wisely in the matter of a royal banquet thrown into turmoil, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into

public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257): Macbeth to the ghost. On characterization: Macbeth's public breakdown; Lady Macbeth tries to cover for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act III, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, line 1341): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act III, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “I am in blood / Stepp’d in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o’er” (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1356–1358): Macbeth chooses to go on. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act III, Scene IV”, with its focus on a royal banquet thrown into turmoil, to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me” (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257): Macbeth to the ghost. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the symbolism in “Act III, Scene IV” effective in presenting a royal banquet thrown into turmoil, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: “It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood” (Act III, Scene IV, line 1341): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act III, Scene IV" treats a royal banquet thrown into turmoil with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: "I am in blood / Stepp'd in so far that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o'er" (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1356–1358): Macbeth chooses to go on. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Act III, Scene V" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: "Thou canst not say I did it: never shake / Thy gory locks at me" (Act III, Scene IV, lines 1256–1257): Macbeth to the ghost. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Act III, Scene IV" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The banquet shows Macbeth's guilt breaking into public view, but he chooses to continue rather than turn back. Useful evidence: "It will have blood; they say, blood will have blood" (Act III, Scene IV, line 1341): Violence breeds violence. Theme link: guilt made visible; Macbeth resolves to wade on. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does this scene take place?

   A. The hall of the palace

   B. A dark park near the gate

   C. The Witches' cave on the heath

   D. A room in Macduff's castle

   Key: A (The hall of the palace)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the First Murderer say he did to Banquo?

   A. Drowned him in the river

   B. Cut his throat

   C. Struck him with a club

   D. Stabbed him in the back

   Key: B (Cut his throat)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What role does Macbeth say he will play at the feast?

   A. The stern judge of his thanes

   B. The silent guest at the end

   C. The humble host

   D. The king's chief soldier

   Key: C (The humble host)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Macbeth's line: "Thou art the best o' the _____"

   Key: cut-throats

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does the First Murderer say Banquo now lies?

   A. In the castle chapel

   B. On the road to Fife

   C. Under a tree in the park

   D. Safe in a ditch

   Key: D (Safe in a ditch)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say when told the table is full?

   A. The table's full

   B. Bring another stool for me

   C. Let us eat without delay

   D. I will sit with the guests

   Key: A (The table's full)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth propose a toast to?

   A. The health of Malcolm, now in England

   B. The general joy of the whole table

   C. Victory over the Norwegians

   D. The memory of King Duncan

   Key: B (The general joy of the whole table)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Lady Macbeth end the feast?

   A. She orders music and dancing

   B. She calls for the guards to arrest Ross

   C. She tells the guests to leave at once

   D. She leaves and the guests stay on

   Key: C (She tells the guests to leave at once)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Lady Macbeth try to rescue the feast?
   Sample answer: She tells the thanes to keep their seats, says the fit is momentary and that they should feed and ignore him. Aside, she asks Macbeth if he is a man and mocks his fear as a woman's story at a winter fire. When he gets worse, she sends the guests away at once without ceremony.
10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Macbeth plan to do at the end of the scene?
    Sample answer: Macbeth says he will go early the next day to the weird sisters, because now he is bent to know the worst by the worst means. He also mentions that he keeps a paid servant in every thane's house. His plans show a ruler who now depends on spies and dark powers to stay in control.
11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth mean by "cabin'd, cribb'd, confined"?
    A. He feels trapped by doubts and fears
    B. He has been locked in a small, dark room
    C. He is building a new cabin
    D. He is ready for a long sea voyage

    Key: A (He feels trapped by doubts and fears)
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth mean by "the worm that's fled Hath nature that in time will venom breed"?
    A. A snake has escaped from the palace
    B. The escaped son will grow into a danger
    C. The murderers will betray him later
    D. The feast food is spoiled and poisonous

    Key: B (The escaped son will grow into a danger)
13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Why does Lady Macbeth say "the sauce to meat is ceremony"?
    A. The cooks have made a poor sauce
    B. The guests should eat more quickly
    C. A good host must make guests feel welcome
    D. Ceremony should be left out of every feast

    Key: C (A good host must make guests feel welcome)
14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic in what Macbeth says just before the ghost appears?
    A. He is glad that Banquo stayed away
    B. He has sent Banquo on to England
    C. He thinks Banquo is ill in bed
    D. He wishes Banquo were present

    Key: D (He wishes Banquo were present)
15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: "Avaunt! and quit my sight! let the _____ hide thee!"
    Key: earth
16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What wild animals does Macbeth say he could face without fear?
    A. A bear, a rhinoceros or a tiger

B. A wolf, a boar or a lion

C. An eagle, a hawk or a hunting falcon

D. A serpent, a toad or a bat

Key: A (A bear, a rhinoceros or a tiger)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth say about the time when 'the brains were out'?

A. Men once lived forever

B. The dead used to stay dead

C. Murder was not punished in those days

D. Doctors could cure any wound

Key: B (The dead used to stay dead)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth reveal about how he watches the thanes?

A. He reads all their letters at court

B. He asks the Witches to watch them

C. He pays a servant in each of their houses

D. He visits each castle at night in disguise

Key: C (He pays a servant in each of their houses)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Why does the ghost appear when Macbeth names Banquo in the toast?

Sample answer: Macbeth drinks to our dear friend Banquo, whom we miss, and wishes he were here. The ghost returns just as he says it, so his false words seem to summon the truth. The timing makes his hypocrisy painfully clear to the audience and turns his public pretence into a public breakdown.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Lady Macbeth mean when she says the ghost is the very painting of your fear?

Sample answer: She thinks the vision is only a picture made by Macbeth's terror, like the air-drawn dagger that led him to Duncan. She calls his fits flaws and starts, fit only for an old woman's tale, and reminds him that he is only staring at a stool. To her, the ghost is imaginary, a sign of weakness.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does “Whole as the marble, founded as the rock” reveal about Macbeth's hopes?

A. He wanted to feel solid and secure

B. He plans to build a stone palace

C. He wishes to become a statue

D. He hopes to be buried in a marble tomb

Key: A (He wanted to feel solid and secure)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic in “’Tis better thee without than he within”?

A. Macbeth wants the killer to come inside

B. Macbeth prefers blood on the killer to blood in Banquo

C. Macbeth wants Banquo to join the feast

D. Macbeth blames the killer for the blood

Key: B (Macbeth prefers blood on the killer to blood in Banquo)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the empty place at the table come to symbolize?

    A. Macbeth sits at the head as a lord

    B. The thanes refuse to sit near Ross

    C. The empty place becomes the ghost's seat

    D. Lady Macbeth sits alone, near the door

    Key: C (The empty place becomes the ghost's seat)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth's speech about the 'olden time' suggest?

    A. He longs for the days of his youth in battle

    B. He blames history for his crime

    C. He thinks murder used to be lawful

    D. He feels the natural order is broken

    Key: D (He feels the natural order is broken)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “Strange things I have in head, that will to _____”

    Key: hand

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does Macbeth's “We are yet but young in deed” suggest?

    A. He believes greater crimes still lie ahead

    B. He feels too young and green to be a king

    C. He plans to give up his crimes

    D. He thinks he is still innocent

    Key: A (He believes greater crimes still lie ahead)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macbeth's courage speech to the ghost reveal his fear?

    A. He calmly invites the ghost to sit down

    B. He insists he fears no living thing, only this

    C. He jokes with the ghost about the feast

    D. He pretends not to see the ghost at all

    Key: B (He insists he fears no living thing, only this)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Lady Macbeth's 'You lack the season of all natures, sleep' suggest?

    A. Macbeth has eaten too much at the feast

    B. The seasons are changing to winter

    C. Lack of sleep is wearing Macbeth down

    D. She wants him to stay awake and plan

    Key: C (Lack of sleep is wearing Macbeth down)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the banquet scene shows a turning point in Macbeth's reign.

    Sample answer: The banquet should prove that Macbeth is a gracious king at ease with his thanes. Instead the ghost drives him to rave in public, and the thanes see a strange infirmity. By the end he speaks of paid spies, of seeking the Witches and of strange things he will act on. The public show of order has collapsed.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how the scene presents the relationship between Macbeth and Lady Macbeth.

    Sample answer: She works hard to cover for him, excusing him to the guests and scolding him privately. Yet after the guests leave, she says little and only reminds him he needs sleep. He tells her his plans without asking her opinion. The scene shows her losing influence while he grows more determined to act alone.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the ghost's silence affect the scene?

    A. It forces Macbeth to reveal himself through his words
    B. It makes the scene feel comic
    C. It shows the ghost is not real
    D. It allows Banquo to accuse Macbeth

    Key: A (It forces Macbeth to reveal himself through his words)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does “Stones have been known to move and trees to speak” suggest?

    A. Macbeth is going mad from lack of sleep
    B. Nature itself will expose the murderer
    C. The Witches can work miracles
    D. The castle is haunted by spirits

    Key: B (Nature itself will expose the murderer)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why might Shakespeare have Lady Macbeth recall the dagger here?

    A. To reveal that she also saw the dagger
    B. To accuse Macbeth of Banquo's murder
    C. To link this vision to Macbeth's earlier one
    D. To warn the thanes of a plot

    Key: C (To link this vision to Macbeth's earlier one)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “There the grown _____ lies”

    Key: serpent

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Macbeth's description of the ghost's eyes heighten horror?

    A. They shine with joy at the feast
    B. They weep tears of blood for the dead Duncan
    C. They are closed as if in sleep
    D. They glare yet have no sight in them

    Key: D (They glare yet have no sight in them)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the scene suggest about how far Macbeth's secret has spread?

    A. Public suspicion is now growing
    B. No one suspects him at all
    C. Everyone knows the full truth
    D. Only his wife suspects him of anything

Key: A (Public suspicion is now growing)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate whether the ghost should be played as real or imagined.
    Sample answer: Only Macbeth reacts to the ghost, and Lady Macbeth links it to the air-drawn dagger. Yet the stage directions have the ghost enter and exit, and it sits in his place as if real. A strong answer weighs these points, considers the effect of each staging choice on the audience, and links the question to Macbeth's guilt.
38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Macbeth's state of mind at the end of the scene.
    Sample answer: He speaks of nature exposing murderers, notices that Macduff stays away, admits he keeps spies in every house, and plans to seek the Witches. He says strange things in his head must be acted before they are thought through. A strong answer argues whether this shows resolve, despair or growing madness, using his words as evidence.
39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What contrast does Macbeth draw between himself and the thanes?
    A. They are braver soldiers than he is
    B. They keep their color while he turns pale
    C. They hate Banquo and he loves him
    D. They are richer and far better fed than he is

    Key: B (They keep their color while he turns pale)
40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Compare the banquet with Duncan's feast in Act I.
    Sample answer: In Act I Duncan dined as a guest while Macbeth slipped away to plan murder. Now Macbeth hosts a feast to show order, but murder intrudes as the ghost takes his seat. A strong answer contrasts the two feasts and argues that the second shows how his crimes have destroyed the bonds of hospitality.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 3, inference 7, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene IV develops the idea of a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act III, Scene IV” could deliver about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a royal banquet thrown into turmoil in “Act III, Scene IV”: each member takes one passage,

quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene IV" could deliver about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a royal banquet thrown into turmoil in "Act III, Scene IV": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene IV suggests about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's symbolism and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene IV" could deliver about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a royal banquet thrown into turmoil in "Act III, Scene IV": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses symbolism in Act III, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene IV" could deliver about a royal banquet thrown into turmoil. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a royal banquet thrown into turmoil in "Act III, Scene IV": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Which of you have done this? What, my good lord? Thou canst not say I did it: never shake Thy gory locks at me. Gentlemen, rise: his highness is not well. Sit, worthy friends: my lord is often thus, And hath been from his youth: pray you, keep seat; The fit is momentary; upon a thought He will again be well: if much you note him, You shall offend him and extend his passion: Feed, and regard him not. Are you a man? Ay, and a bold one, that dare look on that Which might appal the devil. O proper stuff! This is the very painting of your fear: This is the air-drawn dagger which, you said, Led you to Duncan. O, these flaws and starts, Impostors to true fear, would well become A woman's story at a winter's fire, Authorized by her grandam. Shame itself! Why do you make such faces? When all's done, You look but on a stool.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene IV"?

   A. A royal banquet thrown into turmoil

   B. The murder and its first guilt

   C. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief

   D. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

SAT key: 1. A (A royal banquet thrown into turmoil)

Lesson 18: Act III, Scene V

Focus: Hecate and the machinery of fate

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act III, Scene V (Hecate and the machinery of fate) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

Hecate angrily scolds the Witches, 'beldams' who are 'saucy and overbold,' for trading with Macbeth in riddles without her, for a 'wayward son' who loves for his own ends. She orders them to meet her at the pit of Acheron in the morning, where Macbeth will come to know his destiny, and plans illusions that will draw him on to his confusion. 'Security is mortals' chiefest enemy.'

Background: Most editors think this scene (in rhyming tetrameter and calling for a song found in Thomas Middleton's play The Witch) was added after Shakespeare's death, perhaps for a revival.

Significance: Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....*
> **Prompt:** Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy."

> **8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)**
> Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
> *Most editors think this scene (in rhyming tetrameter and calling for a song found in Thomas Middleton's play The Witch) was added after Shakespeare's death, perhaps for a revival. Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions. Characterization: Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence). Structure: The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton. Diction / vocabulary: Rhyming tetrameter like the witches'. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.*

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Hecate and the machinery of fate. Key takeaway: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy."*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence).
- **Structure:** The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Rhyming tetrameter like the witches'.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.
- **darkness and light:** Night and darkness hide crimes; the Macbeths call on darkness to cover their deeds, and putting out a light marks murder.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, lines 1398–1399) Overconfidence.
- “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate) Hecate's complaint.
- “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, line 1396) Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence.
> **Evidence:** “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, line 1396)
> **Reasoning:** She says "security / Is mortals' chiefest enemy" and that Macbeth will "spurn fate, scorn death."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
overbold (adjective)	too bold; presumptuous	*Have I not reason, beldams as you are, Saucy and overbold?*	“overbold”: Origin: an English formation from over- + bold. (Liber et

			Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/overbold#Etymology)
wayward (adjective)	stubborn and self-willed	*And, which is worse, all you have done Hath been but for a wayward son, Spiteful and wrathful, who, as others do, Loves for his own ends, not for you.*	
riddles (noun)	puzzling questions with hidden answers	*How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?*	
traffic (verb)	to deal or trade with	*How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?*	"traffic": Origin: possibly Middle French trafique. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/traffic#Etymology)
vessels (noun)	containers	*But make amends now: get you gone, And at the pit of Acheron Meet me i' the morning: thither he Will come to know his destiny: Your vessels and your spells provide, Your charms and every thing beside.*	
beldams (noun)	hags; spiteful old women	*Have I not reason, beldams as you are, Saucy and overbold?*	
angerly (adverb)	angrily	*Why, how now, Hecate! you look angerly.*	"angerly": Origin: an English formation from anger + -ly. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/angerly#Etymology)
sprites (noun)	spirits; ghosts	*And that distill'd by magic sleights / Shall raise such artificial sprites*	
contriver (noun)	a planner; one who devises	*How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?*	
wrathful (adjective)	full of anger	*And, which is worse, all you have done Hath been but for a wayward son, Spiteful*	

		and wrathful, who, as others do, Loves for his own ends, not for you.	

Discussion questions

1. Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Hecate call the Witches when she scolds them? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Beldams, saucy and overbold.
   Answer guidance: Beldams, saucy and overbold.
2. Why is Hecate angry with the Witches? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** They dealt with Macbeth without her
   Answer guidance: They dealt with Macbeth without her.
3. What does Hecate call Macbeth? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A wayward son
   Answer guidance: A wayward son.
4. Where will they meet in the morning? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The pit of Acheron
   Answer guidance: The pit of Acheron.
5. What does Hecate say is mortals' chiefest enemy? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Security, or overconfidence
   Answer guidance: Security, or overconfidence.
6. What will Hecate use to draw Macbeth on? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Illusions raised by magic
   Answer guidance: Illusions raised by magic.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act III, Scene V" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Hecate angrily scolds the Witches, 'beldams' who are 'saucy and overbold,' for trading with Macbeth in riddles without her, for a 'wayward son' who loves for his own ends. She orders them to meet her at the pit of Acheron in the morning, where Macbeth will come to know his destiny, and plans illusions that will draw him on to his confusion. 'Security is mortals' chiefest enemy.'
   Answer guidance: Hecate angrily scolds the Witches, 'beldams' who are 'saucy and overbold,' for trading with Macbeth in riddles without her, for a 'wayward son' who loves for his own ends. She orders them to

meet her at the pit of Acheron in the morning, where Macbeth will come to know his destiny, and plans illusions that will draw him on to his confusion. 'Security is mortals' chiefest enemy.'

8. Who is on stage in “Act III, Scene V”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is “Act III, Scene V” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Have I not reason, beldams as you are, Saucy and overbold?” What does “overbold” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** overbold: too bold; presumptuous.
    Answer guidance: overbold: too bold; presumptuous.

Inferential / analytical

1. How does the verse of this scene differ from the rest of the play, and why does that matter to editors? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Rhyming tetrameter and songs suggest a later addition, probably by Middleton.
   Answer guidance: Rhyming tetrameter and songs suggest a later addition, probably by Middleton.
2. What does “Act III, Scene V” suggest about Hecate and the machinery of fate? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions.
   Answer guidance: Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions. Evidence to accept: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, lines 1398–1399): Overconfidence. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of setting in “Act III, Scene V”. What does it reveal about Hecate and the machinery of fate that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling. Evidence to accept: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Hecate's complaint. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the foreshadowing in “Act III, Scene V” shape what we understand about Hecate and the machinery of fate? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, lines 1398–1399): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “Have I not reason…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, line 1396): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act III, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Hecate's plan to give Macbeth false security; evidence: “security Is mortals' chiefest enemy.”
   Answer guidance: Look for: Hecate's plan to give Macbeth false security; evidence: “security Is mortals' chiefest enemy.”. Evidence to accept: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, lines 1398–1399): Overconfidence. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Act III, Scene V” build on “Act III, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Hecate's complaint. On structure: The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Act III, Scene V”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about Hecate and the machinery of fate, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, line 1396): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. On characterization: Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Is feeling completely safe ever dangerous? When?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Hecate's complaint. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does tone / mood appear in “Act III, Scene V”, and how does it connect Hecate and the machinery of fate to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, lines 1398–1399): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. If this scene was not written by Shakespeare, should productions cut it? Argue for keeping or cutting it. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment balancing authorship and dramatic effect.
   Answer guidance: A judgment balancing authorship and dramatic effect.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Hecate states the trap outright: false confidence ('security') will ruin Macbeth. Whether the scene is Shakespeare's or not, it shapes how audiences read the apparitions. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, line 1396): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act III, Scene V” acts most wisely in the matter of Hecate and the machinery of fate, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, lines 1398–1399): Overconfidence. On characterization: Hecate scolds the witches and plans Macbeth's ruin through "security" (overconfidence). Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Hecate and the machinery of fate. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Hecate's complaint. On structure: The scene is often cut or attributed to Middleton. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write your own questions about “Act III, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, line 1396): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals'

chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act III, Scene V”, with its focus on Hecate and the machinery of fate, to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, lines 1398–1399): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the setting in “Act III, Scene V” effective in presenting Hecate and the machinery of fate, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Hecate's complaint. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act III, Scene V” treats Hecate and the machinery of fate with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear” (Act III, Scene V, line 1396): Her plan for Macbeth: confidence will make him careless. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Act III, Scene VI” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “And you all know, security / Is mortals’ chiefest enemy” (Act III, Scene V, lines 1398–1399): Overconfidence. Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act III, Scene V” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Hecate and the machinery of fate? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hecate's plan is to destroy Macbeth through his own overconfidence. Useful evidence: “Saucy and overbold” (Act III, Scene V, Hecate): Hecate's complaint.

Theme link: Hecate says security is "mortals' chiefest enemy." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does this scene take place?
   A. A heath
   B. The palace hall
   C. A park
   D. Inverness castle

   Key: A (A heath)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What sound opens the scene?
   A. Bells
   B. Thunder
   C. Trumpets
   D. Drums

   Key: B (Thunder)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does the First Witch say Hecate looks?
   A. Joyful
   B. Tired
   C. Angry
   D. Afraid

   Key: C (Angry)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Hecate's line: “Sits in a foggy _____, and stays for me”
   Key: cloud
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hecate call herself?
   A. The queen of the whole night sky
   B. The servant of the Witches
   C. The keeper of the cauldron
   D. The mistress of your charms

   Key: D (The mistress of your charms)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hecate tell the Witches to bring in the morning?
   A. Their vessels, spells and charms
   B. Their brooms, cats and toads

C. Gold and jewels from the castle

D. Food and wine for a great feast at dawn

Key: A (Their vessels, spells and charms)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hecate plan to catch from the corner of the moon?

   A. A falling star

   B. A vaporous drop

   C. A silver thread

   D. A bat's wing

   Key: B (A vaporous drop)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Hecate leave the scene?

   A. She sinks into the ground

   B. She rides off on a horse

   C. She is called away by a song

   D. She falls asleep on the heath

   Key: C (She is called away by a song)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Hecate say she will do during the night?

   Sample answer: She says she is for the air and will spend the night working toward a dismal and fatal end. She will catch a vaporous drop hanging from the corner of the moon before it falls, and turn it by magic into artificial spirits. Their illusions will lead Macbeth on to his ruin.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] How does Hecate's scene change what the audience expects of Macbeth's next visit to the Witches?

    Sample answer: Before this scene, Macbeth said he would go to the Witches to learn more. Now the audience knows that Hecate is preparing a trap with magical sprites to fool him. Whatever he hears will be designed to lead him on, so the audience can expect to watch him be deceived.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Hecate say the Witches' work has been wasted?

    A. Their favourite cares only for himself

    B. Macbeth has refused to listen to them

    C. The prophecies did not come true

    D. Banquo has warned the king against them

    Key: A (Their favourite cares only for himself)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does “Loves for his own ends, not for you” suggest about Macbeth?

    A. He is loyal to the Witches

    B. He is selfish and uses others

    C. He loves his wife deeply

    D. He is generous to his friends

    Key: B (He is selfish and uses others)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Hecate plan for Macbeth?

    A. To warn him of all the dangers that lie ahead

    B. To free him from the prophecies

C. To lead him to ruin through false hope

D. To reward him for his loyalty

Key: C (To lead him to ruin through false hope)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does Hecate mean by "He shall spurn fate, scorn death"?

A. Macbeth will give up the crown

B. Macbeth will die soon after

C. Macbeth will repent his crimes and seek forgiveness

D. Macbeth will think himself above all danger

Key: D (Macbeth will think himself above all danger)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the First Witch's line: "Come, let's make haste; she'll soon be back _____"

Key: again

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the rhythm of Hecate's speech differ from most speeches in the play?

A. It uses short rhyming lines

B. It is written in prose

C. It has no rhythm at all

D. It is sung as a single song

Key: A (It uses short rhyming lines)

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Hecate say she will spend the night doing?

A. Sleeping on the heath

B. Working toward a fatal end

C. Visiting Lady Macbeth in her chamber

D. Flying to England

Key: B (Working toward a fatal end)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Hecate say the artificial sprites will do?

A. Protect Macbeth from his foes

B. Tell Macbeth the full truth

C. Draw Macbeth on to his confusion

D. Frighten Macbeth into fleeing the country

Key: C (Draw Macbeth on to his confusion)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why is Hecate angry that she was not included?

Sample answer: She says she is the mistress of the Witches' charms and the close contriver of harms, yet she was never called to take part or show the glory of their art. She feels her authority was ignored. She also complains that their efforts went to a selfish man who does not love them.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does this scene build suspense for what follows?

Sample answer: Hecate announces that Macbeth will come to learn his destiny and that she will raise sprites whose illusions will lead him to confusion. She says great business must be done before noon. The audience now waits for the meeting, knowing the Witches will use tricks to make Macbeth overconfident.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene's rhyming verse set the supernatural apart?

    A. It gives the spirits a chant-like sound

    B. It shows they speak like kings

    C. It makes them sound like soldiers

    D. It matches the Porter's prose

    Key: A (It gives the spirits a chant-like sound)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Hecate's plan suggest about free will in the play?

    A. Macbeth has no choices at all

    B. Macbeth's choices are shaped by deception

    C. The Witches have lost all their power over men

    D. Macbeth will choose to repent

    Key: B (Macbeth's choices are shaped by deception)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does “bear His hopes ’bove wisdom, grace and fear” predict?

    A. Macbeth will become wise and humble after the visit

    B. Macbeth will be afraid of everything

    C. Macbeth's hope will outrun his judgment

    D. Macbeth will pray for grace

    Key: C (Macbeth's hope will outrun his judgment)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Hecate's description of Macbeth echo earlier scenes?

    A. It shows he is still loyal

    B. It praises his courage in the battle against Norway

    C. It recalls his love for Duncan

    D. It matches his growing selfishness

    Key: D (It matches his growing selfishness)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the First Witch's line: “Why, how now, Hecate! you look _____”

    Key: angerly

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why might this scene unsettle the audience's view of the Witches?

    A. They answer to a higher power

    B. They seem harmless and kind

    C. They plan to help Macbeth

    D. They are revealed to be human

    Key: A (They answer to a higher power)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Hecate's 'Great business must be wrought ere noon' create?

    A. A sense of calm and patience

B. A sense of urgency before the meeting

C. A pause for comic relief

D. A link back to the Porter's drunken jokes

Key: B (A sense of urgency before the meeting)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene's position after the banquet affect its meaning?

A. It ends the play's main conflict between the thanes

B. It shows Macbeth at peace

C. Macbeth's crisis now draws dark forces

D. It reveals Banquo's killer

Key: C (Macbeth's crisis now draws dark forces)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze Hecate's warning about overconfidence.

Sample answer: Hecate says that by false visions Macbeth will be drawn on until he spurns fate, scorns death and puts his hopes above wisdom, grace and fear. She knows that a man who feels safe stops being careful. The speech explains the strategy that will shape the rest of the play and invites the audience to watch for it.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the role of illusion in this scene.

Sample answer: Hecate plans to use a drop from the moon, distilled by magic, to raise artificial sprites whose illusions will draw Macbeth to his confusion. The Witches will not lie outright but will show deceptive visions. The scene links back to the air-drawn dagger and the ghost, and suggests that Macbeth's world is ruled by false appearances.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What sets Hecate's speech apart from the Witches' earlier riddles?

A. She openly explains the plan to deceive

B. She speaks only in riddles and puzzles

C. She gives Macbeth a clear warning

D. She refuses to say anything about Macbeth

Key: A (She openly explains the plan to deceive)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Hecate's view of Macbeth complicate the Witches' role?

A. It shows they only wanted to help him

B. It suggests they serve a larger plan of ruin

C. It proves they have no real power

D. It reveals they work for Duncan's sons

Key: B (It suggests they serve a larger plan of ruin)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Hecate's complaint that Macbeth loves 'for his own ends' imply?

A. Macbeth is loyal to the Witches

B. The Witches love Macbeth deeply

C. Evil cannot inspire loyalty

D. Macbeth will reward the Witches

Key: C (Evil cannot inspire loyalty)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Hecate's line: “Hark! I am _____; my little spirit, see”
    Key: call’d

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene shape the audience's response to the next prophecies?
    A. It makes them trust every prophecy
    B. It removes all suspense from the rest of the play
    C. It shows the prophecies are harmless
    D. It makes them read the prophecies as traps
    Key: D (It makes them read the prophecies as traps)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What is the effect of Hecate's departure on a foggy cloud?
    A. It recalls the fog of the Witches' first meeting
    B. It shows that she is afraid of the coming daylight
    C. It ends the play's supernatural plot
    D. It hints that she will help Macduff
    Key: A (It recalls the fog of the Witches' first meeting)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate whether the play is stronger with or without this scene.
    Sample answer: The scene adds Hecate, rhyming verse and songs, and states plainly that Macbeth will be deceived into false confidence. A strong answer weighs its value in building suspense and clarifying the Witches' plan against the argument that it explains too much, breaks the style of the play, and may not be Shakespeare's own work.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Hecate's claim that the Witches' work was done 'for a wayward son'.
    Sample answer: Hecate complains that Macbeth is spiteful and wrathful and loves for his own ends. A strong answer considers whether this is a fair description based on his actions, such as hiring murderers and hiding plans from his wife, and whether the Witches truly helped him or simply used his ambition for their own purpose.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Hecate's speech change the tone of the play after the banquet?
    A. It turns from tragedy to comedy
    B. It turns from human crisis to cosmic plotting
    C. It turns from fear to celebration
    D. It turns from war to romance
    Key: B (It turns from human crisis to cosmic plotting)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare Hecate's plan with Lady Macbeth's earlier persuasion.
    Sample answer: Lady Macbeth pushed Macbeth to act by questioning his courage and promising success. Hecate plans to push him with visions that make him feel safe. A strong answer shows that both use his ambition against him, and argues whether Hecate's method of false confidence is more dangerous than his wife's direct challenge.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 2, inference 8, analysis 0, synthesis 0

HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene V develops the idea of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene V" could deliver about Hecate and the machinery of fate. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Hecate and the machinery of fate in "Act III, Scene V": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene V" could deliver about Hecate and the machinery of fate. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Hecate and the machinery of fate in "Act III, Scene V": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene V suggests about Hecate and the machinery of fate. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene V" could deliver about Hecate and the machinery of fate. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Hecate and the machinery of fate in "Act III, Scene V": each member takes one passage,

quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act III, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of Hecate and the machinery of fate. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene V" could deliver about Hecate and the machinery of fate. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for Hecate and the machinery of fate in "Act III, Scene V": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art?*

   As used in the text, what does the word "traffic" most nearly mean?

   A. full of anger

   B. a planner; one who devises

   C. to deal or trade with

   D. spirits; ghosts

2. *Have I not reason, beldams as you are, Saucy and overbold? How did you dare To trade and traffic with Macbeth In riddles and affairs of death; And I, the mistress of your charms, The close contriver of all harms, Was never call'd to bear my part, Or show the glory of our art? And, which is worse, all you have done Hath been but for a wayward son, Spiteful and wrathful, who, as others do, Loves for his own ends, not for you. But make amends now: get you gone, And at the pit of Acheron Meet me i' the morning: thither he Will come to know his destiny: Your vessels and your spells provide, Your charms and every thing beside. I am for the air; this night I'll spend Unto a dismal and a fatal end: Great business must be wrought ere noon: Upon the corner of the moon There hangs a vaporous drop profound; I'll catch it ere it come to ground: And that distill'd by magic sleights Shall raise such artificial sprites As by the strength of their illusion Shall draw him on to his confusion: He shall spurn fate, scorn death, and bear His hopes 'bove wisdom, grace and fear: And you all know, security Is mortals' chiefest enemy.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene V"?

   A. The discovery of the murder

   B. The apparitions and false security

   C. The tyrant's end and a new order

   D. Hecate and the machinery of fate

SAT key: 1. C (to deal or trade with); 2. D (Hecate and the machinery of fate)

Lesson 19: Act III, Scene VI

Focus: suspicion spoken through irony

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Act III, Scene VI" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep? Was not that nobl…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Lennox, speaking with heavy irony, lists the 'convenient' deaths and flights: how the 'right-valiant' Banquo walked too late, how Fleance must have killed his father because he fled, how wisely Macbeth killed the grooms. A Lord reports that Malcolm lives at the English court of the holy King Edward, that Macduff has gone to ask Edward to rouse Northumberland and Siward, and that Macbeth prepares for war.

Background: Edward the Confessor (reigned 1042 to 1066) was revered as a saintly king; contrasting him with Macbeth sets holy kingship against tyranny.

Significance: Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power? Write for five minutes.
Starters: I think... because... / This connects to appearance and reality because....
Prompt: Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to appearance and reality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: speech must be guarded under tyranny.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: delinquents — offenders; bestows — lodges (himself); places; interpret — to explain the meaning of; accursed — under a curse; caution — a warning; care to avoid danger. "delinquents": Origin of "delinquent": Middle French délinquant; earlier Latin delinquens. "interpret": Origin: probably Old French enterpreter; earlier Latin interpretor ("to explain"). "caution": Origin: Old French caution ("security"); earlier Latin cautiō.
Words: delinquents: offenders · bestows: lodges (himself); places · interpret: to explain the meaning of · accursed: under a curse · caution: a warning; care to avoid danger

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Edward the Confessor (reigned 1042 to 1066) was revered as a saintly king; contrasting him with Macbeth sets holy kingship against tyranny. Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony. Irony: Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's "deaths," exposing Macbeth's guilt. Characterization: Macduff has gone to England to seek help. Watch for kingship and order: Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Things have been strangely borne" slowly and put it in my own words: Talking with another lord, Lennox remarks that things have been strangely managed since Duncan's death. Next, craft. I notice his ironic understatement: he praises Macbeth on the surface while hinting at guilt underneath. The strongest word is "strangely": it hints at suspicion without making an accusation that could get him killed. Then, effect. What is Lennox really saying when he calls events "strangely borne"? My answer: When Lennox calls events "strangely borne," he is really saying Macbeth arranged the murders of Duncan and Banquo; his careful sarcasm shows that the thanes now distrust Macbeth but fear to speak openly.

> *Things have been strangely borne (Act III, Scene VI, line 1407)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Things have been strangely borne" slowly and put it in my own words: Talking with another lord, Lennox remarks that things have been strangely managed since Duncan's death. Next, craft. I notice his ironic understatement: he praises Macbeth on the surface while hinting at guilt underneath. The strongest word is "strangely": it hints at suspicion without making an accusation that could get him killed. Then, effect. What is Lennox really saying when he calls events "strangely borne"? My answer: When Lennox calls events "strangely borne," he is really saying Macbeth arranged the murders of Duncan and Banquo; his careful sarcasm shows that the thanes now distrust Macbeth but fear to speak openly.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Gracious", "pitied" and "marry, he was dead" stand out. Lennox praises Macbeth's pity, then adds that Duncan was already dead, so the praise turns into a sly accusation. Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality? Expected student answer: Lennox seems to praise Macbeth but means the opposite, so the line shows how, under a tyrant, people must hide what they really think behind polite words.

> *The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Gracious", "pitied" and "marry, he was dead" stand out. Lennox praises Macbeth's pity, then adds that Duncan was already dead, so the praise turns into a sly accusation.
Ask: How does this line connect to appearance and reality?
Expected student answer: Lennox seems to praise Macbeth but means the opposite, so the line shows how, under a tyrant, people must hide what they really think behind polite words.

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene VI develops the idea of suspicion spoken through irony. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. When the text says "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408), it shows this directly. He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.
Task: Annotate the scene for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act III, Scene VI develops the idea of suspicion spoken through irony. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. When the text says "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408), it shows this directly. He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power? Ask: when do people speak in irony instead of directly?
Anchor question: Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?
Facilitation: Ask: when do people speak in irony instead of directly?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. ("The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead", Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. ("The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead", Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes suspicion spoken through irony. Key takeaway: speech must be guarded under tyranny.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's "deaths," exposing Macbeth's guilt.
- **Characterization:** Macduff has gone to England to seek help.

Themes and how they develop

- **appearance and reality:** speech must be guarded under tyranny.

Symbols and motifs

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.
- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour; watch how its meaning changes as the play goes on.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408) Irony.
- "Things have been strangely borne" (Act III, Scene VI, line 1407) Understatement.
- "this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed" (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1455–1456) Scotland under tyranny.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly.
Evidence: "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408)
Reasoning: He says "the gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead," a joke that accuses.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
delinquents (noun)	offenders	*How it did grieve Macbeth! did he not straight In pious rage the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep?*	"delinquents": Origin of "delinquent": Middle French délinquant; earlier Latin delinquens. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/delinquent#Etymology)
bestows (verb)	lodges (himself); places	*But, peace! for from broad words and 'cause he fail'd His presence at the tyrant's feast, I hear Macduff lives in disgrace: sir, can you tell Where he bestows himself?*	
interpret (verb)	to explain the meaning of	*My former speeches have but hit your thoughts, Which can interpret further: only, I say, Things have been strangely borne.*	"interpret": Origin: probably Old French enterpreter; earlier Latin interpretor ("to explain"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/interpret#Etymology)
accursed (adjective)	under a curse	*Some holy angel Fly to the court of England and unfold His message ere he come, that a swift blessing May soon return to this our suffering country Under a hand accursed!*	
caution (noun)	a warning; care to avoid danger	*And that well might Advise him to a caution, to hold what distance His wisdom can provide.*	"caution": Origin: Old French caution ("security"); earlier Latin cautiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/caution#Etymology)
thralls (noun)	slaves; captives	*How it did grieve Macbeth! did he not straight In pious rage the two*	

		delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep?	
monstrous (adjective)	horrible; unnatural	*Who cannot want the thought how monstrous It was for Malcolm and for Donalbain To kill their gracious father? damned fact!*	"monstrous": Origin: Old French monstrueuse; earlier Latin mōnstrōsus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/monstrous#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Whom does Lennox say Fleance must have killed, since he fled? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** His father, Banquo (said ironically).
   Answer guidance: His father, Banquo (said ironically).
2. How does Lennox speak about the recent deaths? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** With irony, hinting that Macbeth is guilty
   Answer guidance: With irony, hinting that Macbeth is guilty.
3. Where is Malcolm living? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** At the English court of King Edward
   Answer guidance: At the English court of King Edward.
4. Where has Macduff gone? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To England to seek help
   Answer guidance: To England to seek help.
5. Whom does Macduff hope Edward will rouse? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Northumberland and warlike Siward
   Answer guidance: Northumberland and warlike Siward.
6. How do Lennox and the Lord now refer to Macbeth? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** As a tyrant
   Answer guidance: As a tyrant.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act III, Scene VI" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Lennox, speaking with heavy irony, lists the 'convenient' deaths and flights: how the 'right-valiant' Banquo walked too late, how Fleance must have killed his father because he fled, how wisely Macbeth killed the grooms. A Lord reports that Malcolm lives at the English court of the holy King Edward, that Macduff has gone to ask Edward to rouse Northumberland

and Siward, and that Macbeth prepares…

Answer guidance: Lennox, speaking with heavy irony, lists the 'convenient' deaths and flights: how the 'right-valiant' Banquo walked too late, how Fleance must have killed his father because he fled, how wisely Macbeth killed the grooms. A Lord reports that Malcolm lives at the English court of the holy King Edward, that Macduff has gone to ask Edward to rouse Northumberland and Siward, and that Macbeth prepares…

8. Who is on stage in "Act III, Scene VI", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act III, Scene VI" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "How it did grieve Macbeth! did he not straight In pious rage the two delinquents tear, That were the slaves of drink and thralls of sleep?" What does "delinquents" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** delinquents: offenders.

    Answer guidance: delinquents: offenders.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Lennox never say directly that Macbeth is a murderer? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** Speaking openly under a tyrant is dangerous; irony protects him.

   Answer guidance: Speaking openly under a tyrant is dangerous; irony protects him.
2. What does "Act III, Scene VI" suggest about suspicion spoken through irony? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony.

   Answer guidance: Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony. Evidence to accept: "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408): Irony. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of irony in "Act III, Scene VI". What does it reveal about suspicion spoken through irony that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true. Evidence to accept: "Things have been strangely borne" (Act III, Scene VI, line 1407): Understatement. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the tone / mood in "Act III, Scene VI" shape what we understand about suspicion spoken through irony? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with "The son of Duncan…", why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: "this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed" (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1455–1456): Scotland under tyranny. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in "Act III, Scene VI", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Lennox's ironic speech and the news that Macduff has gone to England; evidence: "Macduff lives in disgrace".
   Answer guidance: Look for: Lennox's ironic speech and the news that Macduff has gone to England; evidence: "Macduff lives in disgrace". Evidence to accept: "The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead" (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408): Irony. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does "Act III, Scene VI" build on "Act III, Scene V"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "Things have been strangely borne" (Act III, Scene VI, line 1407): Understatement. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In "Act III, Scene VI", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about suspicion spoken through irony, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: "this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed" (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1455–1456): Scotland under tyranny. On characterization: Macduff has gone to England to seek help. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why might people use sarcasm or hints rather than speak plainly about someone in power?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "Things have been strangely borne" (Act III, Scene VI, line 1407): Understatement. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does plot appear in "Act III, Scene VI", and how does it connect suspicion spoken through irony to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the

previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** key events and the causes linking them.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is irony a form of courage or a way of avoiding risk? Judge Lennox. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment about indirect resistance.

   Answer guidance: A judgment about indirect resistance.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Public opinion turns: the thanes now speak of Macbeth as a tyrant. The scene shows how people talk under a dangerous ruler, in hints and irony. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1455–1456): Scotland under tyranny. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act III, Scene VI” acts most wisely in the matter of suspicion spoken through irony, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408): Irony. On characterization: Macduff has gone to England to seek help. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act III, Scene VI”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of suspicion spoken through irony. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, line 1407): Understatement. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write your own questions about “Act III, Scene VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1455–1456): Scotland under tyranny. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act III, Scene VI”, with its focus on suspicion spoken through irony, to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in “Act III, Scene VI” effective in presenting suspicion spoken through irony, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, line 1407): Understatement. On irony: Lennox speaks sarcastically about Duncan and Banquo's "deaths," exposing Macbeth's guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act III, Scene VI” treats suspicion spoken through irony with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “this our suffering country / Under a hand accursed” (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1455–1456): Scotland under tyranny. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “The gracious Duncan / Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was dead” (Act III, Scene VI, lines 1407–1408): Irony. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act III, Scene VI” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about suspicion spoken through irony? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative

transfer that keeps the core idea.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lennox's irony shows that under a tyrant, truth can only be spoken indirectly. Useful evidence: “Things have been strangely borne” (Act III, Scene VI, line 1407): Understatement. Theme link: speech must be guarded under tyranny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does this scene take place?

   A. The palace at Forres

   B. A dark heath near the Witches' cave

   C. Macduff's castle in Fife

   D. The English court of the king

   Key: A (The palace at Forres)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who talks with Lennox in this scene?

   A. Ross and the old Man from the road

   B. Another Lord

   C. Lady Macbeth

   D. The Doctor of the court

   Key: B (Another Lord)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which feast does Lennox say Macduff failed to attend?

   A. The crowning feast at Scone in spring

   B. Duncan's welcome feast

   C. The tyrant's feast

   D. The wedding of Malcolm

   Key: C (The tyrant's feast)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Lennox's line: “men must not walk too _____”

   Key: late

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lennox say Macbeth did to the two grooms?

   A. Sent them away to England in chains

   B. Paid them to stay silent

   C. Forgave them in front of the court

   D. Tore them in pious rage

   Key: D (Tore them in pious rage)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Lennox describe the grooms?

   A. Slaves of drink and thralls of sleep

   B. Brave men who guarded the king well all night

   C. Spies sent by the King of Norway

   D. Old friends of Banquo and Fleance

   Key: A (Slaves of drink and thralls of sleep)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What word does Lennox use for the princes' supposed crime?

   A. Noble

   B. Monstrous

   C. Wise

   D. Pious

   Key: B (Monstrous)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Macbeth react to the news about Macduff?

   A. He sends gifts to England in peace

   B. He falls into a deep sleep

   C. He prepares for war

   D. He gives the crown to Malcolm

   Key: C (He prepares for war)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does the Lord hope will happen if help comes from England?

   Sample answer: He hopes that with God's help Scotland can again have food on its tables and sleep at night, feasts without bloody knives, faithful homage and honours given freely. These are ordinary things the country now pines for. His hope shows how fear has spread through every part of life under Macbeth.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What happened when Macbeth sent a messenger to Macduff?

    Sample answer: Macduff refused with an absolute 'Sir, not I.' The cloudy messenger turned his back and hummed, as if to say Macduff would regret giving such an answer. The refusal shows Macduff openly defying the king, and the messenger's reaction warns that Macbeth will want revenge.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Lennox mean by “Things have been strangely borne”?

    A. Events have been handled in a suspicious way

    B. The king has been carried on a strange litter

    C. The weather has been unusually stormy lately

    D. The harvest has been poor this year

    Key: A (Events have been handled in a suspicious way)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about Lennox's phrase “Was not that nobly done?”?

    A. He truly praises Macbeth's honour and loyalty

    B. He really suggests the act was a cover-up

    C. He is asking for Macbeth's advice

D. He does not know about the grooms

Key: B (He really suggests the act was a cover-up)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is Lennox's ironic reason that killing the grooms was 'wise'?

A. They were plotting to kill Malcolm in his bed

B. They had stolen from the king

C. Their denials would have angered anyone

D. The Witches had commanded it

Key: C (Their denials would have angered anyone)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What does Lennox ironically suggest would happen to Duncan's sons under Macbeth's key?

A. They would be crowned by the thanes at Scone in state

B. They would be given lands in Fife

C. They would be set free with honour

D. They would learn what it means to kill a father

Key: D (They would learn what it means to kill a father)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Lennox's line: “The gracious Duncan Was pitied of Macbeth: marry, he was _____”

Key: dead

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Why does Lennox say Macduff 'lives in disgrace'?

A. He spoke openly and missed the feast

B. He was caught stealing from the king

C. He lost a battle against Norway

D. He was found asleep at his post

Key: A (He spoke openly and missed the feast)

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Lord say Malcolm has kept despite misfortune?

A. Duncan's sword and crown

B. Edward's high respect

C. His lands in Scotland

D. The Witches' favour

Key: B (Edward's high respect)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Lennox pray an angel will do?

A. Protect Macbeth from his enemies

B. Bring Duncan back to life

C. Fly to England before Macduff arrives

D. Guide young Fleance safely home to Scotland

Key: C (Fly to England before Macduff arrives)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the Lord's view of Scotland compare with Lennox's?

Sample answer: Lennox speaks carefully, hinting at the truth through mock praise. The Lord speaks more openly, calling Macbeth a tyrant who holds Malcolm's birthright and describing a land without sleep, safe feasts or free honours. Together they show that the thanes now see Macbeth as the cause of Scotland's suffering.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this scene reveal about Lennox's view of the official story?

    Sample answer: Lennox repeats each part of the official story, that Fleance killed Banquo, that the princes killed Duncan, and that Macbeth killed the grooms in grief. But he adds remarks like men must not walk too late and was not that nobly done, which show he does not believe a word of it.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What makes Lennox's irony a model of dangerous speech under tyranny?

    A. He says nothing openly yet everything is clear
    B. He openly accuses the king of murder
    C. He refuses to speak about the king at all, out of fear
    D. He praises the king sincerely and loyally

    Key: A (He says nothing openly yet everything is clear)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of the parenthesis “As, an’t please heaven, he shall not”?

    A. It shows Lennox wants the princes caught
    B. It shows Lennox hopes the princes stay safe
    C. It shows Lennox has lost his faith
    D. It shows Lennox is about to leave

    Key: B (It shows Lennox hopes the princes stay safe)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Lennox stop himself with 'But, peace!'?

    A. He hears Macbeth coming near with his guards
    B. He wants the Lord to speak
    C. He realizes he has said too much
    D. He forgot what he was saying

    Key: C (He realizes he has said too much)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Lord's list of things Scotland 'pines for' suggest?

    A. Scotland is at war with Norway once again
    B. The harvest has failed
    C. The king is generous
    D. Ordinary life has been destroyed

    Key: D (Ordinary life has been destroyed)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Lennox's line: “My former speeches have but hit your _____”

    Key: thoughts

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene shift the play's focus toward resistance?

    A. It shows plans forming against Macbeth

B. It shows Macbeth's enemies giving up the struggle

C. It celebrates Macbeth's victory

D. It ends the threat from England

Key: A (It shows plans forming against Macbeth)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does 'cloudy messenger' suggest about Macbeth's servant?

A. He is cheerful and kind

B. He is sullen and threatening

C. He is lost in a fog

D. He is a spirit of the air sent by Hecate

Key: B (He is sullen and threatening)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why is the Lord's description of Edward as 'most pious' important?

A. It shows Edward is weak

B. It shows Edward is Scottish

C. It contrasts a holy king with a murderous one

D. It shows Edward knows the Witches and their spells

Key: C (It contrasts a holy king with a murderous one)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze how Lennox uses mock praise of Macbeth.

Sample answer: Lennox says Duncan was pitied by Macbeth, but adds marry, he was dead. He asks whether killing the grooms was not nobly done and wisely too. By pretending to admire Macbeth's grief and loyalty, he exposes how convenient every death has been for the king. The listener is invited to see through the pretence.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the importance of this scene coming just before the Witches' cauldron scene.

Sample answer: This scene shows the thanes turning against Macbeth and Macduff seeking help in England, so the threat to Macbeth is growing. The next scene shows Macbeth seeking the Witches for reassurance. Placing them together suggests that, as human opposition grows, Macbeth turns to supernatural forces rather than to his people.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Shakespeare use a nameless Lord in this scene?

A. To voice the general opinion of the nobles

B. To introduce a future king of Scotland and England

C. To provide comic relief

D. To bring news from Norway

Key: A (To voice the general opinion of the nobles)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the scene suggest about political speech under tyranny?

A. Truth can be spoken freely at court

B. Truth must be hinted rather than spoken

C. Lies are punished at once by the law of the land

D. Silence is the wisest choice for a thane

Key: B (Truth must be hinted rather than spoken)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does “Give to our tables meat, sleep to our nights” connect to earlier imagery?

    A. It recalls the sergeant's battlefield reports in Act I

    B. It recalls the Porter's jokes

    C. It recalls the murdered sleep and broken feasts

    D. It recalls the dagger vision

    Key: C (It recalls the murdered sleep and broken feasts)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Lennox's line: “To kill their gracious father? damned _____!”

    Key: fact

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene prepare the audience for the play's final conflict?

    A. It shows Macbeth making peace with England

    B. It shows Malcolm giving up his claim

    C. It shows the Witches warning Macduff

    D. It shows allies gathering for war

    Key: D (It shows allies gathering for war)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the closing prayer for 'this our suffering country' add to the scene's tone?

    A. A note of hope amid despair

    B. A note of comic relief after the banquet

    C. A tone of triumph

    D. A tone of anger

    Key: A (A note of hope amid despair)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Lennox is a brave or cautious figure.
    Sample answer: Lennox reveals his suspicions only through careful irony and then stops himself with But, peace. Yet he names Macbeth a tyrant and prays for help from England. A strong answer weighs his caution against his willingness to speak at all, and considers what his behaviour suggests about life under a tyrant.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate how the scene presents Scotland as a sick nation.
    Sample answer: The Lord describes a country without food, sleep, safe feasts or free honour, and Lennox prays for a swift blessing to a suffering country under a hand accursed. A strong answer links these images to the idea that the land shares the king's corruption and argues that healing will require outside help from a holy king.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Lennox ask where Macduff 'bestows himself'?

    A. He wishes to arrest Macduff

    B. He wants to know where resistance is gathering

    C. He wants to invite Macduff to supper

    D. He wants to warn Macbeth

    Key: B (He wants to know where resistance is gathering)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Lennox here with his role in Act II.
    Sample answer: In Act II Lennox described the unruly night and accepted the grooms as the killers, even approving

Macbeth's quick action. Now he mocks that same story. A strong answer traces how his doubts grew, showing that Macbeth's actions have turned even loyal thanes into quiet critics.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act III, Scene VI develops the idea of suspicion spoken through irony. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act III, Scene VI” could deliver about suspicion spoken through irony. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for suspicion spoken through irony in “Act III, Scene VI”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act III, Scene VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of suspicion spoken through irony. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act III, Scene VI” could deliver about suspicion spoken through irony. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for suspicion spoken through irony in “Act III, Scene VI”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act III, Scene VI suggests about suspicion spoken through irony. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene VI" could deliver about suspicion spoken through irony. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for suspicion spoken through irony in "Act III, Scene VI": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act III, Scene VI to complicate the reader's understanding of suspicion spoken through irony. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act III, Scene VI" could deliver about suspicion spoken through irony. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for suspicion spoken through irony in "Act III, Scene VI": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Some holy angel Fly to the court of England and unfold His message ere he come, that a swift blessing May soon return to this our suffering country Under a hand accursed!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "accursed" most nearly mean?

   A. a warning; care to avoid danger

   B. slaves; captives

   C. under a curse

   D. horrible; unnatural

2. *The son of Duncan, From whom this tyrant holds the due of birth, Lives in the English court, and is received Of the most pious Edward with such grace That the malevolence of fortune nothing Takes from his high respect: thither Macduff Is gone to pray the holy king, upon his aid To wake Northumberland and warlike Siward: That, by the help of these—with Him above To ratify the work—we may again Give to our tables meat, sleep to our nights, Free from our feasts and banquets bloody knives, Do faithful homage and receive free honours: All which we pine for now: and this report Hath so exasperate the king that he Prepares for some attempt of war. Sent he to Macduff? He did: and with an absolute "Sir, not I," The cloudy messenger turns me his back, And hums, as who should say "You'll rue the time That clogs me with this answer." And that well might Advise him to a caution, to hold what distance His wisdom can provide. Some holy angel Fly to the court of England and unfold His message ere he come, that a swift blessing May soon return to this our suffering country Under a hand accursed! I'll send my prayers with him.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act III, Scene VI"?

A. Suspicion spoken through irony

B. Lady Macbeth's resolve

C. The murder and its first guilt

D. Banquo's murder and Fleance's escape

SAT key: 1. C (under a curse); 2. A (Suspicion spoken through irony)

Lesson 20: Act IV, Scene I

Focus: the apparitions and false security

Objective: Students will analyze how foreshadowing develops in "Act IV, Scene I" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (antisemitic and ethnic slurs (period language), infanticide imagery): The witches' recipe includes 'Liver of blaspheming Jew', 'Nose of Turk and Tartar's lips' and 'Finger of birth-strangled babe / Ditch-deliver'd by a drab'. Name the antisemitic and ethnic othering as period prejudice that marks the brew as evil by association; decide in advance that these lines are not performed or read aloud for effect, and discuss why the play links outsiders with evil.
Suggested language: "What does the recipe show about who the play treats as 'other'?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The Witches brew their potion ('Double, double toil and trouble'). Macbeth demands answers. Three apparitions warn him to beware Macduff (an armed head), tell him none of woman born shall harm him (a bloody child), and that he will never be vanquished until Great Birnam Wood comes to high Dunsinane Hill (a child crowned, with a tree in his hand). He then sees a show of eight kings followed by Banquo's ghost, the last king holding a glass. Learning from Lennox that Macduff has fled to England, Macbeth vows to seize Fife and kill his wife and children.

Background: The line of eight kings honors the Stuart ancestors of James I; the glass (mirror) may have reflected King James himself if he watched a performance.

Significance: Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.'

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: scepters — rods carried by kings as a sign of power; pricking — a tingling feeling; vanquish — to defeat completely; exploits — bold deeds; boasting — bragging. “vanquish”: Origin: Middle English venquysshen; earlier Old French veincre. “exploits”: Origin of “exploit”: Old French esploit.
Words: scepters: rods carried by kings as a sign of power · pricking: a tingling feeling · vanquish: to defeat completely · exploits: bold deeds · boasting: bragging

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The line of eight kings honors the Stuart ancestors of James I; the glass (mirror) may have reflected King James himself if he watched a performance. Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.' Imagery: The cauldron's recipe ("Eye of newt, and toe of frog"): grotesque catalogue of body parts. Structure: Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle. Dramatic irony: The audience can guess the tricks (a man not "of woman born," the wood that moves); Macbeth cannot. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” slowly and put it in my own words: Around the cauldron, the witches chant "double, double toil and trouble; fire burn and cauldron bubble." Next, craft. I notice the strong four-beat rhythm and rhyme, unlike the play's usual blank verse, which marks it as a spell. The strongest word is “cauldron”: it is the pot where their horrible ingredients brew, the source of the visions they will show. Then, effect. What mood does the witches' chant create as Macbeth comes to them? My answer: The chant creates a supernatural, threatening mood; Macbeth now seeks the witches himself, and the prophecies they brew will give him false confidence.

> *Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble* *(Act IV, Scene I, lines 1469–1470)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” slowly and put it in my own words: Around the cauldron, the witches chant "double, double toil and trouble; fire burn and cauldron bubble." Next, craft. I notice the strong four-beat rhythm and rhyme, unlike the play's usual blank verse, which marks it as a spell. The strongest word is “cauldron”: it is the pot where their horrible ingredients brew, the source of the visions they will show. Then, effect. What mood does the witches' chant create as Macbeth comes to them? My answer: The chant creates a supernatural, threatening mood; Macbeth now seeks the witches himself, and the prophecies they brew will give him false confidence.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "None of woman born" and "harm" stand out. The promise sounds absolute, as if no man could hurt Macbeth, but its exact wording leaves a gap. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected student answer: The apparition seems to promise safety, so the line shows a prophecy that Macbeth takes as a guarantee, leaving his fate to rest on how he reads the words.

> *none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "None of woman born" and "harm" stand out. The promise sounds absolute, as if no man could hurt Macbeth, but its exact wording leaves a gap.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected student answer: The apparition seems to promise safety, so the line shows a prophecy that Macbeth takes as a guarantee, leaving his fate to rest on how he reads the words.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for imagery, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the apparitions and false security. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. When the text says "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551), it shows this directly. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.
Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the apparitions and false security. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. When the text says "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551), it shows this directly. Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?
Ask: why does Macbeth kill Macduff's family if he believes he is safe?
Anchor question: Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Macbeth kill Macduff's family if he believes he is safe?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. ("none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth", Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the apparitions and false security? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. ("none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth", Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the apparitions and false security. Key takeaway: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The cauldron's recipe ("Eye of newt, and toe of frog"): grotesque catalogue of body parts.
- **Structure:** Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle.
- **Dramatic irony:** The audience can guess the tricks (a man not "of woman born," the wood that moves); Macbeth cannot.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1469–1470) The chant; trochaic rhythm.
- "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551) The equivocal prophecy.
- "The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1628–1629) Macbeth will act without thought.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime.
Evidence: "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551)
Reasoning: Told that "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth," he feels safe, yet he vows "the very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand," and orders the murder of Macduff's family.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
scepters (noun)	rods carried by kings as a sign of power	*I'll see no more: And yet the eighth appears, who bears a glass Which shows me many more; and some I see That two-fold balls and treble scepters carry: Horrible sight!*	
pricking (noun)	a tingling feeling	*By the pricking of my thumbs, Something wicked this way comes.*	
vanquish (verb)	to defeat completely	*Be lion-mettled, proud; and take no care Who chafes, who frets, or where conspirers are: Macbeth shall never vanquish'd be until Great Birnam wood to high Dunsinane hill Shall come against him.*	"vanquish": Origin: Middle English venquysshen; earlier Old French veincre. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/vanquish#Etymology)
exploits (noun)	bold deeds	*Time, thou anticipatest my dread exploits: The flighty purpose never is o'ertook Unless the deed go with it: from this moment The very firstlings of my heart shall be The firstlings of my hand.*	"exploits": Origin of "exploit": Old French esploit. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/exploit#Etymology)

boasting (noun)	bragging	*No boasting like a fool; This deed I'll do before this purpose cool.*	
impress (verb)	to force into service; also, to cut into or mark	*That will never be: Who can impress the forest, bid the tree Unfix his earth-bound root?*	
brinded (adjective)	streaked; tabby	*Thrice the brinded cat hath mew'd.*	
amazedly (adverb)	in a stunned way	*Ay, sir, all this is so: but why Stands Macbeth thus amazedly?*	
firstlings (noun)	first impulses	*Time, thou anticipatest my dread exploits: The flighty purpose never is o'ertook Unless the deed go with it: from this moment The very firstlings of my heart shall be The firstlings of my hand.*	
mettled (adjective)	spirited; courageous (lion-mettled: brave as a lion)	*Be lion-mettled, proud; and take no care Who chafes, who frets, or where conspirers are: Macbeth shall never vanquish'd be until Great Birnam wood to high Dunsinane hill Shall come against him.*	

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does the Second Witch say just before Macbeth enters? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** 'By the pricking of my thumbs, something wicked this way comes.'
   Answer guidance: 'By the pricking of my thumbs, something wicked this way comes.'.
2. What does the first apparition, an armed head, warn? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Beware Macduff
   Answer guidance: Beware Macduff.

3. What does the bloody child say? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** None of woman born shall harm Macbeth
   Answer guidance: None of woman born shall harm Macbeth.
4. Until what happens will Macbeth never be vanquished? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Birnam Wood comes to Dunsinane
   Answer guidance: Birnam Wood comes to Dunsinane.
5. What does the show of eight kings reveal? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Banquo's descendants will rule
   Answer guidance: Banquo's descendants will rule.
6. What does Macbeth decide after hearing Macduff has fled? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To kill Macduff's wife and children
   Answer guidance: To kill Macduff's wife and children.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act IV, Scene I" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The Witches brew their potion ('Double, double toil and trouble'). Macbeth demands answers. Three apparitions warn him to beware Macduff (an armed head), tell him none of woman born shall harm him (a bloody child), and that he will never be vanquished until Great Birnam Wood comes to high Dunsinane Hill (a child crowned, with a tree in his hand). He then sees a show of eight kings followed by…
   Answer guidance: The Witches brew their potion ('Double, double toil and trouble'). Macbeth demands answers. Three apparitions warn him to beware Macduff (an armed head), tell him none of woman born shall harm him (a bloody child), and that he will never be vanquished until Great Birnam Wood comes to high Dunsinane Hill (a child crowned, with a tree in his hand). He then sees a show of eight kings followed by…
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act IV, Scene I" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "I'll see no more: And yet the eighth appears, who bears a glass Which shows me many more; and some I see That two-fold balls and treble scepters carry: Horrible sight!" What does "scepters" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** scepters: rods carried by kings as a sign of power.
    Answer guidance: scepters: rods carried by kings as a sign of power.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth feel safe after the apparitions, even though the first one warned him? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** He

trusts the reassuring riddles and ignores the warning: overconfidence.

Answer guidance: He trusts the reassuring riddles and ignores the warning: overconfidence.

2. What does Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family show about how his violence has changed? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** It is now reflexive and pointless, aimed at the innocent.

   Answer guidance: It is now reflexive and pointless, aimed at the innocent.

3. What does “Act IV, Scene I” suggest about the apparitions and false security? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.'

   Answer guidance: Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.'. Evidence to accept: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1469–1470): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. Find one example of foreshadowing in “Act IV, Scene I”. What does it reveal about the apparitions and false security that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events. Evidence to accept: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551): The equivocal prophecy. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

5. How does the symbolism in “Act IV, Scene I” shape what we understand about the apparitions and false security? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1469–1470): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. In the passage that opens with “Macbeth!”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1628–1629): Macbeth will act without thought. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the apparitions' promises and the news that Macduff has fled, which turn Macbeth to Macduff's family; evidence: “none of woman born Shall harm Macbeth”.

   Answer guidance: Look for: the apparitions' promises and the news that Macduff has fled, which turn Macbeth to Macduff's family; evidence: “none of woman born Shall harm Macbeth”. Evidence to accept:

"Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1469–1470): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

8. How does "Act IV, Scene I" build on "Act III, Scene VI"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551): The equivocal prophecy. On structure: Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. In "Act IV, Scene I", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the apparitions and false security, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: "The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1628–1629): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Have you ever heard exactly what you wanted to hear and ignored the warning that came with it?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
    Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551): The equivocal prophecy. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the Witches' prophecies lies? Argue whether deceiving with literal truth is worse than lying. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment about deception through literal truth.
   Answer guidance: A judgment about deception through literal truth.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Each prophecy is literally true and deeply misleading. Macbeth's decision to kill Macduff's family shows how far he has fallen: 'The very firstlings of my heart shall be the firstlings of my hand.' How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551): The equivocal prophecy. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and

he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in "Act IV, Scene I" acts most wisely in the matter of the apparitions and false security, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: "The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1628–1629): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Act IV, Scene I". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the apparitions and false security. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: "Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1469–1470): The chant; trochaic rhythm. On structure: Three apparitions (an armed head, a bloody child, a crowned child with a tree) and a show of eight kings: each prophecy is a riddle. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about "Act IV, Scene I": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: "none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551): The equivocal prophecy. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect "Act IV, Scene I", with its focus on the apparitions and false security, to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: "The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand" (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1628–1629): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the foreshadowing in "Act IV, Scene I" effective in presenting the apparitions and false security, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the

corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1469–1470): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene I” treats the apparitions and false security with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “none of woman born / Shall harm Macbeth” (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1550–1551): The equivocal prophecy. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “The very firstlings of my heart shall be / The firstlings of my hand” (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1628–1629): Macbeth will act without thought. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act IV, Scene I” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the apparitions and false security? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The apparitions give Macbeth false security, which leads him to his most senseless crime. Useful evidence: “Double, double toil and trouble; / Fire burn, and cauldron bubble” (Act IV, Scene I, lines 1469–1470): The chant; trochaic rhythm. Theme link: the riddles give Macbeth "security," and he resolves to kill Macduff's family immediately. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does this scene take place?
   A. A cavern with a boiling cauldron
   B. The great banquet hall at Forres
   C. A park near the palace
   D. The English court

   Key: A (A cavern with a boiling cauldron)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What refrain do the Witches chant together?
   A. Fair is foul, and foul is fair, in fog
   B. Double, double toil and trouble
   C. Hail, hail, hail to the king
   D. When shall we three meet again

   Key: B (Double, double toil and trouble)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who praises the Witches for their work on the brew?
   A. Macbeth
   B. Banquo's ghost
   C. Hecate
   D. Lady Macbeth

   Key: C (Hecate)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Witches' answer to Macbeth: "A deed without a _____"

   Key: name
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth call the Witches when he enters?
   A. Wise women of the heath and hill
   B. Sisters of the moon and stars
   C. Prophets of the coming age
   D. Secret, black, and midnight hags

   Key: D (Secret, black, and midnight hags)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the First Witch offer Macbeth before the spirits appear?
   A. To hear it from their masters
   B. A cup of the boiling brew
   C. A crown of gold for his son
   D. A charm to protect his castle

   Key: A (To hear it from their masters)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What object, a symbol of the endless line, does the eighth king carry?
   A. A sword
   B. A glass

C. A torch

D. A scroll

Key: B (A glass)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lennox say when Macbeth asks if he saw the weird sisters?

   A. Yes, they flew past

   B. I saw three shadows

   C. No, my lord

   D. They went toward Fife

   Key: C (No, my lord)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] What ingredients go into the Witches' cauldron, and what mood do they create?

   Sample answer: They throw in a poisoned toad, a fenny snake, eye of newt, toe of frog, wool of bat, tongue of dog, a lizard's leg, an owlet's wing, scale of dragon, tooth of wolf and root of hemlock, among other things. The gruesome list creates a dark, frightening mood and shows the evil nature of their magic.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How do the Witches react when Macbeth demands to know more?

    Sample answer: They warn him to seek to know no more. When he threatens them with an eternal curse, the cauldron sinks and they show him a procession that grieves his heart. Then they dance mockingly, pretending to welcome a great king, and vanish. They give him what he asks for but only to hurt him.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of the rhythm in “Fire burn, and cauldron bubble”?

    A. Its chant-like beat sounds like a spell

    B. It sounds like an ordinary conversation

    C. It slows the scene to a calm and quiet pace

    D. It mimics a soldier's report from battle

    Key: A (Its chant-like beat sounds like a spell)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What do Macbeth's images of churches, waves and falling castles show?

    A. He wants to build new churches in Scotland

    B. He would let the world be destroyed for answers

    C. He fears a great storm will sink his ships at sea

    D. He is describing his recent battle victory

    Key: B (He would let the world be destroyed for answers)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth mean by “I’ll make assurance double sure”?

    A. He will ask the spirits the same question twice

    B. He will sign a treaty with England

    C. He will kill the threat anyway, to be certain

    D. He will double the guards around his castle

Key: C (He will kill the threat anyway, to be certain)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth hope to do by killing his enemy, according to “sleep in spite of thunder”?

    A. Win a battle in a storm

    B. Silence the Witches

    C. Wake Lady Macbeth

    D. Rest without fear

    Key: D (Rest without fear)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “Let this pernicious hour Stand aye accursed in the _____!”

    Key: calendar

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “the crack of doom” suggest about the line of kings?

    A. It will last until the end of the world

    B. It will end with a great earthquake that shakes Scotland

    C. It will be cursed by heaven

    D. It will be broken by Macbeth's son

    Key: A (It will last until the end of the world)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth mean by “Infected be the air whereon they ride”?

    A. He fears a plague is spreading through all of Scotland

    B. He curses the Witches for what they showed him

    C. He wants the Witches to ride with him

    D. He thinks the air is too cold to breathe

    Key: B (He curses the Witches for what they showed him)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “The very firstlings of my heart shall be The firstlings of my hand” mean?

    A. He will write down his first thoughts

    B. He will give his first son a gift

    C. He will act on impulses immediately

    D. He will hold his heart in his hand

    Key: C (He will act on impulses immediately)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Macbeth react so strongly to the procession of kings?

    Sample answer: Each crowned figure looks like Banquo, and the line seems to stretch out to the crack of doom. The last holds a glass showing many more, and the bloodied ghost smiles and points at them as his. Macbeth realizes he has murdered only to make another man's sons kings, so the sight burns his eyes.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How has Macbeth's attitude toward the Witches changed since Act I?

    Sample answer: In Act I he was startled and fascinated by them and wondered whether their words were good or ill. Now he

seeks them out, orders them to answer and threatens them with a curse. After the show of kings he calls them filthy hags and damns all who trust them, yet he still relies on their words.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about Macbeth's curse on 'all those that trust them'?

    A. He curses himself, since he trusts them

    B. He has not trusted the Witches since the first meeting

    C. The Witches are about to help him

    D. Lennox trusts the Witches more than Macbeth does

    Key: A (He curses himself, since he trusts them)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the setting of a dark cavern suit the scene's purpose?

    A. It suggests a holy place of prayer and peace

    B. It suits a descent into hidden evil

    C. It shows the Witches are poor

    D. It hides the scene from Hecate

    Key: B (It suits a descent into hidden evil)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “Time, thou anticipatest my dread exploits” reveal?

    A. He is late for a meeting with Lennox

    B. He wants time to stop for a while

    C. He feels events are moving faster than his plans

    D. He believes he has plenty of time

    Key: C (He feels events are moving faster than his plans)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macbeth's reaction to the bloody child show his divided mind?

    A. He is calm and gives up all of his violent plans

    B. He fears the child and runs away

    C. He forgets the child immediately

    D. He feels safe yet still plans a killing

    Key: D (He feels safe yet still plans a killing)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “For the blood-_____ Banquo smiles upon me”

    Key: bolter’d

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the crowned child holding a tree symbolize about the future?

    A. A young heir will bring about Macbeth's end

    B. Macbeth's own son will be crowned king

    C. A forest will be planted in his honour by his subjects

    D. The Witches will crown a new queen

    Key: A (A young heir will bring about Macbeth's end)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How do the Witches' final dance and song add to the scene's cruelty?

    A. They comfort Macbeth after the vision

    B. They mock Macbeth's misery with false welcome

    C. They summon Banquo's ghost again

    D. They thank Macbeth for his gifts

    Key: B (They mock Macbeth's misery with false welcome)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's "No boasting like a fool" show?

    A. He knows he is a fool

    B. He wants to boast later

    C. He wants action, not words

    D. He regrets his crimes and wants peace

    Key: C (He wants action, not words)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the apparitions are designed to deceive Macbeth.

    Sample answer: The spirits speak in half-truths: one warns him, but the next two seem to promise safety through riddles that sound impossible. Hecate said illusions would draw him to confusion and false security. A strong answer shows that each vision is technically true but framed to make Macbeth feel invincible while leading him to destruction.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze Macbeth's decision at the end of the scene.

    Sample answer: On hearing that Macduff has fled, Macbeth says he will act on the firstlings of his heart, surprise Macduff's castle and kill all who share his blood. He says he will act before the purpose cools and will see no more sights. A strong answer shows how he now acts without thought or purpose, aiming his violence at the defenceless.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Macbeth's conjuration speech parallel the Witches' own powers?

    A. He invokes storms and ruin as they do

    B. He prays to heaven for forgiveness

    C. He makes a calm and reasoned argument

    D. He offers them gold for their help

    Key: A (He invokes storms and ruin as they do)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the procession reveal about Macbeth's central fear?

    A. A defeat in battle against the English and Siward

    B. A future of kings not descended from him

    C. The loss of Lady Macbeth's love

    D. A plague spreading through his land

    Key: B (A future of kings not descended from him)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene connect to the play's opening?

    A. Duncan returns as a ghost to warn him

    B. The battle with Norway begins again

    C. The Witches again lure Macbeth with equivocation

D. Banquo meets the Witches for the first time

Key: C (The Witches again lure Macbeth with equivocation)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “Thy crown does sear mine _____”

Key: eye-balls

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the phrase “two-fold balls and treble scepters” likely allude to?

A. The war between Scotland and Norway at the play's start

B. The Witches' magical tools

C. Duncan's royal regalia

D. The future union of the crowns under King James

Key: D (The future union of the crowns under King James)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why might Shakespeare have Lennox enter immediately after the Witches vanish?

A. To pull Macbeth back into political reality

B. To provide comic relief for the audience after the dance

C. To show that Lennox can see the Witches

D. To warn Macbeth about the Witches

Key: A (To pull Macbeth back into political reality)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the claim that Macbeth chooses his fate in this scene rather than receiving it.

Sample answer: The spirits show him visions, but Macbeth chooses how to interpret them, deciding to make assurance double sure and to attack Macduff's family on impulse. A strong answer weighs the Witches' deception against his own choices, and argues whether the scene shows fate, free will, or a dangerous mix of the two.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate how the scene uses spectacle.

Sample answer: The scene uses a boiling cauldron, chanting, thunder, apparitions rising and descending, music, a procession of eight kings and a mocking dance. A strong answer argues how this spectacle entertains the audience, makes the supernatural vivid and contrasts with Macbeth's isolation, and considers how it might have been staged for King James.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the Witches' refusal to answer the final question at first suggest?

A. They do not know the answer

B. Knowledge itself will be his punishment

C. They want to protect Banquo

D. They are afraid of Macbeth's curse and his anger

Key: B (Knowledge itself will be his punishment)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Macbeth's response here with his response to the prophecies in Act I.

Sample answer: In Act I he was torn between hope and horror and thought chance might crown him without his stir. Now he demands answers, hears only what he wants and decides to kill on impulse. A strong answer traces how his relationship to prophecy has shifted from uncertainty to reckless dependence.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix

HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 9, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene I develops the idea of the apparitions and false security. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act IV, Scene I" could deliver about the apparitions and false security. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the apparitions and false security in "Act IV, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the apparitions and false security. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act IV, Scene I" could deliver about the apparitions and false security. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the apparitions and false security in "Act IV, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene I suggests about the apparitions and false security. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's foreshadowing and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act IV, Scene I" could deliver about the apparitions and false security. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the apparitions and false security in "Act IV, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses foreshadowing in Act IV, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the apparitions and false security. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act IV, Scene I" could deliver about the apparitions and false security. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the apparitions and false security in "Act IV, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Macbeth! Macbeth! Macbeth! beware Macduff; Beware the thane of Fife. Dismiss me. Enough. Descends. Whate'er thou art, for thy good caution, thanks; Thou hast harp'd my fear aright: but one word more— He will not be commanded: here's another, More potent than the first. Thunder. Second Apparition: A bloody Child. Macbeth! Macbeth! Macbeth! Had I three ears, I'ld hear thee. Be bloody, bold, and resolute; laugh to scorn The power of man, for none of woman born Shall harm Macbeth. Descends. Then live, Macduff: what need I fear of thee? But yet I'll make assurance double sure, And take a bond of fate: thou shalt not live; That I may tell pale-hearted fear it lies, And sleep in spite of thunder. Thunder. Third Apparition: a Child crowned, with a tree in his hand. What is this That rises like the issue of a king, And wears upon his baby-brow the round And top of sovereignty? Listen, but speak not to't. Be lion-mettled, proud; and take no care Who chafes, who frets, or where conspirers are: Macbeth shall never vanquish'd be until Great Birnam wood to high Dunsinane hill Shall come against him. Descends.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene I"?

   A. The Witches' greetings and their pull

   B. The Witches' riddling world

   C. The apparitions and false security

   D. The cast and world of the play

SAT key: 1. C (The apparitions and false security)

Lesson 21: Act IV, Scene II

Focus: the murder of the innocent

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "Act IV, Scene II" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (murder of a child, violence against a mother, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): A child is stabbed on stage and his mother pursued by murderers. Some students may have experienced violence or loss; allow a pass on reading aloud. Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…never fear the net nor lime, The pitfall nor the gin. Why should I, mother? Poor birds they…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Suggested language: "What does this scene show about what Macbeth has become?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At Fife, Lady Macduff tells Ross that her husband's flight was madness and that he loves them not; Ross defends him as wise and leaves. She tells her son his father is dead and a traitor; the clever boy banters that the liars and swearers are enough to beat the honest men and hang them up. A messenger warns her to flee. Murderers enter, call Macduff a traitor, and stab the boy ('He has kill'd me, mother'); she runs out crying 'Murder!' and is pursued.

Background: The scene is one of very few in Shakespeare to show a child killed on stage. It is the moment many audiences turn wholly against Macbeth.

Significance: The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because....
Prompt: Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: pitfall — a trap for catching birds; diminutive — tiny; smallest; laudable — praiseworthy; methinks — it seems to me; swearers — people who swear oaths. “laudable”: Origin: Old French laudable; earlier Latin laudabilis. “swearers”: Origin of “swearer”: an English formation from swear + -er.
Words: pitfall: a trap for catching birds · diminutive: tiny; smallest · laudable: praiseworthy · methinks: it seems to me · swearers: people who swear oaths

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The scene is one of very few in Shakespeare to show a child killed on stage. It is the moment many audiences turn wholly against Macbeth. The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family. Characterization: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Dramatic irony: A messenger warns them too late; murderers arrive. Structure: The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” slowly and put it in my own words: Lady Macduff tells Ross that Macduff does not love his family, since he fled and left them unprotected. Next, craft. I notice the bitter comparison she goes on to make with a small bird that fights to protect its nest. The strongest word is “natural”: it means the instinctive love that makes even animals defend their young. Then, effect. Why does Lady Macduff say her husband lacks "the natural touch"? My answer: Lady Macduff says her husband lacks "the natural touch" because he fled and left his family unprotected, unlike even a small bird; she does not know he went to raise an army, which makes the coming murder more painful.

> *He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch (Act IV, Scene II, lines 1649–1650)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” slowly and put it in my own words: Lady Macduff tells Ross that Macduff does not love his family, since he fled and left them unprotected. Next, craft. I notice the bitter comparison she goes on to make with a small bird that fights to protect its nest. The strongest word is “natural”: it means the instinctive love that makes even animals defend their young. Then, effect. Why does Lady Macduff say her husband lacks "the natural touch"? My answer: Lady Macduff says her husband lacks "the natural touch" because he fled and left his family unprotected, unlike even a small bird; she does not know he went to raise an army, which makes the coming murder more painful.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Liars", "swearers" and "honest men" stand out. The boy jokes that the dishonest outnumber the honest, so a child's wit describes the state of Scotland under Macbeth. Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected student answer: The boy speaks with the confidence of a man, defending his absent father, so the line shows a child's courage set against a world where liars now rule.

> *Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them (Act IV, Scene II, line 1698)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Liars", "swearers" and "honest men" stand out. The boy jokes that the dishonest outnumber the honest, so a child's wit describes the state of Scotland under Macbeth.
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected student answer: The boy speaks with the confidence of a man, defending his absent father, so the line shows a child's courage set against a world where liars now rule.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of the murder of the innocent. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. When the text says "Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them" (Act IV, Scene II, line 1698), it shows this directly. The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, dramatic irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of the murder of the innocent. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. When the text says "Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them" (Act IV, Scene II, line 1698), it shows this directly. The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause? Ask how staging choices affect the audience.
Anchor question: Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?
Facilitation: Ask how staging choices affect the audience.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. ("Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them", Act IV, Scene II, line 1698). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the murder of the innocent? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. ("Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them", Act IV, Scene II, line 1698). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the murder of the innocent. Key takeaway: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave.
- **Dramatic irony:** A messenger warns them too late; murderers arrive.
- **Structure:** The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.
- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": watch for appearances and words that mean two things.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch" (Act IV, Scene II, lines 1649–1650) Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight.
- "Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them" (Act IV, Scene II, line 1698) The son's wit.
- "He has kill'd me, mother" (Act IV, Scene II, line 1729) The son's death.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny.
Evidence: "Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them" (Act IV, Scene II, line 1698)
Reasoning: The child who jokes that "liars and swearers" outnumber "the honest men" is killed on stage: "He has killed me, mother."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pitfall (noun)	a trap for catching birds	*Poor bird! thou'ldst never fear the net nor lime, The pitfall nor the gin.*	
diminutive (adjective)	tiny; smallest	*He loves us not; He wants the natural touch: for the poor wren, The most diminutive of birds, will fight, Her young ones in her nest, against the owl.*	
laudable (adjective)	praiseworthy	*But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that womanly defence, To say I have done no harm?*	"laudable": Origin: Old French laudable; earlier Latin laudabilis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/laudable#Etymology)
methinks (verb)	it seems to me	*To fright you thus, methinks, I am too savage; To do worse to you were fell cruelty, Which is too nigh your person.*	
swearers (noun)	people who swear oaths	*Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them.*	"swearers": Origin of "swearer": an English formation from swear + -er. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/swearer#Etymology)
fatherless (adjective)	without a father	*Father'd he is, and yet he's fatherless.*	
discomfort (noun)	distress; embarrassment	*I am so much a fool, should I stay longer, It would be my disgrace and*	"discomfort": Origin: Anglo-Norman descomforter. (Liber et Libri origin note,

		your discomfort: I take my leave at once.	https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/discomfort#Etymology)
womanly (adjective)	typical of a woman (in the period's view)	*But I remember now I am in this earthly world; where to do harm Is often laudable, to do good sometime Accounted dangerous folly: why then, alas, Do I put up that womanly defence, To say I have done no harm?*	
judicious (adjective)	showing good judgment	*My dearest coz, I pray you, school yourself: but for your husband, He is noble, wise, judicious, and best knows The fits o' the season.*	"judicious": Origin: French judicieux; earlier Latin iudico. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/judicious#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does the son say about liars and swearers? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** They are fools: there are enough of them to beat the honest men and hang them up.
   Answer guidance: They are fools: there are enough of them to beat the honest men and hang them up.
2. What does Lady Macduff think of her husband's flight? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It was madness, and he loves his family not
   Answer guidance: It was madness, and he loves his family not.
3. Who visits her and then leaves? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Ross
   Answer guidance: Ross.
4. What does she tell her son about his father? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** That he is dead and a traitor
   Answer guidance: That he is dead and a traitor.
5. What happens to the son? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The murderers kill him
   Answer guidance: The murderers kill him.

6. Who warns her to flee? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** An unnamed messenger

   Answer guidance: An unnamed messenger.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act IV, Scene II" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** At Fife, Lady Macduff tells Ross that her husband's flight was madness and that he loves them not; Ross defends him as wise and leaves. She tells her son his father is dead and a traitor; the clever boy banters that the liars and swearers are enough to beat the honest men and hang them up. A messenger warns her to flee. Murderers enter, call Macduff a traitor, and stab the boy ('He has kill'd me,…

   Answer guidance: At Fife, Lady Macduff tells Ross that her husband's flight was madness and that he loves them not; Ross defends him as wise and leaves. She tells her son his father is dead and a traitor; the clever boy banters that the liars and swearers are enough to beat the honest men and hang them up. A messenger warns her to flee. Murderers enter, call Macduff a traitor, and stab the boy ('He has kill'd me,…
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene II", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act IV, Scene II" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Poor bird! thou'ldst never fear the net nor lime, The pitfall nor the gin." What does "pitfall" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** pitfall: a trap for catching birds.

    Answer guidance: pitfall: a trap for catching birds.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Shakespeare give the boy such clever, funny lines just before his death? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** It makes him vivid and the loss more painful: innocence against tyranny.

   Answer guidance: It makes him vivid and the loss more painful: innocence against tyranny.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene II" suggest about the murder of the innocent? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family.

   Answer guidance: The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family. Evidence to accept: "He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch" (Act IV, Scene II, lines 1649–1650): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of irony in "Act IV, Scene II". What does it reveal about the murder of the innocent that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

Answer guidance: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true. Evidence to accept: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, line 1698): The son's wit. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the characterization in “Act IV, Scene II” shape what we understand about the murder of the innocent? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, lines 1649–1650): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. On characterization: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “What had he done…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, line 1729): The son's death. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the murderers' arrival in Macduff's home; evidence: “Where is your husband?”
   Answer guidance: Look for: the murderers' arrival in Macduff's home; evidence: “Where is your husband?”. Evidence to accept: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, lines 1649–1650): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Act IV, Scene II” build on “Act IV, Scene I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, line 1698): The son's wit. On structure: The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Act IV, Scene II”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the murder of the innocent, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, line 1729): The son's death. On characterization: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Is it ever right to leave your family to fight for a larger cause?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind?

[DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, line 1698): The son's wit. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does tone / mood appear in “Act IV, Scene II”, and how does it connect the murder of the innocent to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, lines 1649–1650): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Should this scene be staged in full or with the violence offstage? Defend your choice, considering the audience. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A staging judgment balancing impact and care.

    Answer guidance: A staging judgment balancing impact and care.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The domestic warmth and wit of mother and son make the violence unbearable and show Macbeth's tyranny reaching the defenseless. It also raises the question of why Macduff left his family. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, line 1729): The son's death. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in “Act IV, Scene II” acts most wisely in the matter of the murder of the innocent, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, lines 1649–1650): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. On characterization: Lady Macduff and her son talk about traitors; the son is witty and brave. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the murder of the innocent. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, line 1698): The son's wit. On structure: The only domestic scene in the play: innocence slaughtered. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act IV, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, line 1729): The son's death. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act IV, Scene II”, with its focus on the murder of the innocent, to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, lines 1649–1650): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in “Act IV, Scene II” effective in presenting the murder of the innocent, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, line 1698): The son's wit. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene II” treats the murder of the innocent with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He has kill’d me, mother” (Act IV, Scene II, line 1729): The son's death. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act IV, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s ·

RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “He loves us not; / He wants the natural touch” (Act IV, Scene II, lines 1649–1650): Lady Macduff on Macduff's flight. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act IV, Scene II” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the murder of the innocent? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The murder of Macduff's family marks Macbeth's descent into pure tyranny. Useful evidence: “Then the liars and swearers are fools, for there are liars and swearers enow to beat the honest men and hang up them” (Act IV, Scene II, line 1698): The son's wit. Theme link: Lady Macduff calls her husband's flight unnatural: "He loves us not." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does this scene take place?

    A. Macduff's castle in Fife

    B. The palace hall at Forres

    C. A cavern on the heath

    D. The English court

    Key: A (Macduff's castle in Fife)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Ross tell Lady Macduff her husband is?

    A. Cowardly and foolish, like his father

    B. Noble, wise, judicious

    C. Cruel and unfeeling

    D. Lost and confused

    Key: B (Noble, wise, judicious)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Lady Macduff's son say he will live?

    A. By working in the fields

    B. By begging in the town

    C. As birds do

    D. As soldiers do

    Key: C (As birds do)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Lady Macduff's line: "Why, I can buy me _____ at any market"

   Key: twenty

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Lady Macduff call her son when he jokes?

   A. Brave soldier
   B. Little lord
   C. Sweet lamb
   D. Poor monkey

   Key: D (Poor monkey)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does the son describe a traitor?

   A. One that swears and lies
   B. One that steals gold
   C. One that runs from war
   D. One that hates the king

   Key: A (One that swears and lies)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the son call the First Murderer?

   A. A coward and a thief
   B. A shag-haired villain
   C. A servant of the devil
   D. A liar and a fool

   Key: B (A shag-haired villain)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What are the boy's dying words to Lady Macduff?

   A. To hide in the tower
   B. To find his father
   C. To run away
   D. To pray for him

   Key: C (To run away)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Ross respond to Lady Macduff's anger about her husband?

   Sample answer: Ross asks her to school herself and says her husband is noble, wise, judicious and understands the times. He hints that the times are cruel, when people are called traitors without knowing why and float on a wild and violent sea of rumour. He dares not say more and leaves quickly, close to tears.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does the scene between Lady Macduff and her son reveal about him?

    Sample answer: The boy is clever and brave. He jokes that his mother could buy twenty husbands only to sell them again and argues that liars outnumber honest men. When the murderers call his father a traitor, he calls one of them a liar and a villain. His wit and courage make his death even more shocking.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Lady Macduff mean by "our fears do make us traitors"?

    A. Running in fear can look like treason

B. Fear makes people betray their friends

C. Traitors fear death more than others do

D. Fear is a crime against the king

Key: A (Running in fear can look like treason)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which bird does Lady Macduff use as a symbol of a parent fighting for its young?

A. The eagle

B. The wren

C. The falcon

D. The raven

Key: B (The wren)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Ross mean by "float upon a wild and violent sea"?

A. Ross is about to sail for England with Macduff

B. Scotland's ships are lost at sea

C. People are tossed by rumour and fear

D. The weather is stormy at Fife

Key: C (People are tossed by rumour and fear)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Lady Macduff mean by "Father'd he is, and yet he's fatherless"?

A. His father has died in battle

B. He was adopted by Ross

C. He does not know his father

D. He has a father who is absent

Key: D (He has a father who is absent)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Ross's line: "Things at the worst will cease, or else climb _____"

Key: upward

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the messenger mean by "I am not to you known"?

A. She does not know who he is

B. He has forgotten her name

C. He is a spirit in disguise

D. He is her long-lost brother

Key: A (She does not know who he is)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic in Lady Macduff's claim that in this world "to do harm Is often laudable"?

A. She wants to do some harm of her own to Macbeth

B. Evil is rewarded under this rule

C. She praises Macbeth's rule

D. She is joking with her son

Key: B (Evil is rewarded under this rule)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Lady Macduff say when the murderers ask where her husband is?

    A. She says he is hiding in the tower

    B. She says he has gone to Scone

    C. She hopes he is in no unholy place

    D. She says he is dead

    Key: C (She hopes he is in no unholy place)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the son's conversation about traitors connect to the rest of the play?

    Sample answer: The son asks what a traitor is, and his mother says one who swears and lies. In a play where Cawdor betrayed Duncan and Macbeth lies to everyone, the boy's innocent questions point at the real traitor on the throne. They also make the murderers' later claim that Macduff is a traitor seem false.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does the messenger warn Lady Macduff, and why does he not stay?

    Sample answer: He says he knows her honour and fears danger is near, so he urges her to leave with her children. He feels savage even for frightening her but knows worse cruelty is coming. He dares not stay longer, which shows how dangerous it is to help Macbeth's targets.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does “He wants the natural touch” imply about Macduff?

    A. He lacks the instinct to protect his family

    B. He is too gentle to fight in a battle against the king

    C. He has lost his sense of touch

    D. He is too close to his family

    Key: A (He lacks the instinct to protect his family)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the image of the wren and owl connect to earlier imagery?

    A. It recalls Banquo's martlet nesting on the castle walls

    B. It recalls the owl killing the falcon

    C. It recalls the raven's croak

    D. It recalls the crow's flight

    Key: B (It recalls the owl killing the falcon)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Lady Macduff's “womanly defence” reveal about her view of innocence?

    A. It is enough to save her children

    B. It will win the court's favour

    C. It no longer protects anyone

    D. It is a trick to fool the murderers

    Key: C (It no longer protects anyone)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How do the jokes between mother and son affect the scene's ending?

    A. They make the scene feel comic

    B. They hint that the son will survive

    C. They show the mother is careless

    D. They make the violence more painful

    Key: D (They make the violence more painful)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the First Murderer's line: “Young fry of _____!”

    Key: treachery

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the murderer's insult 'What, you egg!' suggest about the victim?

    A. He is a small, defenceless child

    B. He is a coward who hides behind his mother

    C. He is a farmer's son

    D. He is foolish and slow

    Key: A (He is a small, defenceless child)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Ross avoid explaining the danger directly?

    A. He does not know of any danger to the family at all

    B. Speaking openly under Macbeth is dangerous

    C. He wants Lady Macduff to suffer

    D. He is a spy for Macbeth

    Key: B (Speaking openly under Macbeth is dangerous)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the murder of the Macduff family show about Macbeth's tyranny?

    A. It is aimed only at soldiers

    B. It is a necessary act of war

    C. It now targets the innocent and helpless

    D. It is carried out openly in court

    Key: C (It now targets the innocent and helpless)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze Lady Macduff's speech after the messenger leaves.

    Sample answer: She asks where she should fly, since she has done no harm, then remembers that in this world doing harm is often praised and doing good is called dangerous folly. Her words show a world turned upside down by Macbeth's rule, where innocence offers no protection and morality has been reversed.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the scene uses bird imagery.

    Sample answer: Lady Macduff compares herself to a wren that would fight an owl to protect its nest, and her son says he will live as birds do. She calls him a poor bird who does not fear nets or traps. The imagery stresses the family's smallness and vulnerability and prepares for their destruction by Macbeth's predators.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does this scene differ from the earlier murders in the play?

    A. The killing of a child happens on stage

B. The victims fight back successfully

C. It takes place in Macbeth's own castle

D. Macbeth himself commits the murder

Key: A (The killing of a child happens on stage)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Ross's line about 'cruel times' suggest about political life?

A. Traitors are caught and punished by the king's law

B. People are condemned without knowing why

C. The times will soon be peaceful again

D. Rumour is the best source of truth

Key: B (People are condemned without knowing why)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Lady Macduff's judgment of her husband complicate our view of Macduff?

A. It proves he is a coward and a traitor to his country

B. It shows he is loyal to Macbeth

C. It raises questions about leaving his family

D. It suggests he knew of the murder

Key: C (It raises questions about leaving his family)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Lady Macduff's line: “Poor _____, how thou talk’st!”

Key: prattler

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why might Shakespeare include a domestic scene at this point in the play?

A. To give the audience relief from the long story of war

B. To introduce a new main character

C. To explain Macduff's reasons for leaving

D. To show tyranny's reach into ordinary homes

Key: D (To show tyranny's reach into ordinary homes)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] How does the boy's defence of Macduff act as dramatic irony?

A. He defends a man he has just heard called a traitor

B. He knows his father has betrayed Macbeth

C. He knows the murderers are coming

D. He knows his mother lied about his father

Key: A (He defends a man he has just heard called a traitor)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Lady Macduff's judgment of the absent father of her children.

Sample answer: She argues that even a tiny wren would fight an owl for its nest, so his going away showed fear, not wisdom. Ross defends him as noble and wise. A strong answer weighs both views, considers what Macduff may have known, and argues how the audience's judgment of him is shaped by what happens to his family.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate how this scene affects the audience's view of Macbeth.

Sample answer: Until now, Macbeth's victims were rivals or threats. Here he kills a woman and her children who have done no harm, after hearing no prophecy against them. A strong answer argues that this act removes any remaining sympathy for him, and explains how the domestic warmth of the scene makes his tyranny unforgivable.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the messenger's 'I am too savage' reveal about ordinary people under Macbeth?
    A. Messengers enjoy bringing bad news to noble households
    B. Even warning someone feels dangerous and cruel
    C. The messenger works for the murderers
    D. The messenger has lost his reason

    Key: B (Even warning someone feels dangerous and cruel)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Lady Macduff with Lady Macbeth.
    Sample answer: Lady Macduff is a devoted mother who would fight like a wren for her children and who believes in honesty. Lady Macbeth claimed she would dash out her own baby's brains to keep a vow. A strong answer contrasts their values and roles and argues what the comparison reveals about the play's ideas of womanhood and power.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 4, inference 6, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene II develops the idea of the murder of the innocent. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act IV, Scene II” could deliver about the murder of the innocent. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the murder of the innocent in “Act IV, Scene II”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the murder of the innocent. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act IV, Scene II" could deliver about the murder of the innocent. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the murder of the innocent in "Act IV, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene II suggests about the murder of the innocent. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act IV, Scene II" could deliver about the murder of the innocent. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the murder of the innocent in "Act IV, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act IV, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the murder of the innocent. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act IV, Scene II" could deliver about the murder of the innocent. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the murder of the innocent in "Act IV, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *To fright you thus, methinks, I am too savage; To do worse to you were fell cruelty, Which is too nigh your person.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "methinks" most nearly mean?

   A. typical of a woman (in the period's view)

   B. distress; embarrassment

   C. showing good judgment

   D. it seems to me

2. *What had he done, to make him fly the land? You must have patience, madam. He had none: His flight was madness: when our actions do not, Our fears do make us traitors. You know not Whether it was his wisdom or his fear. Wisdom! to leave his wife, to leave his babes, His mansion and his titles in a place From whence himself does fly? He loves us not; He wants the natural touch: for the poor wren, The most diminutive of birds, will fight, Her young ones in her nest, against the owl. All is the fear and nothing is the love; As little is the wisdom, where the flight So runs against all reason.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene II"?

A. The murder of the innocent

B. The last false confidence

C. Suspicion spoken through irony

D. The tyrant's end and a new order

SAT key: 1. D (it seems to me); 2. A (The murder of the innocent)

Lesson 22: Act IV, Scene III

Focus: testing loyalty and the cost of grief

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “Act IV, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (grief for murdered family): Macduff learns his wife and children were killed. Give space for the emotion of the scene; the focus is grief and what strength means.
Suggested language: “What does Macduff mean by 'I must also feel it as a man'?”

Teacher only · spoilers

In England, Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and without any of the 'king-becoming graces.' When Macduff despairs ('O Scotland, Scotland!'), Malcolm reveals it was a test and that old Siward with ten thousand men is ready. A Doctor describes King Edward healing the sick by touch. Ross arrives and, after hesitating, tells Macduff his wife and children have been slaughtered. Macduff asks 'All my pretty ones?' and, told to 'dispute it like a man,' answers 'I shall do so; but I must also feel it as a man.' He vows to face Macbeth.

Background: The 'king's evil' (scrofula) was believed to be cured by a monarch's touch; James I continued the ceremony. The scene contrasts a healing king with a destroying one.

Significance: The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to masculinity and power because....
Prompt: What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to masculinity and power because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: transpose — to change; hoodwink — to deceive; to blind; rawness — haste that leaves people unprotected; demerits — faults; wrongdoings; whetstone — a stone for sharpening blades. “transpose”: Origin: Old French transposer; earlier Latin trānspositus. “hoodwink”: Origin: an English formation from hood + wink. “demerits”: Origin of “demerit”: Old French desmerite; earlier Latin dēmeritum.
Words: transpose: to change · hoodwink: to deceive; to blind · rawness: haste that leaves people unprotected · demerits: faults; wrongdoings · whetstone: a stone for sharpening blades

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The 'king's evil' (scrofula) was believed to be cured by a monarch's touch; James I continued the ceremony. The scene contrasts a healing king with a destroying one. The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii. Dialogue: Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and vicious; Macduff's despair proves his loyalty. Characterization: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Structure: The long scene in England sets up the counterforce. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” slowly and put it in my own words: Told his wife and children were killed, Macduff asks again and again whether all his pretty ones are dead. Next, craft. I notice the repeated "all," and the broken questions, which show shock and disbelief. The strongest word is “all”: it shows the totality of his loss, which he cannot take in. Then, effect. What does Macduff's reaction to the news show? My answer: Macduff's reaction to the news, repeating "all," shows a grief so complete that Malcolm's call to fight it like a man seems cold; Macduff vows to face Macbeth himself, setting up their final fight.

> *All my pretty ones? / Did you say all* *(Act IV, Scene III, lines 1986–1987)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” slowly and put it in my own words: Told his wife and children were killed, Macduff asks again and again whether all his pretty ones are dead. Next, craft. I notice the repeated "all," and the broken questions, which show shock and disbelief. The strongest word is “all”: it shows the totality of his loss, which he cannot take in. Then, effect. What does Macduff's reaction to the news show? My answer: Macduff's reaction to the news, repeating "all," shows a grief so complete that Malcolm's call to fight it like a man seems cold; Macduff vows to face Macbeth himself, setting up their final fight.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Dispute it like a man" stands out. Malcolm tells Macduff to answer his grief with action, as a soldier would. Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power? Expected student answer: Malcolm defines a man as one who fights back, but Macduff answers that he must also feel his loss as a man, so the line opens a fuller idea of manhood that includes grief.

> *Dispute it like a man (Act IV, Scene III, line 1990)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Dispute it like a man" stands out. Malcolm tells Macduff to answer his grief with action, as a soldier would.
Ask: How does this line connect to masculinity and power?
Expected student answer: Malcolm defines a man as one who fights back, but Macduff answers that he must also feel his loss as a man, so the line opens a fuller idea of manhood that includes grief.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. When the text says "Dispute it like a man" (Act IV, Scene III, line 1990), it shows this directly. Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man."
Task: Annotate the scene for dialogue, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. When the text says "Dispute it like a man" (Act IV, Scene III, line 1990), it shows this directly. Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed? Compare this with Lady Macbeth's "When you durst do it, then you were a man."
Anchor question: What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?
Facilitation: Compare this with Lady Macbeth's "When you durst do it, then you were a man."

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. ("Dispute it like a man", Act IV, Scene III, line 1990). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. ("Dispute it like a man", Act IV, Scene III, line 1990). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how dialogue shapes testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Key takeaway: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Dialogue:** Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and vicious; Macduff's despair proves his loyalty.
- **Characterization:** Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children."
- **Structure:** The long scene in England sets up the counterforce.

Themes and how they develop

- **masculinity and power:** "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "All my pretty ones? / Did you say all" (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1986–1987) Macduff's grief.
- "Dispute it like a man" (Act IV, Scene III, line 1990) Malcolm's advice.
- "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man" (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1991–1992) Macduff's redefinition of manhood.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness.
Evidence: "Dispute it like a man" (Act IV, Scene III, line 1990)
Reasoning: Told to "dispute it like a man," he replies "But I must also feel it as a man."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
transpose (verb)	to change	*But I shall crave your pardon; That which you are my thoughts cannot transpose: Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell: Though all things foul would wear the brows of grace, Yet grace must still look so.*	"transpose": Origin: Old French transposer; earlier Latin trānspositus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/transpose#Etymology)
hoodwink (verb)	to deceive; to blind	*But fear not yet To take upon you what is yours: you may Convey your pleasures in a spacious plenty, And yet seem cold, the time you may so hoodwink.*	"hoodwink": Origin: an English formation from hood + wink. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/hoodwink#Etymology)
rawness (noun)	haste that leaves people unprotected	*Why in that rawness left you wife and child, Those precious motives, those strong knots of love, Without leave-taking?*	
demerits (noun)	faults; wrongdoings	*Sinful Macduff, They were all struck for thee! naught that I am, Not for their own demerits, but for mine, Fell slaughter on their souls.*	"demerits": Origin of "demerit": Old French desmerite; earlier Latin dēmeritum. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/demerit#Etymology)
whetstone (noun)	a stone for sharpening blades	*Be this the whetstone of your sword: let grief Convert to anger; blunt not the heart, enrage it.*	
lowliness (noun)	humility	*But I have none: the king-becoming graces, As justice, verity, temperance, stableness, Bounty, perseverance, mercy, lowliness, Devotion, patience, courage, fortitude, I have no relish of them, but abound In the division of each several crime, Acting it many ways.*	
blisters (verb)	raises sores on (an image of disgust)	*This tyrant, whose sole name blisters our tongues, Was once thought honest: you have loved him well: He hath not touch'd you yet.*	

niggard (noun)	a miser; one who holds back	*But not a niggard of your speech: how goes't?*	
grafted (adjective)	firmly planted; fixed deep	*It is myself I mean: in whom I know All the particulars of vice so grafted That, when they shall be open'd, black Macbeth Will seem as pure as snow, and the poor state Esteem him as a lamb, being compared With my confineless harms.*	
motives (noun)	people or things that move someone to act (here, Macduff's family)	*Why in that rawness left you wife and child, Those precious motives, those strong knots of love, Without leave-taking?*	

Discussion questions

1. What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Macduff vow at the end of the scene? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To bring Macbeth within his sword's length, 'front to front.'
   Answer guidance: To bring Macbeth within his sword's length, 'front to front.'.
2. Why does Malcolm pretend to be wicked? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To test whether Macduff is loyal or Macbeth's agent
   Answer guidance: To test whether Macduff is loyal or Macbeth's agent.
3. What does King Edward do for the sick? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Heals them by touch
   Answer guidance: Heals them by touch.
4. What news does Ross bring Macduff? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** His wife and children have been slaughtered
   Answer guidance: His wife and children have been slaughtered.
5. How does Macduff answer the call to 'dispute it like a man'? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He must also feel it as a man
   Answer guidance: He must also feel it as a man.

6. How many men does Malcolm say Siward has? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Ten thousand

   Answer guidance: Ten thousand.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act IV, Scene III" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** In England, Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and without any of the 'king-becoming graces.' When Macduff despairs ('O Scotland, Scotland!'), Malcolm reveals it was a test and that old Siward with ten thousand men is ready. A Doctor describes King Edward healing the sick by touch. Ross arrives and, after hesitating, tells Macduff his wife and children have been slaughtered…

   Answer guidance: In England, Malcolm tests Macduff by claiming to be lustful, greedy and without any of the 'king-becoming graces.' When Macduff despairs ('O Scotland, Scotland!'), Malcolm reveals it was a test and that old Siward with ten thousand men is ready. A Doctor describes King Edward healing the sick by touch. Ross arrives and, after hesitating, tells Macduff his wife and children have been slaughtered…
8. Who is on stage in "Act IV, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act IV, Scene III" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "But I shall crave your pardon; That which you are my thoughts cannot transpose: Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell: Though all things foul would wear the brows of grace, Yet grace must still look so." What does "transpose" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** transpose: to change.

    Answer guidance: transpose: to change.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Ross hesitate before telling Macduff the news? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** He fears the pain it will cause and perhaps the blame for Macduff's absence.

   Answer guidance: He fears the pain it will cause and perhaps the blame for Macduff's absence.
2. What does "Act IV, Scene III" suggest about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii.

   Answer guidance: The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii. Evidence to accept: "All my pretty ones? / Did you say all" (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1986–1987): Macduff's grief. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of characterization in “Act IV, Scene III”. What does it reveal about testing loyalty and the cost of grief that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them. Evidence to accept: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, line 1990): Malcolm's advice. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the conflict in “Act IV, Scene III” shape what we understand about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1986–1987): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “What I believe I’ll…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1991–1992): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act IV, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Ross's news to Macduff and Macduff's turn from grief to resolve; evidence: “But I must also feel it as a man”.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Ross's news to Macduff and Macduff's turn from grief to resolve; evidence: “But I must also feel it as a man”. Evidence to accept: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1986–1987): Macduff's grief. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Act IV, Scene III” build on “Act IV, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, line 1990): Malcolm's advice. On structure: The long scene in England sets up the counterforce. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Act IV, Scene III”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about testing loyalty and the cost of grief, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1991–1992): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. On characterization: Ross

brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (What does it mean to 'be a man' or to be strong? Has the meaning changed?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, line 1990): Malcolm's advice. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does theme appear in “Act IV, Scene III”, and how does it connect testing loyalty and the cost of grief to the larger concern with ambition and its costs? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1986–1987): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Malcolm's test fair to Macduff? Is it a sign that Malcolm will be a good king? Argue. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** An evaluation of Malcolm's caution and its cost.
   Answer guidance: An evaluation of Malcolm's caution and its cost.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The long test scene defines good kingship, and Macduff's grief redefines manhood: feeling is not weakness. This answers Lady Macbeth's use of manhood in I.vii. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1991–1992): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act IV, Scene III” acts most wisely in the matter of testing loyalty and the cost of grief, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1986–1987): Macduff's grief. On characterization: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act IV, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, line 1990): Malcolm's advice. On structure: The long scene in England sets up the counterforce. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write your own questions about “Act IV, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1991–1992): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect “Act IV, Scene III”, with its focus on testing loyalty and the cost of grief, to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1986–1987): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in “Act IV, Scene III” effective in presenting testing loyalty and the cost of grief, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, line 1990): Malcolm's advice. On characterization: Ross brings news of the slaughter; Macduff's grief: "He has no children." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Act IV, Scene III” treats testing loyalty and the cost of grief with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man” (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1991–1992): Macduff's redefinition of manhood. Theme link: "Dispute it

like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene I” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “All my pretty ones? / Did you say all” (Act IV, Scene III, lines 1986–1987): Macduff's grief. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act IV, Scene III” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about testing loyalty and the cost of grief? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macduff redefines manhood to include grief, against the Macbeths' definition of manhood as ruthlessness. Useful evidence: “Dispute it like a man” (Act IV, Scene III, line 1990): Malcolm's advice. Theme link: "Dispute it like a man." "I shall do so; / But I must also feel it as a man." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does this scene take place?
   A. Before the King's palace in England
   B. Macduff's castle in Fife, at night
   C. The palace hall at Forres
   D. A heath near Birnam

   Key: A (Before the King's palace in England)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Malcolm first suggest he and Macduff do?
   A. Ride straight back to Scotland
   B. Find a lonely shade and weep
   C. Write a letter to Macbeth
   D. Ask the Witches for advice

   Key: B (Find a lonely shade and weep)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff say greets each new morning in Scotland?
   A. Bells ring for the new king's health

B. Soldiers march to Dunsinane hill

C. New widows howl and new orphans cry

D. Farmers plant their fields again

Key: C (New widows howl and new orphans cry)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Macduff's line: “Such welcome and unwelcome things at once ’Tis hard to _____”

   Key: reconcile

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Malcolm say he will put himself under?

   A. King Edward's command alone

   B. The Witches' guidance

   C. Siward's son's orders

   D. Macduff's direction

   Key: D (Macduff's direction)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who enters to say the English king is healing sick people?

   A. A Doctor

   B. A Messenger

   C. Lennox

   D. Seyton

   Key: A (A Doctor)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What ironic answer does Ross first give when Macduff asks about his wife?

   A. She is dead

   B. Why, well

   C. I do not know

   D. She has fled

   Key: B (Why, well)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Malcolm urge Macduff to make of his grief?

   A. A song of mourning for Fife

   B. A prayer for peace

   C. Medicines of revenge

   D. A reason to go home

   Key: C (Medicines of revenge)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Ross describe the state of Scotland?

   Sample answer: He says Scotland is almost afraid to know itself and can no longer be called a mother, only a grave. No one smiles but those who know nothing, and shrieks fill the air unnoticed. Bells toll so often that nobody asks who has died, and good men die before the flowers in their caps wither.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Macduff react when he first hears the terrible news from Fife?

    Sample answer: At first he cannot speak and pulls his hat over his brows. Then he asks again and again whether all his

children and his wife were killed, calling Macbeth a hell-kite who took his pretty chickens at one fell swoop. He blames himself, saying they died because of him, and begs heaven to bring him face to face with Macbeth.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Malcolm suggest by "To offer up a weak poor innocent lamb To appease an angry god"?
    A. Macduff might betray him to Macbeth
    B. Malcolm wants to give an offering at church
    C. Macduff should sacrifice his own children
    D. The English king is angry with Scotland

    Key: A (Macduff might betray him to Macbeth)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does "Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell" mean?
    A. Angels are no longer bright since the first one fell
    B. One fallen angel does not make all angels bad
    C. Macduff is an angel sent from heaven
    D. Malcolm thinks he himself has fallen

    Key: B (One fallen angel does not make all angels bad)

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What vices does Malcolm first claim to have?
    A. Laziness and cowardice
    B. Pride and foolishness
    C. Endless lust and greed
    D. Drunkenness and sloth

    Key: C (Endless lust and greed)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macduff answer Malcolm's first confession?
    A. He walks away at once
    B. He calls Malcolm a liar
    C. He agrees to crown Macbeth
    D. He says it can be managed

    Key: D (He says it can be managed)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Malcolm's line: "Pour the sweet milk of _____ into hell"

    Key: concord

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macduff mean by "O Scotland, Scotland!"?
    A. He despairs for his country's future
    B. He celebrates a victory at home
    C. He is calling to soldiers in Scotland
    D. He is naming the king of Scotland

    Key: A (He despairs for his country's future)

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Malcolm admit after Macduff's despairing speech?
    A. He truly is as wicked as he said

B. His confessions were false

C. He will stay in England

D. He fears Macduff's sword

Key: B (His confessions were false)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “Give sorrow words” advise?

A. Write sorrowful poems in memory of the dead

B. Keep sorrow silent and hidden

C. Speak grief aloud or it will break the heart

D. Ask others to speak for you

Key: C (Speak grief aloud or it will break the heart)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Ross lead up to the news from Fife, and what does the delay show?

Sample answer: Ross first says the family is well and at peace, which is true only in the sense that they are dead. He speaks of rumours of rebellion and the need for help before admitting he has words that should be howled in the desert. The slow approach shows his own sorrow and how hard it is to say such words aloud to a friend.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Malcolm describe King Edward, and why is it important?

Sample answer: Malcolm says Edward cures people swollen with the evil by touch, hanging a golden stamp about their necks with holy prayers. He has a heavenly gift of prophecy and blessings around his throne. Edward is a picture of a good king whose power heals, in sharp contrast to Macbeth, whose rule makes his country sick.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Malcolm mean by “A good and virtuous nature may recoil In an imperial charge”?

A. A royal command can make good men do evil

B. Good men refuse royal orders that they think are wrong

C. Virtuous men make the best soldiers

D. Imperial power makes men virtuous

Key: A (A royal command can make good men do evil)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Malcolm describe himself as worse than Macbeth?

A. Because he truly is more wicked

B. To see whether Macduff will refuse him

C. To scare Macduff into returning home to his family

D. To win the trust of King Edward

Key: B (To see whether Macduff will refuse him)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about Ross's answer that Macduff's family is 'well at peace'?

A. They have fled to England in safety with their servants

B. They have made peace with Macbeth

C. They are at peace because they are dead

D. They are sleeping soundly in Fife

Key: C (They are at peace because they are dead)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macduff's "He has no children" most likely refer to?

    A. Ross has no family in Fife

    B. Ross does not know the pain of a father

    C. King Edward has no heirs

    D. Macbeth cannot feel such a loss

    Key: D (Macbeth cannot feel such a loss)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macduff's line: "All my pretty chickens and their dam At one fell _____?"

    Key: swoop

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macduff's "I must also feel it as a man" reveal?

    A. True manhood includes deep feeling

    B. Men should not show emotion in public

    C. He is ashamed of his tears

    D. He wishes he were a woman so he could weep

    Key: A (True manhood includes deep feeling)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Malcolm mean by "Be this the whetstone of your sword"?

    A. Use a stone to sharpen his blade before the battle

    B. Let grief sharpen his will to fight

    C. Let grief make him gentle

    D. Throw his sword away in grief

    Key: B (Let grief sharpen his will to fight)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does "The night is long that never finds the day" suggest?

    A. The night will last for a long time

    B. They must travel through the long night to Scotland

    C. Darkness will end and hope will return

    D. They will not live to see daylight

    Key: C (Darkness will end and hope will return)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze Malcolm's false confession of vices.

    Sample answer: Malcolm, wary of traps the tyrant has set before, claims to be full of lust, greed and every vice, worse even than the man he wants to replace. Macduff excuses the first two sins but finally despairs and refuses to support such a man. His refusal proves he serves Scotland rather than power, so Malcolm takes back every false charge.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze the contrast between Edward and Macbeth in this scene.

    Sample answer: Edward heals the sick with a holy touch, has a gift of prophecy and passes his blessing to his heirs. Macbeth, in contrast, kills, makes his land sick and has no heirs. A strong answer shows how this image of healing kingship defines the good ruler that Malcolm must become.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Malcolm's list of 'king-becoming graces' define?

    A. The virtues a true king should have

    B. The vices Macbeth has shown in his reign

    C. The skills needed in battle

    D. The duties of a thane

    Key: A (The virtues a true king should have)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Shakespeare use the long test scene structurally?

    A. It speeds up the play's ending toward the battle

    B. It delays the news to build tension

    C. It provides a comic interlude

    D. It shows Malcolm is a tyrant

    Key: B (It delays the news to build tension)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does “Did heaven look on, And would not take their part?” raise a question?

    A. Why did Macduff leave England

    B. Why does Malcolm doubt him

    C. Why does heaven allow innocent suffering

    D. Why is Edward a healer

    Key: C (Why does heaven allow innocent suffering)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Malcolm's line: “Macbeth Is ripe for _____”

    Key: shaking

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Macduff's grief answer Lady Macbeth's earlier ideas of manhood?

    A. It shows men must hide all feeling

    B. It proves Lady Macbeth was right

    C. It shows grief is a sign of weakness

    D. It shows feeling is part of being a man

    Key: D (It shows feeling is part of being a man)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Ross's image “good men’s lives Expire before the flowers in their caps” work?

    A. It contrasts quick death with brief life

    B. It describes a spring festival

    C. It praises soldiers' bravery

    D. It recalls the flowers at Duncan's royal funeral

    Key: A (It contrasts quick death with brief life)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Malcolm's deception of Macduff is justified.

    Sample answer: Malcolm lies about himself to test Macduff's honesty because Macbeth has sent agents to trap him before. A strong answer weighs the need for caution under tyranny against the cost of deceiving a loyal man, and considers what the test shows about Malcolm as a future king who has learned to look past appearances.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate how this scene prepares for the play's final act.
    Sample answer: It brings together Malcolm, Macduff, Ross and the promise of Siward's ten thousand men. It defines good kingship through Edward and gives Macduff a personal reason to face Macbeth. A strong answer argues how the scene shifts the play from Macbeth's tyranny to the rising forces of justice and revenge.
39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macduff's self-blame, 'Sinful Macduff', suggest about his character?
    A. He thinks he is a worse man than Macbeth
    B. He feels responsible for leaving his family
    C. He has committed a secret crime
    D. He blames Malcolm for the deaths

    Key: B (He feels responsible for leaving his family)
40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Macduff's response to loss with Macbeth's response to his own crimes.
    Sample answer: Macduff openly grieves, blames himself and turns sorrow into a resolve to face Macbeth. Macbeth hides his guilt, fears his visions and commits new crimes to escape fear. A strong answer argues that Macduff's honest grief makes him a moral counterweight to Macbeth.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 3, inference 7, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act IV, Scene III develops the idea of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act IV, Scene III” could deliver about testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for testing loyalty and the cost of grief in “Act IV, Scene III”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act IV, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act IV, Scene III" could deliver about testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for testing loyalty and the cost of grief in "Act IV, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act IV, Scene III suggests about testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act IV, Scene III" could deliver about testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for testing loyalty and the cost of grief in "Act IV, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses characterization in Act IV, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act IV, Scene III" could deliver about testing loyalty and the cost of grief. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for testing loyalty and the cost of grief in "Act IV, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Sinful Macduff, They were all struck for thee! naught that I am, Not for their own demerits, but for mine, Fell slaughter on their souls.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "demerits" most nearly mean?

   A. faults; wrongdoings

   B. firmly planted; fixed deep

   C. people or things that move someone to act (here, Macduff's family)

D. a miser; one who holds back

2. *What I believe I'll wail, What know believe, and what I can redress, As I shall find the time to friend, I will. What you have spoke, it may be so perchance. This tyrant, whose sole name blisters our tongues, Was once thought honest: you have loved him well: He hath not touch'd you yet. I am young; but something You may deserve of him through me, and wisdom To offer up a weak poor innocent lamb To appease an angry god. I am not treacherous. But Macbeth is. A good and virtuous nature may recoil In an imperial charge. But I shall crave your pardon; That which you are my thoughts cannot transpose: Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell: Though all things foul would wear the brows of grace, Yet grace must still look so. I have lost my hopes. Perchance even there where I did find my doubts. Why in that rawness left you wife and child, Those precious motives, those strong knots of love, Without leave-taking? I pray you, Let not my jealousies be your dishonours, But mine own safeties. You may be rightly just, Whatever I shall think. Bleed, bleed, poor country! Great tyranny! lay thou thy basis sure, For goodness dare not cheque thee: wear thou thy wrongs; The title is affeer'd! Fare thee well, lord: I would not be the villain that thou think'st For the whole space that's in the tyrant's grasp, And the rich East to boot.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act IV, Scene III"?

A. The hidden mind behind a loyal face

B. The Witches' greetings and their pull

C. The cast and world of the play

D. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief

SAT key: 1. A (faults; wrongdoings); 2. D (Testing loyalty and the cost of grief)

Lesson 23: Act V, Scene I

Focus: the guilt that will not wash away

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Act V, Scene I" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide (mentioned in lesson text)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.

Teacher only · spoilers

A Doctor and a Gentlewoman watch Lady Macbeth sleepwalk with a taper; she has light by her continually, by her own command. She rubs her hands as if washing them ('Out, damned spot!'), recalls the murder of Duncan ('who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him?'), Lady Macduff ('The Thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?') and Banquo, and says 'What's done cannot be undone.' The Doctor says she needs 'the divine' more than the physician.

Background: Lady Macbeth speaks in prose here, though earlier she spoke commanding verse; prose often marks madness or loss of control in Shakespeare.

Significance: The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: what she suppressed now speaks.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: discharge — to unload; to pour out; troubles — worries; whisperings — rumors spoken quietly; sweeten — to make smell pleasant; perfumes — sweet-smelling liquids. "troubles": Origin of "trouble": Old French troubler; earlier Latin turbula ("disorderly group").
Words: discharge: to unload; to pour out · troubles: worries · whisperings: rumors spoken quietly · sweeten: to make smell pleasant · perfumes: sweet-smelling liquids

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Lady Macbeth speaks in prose here, though earlier she spoke commanding verse; prose often marks madness or loss of control in Shakespeare. The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments. Characterization: Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose. Structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Imagery: Blood, the smell of blood, "all the perfumes of Arabia." Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Out, damned spot! out, I say" slowly and put it in my own words: Sleepwalking, Lady Macbeth tries to rub away an imaginary spot of blood from her hand. Next, craft. I notice the frantic commands, "Out, damned spot! out, I say," spoken to something that is not there. The strongest word is "spot": the tiny stain stands for guilt she cannot wash away. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking show about her? My answer: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking shows that she is broken by guilt; the woman who said "a little water clears us of this deed" now reveals in her sleep what her waking self hid.

> *Out, damned spot! out, I say* *(Act V, Scene I, line 2031)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Out, damned spot! out, I say" slowly and put it in my own words: Sleepwalking, Lady Macbeth tries to rub away an imaginary spot of blood from her hand. Next, craft. I notice the frantic commands, "Out, damned spot! out, I say," spoken to something that is not there. The strongest word is "spot": the tiny stain stands for guilt she cannot wash away. Then, effect. What does Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking show about her? My answer: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking shows that she is broken by guilt; the woman who said "a little water clears us of this deed" now reveals in her sleep what her waking self hid.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Smell of the blood", "perfumes of Arabia" and "little hand" stand out. All the world's perfume cannot hide one small hand's smell, so her guilt feels beyond any cure. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected student answer: In her sleep Lady Macbeth says what she once denied, so the line shows guilt she had pushed down now coming out in her own words.

> *Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand (Act V, Scene I, line 2036)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Smell of the blood", "perfumes of Arabia" and "little hand" stand out. All the world's perfume cannot hide one small hand's smell, so her guilt feels beyond any cure.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected student answer: In her sleep Lady Macbeth says what she once denied, so the line shows guilt she had pushed down now coming out in her own words.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of the guilt that will not wash away. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. When the text says "Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand" (Act V, Scene I, line 2036), it shows this directly. She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of the guilt that will not wash away. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. When the text says "Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand" (Act V, Scene I, line 2036), it shows this directly. She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it? Ask what the Doctor and Gentlewoman add as witnesses.
Anchor question: Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?
Facilitation: Ask what the Doctor and Gentlewoman add as witnesses.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. ("Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand", Act V, Scene I, line 2036). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. ("Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand", Act V, Scene I, line 2036). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the guilt that will not wash away. Key takeaway: what she suppressed now speaks.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose.
- **Structure:** She speaks prose; her verse control is gone.
- **Imagery:** Blood, the smell of blood, "all the perfumes of Arabia."

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** what she suppressed now speaks.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Out, damned spot! out, I say" (Act V, Scene I, line 2031) Guilt as stain.
- "Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand" (Act V, Scene I, line 2036) Echoes Macbeth's ocean.
- "What's done cannot be undone" (Act V, Scene I, line 2044) Echo of "what's done is done."

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away.
Evidence: "Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand" (Act V, Scene I, line 2036)
Reasoning: She once said "A little water clears us of this deed," but now cries "all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
discharge (verb)	to unload; to pour out	*Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.*	
troubles (noun)	worries	*Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.*	"troubles": Origin of "trouble": Old French troubler; earlier Latin turbula ("disorderly group"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/trouble#Etymology)
whisperings (noun)	rumors spoken quietly	*Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.*	
sweeten (verb)	to make smell pleasant	*Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand.*	

perfumes (noun)	sweet-smelling liquids	*Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand.*	
performances (noun)	actions; things done	*In this slumbery agitation, besides her walking and other actual performances, what, at any time, have you heard her say?*	
perturbation (noun)	a disturbance; upset	*A great perturbation in nature, to receive at once the benefit of sleep, and do the effects of watching!*	
infected (adjective)	diseased; corrupted	*Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician.*	"infected": Origin of "infect": Middle French infect; earlier Latin infectus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/infect#Etymology)
annoyance (noun)	harm; injury	*Look after her; Remove from her the means of all annoyance, And still keep eyes upon her.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Who watches Lady Macbeth sleepwalk? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A Doctor of Physic and a Waiting-Gentlewoman.
   Answer guidance: A Doctor of Physic and a Waiting-Gentlewoman.
2. What does Lady Macbeth do while sleepwalking? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Rubs her hands as if washing them
   Answer guidance: Rubs her hands as if washing them.
3. What does she keep by her continually? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A light
   Answer guidance: A light.

4. Whom does she mean by 'The Thane of Fife had a wife'? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Lady Macduff
   Answer guidance: Lady Macduff.
5. What does she say about what's done? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It cannot be undone
   Answer guidance: It cannot be undone.
6. What does the Doctor say she needs more than a physician? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The divine (a priest)
   Answer guidance: The divine (a priest).
7. Retell the most important events of "Act V, Scene I" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A Doctor and a Gentlewoman watch Lady Macbeth sleepwalk with a taper; she has light by her continually, by her own command. She rubs her hands as if washing them ('Out, damned spot!'), recalls the murder of Duncan ('who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him?'), Lady Macduff ('The Thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?') and Banquo, and says 'What's done cannot be…
   Answer guidance: A Doctor and a Gentlewoman watch Lady Macbeth sleepwalk with a taper; she has light by her continually, by her own command. She rubs her hands as if washing them ('Out, damned spot!'), recalls the murder of Duncan ('who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him?'), Lady Macduff ('The Thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?') and Banquo, and says 'What's done cannot be…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene I", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act V, Scene I" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Foul whisperings are abroad: unnatural deeds Do breed unnatural troubles: infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets: More needs she the divine than the physician." What does "discharge" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** discharge: to unload; to pour out.
    Answer guidance: discharge: to unload; to pour out.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Lady Macbeth now need a light, when in Act I she called for 'thick night'? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Darkness, once her ally, now terrifies her: guilt has reversed her.
   Answer guidance: Darkness, once her ally, now terrifies her: guilt has reversed her.
2. What does "Act V, Scene I" suggest about the guilt that will not wash away? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait

5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments.

Answer guidance: The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments. Evidence to accept: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, line 2031): Guilt as stain. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of imagery in “Act V, Scene I”. What does it reveal about the guilt that will not wash away that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, line 2036): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the symbolism in “Act V, Scene I” shape what we understand about the guilt that will not wash away? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, line 2031): Guilt as stain. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “What is it she…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, line 2044): Echo of "what's done is done." Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking confession of what she once denied; evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say!”

   Answer guidance: Look for: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking confession of what she once denied; evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say!”. Evidence to accept: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, line 2031): Guilt as stain. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Act V, Scene I” build on “Act IV, Scene III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, line 2036): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. On structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Act V, Scene I”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the guilt that will not wash away, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that

builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, line 2044): Echo of "what's done is done." On characterization: Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Can people truly escape guilt by refusing to think about it?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, line 2036): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does structure appear in “Act V, Scene I”, and how does it connect the guilt that will not wash away to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, line 2031): Guilt as stain. On structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the sleepwalking scene a punishment, a confession or a cry for help? Defend your reading. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** An interpretive judgment with evidence.

   Answer guidance: An interpretive judgment with evidence.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The scene reverses II.ii: water no longer clears her, darkness frightens her, and her buried guilt surfaces. Her lines replay the play's crimes in fragments. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, line 2044): Echo of "what's done is done." Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in “Act V, Scene I” acts most wisely in the matter of the guilt that will not wash away, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier

confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, line 2031): Guilt as stain. On characterization: Lady Macbeth sleepwalks, washing her hands, reliving the murders in prose. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene I”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the guilt that will not wash away. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, line 2036): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. On structure: She speaks prose; her verse control is gone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act V, Scene I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, line 2044): Echo of "what's done is done." Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act V, Scene I”, with its focus on the guilt that will not wash away, to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, line 2031): Guilt as stain. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in “Act V, Scene I” effective in presenting the guilt that will not wash away, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, line 2036): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. On imagery: Blood, the smell of blood, "all the perfumes of Arabia." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene I” treats the guilt that will not wash away with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “What’s done cannot be undone” (Act V, Scene I, line 2044): Echo of "what's done is done." Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene II” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Out, damned spot! out, I say” (Act V, Scene I, line 2031): Guilt as stain. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act V, Scene I” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the guilt that will not wash away? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking reverses her earlier confidence that guilt could be washed away. Useful evidence: “Here’s the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand” (Act V, Scene I, line 2036): Echoes Macbeth's ocean. Theme link: what she suppressed now speaks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where do the Doctor and Gentlewoman keep watch?
   A. An ante-room in the castle at Dunsinane
   B. Before the King's palace in England, by day
   C. Macduff's castle in Fife
   D. The heath near Forres

   Key: A (An ante-room in the castle at Dunsinane)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How many nights has the Doctor watched?
   A. Five
   B. Two
   C. One
   D. Seven

   Key: B (Two)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has the Gentlewoman seen Lady Macbeth write while asleep?

   A. A list of the thanes' names

   B. A letter to Malcolm in England

   C. A paper she folds and seals

   D. A prayer for her husband

   Key: C (A paper she folds and seals)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the Gentlewoman's line: "You see, her eyes are open. Ay, but their sense is _____"

   Key: shut

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why won't the Gentlewoman repeat what she has heard?

   A. She has forgotten every word

   B. She has sworn an oath to the king

   C. She cannot understand the words

   D. She has no witness to confirm it

   Key: D (She has no witness to confirm it)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How long has the Gentlewoman known the hand-washing to go on?

   A. A quarter of an hour

   B. All night long until dawn

   C. Only a moment or two

   D. Several hours at a time

   Key: A (A quarter of an hour)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Doctor decide to do when Lady Macbeth speaks?

   A. Wake her up at once

   B. Write down what she says

   C. Call for the king

   D. Leave the room quietly and pray

   Key: B (Write down what she says)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Doctor tell the Gentlewoman to do at the end?

   A. Send for Macbeth at once

   B. Lock her in her room

   C. Keep watching her closely

   D. Give her a sleeping drink

   Key: C (Keep watching her closely)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does the Gentlewoman describe Lady Macbeth doing at night?

   Sample answer: Since Macbeth went to war, she has seen her rise from bed, throw on her nightgown, unlock her closet, take out paper, fold it, write on it, read it, seal it and return to bed, all while fast asleep. The Doctor calls this a great disturbance in nature, sleeping and acting as if awake at once.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Doctor say he dares not speak at the end of the scene?

    Sample answer: He has heard Lady Macbeth reveal the murders of Duncan, Lady Macduff and Banquo in her sleep. Knowing such secrets about the king and queen is dangerous, so he keeps quiet. He says his mind is confused and his sight amazed. His fear shows how Macbeth's tyranny silences even those who learn the truth.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Doctor mean by "A great perturbation in nature"?

    A. Sleeping while acting awake is unnatural
    B. A storm has broken out over the castle tonight
    C. Lady Macbeth has caught a fever
    D. The seasons have turned strange

    Key: A (Sleeping while acting awake is unnatural)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which earlier moment does "Fie, my lord, fie! a soldier, and afeard?" echo?

    A. Macbeth's speech to the murderers about Banquo's line
    B. Her scorn of Macbeth's fear after Duncan's murder
    C. Banquo's last words in the park
    D. The Porter's jokes at the gate

    Key: B (Her scorn of Macbeth's fear after Duncan's murder)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does "who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him" show?

    A. She is worried about an old servant
    B. She thinks Duncan is still alive
    C. The memory of Duncan's murder haunts her
    D. She is reading a letter about a battle in the north

    Key: C (The memory of Duncan's murder haunts her)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does "you mar all with this starting" recall?

    A. Macbeth's fight with Macdonwald
    B. Macbeth's letter to his wife
    C. Macbeth's visit to the Witches
    D. Macbeth's fits at the banquet

    Key: D (Macbeth's fits at the banquet)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Lady Macbeth's line: "Banquo's buried; he cannot come out on's _____"

    Key: grave

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Doctor mean by "The heart is sorely charged"?

    A. Her heart is heavily burdened
    B. Her heart is beating too fast
    C. She is about to die tonight

D. She has been accused in court

Key: A (Her heart is heavily burdened)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Gentlewoman mean by not wanting such a heart "for the dignity of the whole body"?

A. She would like to be the queen

B. Not even being queen would be worth such guilt

C. She envies Lady Macbeth's wealth

D. She fears for her own health

Key: B (Not even being queen would be worth such guilt)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does Lady Macbeth's sleeping cry about knocking at the gate recall?

A. Macduff's knock at the gate of his castle in Fife

B. The Witches' arrival

C. The knocking after Duncan's murder

D. The murderers' arrival

Key: C (The knocking after Duncan's murder)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How do Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking words reveal her guilt?

Sample answer: She tries to rub away a spot, remembers the time to do the deed, scolds her husband for fear, recalls Duncan's blood, asks where Macduff's wife is and insists Banquo is buried. Her broken sentences jump between the crimes, showing that the memories she pushed down while awake now torment her in sleep.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Lady Macbeth's condition here contrast with her strength in Act I?

Sample answer: In Act I she called on spirits to fill her with cruelty and told her husband that a little water would clear them of the deed. Now she cannot sleep, cannot stop washing and cannot escape her memories. The woman who seemed fearless has been destroyed by the guilt she once dismissed.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does Shakespeare have Lady Macbeth speak in prose in this scene?

A. Her broken mind no longer orders its speech

B. Prose shows she has become a commoner since the war

C. She is reading aloud from a letter

D. Prose is required for sleeping characters

Key: A (Her broken mind no longer orders its speech)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does "Hell is murky!" reveal her state of mind?

A. She is describing the dark castle

B. She fears the damnation awaiting her

C. She is quoting the Porter's joke

D. She longs for the darkness of night to hide her deeds

Key: B (She fears the damnation awaiting her)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What irony lies in "What need we fear who knows it, when none can call our power to account?"

    A. No one has ever learned of the murder

    B. She is speaking to Macbeth directly

    C. The secret is now being heard by witnesses

    D. She has confessed to the Doctor

    Key: C (The secret is now being heard by witnesses)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the Doctor mean by "infected minds To their deaf pillows will discharge their secrets"?

    A. Sick patients need softer pillows

    B. Secrets spread like a plague

    C. Pillows can somehow hear the sleeper's private thoughts

    D. Guilty people reveal their secrets in sleep

    Key: D (Guilty people reveal their secrets in sleep)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Doctor's line: "Foul whisperings are _____"

    Key: abroad

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does "Remove from her the means of all annoyance" suggest?

    A. The Doctor fears she may harm herself

    B. The Doctor wants her room cleaned

    C. The Doctor wants her kept far away from all noise

    D. The Doctor fears she may run away

    Key: A (The Doctor fears she may harm herself)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How do the Doctor and Gentlewoman function in the scene?

    A. As comic characters easing tension

    B. As witnesses whose reactions guide the audience

    C. As spies sent by Malcolm

    D. As accomplices in the murders

    Key: B (As witnesses whose reactions guide the audience)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the Doctor's "My mind she has mated, and amazed my sight" reveal?

    A. He has fallen in love with the queen he is watching

    B. He has lost his eyesight

    C. He is stunned and confused by what he saw

    D. He plans to marry the Gentlewoman

    Key: C (He is stunned and confused by what he saw)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the sleepwalking scene replays earlier crimes.

    Sample answer: Her words move through the murder of Duncan, with the time to do it, the old man's blood and the knocking at the gate; the slaughter of Lady Macduff; and Banquo's burial. Each line returns to a scene the audience has witnessed. Her mind replays the play's crimes in fragments, showing guilt that cannot be escaped.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze the Doctor's final speech.
    Sample answer: He says unnatural deeds breed unnatural troubles and that infected minds tell their secrets to deaf pillows. He tells the Gentlewoman to remove anything she might hurt herself with and to watch her. He ends saying he thinks but dares not speak, showing how fear silences people under tyranny and hinting at a tragic end.
31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the scene suggest about the relationship between body and conscience?
    A. Guilt drives the body even in sleep
    B. The body is free of the mind in sleep
    C. Conscience fades as the body rests
    D. Sleep cleanses the body of guilt

    Key: A (Guilt drives the body even in sleep)
32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the scene invert the symbolism of water in Lady Macbeth's earlier advice?
    A. Water is now poisoned by the Witches
    B. Water can no longer clean her guilt
    C. She now refuses all water
    D. She has learned to love washing

    Key: B (Water can no longer clean her guilt)
33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why might Shakespeare have Lady Macbeth's final appearance be without her husband?
    A. It shows she has left the castle
    B. It reveals that Macbeth is dead
    C. It stresses how isolated the couple has become
    D. It shows she has joined the rebels

    Key: C (It stresses how isolated the couple has become)
34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Doctor's line: “This disease is beyond my _____”
    Key: practice
35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the Doctor's “God, God forgive us all!” widen the scene's meaning?
    A. It shows the Doctor is guilty of murder
    B. It is a joke at the queen's expense to ease the Gentlewoman
    C. It shows he is leaving the castle
    D. It suggests all share in human sinfulness

    Key: D (It suggests all share in human sinfulness)
36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Lady Macbeth's habit of writing and sealing a paper symbolize?
    A. Her mind repeats secret actions she cannot escape
    B. She is writing a will for Fleance
    C. She is planning to flee to England
    D. She is writing to the Witches

Key: A (Her mind repeats secret actions she cannot escape)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate how the sleepwalking scene completes Lady Macbeth's arc.

    Sample answer: In Act I she was the stronger partner, calling on spirits and mocking her husband's fear. In this scene she is alone, unable to sleep, washing hands that will never be clean and replaying every crime. A strong answer argues whether her collapse is punishment, the return of a suppressed conscience, or both.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the role of the observers' silence in the scene.

    Sample answer: The Doctor and Gentlewoman hear the queen confess to murders, yet both refuse to repeat what they heard. A strong answer considers how their fear reflects the danger of speaking under Macbeth, how it builds dramatic irony since the audience knows everything, and how their silence contrasts with Lady Macbeth's unwilling confession.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which feature of her speech most clearly signals a mind in fragments?

    A. Long, carefully reasoned arguments about her husband

    B. Sudden jumps between unrelated memories

    C. Formal rhymed couplets

    D. Polite greetings to the Doctor

    Key: B (Sudden jumps between unrelated memories)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Lady Macbeth's sleepwalking with Macbeth's visions.

    Sample answer: Macbeth saw a dagger and a ghost while awake and spoke his fears aloud. Lady Macbeth hid her fear while awake, but now it emerges in sleep. A strong answer compares how each partner's guilt surfaces, and argues what the difference suggests about how they handled their crimes.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 9, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene I develops the idea of the guilt that will not wash away. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene I” could deliver about the guilt that will not wash away. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the guilt that will not wash away in “Act V, Scene I”: each member takes one passage, quotes

it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the guilt that will not wash away. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene I" could deliver about the guilt that will not wash away. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the guilt that will not wash away in "Act V, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene I suggests about the guilt that will not wash away. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene I" could deliver about the guilt that will not wash away. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the guilt that will not wash away in "Act V, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act V, Scene I to complicate the reader's understanding of the guilt that will not wash away. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene I" could deliver about the guilt that will not wash away. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the guilt that will not wash away in "Act V, Scene I": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "sweeten" most nearly mean?

   A. a disturbance; upset

   B. harm; injury

   C. diseased; corrupted

   D. to make smell pleasant

2. *What is it she does now? Look, how she rubs her hands. It is an accustomed action with her, to seem thus washing her hands: I have known her continue in this a quarter of an hour. Yet here's a spot. Hark! she speaks: I will set down what comes from her, to satisfy my remembrance the more strongly. Out, damned spot! out, I say!—One: two: why, then, 'tis time to do't.—Hell is murky!—Fie, my lord, fie! a soldier, and afeard? What need we fear who knows it, when none can call our power to account?—Yet who would have thought the old man to have had so much blood in him. Do you mark that? The thane of Fife had a wife: where is she now?—What, will these hands ne'er be clean?—No more o' that, my lord, no more o' that: you mar all with this starting. Go to, go to; you have known what you should not. She has spoke what she should not, I am sure of that: heaven knows what she has known. Here's the smell of the blood still: all the perfumes of Arabia will not sweeten this little hand. Oh, oh, oh!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene I"?

   A. The cast and world of the play

   B. A marriage drifting apart

   C. The guilt that will not wash away

   D. The dagger of the mind

SAT key: 1. D (to make smell pleasant); 2. C (The guilt that will not wash away)

Lesson 24: Act V, Scene II

Focus: the tyrant's weakening grip

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act V, Scene II (the tyrant's weakening grip) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Scottish thanes (Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox) march to join Malcolm's English power near Birnam Wood. They say Macbeth strongly fortifies Dunsinane; some call him mad, and those he commands 'move only in command, nothing in love.' Angus says Macbeth's title hangs loose about him 'like a giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief.' They march to give their blood as medicine to purge their sick country.

Background: Images of clothing that does not fit Macbeth recur through the play ('borrow'd robes' in I.iii); here they end in contempt.

Significance: Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition because....
Prompt: How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the stolen title does not fit.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Images of clothing that does not fit Macbeth recur through the play ('borrow'd robes' in I.iii); here they end in contempt. Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland. Imagery: Clothing imagery: Macbeth's title hangs "loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief." Characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the tyrant's weakening grip. Key takeaway: the stolen title does not fit.

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** Clothing imagery: Macbeth's title hangs "loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief."
- **Characterization:** Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition:** the stolen title does not fit.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.
- **clothing:** Borrowed and ill-fitting robes: watch how titles and clothes fit, or fail to fit, the people who wear them.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief" (Act V, Scene II, lines 2081–2083) Clothing imagery.
- "Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love" (Act V, Scene II, lines 2080–2081) His followers obey from fear.
- "Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands" (Act V, Scene II, lines 2077–2078) Guilt.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole.
Evidence: "Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love" (Act V, Scene II, lines 2080–2081)
Reasoning: Angus says his title hangs "like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief," and his soldiers "move only in command, / Nothing in love."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
revolts (noun)	rebellions	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	"revolts": Origin of "revolt": possibly French révolter; earlier Latin revolvō ("roll back"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/revolt#Etymology)

distemper (noun)	a disordered or diseased state	*Great Dunsinane he strongly fortifies: Some say he's mad; others that lesser hate him Do call it valiant fury: but, for certain, He cannot buckle his distemper'd cause Within the belt of rule.*	"distemper": Origin: Old French destemprer; earlier Latin distemperare. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/distemper#Etymology)
upbraid (verb)	to scold; to reproach	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	
mortified (adjective)	deadened; numb as if dead	*The English power is near, led on by Malcolm, His uncle Siward and the good Macduff: Revenges burn in them; for their dear causes Would to the bleeding and the grim alarm Excite the mortified man.*	
condemn (verb)	to declare guilty	*Who then shall blame His pester'd senses to recoil and start, When all that is within him does condemn Itself for being there?*	
commands (verb)	gives orders to	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	
dwarfish (adjective)	tiny; like a dwarf	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	
minutely (adjective)	happening every minute	*Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief.*	

Discussion questions

1. How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Which thanes appear in this scene? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox.
   Answer guidance: Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox.
2. Near where will the thanes meet the English army? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Birnam Wood
   Answer guidance: Birnam Wood.
3. How do Macbeth's followers obey him? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Only in command, nothing in love
   Answer guidance: Only in command, nothing in love.
4. What image does Angus use for Macbeth's title? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief
   Answer guidance: A giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief.
5. What is Macbeth doing at Dunsinane? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Strongly fortifying it
   Answer guidance: Strongly fortifying it.
6. What do the thanes want to do for their country? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Purge it, like medicine for a sick body
   Answer guidance: Purge it, like medicine for a sick body.
7. Retell the most important events of “Act V, Scene II” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Scottish thanes (Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox) march to join Malcolm's English power near Birnam Wood. They say Macbeth strongly fortifies Dunsinane; some call him mad, and those he commands 'move only in command, nothing in love.' Angus says Macbeth's title hangs loose about him 'like a giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief.' They march to give their blood as medicine to purge their sick…
   Answer guidance: Scottish thanes (Menteith, Caithness, Angus and Lennox) march to join Malcolm's English power near Birnam Wood. They say Macbeth strongly fortifies Dunsinane; some call him mad, and those he commands 'move only in command, nothing in love.' Angus says Macbeth's title hangs loose about him 'like a giant's robe upon a dwarfish thief.' They march to give their blood as medicine to purge their sick…
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene II”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when is “Act V, Scene II” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a…” What does “revolts” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** revolts: rebellions.
    Answer guidance: revolts: rebellions.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does the clothing image suggest about Macbeth's right to rule? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** He is small inside a role that does not fit; the crown is stolen.
   Answer guidance: He is small inside a role that does not fit; the crown is stolen.
2. What does “Act V, Scene II” suggest about the tyrant's weakening grip? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland.
   Answer guidance: Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland. Evidence to accept: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2081–2083): Clothing imagery. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of imagery in “Act V, Scene II”. What does it reveal about the tyrant's weakening grip that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2080–2081): His followers obey from fear. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the characterization in “Act V, Scene II” shape what we understand about the tyrant's weakening grip? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2081–2083): Clothing imagery. On characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “What does the tyrant?”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Now does he

feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands" (Act V, Scene II, lines 2077–2078): Guilt. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Act V, Scene II", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the Scottish lords march to join Malcolm's army near Birnam; evidence: "Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands".

   Answer guidance: Look for: the Scottish lords march to join Malcolm's army near Birnam; evidence: "Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands". Evidence to accept: "now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief" (Act V, Scene II, lines 2081–2083): Clothing imagery. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Act V, Scene II" build on "Act V, Scene I"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: "Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love" (Act V, Scene II, lines 2080–2081): His followers obey from fear. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In "Act V, Scene II", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the tyrant's weakening grip, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: "Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands" (Act V, Scene II, lines 2077–2078): Guilt. On characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (How can you tell when a leader has lost the loyalty of the people around them?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love" (Act V, Scene II, lines 2080–2081): His followers obey from fear. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does setting appear in "Act V, Scene II", and how does it connect the tyrant's weakening grip to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: "now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief" (Act V, Scene II, lines 2081–2083): Clothing imagery. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the thanes heroes for changing sides now, or late opportunists? Judge them. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment about timing and loyalty.

   Answer guidance: A judgment about timing and loyalty.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Macbeth's own nobles now see him as a usurper too small for the crown. The medical language (purge, sick country) prepares the healing of Scotland. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2077–2078): Guilt. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act V, Scene II” acts most wisely in the matter of the tyrant's weakening grip, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2081–2083): Clothing imagery. On characterization: Scottish thanes desert Macbeth; the rebels march. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene II”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the tyrant's weakening grip. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2080–2081): His followers obey from fear. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write your own questions about “Act V, Scene II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2077–2078): Guilt. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect “Act V, Scene II”, with its focus on the tyrant's weakening grip, to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2,

SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2081–2083): Clothing imagery. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in “Act V, Scene II” effective in presenting the tyrant's weakening grip, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2080–2081): His followers obey from fear. On imagery: Clothing imagery: Macbeth's title hangs "loose about him, like a giant's robe / Upon a dwarfish thief." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene II” treats the tyrant's weakening grip with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Now does he feel / His secret murders sticking on his hands” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2077–2078): Guilt. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene III” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “now does he feel his title / Hang loose about him, like a giant’s robe / Upon a dwarfish thief” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2081–2083): Clothing imagery. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act V, Scene II” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the tyrant's weakening grip? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rebels see Macbeth as a man too small for the title he stole. Useful evidence: “Those he commands move only in command, / Nothing in love” (Act V, Scene II, lines 2080–2081): His followers obey from fear. Theme link: the stolen title does not fit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does this scene take place?
   A. The country near Dunsinane
   B. Before the King's palace in England
   C. An ante-room in Macbeth's castle
   D. Macduff's castle in Fife

   Key: A (The country near Dunsinane)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who does Menteith say is leading the English power?
   A. Donalbain and the King of Norway
   B. Malcolm, Siward and Macduff
   C. Banquo's son Fleance
   D. King Edward himself

   Key: B (Malcolm, Siward and Macduff)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which prince does Lennox say is not with the army?
   A. Malcolm
   B. Fleance
   C. Donalbain
   D. Edward of England

   Key: C (Donalbain)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Menteith's line: “Revenges _____ in them”

   Key: burn
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whose son does Lennox say is among the young soldiers?
   A. Macduff's
   B. Banquo's
   C. Ross's
   D. Siward's

   Key: D (Siward's)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do some people say about Macbeth's state of mind?
   A. That he is mad
   B. That he is calm and wise
   C. That he is sick in bed
   D. That he is planning to flee

   Key: A (That he is mad)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do those who hate Macbeth less call his behaviour?

   A. Wise caution

   B. Valiant fury

   C. Quiet sorrow

   D. Royal courage

   Key: B (Valiant fury)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What sounds and sights open the scene?

   A. Thunder and lightning

   B. Bells and torches

   C. Drum and colours

   D. Trumpets and banners

   Key: C (Drum and colours)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What do the thanes say about the soldiers joining Malcolm's army?

   Sample answer: Lennox has a list of all the gentlemen. Donalbain is not with his brother, but Siward's son is there, along with many young men who have barely begun to grow beards and are just now claiming their manhood. The list suggests a fresh, hopeful army facing a tyrant whose own men do not love him.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why are the Scottish thanes marching to join the English forces?

    Sample answer: They say Malcolm, Siward and Macduff burn with revenge for causes that would rouse even a dead man. Macbeth is a tyrant whose own men obey him without love. The thanes want to give their loyalty where it is truly owed, to Malcolm, and are ready to give their lives to heal Scotland.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Menteith mean by “Excite the mortified man”?

    A. The causes would rouse even a dead man

    B. They would anger a man of the church

    C. They would wake a sleeping soldier

    D. They would shame a coward into fighting

    Key: A (The causes would rouse even a dead man)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “unrough youths” describe?

    A. Rough soldiers from the hills

    B. Young men without beards yet

    C. Boys who refuse to fight

    D. Thieves from the forest

    Key: B (Young men without beards yet)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “He cannot buckle his distemper’d cause Within the belt of rule” mean?

    A. He cannot fasten his armour on in time for the battle

    B. He has lost his belt and sword

    C. He can no longer control his disordered reign

    D. He refuses to rule fairly

Key: C (He can no longer control his disordered reign)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “His secret murders sticking on his hands” suggest?

    A. His hands were injured in the battle against Norway

    B. He has blood on his gloves

    C. He is holding a dagger

    D. His guilt clings to him and cannot be hidden

    Key: D (His guilt clings to him and cannot be hidden)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Lennox's line: “there is Siward’s son, And many unrough youths that even now Protest their first of _____”

    Key: manhood

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach” mean?

    A. Uprisings every minute reproach his broken faith

    B. Small rebellions are easily crushed by his loyal army

    C. His followers praise his loyalty

    D. His faith in God is growing

    Key: A (Uprisings every minute reproach his broken faith)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Menteith mean by Macbeth's “pester’d senses”?

    A. He is ill with a fever

    B. His troubled mind makes him jumpy

    C. He is deaf and blind

    D. He is bothered by insects in the castle

    Key: B (His troubled mind makes him jumpy)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “To dew the sovereign flower and drown the weeds” mean?

    A. Water the castle garden

    B. Plant flowers on Duncan's grave at Colmekill

    C. Help the rightful king and destroy the tyrant

    D. Flood the fields of Dunsinane

    Key: C (Help the rightful king and destroy the tyrant)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How do the thanes describe Macbeth's position now?

    Sample answer: They say he fortifies Dunsinane, and some call him mad while others call it fury. He cannot control his disordered rule, feels his secret murders sticking to his hands and faces revolts every minute. His troubled senses jump because everything inside him condemns itself. He is weak and isolated despite his power.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the scene show about how Scotland's nobles now see Macbeth?

    Sample answer: The thanes call him the tyrant and describe him as guilty, unloved and unable to rule. They speak of giving obedience where it is truly owed and of healing their country. They have moved from serving him to marching against him, showing that his support has collapsed.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the scene's imagery of sickness frame the coming battle?

    A. As a cure for a diseased country

    B. As a plague that will spread

    C. As a war between two doctors

    D. As a punishment from the Witches

    Key: A (As a cure for a diseased country)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the image of murders 'sticking on' Macbeth's hands echo earlier scenes?

    A. It recalls the dagger in the air before the murder

    B. It recalls the blood that would not wash off

    C. It recalls the Witches' cauldron

    D. It recalls Duncan's gifts

    Key: B (It recalls the blood that would not wash off)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Menteith's question about who can blame Macbeth's 'recoil' suggest?

    A. He deserves pity, not blame

    B. He is innocent of his crimes

    C. His own mind condemns him from within

    D. His senses are sharper than ever before the battle

    Key: C (His own mind condemns him from within)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why might Shakespeare introduce new minor thanes at this point?

    A. To introduce a new hero

    B. To provide comic relief

    C. To slow the action down

    D. To show that the whole nobility is turning

    Key: D (To show that the whole nobility is turning)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Menteith's line: “for their dear causes Would to the bleeding and the grim _____”

    Key: alarm

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the plant imagery at the end connect to earlier imagery?

    A. It recalls Duncan's planting and growth

    B. It recalls the Porter's joke about the primrose way

    C. It recalls the Witches' herbs

    D. It recalls the forest of England

    Key: A (It recalls Duncan's planting and growth)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What do the contrasting views of Macbeth as 'mad' or showing 'valiant fury' show?

    A. He is both mad and wise

    B. His actions can be read as madness or desperate courage

    C. Everyone agrees he is mad

    D. Everyone agrees that he has become brave and wise

    Key: B (His actions can be read as madness or desperate courage)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What dramatic irony does the march toward Birnam create for an audience that remembers the apparitions?

    A. Comic relief before the battle

    B. Confusion about where the armies are going

    C. Anticipation that the prophecy will come true

    D. A sense of peace and calm

    Key: C (Anticipation that the prophecy will come true)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the thanes' language presents Macbeth as a sickness.

    Sample answer: Caithness says Macbeth's cause is distempered and the thanes speak of meeting Malcolm as the medicine of the sick state and pouring themselves in as their country's purge. Lennox speaks of watering the sovereign flower and drowning the weeds. A strong answer shows how this imagery turns rebellion into healing.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the significance of the youths in the army.

    Sample answer: Lennox says many unrough youths, just beginning their manhood, march with Siward's son. They contrast with Macbeth, whose men obey only from fear. A strong answer argues that the young soldiers represent Scotland's future and the hope of renewal, and may prepare for the fate of Siward's son.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the scene shift the audience's view of the coming conflict?

    A. It presents the attack as a restoration of order

    B. It presents it as an English invasion

    C. It presents it as a civil war between two equal sides

    D. It presents it as a hopeless cause

    Key: A (It presents the attack as a restoration of order)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which earlier prophecy does the thanes' route quietly bring into play?

    A. The Witches' first greeting to Banquo

    B. The apparition's words about Birnam

    C. Duncan's naming of Malcolm

    D. Hecate's warning about security

    Key: B (The apparition's words about Birnam)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the thanes' language suggest about how Macbeth rules now?

    A. By love and generosity

B. By law and fairness

C. By fear rather than loyalty

D. By the advice of his wife, the queen

Key: C (By fear rather than loyalty)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Lennox's line: “For certain, sir, he is not: I have a _____ Of all the gentry”

Key: file

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why might Shakespeare give this scene to the Scottish rather than English forces?

A. To show England controls Scotland

B. To delay Macduff's revenge

C. To show the thanes are traitors

D. To show the rebellion comes from within Scotland

Key: D (To show the rebellion comes from within Scotland)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does “give obedience where ’tis truly owed” frame the thanes' rebellion?

A. As true loyalty, not treason

B. As a break from all loyalty

C. As obedience to England

D. As obedience to the Witches

Key: A (As true loyalty, not treason)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Evaluate how this scene uses imagery to judge Macbeth.

Sample answer: The thanes use images of sickness, ill-fitting clothes, murders sticking to his hands and weeds to be drowned. A strong answer argues how these images combine to show Macbeth as illegitimate, guilty and diseased, and how they prepare the audience to see his defeat as both just and necessary.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate the role of collective voice in this scene.

Sample answer: Four thanes share the speech, each adding to a picture of Macbeth's decline and their own resolve. A strong answer argues how this shared voice shows the unity of the nobility against the tyrant, contrasting with Macbeth's isolation, and considers how minor characters can carry the play's moral judgment.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the effect of the scene ending with the thanes marching?

A. It slows the play to a halt

B. It builds momentum toward the final battle

C. It suggests the thanes will retreat to the hills

D. It shows the war is over

Key: B (It builds momentum toward the final battle)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare how the thanes describe Macbeth with how Macbeth described himself after the murder.

Sample answer: After Duncan's death Macbeth said he could not wash the blood from his hands and that his mind was full of scorpions. Now the thanes see the same guilt from outside, describing secret murders sticking to his hands and senses that start. A strong answer argues how the inner torment has become visible to everyone.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 9, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene II develops the idea of the tyrant's weakening grip. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene II” could deliver about the tyrant's weakening grip. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the tyrant's weakening grip in “Act V, Scene II”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the tyrant's weakening grip. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene II” could deliver about the tyrant's weakening grip. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the tyrant's weakening grip in “Act V, Scene II”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene II suggests about the tyrant's weakening grip. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene II” could deliver about the tyrant's weakening grip. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the tyrant's weakening grip in "Act V, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act V, Scene II to complicate the reader's understanding of the tyrant's weakening grip. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene II" could deliver about the tyrant's weakening grip. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the tyrant's weakening grip in "Act V, Scene II": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *What does the tyrant? Great Dunsinane he strongly fortifies: Some say he's mad; others that lesser hate him Do call it valiant fury: but, for certain, He cannot buckle his distemper'd cause Within the belt of rule. Now does he feel His secret murders sticking on his hands; Now minutely revolts upbraid his faith-breach; Those he commands move only in command, Nothing in love: now does he feel his title Hang loose about him, like a giant's robe Upon a dwarfish thief. Who then shall blame His pester'd senses to recoil and start, When all that is within him does condemn Itself for being there? Well, march we on, To give obedience where 'tis truly owed: Meet we the medicine of the sickly weal, And with him pour we in our country's purge Each drop of us. Or so much as it needs, To dew the sovereign flower and drown the weeds. Make we our march towards Birnam.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene II"?

   A. Nature's revolt against the crime

   B. The last false confidence

   C. Suspicion spoken through irony

   D. The tyrant's weakening grip

SAT key: 1. D (The tyrant's weakening grip)

Lesson 25: Act V, Scene III

Focus: defiance and despair

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in “Act V, Scene III” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth, trusting the prophecies, refuses to fear the fleeing thanes or 'the boy Malcolm.' He curses a pale servant who reports ten thousand English soldiers. Aside, he says he has lived long enough: his way of life is fallen 'into the sear, the yellow leaf,' without honor, love, obedience or troops of friends. He insists on putting on his armor. He asks the Doctor to 'minister to a mind diseased'; the Doctor says the patient must minister to himself. 'Throw physic to the dogs; I'll none of it.'

Background: Seyton, Macbeth's last attendant, has a name that sounds like 'Satan' to many readers and directors.

Significance: Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to guilt and conscience because....
Prompt: Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to guilt and conscience because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: antidote — a remedy that counteracts a poison; epicures — people devoted to luxury and fine food; oblivious — causing forgetfulness; diseased — sick; perilous — dangerous. “oblivious”: Origin: Latin oblīviōsus (“forgetful”).
Words: antidote: a remedy that counteracts a poison · epicures: people devoted to luxury and fine food · oblivious: causing forgetfulness · diseased: sick · perilous: dangerous

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Seyton, Macbeth's last attendant, has a name that sounds like 'Satan' to many readers and directors. Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt. Characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Soliloquy: He longs for "honour, love, obedience, troops of friends." Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased" slowly and put it in my own words: Macbeth asks the doctor whether he can treat a diseased mind and pluck a sorrow from the memory. Next, craft. I notice the medical language of "minister" and "diseased," applied to guilt and grief. The strongest word is "diseased": it treats a guilty conscience like an illness of the body. Then, effect. What is Macbeth asking the doctor to do for his wife, and for himself? My answer: Macbeth knows medicine cannot cure guilt; when the doctor says the patient must minister to herself, Macbeth's angry reply shows he is also speaking about his own mind.

> *Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased* (Act V, Scene III, line 2145)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased" slowly and put it in my own words: Macbeth asks the doctor whether he can treat a diseased mind and pluck a sorrow from the memory. Next, craft. I notice the medical language of "minister" and "diseased," applied to guilt and grief. The strongest word is "diseased": it treats a guilty conscience like an illness of the body. Then, effect. What is Macbeth asking the doctor to do for his wife, and for himself? My answer: Macbeth knows medicine cannot cure guilt; when the doctor says the patient must minister to herself, Macbeth's angry reply shows he is also speaking about his own mind.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Sear" and "yellow leaf" stand out. Macbeth pictures his life as autumn, dry and falling, so he feels old and finished before his time. Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience? Expected student answer: The image shows that his crimes have left him empty: he has none of the honour or friends of old age, so the line turns guilt into weariness.

> *I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf* (Act V, Scene III, lines 2122–2123)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Sear" and "yellow leaf" stand out. Macbeth pictures his life as autumn, dry and falling, so he feels old and finished before his time.
Ask: How does this line connect to guilt and conscience?
Expected student answer: The image shows that his crimes have left him empty: he has none of the honour or friends of old age, so the line turns guilt into weariness.

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, soliloquy (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of defiance and despair. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. When the text says “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, line 2145), it shows this directly. He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, soliloquy (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of defiance and despair. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. When the text says “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, line 2145), it shows this directly. He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside? Ask: do we pity Macbeth here?
Anchor question: Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?
Facilitation: Ask: do we pity Macbeth here?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. (“Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased”, Act V, Scene III, line 2145). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about defiance and despair? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. (“Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased”, Act V, Scene III, line 2145). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes defiance and despair. Key takeaway: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf."
- **Soliloquy:** He longs for "honour, love, obedience, troops of friends."

Themes and how they develop

- **guilt and conscience:** he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, lines 2122–2123) Autumn imagery.
- “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, line 2145) Guilt as disease.
- “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, line 2134) Defiance.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him.
Evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, line 2145)
Reasoning: He says his life "is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf," and asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
antidote (noun)	a remedy that counteracts a poison	*Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff’d bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*	
epicures (noun)	people devoted to luxury and fine food	*Then fly, false thanes, And mingle with the English epicures: The mind I sway by and the heart I bear Shall never sag with doubt nor shake with fear.*	

oblivious (adjective)	causing forgetfulness	*Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*	"oblivious": Origin: Latin oblīviōsus ("forgetful"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/oblivious#Etymology)
diseased (adjective)	sick	*Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*	
perilous (adjective)	dangerous	*Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which weighs upon the heart?*	
preparation (noun)	forces made ready	*Ay, my good lord; your royal preparation Makes us hear something.*	
pronounced (verb)	declared	*The spirits that know All mortal consequences have pronounced me thus: "Fear not, Macbeth; no man that's born of woman Shall e'er have power upon thee."*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Who is Macbeth's attendant who brings his armor? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Seyton.
   Answer guidance: Seyton.
2. Why does Macbeth say he will not fear Malcolm? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Malcolm was born of woman
   Answer guidance: Malcolm was born of woman.

3. What season image does Macbeth use for his life? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The sear, the yellow leaf (autumn)
   Answer guidance: The sear, the yellow leaf (autumn).
4. What does Macbeth say he cannot look to have in old age? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Honour, love, obedience, troops of friends
   Answer guidance: Honour, love, obedience, troops of friends.
5. What does Macbeth ask the Doctor? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To minister to a mind diseased
   Answer guidance: To minister to a mind diseased.
6. What does the Doctor reply? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The patient must minister to himself
   Answer guidance: The patient must minister to himself.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act V, Scene III" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Macbeth, trusting the prophecies, refuses to fear the fleeing thanes or 'the boy Malcolm.' He curses a pale servant who reports ten thousand English soldiers. Aside, he says he has lived long enough: his way of life is fallen 'into the sear, the yellow leaf,' without honor, love, obedience or troops of friends. He insists on putting on his armor. He asks the Doctor to 'minister to a mind…
   Answer guidance: Macbeth, trusting the prophecies, refuses to fear the fleeing thanes or 'the boy Malcolm.' He curses a pale servant who reports ten thousand English soldiers. Aside, he says he has lived long enough: his way of life is fallen 'into the sear, the yellow leaf,' without honor, love, obedience or troops of friends. He insists on putting on his armor. He asks the Doctor to 'minister to a mind…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene III", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act V, Scene III" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased, Pluck from the memory a rooted sorrow, Raze out the written troubles of the brain And with some sweet oblivious antidote Cleanse the stuff'd bosom of that perilous stuff Which…" What does "antidote" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** antidote: a remedy that counteracts a poison.
    Answer guidance: antidote: a remedy that counteracts a poison.

Inferential / analytical

1. Macbeth asks the Doctor to cure his wife, then says 'Throw physic to the dogs.' What does this shift reveal? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1,

RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** He knows no medicine can cure guilt, his or hers.

Answer guidance: He knows no medicine can cure guilt, his or hers.

2. What does “Act V, Scene III” suggest about defiance and despair? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt.

   Answer guidance: Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt. Evidence to accept: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, lines 2122–2123): Autumn imagery. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of imagery in “Act V, Scene III”. What does it reveal about defiance and despair that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create. Evidence to accept: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, line 2145): Guilt as disease. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the characterization in “Act V, Scene III” shape what we understand about defiance and despair? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, lines 2122–2123): Autumn imagery. On characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “Bring me no more…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, line 2134): Defiance. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Macbeth's despair beneath his defiance as the English approach; evidence: “I have lived long enough”.

   Answer guidance: Look for: Macbeth's despair beneath his defiance as the English approach; evidence: “I have lived long enough”. Evidence to accept: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, lines 2122–2123): Autumn imagery. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does “Act V, Scene III” build on “Act V, Scene II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, line 2145):

Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. In “Act V, Scene III”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about defiance and despair, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, line 2134): Defiance. On characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why might someone act tough on the outside when they feel hopeless inside?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, line 2145): Guilt as disease. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does irony appear in “Act V, Scene III”, and how does it connect defiance and despair to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, lines 2122–2123): Autumn imagery. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does Macbeth's self-awareness here make him more tragic or less sympathetic? Explain. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment about tragic recognition.
   Answer guidance: A judgment about tragic recognition.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Bravado and despair alternate: Macbeth sees clearly what he has lost but clings to the prophecies. His plea to the Doctor shows he knows his wife's illness is guilt. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, line 2134): Defiance. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act V, Scene III” acts most wisely in the matter of defiance and despair, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner,

then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, lines 2122–2123): Autumn imagery. On characterization: Macbeth, defiant and despairing, mocks the servant ("cream-faced loon"), speaks of his "way of life" fallen "into the sear, the yellow leaf." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene III”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of defiance and despair. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, line 2145): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act V, Scene III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, line 2134): Defiance. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act V, Scene III”, with its focus on defiance and despair, to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, lines 2122–2123): Autumn imagery. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in “Act V, Scene III” effective in presenting defiance and despair, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, line 2145): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene III” treats defiance and despair with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle

discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I’ll fight till from my bones my flesh be hack’d” (Act V, Scene III, line 2134): Defiance. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene IV” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “I have lived long enough: my way of life / Is fall’n into the sear, the yellow leaf” (Act V, Scene III, lines 2122–2123): Autumn imagery. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act V, Scene III” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about defiance and despair? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's despair shows he knows what his crimes have cost him. Useful evidence: “Canst thou not minister to a mind diseased” (Act V, Scene III, line 2145): Guilt as disease. Theme link: he asks the Doctor to "minister to a mind diseased." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where is Macbeth when the scene opens?

   A. In a room of his castle at Dunsinane

   B. The country near Birnam wood

   C. Before the King's palace in England

   D. Macduff's castle in Fife

   Key: A (In a room of his castle at Dunsinane)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth tell his attendants about reports?

   A. Bring him every report at once

   B. Bring him no more of them

   C. Write them down for the Doctor

   D. Send them on to Lady Macbeth

Key: B (Bring him no more of them)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth call the frightened servant?

   A. A brave young soldier

   B. A loyal and honest man

   C. A cream-faced loon

   D. A cunning English spy

   Key: C (A cream-faced loon)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Macbeth's line: "I'll fight till from my bones my flesh be _____"

   Key: hack'd

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the servant say has arrived?

   A. A message from Malcolm

   B. The Witches at the gate

   C. A ship from Norway

   D. Ten thousand soldiers

   Key: D (Ten thousand soldiers)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth order done to those who talk of fear?

   A. Hang them

   B. Send them to England

   C. Promote them

   D. Give them armour

   Key: A (Hang them)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say the Doctor should do to the land?

   A. Leave it to the English and their king

   B. Find its disease and purge it

   C. Bless it with holy water

   D. Count the soldiers in it

   Key: B (Find its disease and purge it)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Doctor say privately at the end?

   A. He will stay to help the king until the end

   B. He will join the English army

   C. He would not return for profit

   D. He will go to see the Witches

   Key: C (He would not return for profit)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Macbeth treat the servant who brings the news?
   Sample answer: Macbeth insults him as a cream-faced loon with a goose look, a lily-livered boy and a whey-face, and tells him to prick his face to cover his fear with blood. He mocks his pale cheeks as counsellors to fear. His cruelty shows how frightened and angry he is beneath his claim to be fearless.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Macbeth behave about his armour in this scene?
    Sample answer: He calls for his armour even though Seyton says it is not needed yet, and insists on putting it on. Then,

distracted, he tells his attendant to pull it off and later says to bring it after him. His confused orders show how restless and divided he is as the enemy approaches.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth mean by “mingle with the English epicures”?
    A. Go join the soft, luxury-loving English
    B. Learn to cook the rich meals of English lords
    C. Become English citizens
    D. Trade wine with England

    Key: A (Go join the soft, luxury-loving English)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “This push Will cheer me ever, or disseat me now” mean?
    A. A push from his horse will throw him off in the battle
    B. The battle will secure his throne or topple him
    C. He is unsure whether to stand or sit
    D. The crowd will cheer for his victory

    Key: B (The battle will secure his throne or topple him)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth mean by “Curses, not loud but deep, mouth-honour”?
    A. People openly curse him in the streets of every town
    B. His followers swear loyalty sincerely
    C. People secretly hate him but praise him in words
    D. His enemies praise him loudly

    Key: C (People secretly hate him but praise him in words)

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth say about the soldiers fleeing to the English?
    A. He will chase every one of them himself
    B. He will forgive them all
    C. He will join them in England
    D. Let them fly, he does not fear

    Key: D (Let them fly, he does not fear)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “Send out more horses; skirr the country _____”

    Key: round

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth mean by “What rhubarb, cyme, or what purgative drug, Would scour these English hence?”?
    A. He wishes a medicine could drive out the English
    B. He wants the Doctor to poison the English soldiers' wells
    C. He is asking for a meal before battle
    D. He is ill and needs medicine

    Key: A (He wishes a medicine could drive out the English)

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the Doctor say troubles Lady Macbeth?

    A. A fever she caught walking on the cold heath

    B. Thick coming fancies that keep her from rest

    C. A wound from a dagger

    D. Hunger and thirst

    Key: B (Thick coming fancies that keep her from rest)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macbeth's mood change during the scene?

    A. He remains calm and steady

    B. He grows happier and calmer with each report

    C. His mood rises and falls between boasts and gloom

    D. He falls silent and sleeps

    Key: C (His mood rises and falls between boasts and gloom)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Macbeth break off his arming to say 'Doctor, the thanes fly from me'?

    Sample answer: In the middle of giving orders about armour, horses and scouts, Macbeth's mind keeps returning to the desertion of his nobles. The aside shows that, despite his boasts, he knows his support is draining away. The broken rhythm of the scene, with orders interrupted by worries, mirrors a king who cannot keep his thoughts steady.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does Macbeth repeat the prophecy about Birnam wood?

    Sample answer: He reminds himself that he cannot fear until Birnam wood comes to Dunsinane and closes the scene with the same idea. Repeating the prophecy is how he keeps his courage up while his thanes desert him and the English approach. It shows how completely he now depends on the spirits' words.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's insistence that he 'cannot taint with fear' reveal?

    A. He clings to the prophecies to suppress fear

    B. He has truly lost all ability to feel fear

    C. He fears only the Doctor's report

    D. He fears the boy Malcolm most

    Key: A (He clings to the prophecies to suppress fear)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Macbeth's speech on old age show self-awareness?

    A. He believes he will live to be very old

    B. He sees what his crimes have cost him

    C. He wants to retire to the country

    D. He expects many friends at his side

    Key: B (He sees what his crimes have cost him)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What irony lies in Macbeth asking the Doctor to cure the country's disease?

    A. The Doctor is the real tyrant of the land

    B. The country is perfectly healthy

    C. He himself is the country's disease

D. The English are the cure he wants

Key: C (He himself is the country's disease)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does the Doctor's final couplet affect the scene?

A. It shows the Doctor's loyalty to the end

B. It reveals the Doctor is a spy

C. It shows the Doctor will cure the queen

D. It shows even servants want to escape

Key: D (It shows even servants want to escape)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: "I would applaud thee to the very _____"

Key: echo

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's harsh treatment of the servant suggest?

A. He projects his own fear onto others

B. He is calm and in control

C. He wants to promote the servant to captain

D. He trusts the servant's courage

Key: A (He projects his own fear onto others)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene's alternation of orders and reflections create tension?

A. It slows the play to a calm pace

B. It shows a mind unable to settle

C. It gives comic relief

D. It shows Macbeth's growing peace

Key: B (It shows a mind unable to settle)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Macbeth call Malcolm 'the boy'?

A. Because Malcolm is a child

B. Because he loves Malcolm

C. To dismiss him as no threat

D. Because the Witches did

Key: C (To dismiss him as no threat)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze Macbeth's speech about old age.

Sample answer: Macbeth says his life has fallen into the dry yellow leaf and that he cannot expect the honour, love, obedience and friends that should come with age. Instead he gets quiet curses and hollow praise. A strong answer shows that this moment of clear self-knowledge makes him tragic, since he understands exactly what he has thrown away.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the use of medical imagery in this scene.

Sample answer: Macbeth asks the Doctor to cure his wife's troubled mind, then asks him to diagnose and purge Scotland's disease and asks what drug could scour the English away. The Doctor answers that some patients must heal themselves. A strong answer argues that the imagery shows Macbeth cannot see that he is the sickness the country needs to purge.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Macbeth's rhyming couplet about fear function?

A. As a self-reassuring chant

B. As a prayer for forgiveness

C. As a love poem to his wife

D. As a message to Malcolm

Key: A (As a self-reassuring chant)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth's confused handling of his armour symbolize?

A. His careful preparation for war

B. His disordered mind and failing control

C. His trust in his servants

D. His wish to surrender

Key: B (His disordered mind and failing control)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Macbeth's appeal to the Doctor relate to Lady Macbeth's earlier view of guilt?

A. It agrees that guilt is easily cleaned

B. It shows they did not feel guilt at any time

C. It contradicts her claim that water would clear them

D. It repeats her advice exactly

Key: C (It contradicts her claim that water would clear them)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the Doctor's aside: “Profit again should hardly draw me _____”

Key: here

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What makes this scene a turning point in how the audience sees Macbeth?

A. He becomes purely comic

B. He repents and seeks forgiveness

C. He is shown to be innocent

D. His despair makes him tragic as well as tyrannical

Key: D (His despair makes him tragic as well as tyrannical)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What irony lies in the contrast between Macbeth's words and his situation?

A. Bold claims against a collapsing reality

B. Calm speech in a peaceful castle far from war

C. Kind words to loyal friends

D. Humble words before victory

Key: A (Bold claims against a collapsing reality)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Macbeth is more defiant or despairing in this scene.

Sample answer: He insults the servant, calls for his armour and repeats that he cannot fear until Birnam wood moves. Yet he says he is sick at heart, has lived long enough and has lost all that should come with age. A strong answer weighs these moments and argues how the mix shapes our view of him before the final battle.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate the significance of the Doctor's role in Act V.
    Sample answer: The Doctor watches Lady Macbeth, admits her disease is beyond him, and tells Macbeth a mind must heal itself. He then wishes he were far from Dunsinane. A strong answer argues that he represents ordinary reason and conscience, showing both the limits of medicine and the fear that surrounds the tyrant.
39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth's order to 'skirr the country round' reveal about his rule?
    A. He wants to explore Scotland
    B. He relies on force and fear to hold power
    C. He plans a hunting trip
    D. He wants to welcome the English with a great feast

    Key: B (He relies on force and fear to hold power)
40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare Macbeth's attitude to the prophecies here with his attitude in Act I.
    Sample answer: In Act I he wondered whether the Witches' words were good or ill and feared what they suggested. Now he repeats their promises as protection and dismisses all other news. A strong answer argues how his relationship to prophecy has turned from doubt to blind dependence.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 3, inference 7, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene III develops the idea of defiance and despair. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene III” could deliver about defiance and despair. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for defiance and despair in “Act V, Scene III”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of defiance and despair. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene III" could deliver about defiance and despair. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for defiance and despair in "Act V, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene III suggests about defiance and despair. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene III" could deliver about defiance and despair. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for defiance and despair in "Act V, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses imagery in Act V, Scene III to complicate the reader's understanding of defiance and despair. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene III" could deliver about defiance and despair. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for defiance and despair in "Act V, Scene III": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Bring me no more reports; let them fly all: Till Birnam wood remove to Dunsinane, I cannot taint with fear. What's the boy Malcolm? Was he not born of woman? The spirits that know All mortal consequences have pronounced me thus: "Fear not, Macbeth; no man that's born of woman Shall e'er have power upon thee." Then fly, false thanes, And mingle with the English epicures: The mind I sway by and the heart I bear Shall never sag with doubt nor shake with fear. Enter a Servant. The devil damn thee black, thou cream-faced loon! Where got'st thou that goose look? There is ten thousand— Geese, villain? Soldiers, sir. Go prick thy face, and over-red thy fear, Thou lily-liver'd boy. What soldiers, patch? Death of thy soul! those linen cheeks of thine Are counsellors to fear. What soldiers, whey-face? The English force, so please you. Take thy face hence. Exit*

> *Servant. Seyton!—I am sick at heart, When I behold—Seyton, I say!—This push Will cheer me ever, or disseat me now. I have lived long enough: my way of life Is fall'n into the sear, the yellow leaf; And that which should accompany old age, As honour, love, obedience, troops of friends, I must not look to have; but, in their stead, Curses, not loud but deep, mouth-honour, breath, Which the poor heart would fain deny, and dare not. Seyton!*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene III"?

A. Life as a tale told by an idiot

B. Defiance and despair

C. Suspicion spoken through irony

D. The Witches' riddling world

SAT key: 1. B (Defiance and despair)

Lesson 26: Act V, Scene IV

Focus: a disguised advance on the castle

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act V, Scene IV (a disguised advance on the castle) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Near Birnam Wood, Malcolm orders every soldier to cut down a bough and carry it before him to hide the army's numbers from Macbeth's scouts. Siward reports that Macbeth will wait for a siege at Dunsinane; Malcolm notes that many have revolted and only 'constrained things whose hearts are absent too' serve him. Macduff and Siward urge action over speculation.

Background: Camouflage with branches appears in medieval chronicle tales; Shakespeare uses it to fulfil the apparition's riddle literally.

Significance: A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Camouflage with branches appears in medieval chronicle tales; Shakespeare uses it to fulfil the apparition's riddle literally. A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined. Plot: Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers. Dramatic irony: The audience sees the prophecy being fulfilled by human strategy. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes a disguised advance on the castle. Key takeaway: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers.
- **Dramatic irony:** The audience sees the prophecy being fulfilled by human strategy.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** prophecy fulfilled through practical choices.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2177–2178) Malcolm's order.
- “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2178–2179) The strategy.
- “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2182–2183) Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action.
Evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2177–2178)
Reasoning: Malcolm orders "every soldier hew him down a bough," to "shadow / The numbers of our host."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
soldiership (noun)	military skill	*Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership.*	

censures (noun)	judgments; opinions	*Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership.*	"censures": Origin of "censure": Latin censūra ("censor's office or assessment"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/censure#Etymology)
chambers (noun)	bedrooms	*Cousins, I hope the days are near at hand That chambers will be safe.*	
arbitrate (verb)	to decide; to settle	*Thoughts speculative their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue strokes must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war.*	
speculative (adjective)	based on guesswork	*Thoughts speculative their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue strokes must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war.*	"speculative": Origin: Old French speculatif; earlier Late Latin speculativus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/speculative#Etymology)
constrained (adjective)	forced; acting against their will	*'Tis his main hope: For where there is advantage to be given, Both more and less have given him the revolt, And none serve with him but constrained things Whose hearts are absent too.*	
strokes (noun)	blows in battle	*Thoughts speculative their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue strokes must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war.*	
discovery (noun)	scouting; spying out	*Let every soldier hew him down a bough And bear't before him: thereby shall we shadow The numbers of our host and make discovery Err in report of us.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with masculinity, power and violence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. Near which wood does the army gather? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Birnam Wood.
   Answer guidance: Birnam Wood.
2. What does Malcolm order each soldier to do? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Cut down a bough and carry it
   Answer guidance: Cut down a bough and carry it.
3. Why does he give this order? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** To hide the size of the army
   Answer guidance: To hide the size of the army.
4. Which prophecy does this begin to fulfil? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Birnam Wood coming to Dunsinane
   Answer guidance: Birnam Wood coming to Dunsinane.
5. Who still serves Macbeth, according to Malcolm? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Constrained things whose hearts are absent
   Answer guidance: Constrained things whose hearts are absent.
6. What do Macduff and Siward urge? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Action rather than speculation
   Answer guidance: Action rather than speculation.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act V, Scene IV" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Near Birnam Wood, Malcolm orders every soldier to cut down a bough and carry it before him to hide the army's numbers from Macbeth's scouts. Siward reports that Macbeth will wait for a siege at Dunsinane; Malcolm notes that many have revolted and only 'constrained things whose hearts are absent too' serve him. Macduff and Siward urge action over speculation.
   Answer guidance: Near Birnam Wood, Malcolm orders every soldier to cut down a bough and carry it before him to hide the army's numbers from Macbeth's scouts. Siward reports that Macbeth will wait for a siege at Dunsinane; Malcolm notes that many have revolted and only 'constrained things whose hearts are absent too' serve him. Macduff and Siward urge action over speculation.
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene IV", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act V, Scene IV" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership." What does "soldiership" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss

briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** soldiership: military skill.
Answer guidance: soldiership: military skill.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is it ironic that the trick is Malcolm's ordinary military plan? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** The 'impossible' sign Macbeth trusted is achieved by simple strategy.
   Answer guidance: The 'impossible' sign Macbeth trusted is achieved by simple strategy.
2. What does “Act V, Scene IV” suggest about a disguised advance on the castle? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined.
   Answer guidance: A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined. Evidence to accept: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2177–2178): Malcolm's order. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of foreshadowing in “Act V, Scene IV”. What does it reveal about a disguised advance on the castle that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
   Answer guidance: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events. Evidence to accept: “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2178–2179): The strategy. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. How does the irony in “Act V, Scene IV” shape what we understand about a disguised advance on the castle? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2177–2178): Malcolm's order. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “Cousins, I hope the…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2182–2183): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Malcolm's order that each soldier cut a bough from Birnam Wood; evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough”.
   Answer guidance: Look for: Malcolm's order that each soldier cut a bough from Birnam Wood; evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough”. Evidence to accept: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough /

And bear't before him" (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2177–2178): Malcolm's order. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

7. How does "Act V, Scene IV" build on "Act V, Scene III"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host" (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2178–2179): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In "Act V, Scene IV", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about a disguised advance on the castle, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane" (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2182–2183): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Can a prophecy come true by ordinary means? Does that make it less of a prophecy?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host" (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2178–2179): The strategy. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does plot appear in "Act V, Scene IV", and how does it connect a disguised advance on the castle to the larger concern with masculinity, power and violence? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** key events and the causes linking them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear't before him" (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2177–2178): Malcolm's order. On plot: Malcolm orders soldiers to cut boughs from Birnam Wood to hide their numbers. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the fulfilment of the prophecy make Malcolm a tool of fate or a free agent? Argue. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment on fate and free will.
   Answer guidance: A judgment on fate and free will.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): A practical military trick fulfills a supernatural prophecy, showing how the Witches' words come true in ways Macbeth never imagined.

How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2182–2183): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in “Act V, Scene IV” acts most wisely in the matter of a disguised advance on the castle, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear’t before him” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2177–2178): Malcolm's order. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene IV”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a disguised advance on the castle. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2178–2179): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act V, Scene IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane” (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2182–2183): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act V, Scene IV”, with its focus on a disguised advance on the castle, to ambition and its costs: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: “Let every soldier hew him down

a bough / And bear't before him" (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2177–2178): Malcolm's order. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the foreshadowing in "Act V, Scene IV" effective in presenting a disguised advance on the castle, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host" (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2178–2179): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how "Act V, Scene IV" treats a disguised advance on the castle with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "the confident tyrant / Keeps still in Dunsinane" (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2182–2183): Macbeth's "confidence" (the security Hecate promised) keeps him behind his walls. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Act V, Scene V" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "Let every soldier hew him down a bough / And bear't before him" (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2177–2178): Malcolm's order. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Act V, Scene IV" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a disguised advance on the castle? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Birnam Wood's "movement" is a military tactic, showing that the prophecy is fulfilled by human action. Useful evidence: "thereby shall we shadow / The numbers of our host" (Act V, Scene IV, lines 2178–2179): The strategy. Theme link: prophecy fulfilled through practical choices. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)

- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who asks the name of the wood before the army?

   A. Old Siward
   B. Young Malcolm
   C. Macduff
   D. Lennox

   Key: A (Old Siward)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Malcolm hope will soon be safe again?

   A. Harbours
   B. Chambers
   C. Churches
   D. Roads

   Key: B (Chambers)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Menteith answer Malcolm's hope?

   A. Fail not our feast
   B. Let it come down
   C. We doubt it nothing
   D. Well, march we on to Birnam

   Key: C (We doubt it nothing)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Siward say the tyrant is keeping himself?

   A. Hidden at Inverness
   B. On the road to Fife
   C. Abroad in Ireland
   D. Still in Dunsinane

   Key: D (Still in Dunsinane)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the summary: Siward reports that Macbeth means to endure a _____ of his castle.

   Key: siege

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do the soldiers answer Malcolm's order?

   A. It shall be done
   B. Stand to't, my lords
   C. Fail not our feast
   D. Make haste, make haste

   Key: A (It shall be done)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whose son marches with the army in this scene?

   A. Banquo's

B. Siward's

C. Lennox's

D. Duncan's

Key: B (Siward's)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Malcolm say Macbeth's men have given him?

   A. Their love

   B. Their gold

   C. The revolt

   D. Their land

   Key: C (The revolt)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Siward expect Macbeth to do as the army approaches?

   Sample answer: Siward says they hear nothing except that the confident tyrant stays inside Dunsinane and will endure their setting down before it, meaning he will let them lay siege. Macbeth trusts his castle's strength rather than meeting them in the field. Malcolm agrees that this is the tyrant's main hope.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] According to Malcolm, how loyal is Macbeth's army?

    Sample answer: Malcolm says that wherever they have had a chance, great and small alike have revolted from Macbeth. Those who remain serve only because they must, and their loyalty lies elsewhere. His description shows that Macbeth has an army in name only, held together by fear rather than loyalty.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Malcolm mean by “the days are near at hand That chambers will be safe”?

    A. People will soon sleep safely at home again

    B. The castle rooms will be rebuilt after the long war

    C. The prisoners will soon be freed

    D. The king's chamber will be locked

    Key: A (People will soon sleep safely at home again)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “Both more and less have given him the revolt” mean?

    A. Some have joined his side and some have left him for good

    B. Nobles and commoners alike have deserted him

    C. He has more soldiers than before

    D. He has given his army a rest

    Key: B (Nobles and commoners alike have deserted him)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macduff mean by “Let our just censures Attend the true event”?

    A. Punish the traitors right away

    B. Celebrate the coming victory now, before the battle begins

    C. Judge the outcome only after the battle

    D. Blame Macbeth for every event

    Key: C (Judge the outcome only after the battle)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Siward mean by “certain issue strokes must arbitrate”?

    A. A judge from England will decide the case in court

    B. A treaty will end the war

    C. The Witches will decide

    D. Only fighting will settle the outcome

    Key: D (Only fighting will settle the outcome)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What is Siward's attitude to guessing about the battle?

    A. Hopes and guesses mean little until blows are struck

    B. Guessing about the enemy is the best way to prepare for any battle

    C. The army should wait for omens

    D. The battle is already won

    Key: A (Hopes and guesses mean little until blows are struck)

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What mood does the scene create before the battle?

    A. Panic and confusion among the soldiers

    B. Calm, purposeful confidence

    C. Comic lightness and jokes

    D. Deep and hopeless despair

    Key: B (Calm, purposeful confidence)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does this scene's tone differ from the scenes inside Dunsinane?

    A. It is far more fearful than anything in Macbeth's castle

    B. It is just as chaotic as Dunsinane

    C. It is orderly where Macbeth's castle is frantic

    D. It is full of supernatural events

    Key: C (It is orderly where Macbeth's castle is frantic)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: the branches will hide how many men are in the army, so Macbeth's scouts will make an error in their _____.

    Key: report

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Macduff urge the leaders to put on 'industrious soldiership'?

    Sample answer: After Malcolm describes Macbeth's deserting army, Macduff warns that they should not judge the result before it happens. Rather than relying on reports or hopes, they should do the hard work of soldiers. His words show his practical, determined focus on facing Macbeth in battle.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How do the leaders of the army speak differently from Macbeth?

    Sample answer: Malcolm, Macduff and Siward speak calmly and share plans, warn against overconfidence and focus on action. Macbeth, in his castle, insults his servants, swings between boasting and despair, and relies on prophecies. The contrast shows a united, sensible army facing a frightened, isolated king.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What is the dramatic effect of Siward's question about the wood?

    A. It quietly signals that a prophecy is in play

    B. It shows that old Siward is lost in an unfamiliar Scotland

    C. It delays the battle for comic effect

    D. It reveals that Siward is a spy

    Key: A (It quietly signals that a prophecy is in play)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Malcolm's leadership in this scene compare with earlier scenes?

    A. He is still timid and keeps testing the loyalty of others

    B. He now commands with confidence and strategy

    C. He has handed command to Macduff

    D. He relies on the Witches' advice

    Key: B (He now commands with confidence and strategy)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Malcolm's phrase 'constrained things' imply about tyranny?

    A. It wins loyalty through fear

    B. It fails to raise any army at all in its time of need

    C. It can force service but not loyalty

    D. It is supported by most people

    Key: C (It can force service but not loyalty)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How do Macduff and Siward's warnings contrast with Macbeth's attitude?

    A. They are as confident as he is

    B. They trust the prophecies even more than he does, and wait

    C. They are ready to surrender

    D. They distrust overconfidence while he embraces it

    Key: D (They distrust overconfidence while he embraces it)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does Siward end the scene with a rhyming couplet?

    A. To give a sense of firm resolve before battle

    B. To show that he is a poet as well as a soldier of England

    C. To mock the way Macbeth speaks to his servants

    D. To end the play with a final rhyme

    Key: A (To give a sense of firm resolve before battle)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the order of characters entering suggest about the army?

    A. It is led by Norwegians

    B. It unites English and Scottish leaders

    C. It is made up only of English soldiers

D. It is commanded by the Witches

Key: B (It unites English and Scottish leaders)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Siward's "What we shall say we have and what we owe" suggest?

A. The soldiers will be paid their wages in full after the battle

B. The army is in debt to England

C. The battle will reveal what is truly won and owed

D. Malcolm owes Siward money

Key: C (The battle will reveal what is truly won and owed)

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: Malcolm says Macbeth's soldiers serve him only because they are _____.

Key: forced

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how the scene shows the forces against Macbeth as rational.

Sample answer: The leaders discuss tactics, hear reports, warn against judging before the outcome and insist that only blows will settle the war. Their calm reasoning contrasts with Macbeth's reliance on riddling spirits. A strong answer argues that the play sets human reason and order against supernatural deception and tyranny.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how Malcolm's description of Macbeth's army supports the play's view of kingship.

Sample answer: Malcolm says high and low have revolted and only forced men with absent hearts serve Macbeth. Like Angus's earlier remark that Macbeth's men move only in command, this shows that a tyrant cannot command love. A strong answer links this to the idea, seen in Edward and Duncan, that true kingship rests on loyalty freely given.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the scene treat the line between prophecy and practical action?

A. A practical choice brings a prophecy to life

B. Prophecy replaces all practical action

C. Action makes the prophecy false

D. Neither plays any role

Key: A (A practical choice brings a prophecy to life)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why might Shakespeare make Malcolm, not Macduff, give the key order?

A. Macduff is not present in the scene

B. It confirms Malcolm as the rightful leader

C. Malcolm is a better soldier

D. It hides Malcolm's identity

Key: B (It confirms Malcolm as the rightful leader)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does Malcolm's opening line connect to imagery from earlier in the play?

A. It recalls the battle at the start

B. It recalls the Porter's gate

C. It recalls the murders in bedchambers

D. It recalls the cauldron

Key: C (It recalls the murders in bedchambers)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the soldiers' brief 'It shall be done' contrast with?

A. The Witches' long chants

B. Lady Macbeth's long speeches

C. The Porter's long, drunken jokes at the castle gate

D. Macbeth's servants who obey only in fear

Key: D (Macbeth's servants who obey only in fear)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the scene complicate the idea that the Witches control events?

A. Human strategy fulfils their words

B. The Witches appear to guide the army

C. The prophecy is shown to be false

D. Macbeth controls the outcome

Key: A (Human strategy fulfils their words)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about Macbeth trusting his castle's strength?

A. His castle is truly impregnable, whatever army may come against it

B. His enemies are already using the prophecy against him

C. His army is loyal to him

D. The Witches will defend him

Key: B (His enemies are already using the prophecy against him)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate how this scene builds tension for the final act.

Sample answer: The army gathers near the wood, Macbeth is reported confident in his castle, and the leaders warn against premature judgment. A strong answer argues how the audience's knowledge of the prophecy creates suspense, and how the calm tone of the scene makes the coming collision feel inevitable.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate the role of Siward in this scene.

Sample answer: Siward asks about the wood, reports Macbeth's position and ends with a couplet insisting that only blows will decide. A strong answer argues that he represents experienced, practical soldiership and outside support from England, and considers how his presence frames the war as a restoration rather than a conquest.

39. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: the scene ends as the army begins its _____ toward the castle.

Key: march

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare the order Malcolm gives here with Macbeth's orders in his castle.

Sample answer: Malcolm gives one clear, shared order that every soldier obeys willingly. Macbeth gives confused orders, calls for armour and then takes it off, and threatens to hang anyone who speaks of fear. A strong answer argues what the contrast shows about the two leaders and the kind of loyalty each commands.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0

HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 9, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene IV develops the idea of a disguised advance on the castle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene IV” could deliver about a disguised advance on the castle. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a disguised advance on the castle in “Act V, Scene IV”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of a disguised advance on the castle. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene IV” could deliver about a disguised advance on the castle. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a disguised advance on the castle in “Act V, Scene IV”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene IV suggests about a disguised advance on the castle. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's foreshadowing and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene IV” could deliver about a disguised advance on the castle. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a disguised advance on the castle in "Act V, Scene IV": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses foreshadowing in Act V, Scene IV to complicate the reader's understanding of a disguised advance on the castle. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene IV" could deliver about a disguised advance on the castle. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for a disguised advance on the castle in "Act V, Scene IV": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Thoughts speculative their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue strokes must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "arbitrate" most nearly mean?

   A. blows in battle

   B. scouting; spying out

   C. forced; acting against their will

   D. to decide; to settle

2. *Cousins, I hope the days are near at hand That chambers will be safe. We doubt it nothing. What wood is this before us? The wood of Birnam. Let every soldier hew him down a bough And bear't before him: thereby shall we shadow The numbers of our host and make discovery Err in report of us. It shall be done. We learn no other but the confident tyrant Keeps still in Dunsinane, and will endure Our setting down before't. 'Tis his main hope: For where there is advantage to be given, Both more and less have given him the revolt, And none serve with him but constrained things Whose hearts are absent too. Let our just censures Attend the true event, and put we on Industrious soldiership. The time approaches That will with due decision make us know What we shall say we have and what we owe. Thoughts speculative their unsure hopes relate, But certain issue strokes must arbitrate: Towards which advance the war.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene IV"?

   A. The Witches' riddling world

   B. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   C. A disguised advance on the castle

   D. The army reveals itself

SAT key: 1. D (to decide; to settle); 2. C (A disguised advance on the castle)

Lesson 27: Act V, Scene V

Focus: life as a tale told by an idiot

Objective: Students will analyze how metaphor develops in “Act V, Scene V” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide (mentioned in lesson text)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth orders banners hung on the outward walls, boasting his castle will laugh a siege to scorn. A cry of women is heard; he says he has almost forgotten the taste of fears. Seyton reports 'The queen, my lord, is dead.' Macbeth replies 'She should have died hereafter' and speaks of 'To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow': life is 'a walking shadow, a poor player,' a tale 'told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, signifying nothing.' A messenger reports that Birnam Wood seems to move. Macbeth begins to doubt 'the equivocation of the fiend that lies like truth' and goes out to fight: 'At least we'll die with harness on our back.'

Background: Comparing life to a stage play was a commonplace in Shakespeare's theater; here an actor speaks of life as a part that means nothing.

Significance: The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: meaninglessness.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: yesterdays — past days; equivocation — the use of double meanings to mislead; tarrying — staying; lingering; harness — armor; lighted — lit the way for; guided. “equivocation”: Origin: Old French equivocation; earlier Late Latin aequivocus (“ambiguous”).
Words: yesterdays: past days · equivocation: the use of double meanings to mislead · tarrying: staying; lingering · harness: armor · lighted: lit the way for; guided

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Comparing life to a stage play was a commonplace in Shakespeare's theater; here an actor speaks of life as a part that means nothing. The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom. Soliloquy: "Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow": Macbeth's response to his wife's death. Imagery: Life as a "brief candle," "a walking shadow," "a poor player," "a tale / Told by an idiot." Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "She should have died hereafter" slowly and put it in my own words: Told that the queen is dead, Macbeth says she should have died hereafter, at a later time. Next, craft. I notice the flat, tired tone, with no cry of grief. The strongest word is "hereafter": it means later, as if her death simply came at a bad moment. Then, effect. What does Macbeth's response to his wife's death show? My answer: Macbeth's response to his wife's death, that she should have died hereafter, shows that he has become numb; his following speech shows that life now seems meaningless to him.

> *She should have died hereafter* (Act V, Scene V, line 2219)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "She should have died hereafter" slowly and put it in my own words: Told that the queen is dead, Macbeth says she should have died hereafter, at a later time. Next, craft. I notice the flat, tired tone, with no cry of grief. The strongest word is "hereafter": it means later, as if her death simply came at a bad moment. Then, effect. What does Macbeth's response to his wife's death show? My answer: Macbeth's response to his wife's death, that she should have died hereafter, shows that he has become numb; his following speech shows that life now seems meaningless to him.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Tale", "idiot" and "signifying nothing" stand out. Macbeth calls life a story told by a fool, loud but empty, so he now finds no meaning in anything. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected student answer: Macbeth once trusted prophecies about his future, but here he sees time leading only to dusty death, so the line shows a man who no longer believes fate gives life any purpose.

> *it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing* (Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Tale", "idiot" and "signifying nothing" stand out. Macbeth calls life a story told by a fool, loud but empty, so he now finds no meaning in anything.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected student answer: Macbeth once trusted prophecies about his future, but here he sees time leading only to dusty death, so the line shows a man who no longer believes fate gives life any purpose.

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for soliloquy, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of life as a tale told by an idiot. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of metaphor and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. When the text says "it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing" (Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230), it shows this directly. Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing."
Task: Annotate the scene for soliloquy, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of life as a tale told by an idiot. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of metaphor and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. When the text says "it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing" (Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230), it shows this directly. Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing."

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none? Ask: is this Shakespeare's view or Macbeth's?
Anchor question: What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?
Facilitation: Ask: is this Shakespeare's view or Macbeth's?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. ("it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing", Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. ("it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing", Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how soliloquy shapes life as a tale told by an idiot. Key takeaway: meaninglessness.*

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Soliloquy:** "Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow": Macbeth's response to his wife's death.
- **Imagery:** Life as a "brief candle," "a walking shadow," "a poor player," "a tale / Told by an idiot."

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** meaninglessness.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, line 2219) His response.
- “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2221–2222) Time.
- “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230) Meaninglessness.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning.
> **Evidence:** “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230)
> **Reasoning:** Life is "a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
yesterdays (noun)	past days	*To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*	

equivocation (noun)	the use of double meanings to mislead	*I pull in resolution, and begin To doubt the equivocation of the fiend That lies like truth: "Fear not, till Birnam wood Do come to Dunsinane:" and now a wood Comes toward Dunsinane.*	"equivocation": Origin: Old French equivocation; earlier Late Latin aequivocus ("ambiguous"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/equivocation#Etymology)
tarrying (verb)	staying; lingering	*If this which he avouches does appear, There is nor flying hence nor tarrying here.*	
harness (noun)	armor	*At least we'll die with harness on our back.*	
lighted (verb)	lit the way for; guided	*To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death.*	

Discussion questions

1. What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?
2. Where does metaphor appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with ambition and its costs?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Macbeth say life signifies, at the end of the speech? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Nothing: a tale told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, signifying nothing.
   Answer guidance: Nothing: a tale told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, signifying nothing.
2. What does Seyton report? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** The queen is dead
   Answer guidance: The queen is dead.
3. How does Macbeth first respond to his wife's death? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** She should have died hereafter
   Answer guidance: She should have died hereafter.

4. What does Macbeth compare life to? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A walking shadow and a poor player
   Answer guidance: A walking shadow and a poor player.
5. What does the messenger see? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Birnam Wood beginning to move
   Answer guidance: Birnam Wood beginning to move.
6. What does Macbeth say his castle's strength will do to a siege? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Laugh it to scorn
   Answer guidance: Laugh it to scorn.
7. Retell the most important events of "Act V, Scene V" in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Macbeth orders banners hung on the outward walls, boasting his castle will laugh a siege to scorn. A cry of women is heard; he says he has almost forgotten the taste of fears. Seyton reports 'The queen, my lord, is dead.' Macbeth replies 'She should have died hereafter' and speaks of 'To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow': life is 'a walking shadow, a poor player,' a tale 'told by an idiot,…
   Answer guidance: Macbeth orders banners hung on the outward walls, boasting his castle will laugh a siege to scorn. A cry of women is heard; he says he has almost forgotten the taste of fears. Seyton reports 'The queen, my lord, is dead.' Macbeth replies 'She should have died hereafter' and speaks of 'To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow': life is 'a walking shadow, a poor player,' a tale 'told by an idiot,…
8. Who is on stage in "Act V, Scene V", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is "Act V, Scene V" set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, Creeps in this petty pace from day to day To the last syllable of recorded time, And all our yesterdays have lighted fools The way to dusty death." What does "yesterdays" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** yesterdays: past days.
    Answer guidance: yesterdays: past days.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macbeth react so flatly to his wife's death? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** He has 'supp'd full with horrors'; feeling itself has been numbed by crime.
   Answer guidance: He has 'supp'd full with horrors'; feeling itself has been numbed by crime.
2. What does Macbeth mean by 'the equivocation of the fiend that lies like truth'? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** He realizes the Witches' words were true only in a deceptive sense.
   Answer guidance: He realizes the Witches' words were true only in a deceptive sense.

3. What does “Act V, Scene V” suggest about life as a tale told by an idiot? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom.

   Answer guidance: The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom. Evidence to accept: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, line 2219): His response. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
4. Find one example of metaphor in “Act V, Scene V”. What does it reveal about life as a tale told by an idiot that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** direct comparisons that call one thing another.

   Answer guidance: Look for direct comparisons that call one thing another. Evidence to accept: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2221–2222): Time. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
5. How does the tone / mood in “Act V, Scene V” shape what we understand about life as a tale told by an idiot? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, line 2219): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. In the passage that opens with “Hang out our banners…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230): Meaninglessness. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** the news of the queen's death and the report that the wood is moving; evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow”.

   Answer guidance: Look for: the news of the queen's death and the report that the wood is moving; evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow”. Evidence to accept: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, line 2219): His response. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
8. How does “Act V, Scene V” build on “Act V, Scene IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2221–2222): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. In “Act V, Scene V”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about life as a tale told by an idiot, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Go back to the bell-ringer question (What gives a life meaning? What could make someone feel that it has none?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
    Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2221–2222): Time. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is 'To-morrow, and to-morrow' the play's message or only Macbeth's? Argue with evidence from the ending. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment distinguishing character and work.
   Answer guidance: A judgment distinguishing character and work.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The most famous speech of the play states a nihilism the play does not fully share; it is Macbeth's verdict on a life emptied by crime, and the turn from defiance to doom. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2221–2222): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act V, Scene V” acts most wisely in the matter of life as a tale told by an idiot, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene V”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of life as a tale told by an idiot. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-

Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, line 2219): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act V, Scene V”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2221–2222): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act V, Scene V”, with its focus on life as a tale told by an idiot, to fate and free will: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the metaphor in “Act V, Scene V” effective in presenting life as a tale told by an idiot, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, line 2219): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene V” treats life as a tale told by an idiot with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “To-morrow, and to-morrow, and to-morrow, / Creeps in this petty pace from day to day” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2221–2222): Time. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene VI” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s ·

RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “it is a tale / Told by an idiot, full of sound and fury, / Signifying nothing” (Act V, Scene V, lines 2228–2230): Meaninglessness. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act V, Scene V” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about life as a tale told by an idiot? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's response to his wife's death shows that his crimes have emptied life of meaning. Useful evidence: “She should have died hereafter” (Act V, Scene V, line 2219): His response. Theme link: meaninglessness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Metaphor:** look for direct comparisons that call one thing another (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where is Macbeth as he orders the banners hung?

    A. Inside his castle at Dunsinane

    B. In the country near Birnam wood

    C. Before the King's palace in England

    D. On the open heath at night

    Key: A (Inside his castle at Dunsinane)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth order hung on the outward walls?

    A. Lanterns

    B. Banners

    C. Shields

    D. Bells

    Key: B (Banners)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth hope will destroy the besieging army?

    A. A great storm from the sea

    B. The Witches' spells and charms

    C. Famine and the ague

    D. A sudden flood of the river

    Key: C (Famine and the ague)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “I gin to be aweary of the _____”

   Key: sun

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What noise does Macbeth hear from within the castle?

   A. A trumpet call

   B. A bell ringing

   C. A dog barking

   D. A cry of women

   Key: D (A cry of women)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth call the messenger when he hears the report?

   A. Liar and slave

   B. Brave and loyal friend

   C. Foolish but honest boy

   D. A spy for the English

   Key: A (Liar and slave)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How far away does the messenger say the sight can be seen?

   A. Ten miles off

   B. Within three miles

   C. Just outside the gate

   D. Across the sea

   Key: B (Within three miles)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth tell the messenger as he enters?

   A. Wait until I call for you

   B. Speak only to Seyton

   C. Tell your story quickly

   D. Go back to your post

   Key: C (Tell your story quickly)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Macbeth plan to defend Dunsinane at the start of the scene?

   Sample answer: He orders banners hung on the outer walls and says the castle's strength will laugh a siege to scorn. He plans to let the enemy sit outside until famine and fever destroy them. He adds that if so many of his own men had not joined the other side, he would have met them face to face and beaten them home.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Macbeth react when he realizes the prophecy may be turning against him?

    Sample answer: He says he is pulling in his resolution and starting to doubt the spirit's double meanings. He sees there is no point in fleeing or staying. He grows weary of the sun and wishes the whole world would fall apart, then orders the alarm bell rung and resolves to die fighting.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth mean by “our castle’s strength Will laugh a siege to scorn”?

    A. The castle is strong enough to resist easily

B. The soldiers will laugh out loud at the enemy below

C. The siege will be a comic event

D. The castle will soon be abandoned

Key: A (The castle is strong enough to resist easily)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth mean by "I have almost forgot the taste of fears"?

A. He has lost his sense of taste

B. He has grown numb to fear

C. He is too busy to feel afraid

D. He has not known fear in his life

Key: B (He has grown numb to fear)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does "my fell of hair Would at a dismal treatise rouse and stir" describe?

A. How he combed his hair carefully before each battle

B. How the wind blew his hair

C. How his hair once stood up at frightening tales

D. How his hair turned grey

Key: C (How his hair once stood up at frightening tales)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does "Creeps in this petty pace" suggest about time?

A. Time races by far too quickly for anyone

B. Time stands still in battle

C. Time heals all wounds

D. Time moves slowly and pointlessly

Key: D (Time moves slowly and pointlessly)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: "Ring the alarum-bell! Blow, wind! come, _____!"

Key: wrack

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does "Out, out, brief candle!" compare?

A. A short human life to a flame

B. A dark room to a short night

C. A dying fire to Lady Macbeth's anger

D. A lost battle to a broken lamp

Key: A (A short human life to a flame)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why is the messenger slow to begin the report?

A. He has forgotten most of what he saw on the hill

B. The sight is almost beyond belief

C. He is afraid of the English

D. He has been wounded in battle

Key: B (The sight is almost beyond belief)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth mean by “There is nor flying hence nor tarrying here”?

    A. He can fly to England or stay

    B. He must leave the castle at once

    C. Neither escape nor staying will save him

    D. He must stay forever inside the castle walls

    Key: C (Neither escape nor staying will save him)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's speech after hearing the cry of women reveal about how he has changed?

    Sample answer: He says there was a time when a scream in the night would have chilled him and a frightening story made his hair stand up. Now he has supped full with horrors and nothing dreadful can startle him. The man who once trembled at a vision has been hardened by crime until he can no longer feel fear.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macbeth's speech on life suggest about his view of the world?

    Sample answer: He describes days creeping on one after another until the end of time, with each yesterday lighting fools toward death. Life is a brief candle, an actor who rages on stage and is forgotten, a story full of noise but meaningless. His words show that his crimes have left him believing nothing matters.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macbeth's reaction to the women's cry contrast with his earlier fear?

    A. He feels nothing where he once trembled

    B. He is more frightened than ever before in his life

    C. He weeps openly for the first time

    D. He runs to see what has happened

    Key: A (He feels nothing where he once trembled)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does the theatre imagery in the speech suggest about life?

    A. Life is a joyful comedy to enjoy

    B. Life is a brief performance without lasting meaning

    C. Life is a carefully written plan

    D. Life is a lesson that teaches wisdom

    Key: B (Life is a brief performance without lasting meaning)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic in “At least we’ll die with harness on our back”?

    A. He plans to surrender to Malcolm without a fight

    B. He has no armour at all

    C. He seeks a soldier's death after a tyrant's life

    D. He wants to live in peace

    Key: C (He seeks a soldier's death after a tyrant's life)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does “the last syllable of recorded time” suggest?

    A. The final word of a book

B. The last letter of the alphabet

C. A clock striking midnight

D. The very end of history

Key: D (The very end of history)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macbeth's line: “If thy speech be _____, I care not if thou dost for me as much”

Key: sooth

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's “I pull in resolution” reveal?

A. His confidence is beginning to fail

B. He is growing more confident by the minute

C. He is preparing a new plan

D. He is pulling on his armour

Key: A (His confidence is beginning to fail)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “wish the estate o’ the world were now undone” show?

A. He wishes to rebuild the world after the war

B. He wants everything to end with him

C. He wants to sell his estate

D. He hopes for peace on earth

Key: B (He wants everything to end with him)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's wish that his own soldiers had not deserted reveal?

A. He believes his army is loyal

B. He plans to punish the English

C. He knows his support has collapsed

D. He wants to make peace with Malcolm

Key: C (He knows his support has collapsed)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze the structure of the 'To-morrow' speech.

Sample answer: The speech begins with the slow repetition of to-morrow, which mimics the dragging pace of time, then moves through images of candle, shadow, actor and tale. Each image is shorter-lived than the last, ending on the single word nothing. A strong answer shows how the structure enacts the despair it describes.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how the messenger's report changes Macbeth's mood.

Sample answer: Before the report Macbeth boasts of his castle's strength and of being beyond fear. When the messenger says the wood is moving, he first calls him a liar, then admits his resolution is failing. He decides to go out and fight even though he sees no escape. A strong answer traces this shift from defiance to doomed courage.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Macbeth's speech on life serve as a commentary on the play itself?

A. It calls life a stage play while he stands on a stage

B. It praises the actors in the company for their skill

C. It sums up the plot so far for the audience

D. It explains the Witches' prophecies to Seyton

Key: A (It calls life a stage play while he stands on a stage)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth mean by “There would have been a time for such a word”?

A. He had planned to tell her a secret that day

B. A calmer moment would have allowed true mourning

C. Time has stopped since she died in the night

D. He wishes he had spoken to her of the Witches

Key: B (A calmer moment would have allowed true mourning)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the scene suggest about the relationship between crime and feeling?

A. Crime has made him more sensitive to others' pain

B. Crime has no effect on feeling

C. Repeated crime has deadened his capacity to feel

D. Crime makes him more loving

Key: C (Repeated crime has deadened his capacity to feel)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the messenger's line: “I should report that which I say I _____, But know not how to do it”

Key: saw

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Macbeth's final couplet reverse his earlier plan?

A. He decides to wait for the siege

B. He chooses to flee to England

C. He surrenders to Malcolm

D. He leaves the castle to fight instead of waiting

Key: D (He leaves the castle to fight instead of waiting)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's wish to 'die with harness on' suggest about his self-image?

A. He clings to his identity as a soldier

B. He wants to be remembered as a good and gentle king

C. He wishes to die a peaceful death

D. He plans to escape in disguise

Key: A (He clings to his identity as a soldier)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether Macbeth's 'To-morrow' speech is a response to his wife's death or to his own condition.

Sample answer: The speech follows the news of the queen's death, but it says little about her and much about the emptiness of all life. A strong answer weighs grief against despair, considering whether he mourns her, himself, or the meaninglessness his crimes have made of his world.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate how this scene prepares for Macbeth's end.

Sample answer: In one scene Macbeth loses his wife, his belief in the meaning of life and his trust in the prophecy. Yet he

chooses to fight rather than wait. A strong answer argues whether this makes him a tragic hero facing death with courage or a despairing tyrant with nothing left to lose.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's question 'Wherefore was that cry?' after claiming not to fear suggest?
    A. He is afraid of the women
    B. A trace of concern remains despite his words
    C. He wants the women to be silent so he can think
    D. He is planning an escape

    Key: B (A trace of concern remains despite his words)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Macbeth's response to his wife's death with Macduff's response to the death of his family.
    Sample answer: Macduff asks again and again about his family, blames himself, and turns grief into a resolve for justice. Macbeth answers his wife's death briefly and moves into a speech about the emptiness of life. A strong answer argues what the contrast reveals about each man's state of mind.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 9, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene V develops the idea of life as a tale told by an idiot. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of metaphor and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene V” could deliver about life as a tale told by an idiot. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for life as a tale told by an idiot in “Act V, Scene V”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its metaphor shape the reader's understanding of life as a tale told by an idiot. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene V" could deliver about life as a tale told by an idiot. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for life as a tale told by an idiot in "Act V, Scene V": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene V suggests about life as a tale told by an idiot. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's metaphor and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene V" could deliver about life as a tale told by an idiot. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for life as a tale told by an idiot in "Act V, Scene V": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses metaphor in Act V, Scene V to complicate the reader's understanding of life as a tale told by an idiot. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene V" could deliver about life as a tale told by an idiot. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for life as a tale told by an idiot in "Act V, Scene V": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *At least we'll die with harness on our back.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "harness" most nearly mean?

   A. the use of double meanings to mislead

   B. armor

   C. staying; lingering

   D. lit the way for; guided

2. *Hang out our banners on the outward walls; The cry is still "They come:" our castle's strength Will laugh a siege to scorn: here let them lie Till famine and the ague eat them up: Were they not forced with those that should be ours, We might have met them dareful, beard to beard, And beat them backward home. A cry of women within. What is that noise? It is the cry of women, my good lord. Exit. I have almost forgot the taste of fears: The time has been, my senses would have cool'd To hear a night-shriek; and my fell of hair Would at a dismal treatise rouse and stir As life were in't: I have supp'd full with horrors; Direness, familiar to my slaughterous thoughts, Cannot once start me.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene V"?

A. The Witches' riddling world

B. The Witches' greetings and their pull

C. The cast and world of the play

D. Life as a tale told by an idiot

SAT key: 1. B (armor); 2. D (Life as a tale told by an idiot)

Lesson 28: Act V, Scene VI

Focus: the army reveals itself

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Act V, Scene VI (the army reveals itself) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.3

Teacher only · spoilers

Before Dunsinane, Malcolm orders the soldiers to throw down their 'leavy screens' and show themselves as they are. His uncle Siward and Siward's son will lead the first battle; Malcolm and Macduff will do the rest. Macduff calls for all the trumpets to sound, 'those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.'

Background: Short battle scenes with alarums (trumpet calls) and quick exits created the impression of a large battle on a bare stage.

Significance: The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....*
> **Prompt:** Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the prophecy is fulfilled.

> **8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)**
> Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
> *Short battle scenes with alarums (trumpet calls) and quick exits created the impression of a large battle on a bare stage. The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality. Plot: Malcolm's army throws down its branches and attacks. Structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Watch for blood: Blood begins as a sign of valour; watch how its meaning changes as the play goes on.*

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes the army reveals itself. Key takeaway: the prophecy is fulfilled.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Malcolm's army throws down its branches and attacks.
- **Structure:** A brief scene that speeds the action.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the prophecy is fulfilled.

Symbols and motifs

- **blood:** Blood begins as a sign of valour; watch how its meaning changes as the play goes on.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2261) Malcolm's command.
- “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2270) Battle.
- “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2271) The trumpets.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true.
Evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2261)
Reasoning: Malcolm orders "your leavy screens throw down" and the trumpets become "harbingers of blood and death."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
screens (noun)	coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army)	*Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are.*	
clamorous (adjective)	loud and noisy	*Make all our trumpets speak; give them all breath, Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.*	“clamorous”: Origin: an English formation from clamor + -ous. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/clamorous#Etymology)
trumpets (noun)	brass instruments sounded in battle	*Make all our trumpets speak; give them all breath, Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with fate and free will?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Malcolm call Siward in this scene? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** 'Worthy uncle.'
   Answer guidance: 'Worthy uncle.'.
2. What does Malcolm order the soldiers to throw down? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Their leafy screens
   Answer guidance: Their leafy screens.
3. Who will lead the first battle? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Siward and his son
   Answer guidance: Siward and his son.
4. What does Macduff call the trumpets? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Clamorous harbingers of blood and death
   Answer guidance: Clamorous harbingers of blood and death.
5. Where does this scene take place? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Before Dunsinane castle
   Answer guidance: Before Dunsinane castle.
6. What is the main effect of the short battle scenes? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Speed and the sense of a large battle
   Answer guidance: Speed and the sense of a large battle.
7. Retell the most important events of “Act V, Scene VI” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Before Dunsinane, Malcolm orders the soldiers to throw down their 'leavy screens' and show themselves as they are. His uncle Siward and Siward's son will lead the first battle; Malcolm and Macduff will do the rest. Macduff calls for all the trumpets to sound, 'those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.'
   Answer guidance: Before Dunsinane, Malcolm orders the soldiers to throw down their 'leavy screens' and show themselves as they are. His uncle Siward and Siward's son will lead the first battle; Malcolm and Macduff will do the rest. Macduff calls for all the trumpets to sound, 'those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.'
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene VI”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the

teacher summary.

Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when is “Act V, Scene VI” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are.” What does “screens” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** screens: coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army).

    Answer guidance: screens: coverings that hide something (here, the branches carried by the army).

Inferential / analytical

1. How does dropping the 'leavy screens' connect to the theme of appearance and reality? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Disguise ends; truth is revealed as the tyrant is confronted.

   Answer guidance: Disguise ends; truth is revealed as the tyrant is confronted.

2. What does “Act V, Scene VI” suggest about the army reveals itself? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality.

   Answer guidance: The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality. Evidence to accept: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2261): Malcolm's command. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

3. Find one example of setting in “Act V, Scene VI”. What does it reveal about the army reveals itself that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   Answer guidance: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling. Evidence to accept: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2270): Battle. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the imagery in “Act V, Scene VI” shape what we understand about the army reveals itself? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2261): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that opens with “Now near enough: your…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Those

clamorous harbingers of blood and death" (Act V, Scene VI, line 2271): The trumpets. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

6. What causes the main turn in "Act V, Scene VI", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Malcolm's army throws down the boughs and goes into battle; evidence: "your leavy screens throw down".
   Answer guidance: Look for: Malcolm's army throws down the boughs and goes into battle; evidence: "your leavy screens throw down". Evidence to accept: "your leavy screens throw down" (Act V, Scene VI, line 2261): Malcolm's command. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does "Act V, Scene VI" build on "Act V, Scene V"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: "Make all our trumpets speak" (Act V, Scene VI, line 2270): Battle. On structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In "Act V, Scene VI", what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the army reveals itself, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: "Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death" (Act V, Scene VI, line 2271): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Why do you think the play moves so quickly from scene to scene at the end?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: "Make all our trumpets speak" (Act V, Scene VI, line 2270): Battle. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
10. Where does structure appear in "Act V, Scene VI", and how does it connect the army reveals itself to the larger concern with fate and free will? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: "your leavy screens throw down" (Act V, Scene VI, line 2261): Malcolm's command. On structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. If you staged this scene, how would you make a handful of actors feel like an army? Explain. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative staging solution with rationale.
   Answer guidance: A creative staging solution with rationale.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The disguise is dropped as the play moves from concealment to open conflict, matching its theme of appearances giving way to reality. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2271): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act V, Scene VI” acts most wisely in the matter of the army reveals itself, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2261): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene VI”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the army reveals itself. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Make all our trumpets speak” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2270): Battle. On structure: A brief scene that speeds the action. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write your own questions about “Act V, Scene VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2271): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect “Act V, Scene VI”, with its focus on the army reveals itself, to guilt and conscience: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: “your leavy screens throw down” (Act V, Scene VI, line 2261): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the setting in “Act V, Scene VI” effective in presenting the army reveals itself, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches

their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: "Make all our trumpets speak" (Act V, Scene VI, line 2270): Battle. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Act V, Scene VI" treats the army reveals itself with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: "Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death" (Act V, Scene VI, line 2271): The trumpets. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Act V, Scene VII" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: "your leavy screens throw down" (Act V, Scene VI, line 2261): Malcolm's command. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Act V, Scene VI" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the army reveals itself? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The short scene compresses action as the prophecy comes true. Useful evidence: "Make all our trumpets speak" (Act V, Scene VI, line 2270): Battle. Theme link: the prophecy is fulfilled. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Malcolm say at the start to show the army has arrived?

   A. Now near enough

   B. Make haste, my lords

   C. Stand to't

D. Hark, I hear horses

Key: A (Now near enough)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Malcolm tell the soldiers to show themselves as?

A. Trees of Birnam

B. Those they are

C. Englishmen

D. Ghosts

Key: B (Those they are)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who will fight alongside Malcolm after the first battle?

A. Old Siward

B. Lennox

C. Macduff

D. Ross

Key: C (Macduff)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Siward take leave of Malcolm?

A. God save the king and keep him safe

B. Farewell, father

C. Adieu, my lord

D. Fare you well

Key: D (Fare you well)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Siward say should happen if they cannot fight once they find Macbeth's army?

A. Let them be beaten

B. Let them go home to England in peace

C. Let them hide

D. Let them pray

Key: A (Let them be beaten)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff want the trumpets to do?

A. Stay quiet till dawn

B. Speak with all their breath

C. Play a slow song

D. Call retreat

Key: B (Speak with all their breath)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Malcolm say he and Macduff will follow?

A. The Witches' advice

B. The river

C. Their order

D. The moon

Key: C (Their order)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the summary: the soldiers have carried the branches all the way from Birnam _____.

    Key: Wood

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What plan does Malcolm give for the attack?

    Sample answer: Malcolm tells the soldiers they are near enough to stop hiding and show themselves. His uncle Siward and Siward's son will lead the first attack, while he and Macduff will handle whatever else remains, as they have planned. The orders are clear and calm, showing a well-organized army ready for battle.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How do Siward and Macduff show their readiness for battle?

    Sample answer: Siward says that if they find Macbeth's forces that night and cannot fight, they deserve to be beaten. Macduff calls for every trumpet to sound loudly, announcing bloodshed and death. Both speak in rhyming couplets that sound firm and final, showing they are eager to face the tyrant at last.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “show like those you are” suggest?

    A. The soldiers stop hiding and show their true strength
    B. The soldiers should put on new uniforms for battle
    C. The soldiers should pretend to be trees
    D. The army should retreat

    Key: A (The soldiers stop hiding and show their true strength)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does the scene suggest about the order of battle?

    A. It is being made up on the spot by the soldiers
    B. It has been carefully planned in advance
    C. It was given by the Witches
    D. It has been abandoned

    Key: B (It has been carefully planned in advance)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Siward's “Let us be beaten, if we cannot fight” show?

    A. Fear of losing to Macbeth's great army
    B. A wish to retreat
    C. Confidence and determination
    D. Doubt in Malcolm

    Key: C (Confidence and determination)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does the scene end with rhyming couplets?

    A. To show the soldiers are singing
    B. To mock Macbeth
    C. To slow the pace
    D. To give a sense of firm resolve

    Key: D (To give a sense of firm resolve)

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macduff's call for loud trumpets suggest about his mood?

    A. He is eager for the fight

B. He is afraid and wants the enemy warned

C. He is celebrating

D. He is grieving

Key: A (He is eager for the fight)

16. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: Siward is ready to fight if they meet the tyrant's forces _____.

Key: tonight

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the army's arrival at the castle fulfil?

A. Lady Macbeth's wish for night

B. The apparition's warning

C. Duncan's hope

D. Banquo's prayer

Key: B (The apparition's warning)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Malcolm call Siward's son?

A. My brother

B. My squire

C. My cousin

D. My nephew

Key: C (My cousin)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Malcolm tell the soldiers to drop their branches now?

Sample answer: The branches were used to hide how many soldiers were marching. Now that they are close to the castle, concealment no longer helps, so Malcolm orders them to throw down the screens and show themselves as they truly are. The moment marks the shift from stealth to open battle.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does this brief scene build anticipation for the battle?

Sample answer: The army arrives before the castle, drops its disguise and receives its orders. Siward vows to fight and Macduff calls for every trumpet to sound. The short, rhyming speeches and the sound of drums create urgency, so the audience feels the final confrontation with Macbeth is about to begin.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene connect to the play's opening battle?

A. Again an army gathers to defend Scotland

B. Again Macbeth leads Duncan's forces against the rebels

C. Again the Witches appear

D. Again Norway invades

Key: A (Again an army gathers to defend Scotland)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What is the dramatic function of the army dropping its disguise?

A. It shows the soldiers are tired of carrying branches

B. It marks a shift from hiding to open truth

C. It hides the army further

D. It confuses Malcolm

Key: B (It marks a shift from hiding to open truth)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Malcolm's careful planning suggest about him as a future king?

    A. He depends on Macduff and Siward to command

    B. He is reckless in battle

    C. He is a capable, orderly leader

    D. He is uncertain of himself

    Key: C (He is a capable, orderly leader)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Macduff's couplet use personification?

    A. The castle walls are given the power to weep

    B. The wind sings over the field

    C. The trees march toward the castle

    D. Trumpets become heralds of blood and death

    Key: D (Trumpets become heralds of blood and death)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: the drums and flags show an army that no longer needs to _____ its numbers.

    Key: conceal

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does Siward's couplet echo his earlier speech near Birnam?

    A. Each insists that fighting will decide

    B. Each one doubts that the army can win the war

    C. Each one praises Macbeth

    D. Each one mourns Duncan

    Key: A (Each insists that fighting will decide)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What contrast does this scene set up with the next one?

    A. Peace here, celebration and feasting inside the castle

    B. Order here, chaos inside the castle

    C. Fear here, joy there

    D. Night here, day there

    Key: B (Order here, chaos inside the castle)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which theme does the dropping of the boughs most directly develop?

    A. Love and loyalty between husband and wife

    B. Sleep and guilt

    C. Appearance and reality

    D. Nature and weather

    Key: C (Appearance and reality)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how this scene completes the Birnam prophecy.

    Sample answer: The army has carried boughs from Birnam to hide its numbers and now waits outside the castle walls.

Throwing down the branches shows that the impossible prophecy has been fulfilled by a simple tactic. A strong answer argues how the scene turns a supernatural riddle into ordinary military reality, and what this says about the Witches' power.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the role of sound in this scene.
Sample answer: The scene opens with drums and colours and closes with Macduff's call for trumpets to speak with all their breath as heralds of blood and death. The sound effects mark the formal start of battle. A strong answer shows how sound builds excitement and contrasts with the cry of women and alarm bell in Macbeth's castle.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene's brevity contribute to the rhythm of Act V?
   A. Quick shifts mimic the chaos of battle
   B. It slows the play for a long reflection
   C. It gives time for costume changes
   D. It adds a subplot

   Key: A (Quick shifts mimic the chaos of battle)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Malcolm's division of command show about the alliance?
   A. England alone commands the whole army against Scotland
   B. English and Scots share the fight
   C. Macduff leads alone
   D. The thanes refuse to fight

   Key: B (English and Scots share the fight)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the scene reverse Macbeth's earlier use of concealment?
   A. The good side now hides its plans as Macbeth did
   B. Macbeth reveals all
   C. The good side now ends its disguise openly
   D. No one hides anything

   Key: C (The good side now ends its disguise openly)

34. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why might Shakespeare give Macduff the scene's last words?
   A. To show that Macduff has replaced Malcolm
   B. To end his role
   C. To provide comic relief
   D. To prepare for his personal confrontation

   Key: D (To prepare for his personal confrontation)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the rhyme in Siward's couplet emphasize?
   A. Fight and night, resolve and timing
   B. Love and loss, a father's grief
   C. Sleep and dreams
   D. Gold and power

   Key: A (Fight and night, resolve and timing)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How does the scene's tone compare with the 'To-morrow' speech before it?
    A. Equal despair on both sides of the castle walls
    B. Purposeful energy against empty despair
    C. Comic against tragic
    D. Calm against calm

    Key: B (Purposeful energy against empty despair)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate how this scene presents legitimate authority.
    Sample answer: Malcolm gives clear orders, honours his allies with titles and roles, and follows a shared plan. His soldiers obey willingly. A strong answer argues that the scene presents him as a rightful ruler whose authority rests on cooperation and order, in contrast to Macbeth's rule by fear.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate the significance of the soldiers revealing themselves.
    Sample answer: Throwing down the boughs ends the army's disguise just as Macbeth's own deceptions are collapsing. A strong answer argues how this moment fits the play's pattern of hidden truths being exposed, from the sleepwalking confession to the riddling prophecies, and how it prepares for the final unmasking of Macbeth's false security.

39. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the summary: in this scene the soldiers put down their branches and take up their _____.
    Key: weapons

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Malcolm's leadership here with Duncan's in Act I.
    Sample answer: Duncan relied on reports from others and trusted too easily. Malcolm has learned caution in England, plans the attack himself and divides command wisely. A strong answer argues how Malcolm combines Duncan's goodness with practical judgment, making him a fitting king to restore order.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 2, inference 8, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene VI develops the idea of the army reveals itself. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene VI” could deliver about the army reveals itself. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the army reveals itself in “Act V, Scene VI”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and

explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the army reveals itself. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene VI" could deliver about the army reveals itself. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the army reveals itself in "Act V, Scene VI": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene VI suggests about the army reveals itself. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene VI" could deliver about the army reveals itself. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the army reveals itself in "Act V, Scene VI": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses setting in Act V, Scene VI to complicate the reader's understanding of the army reveals itself. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene VI" could deliver about the army reveals itself. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the army reveals itself in "Act V, Scene VI": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Now near enough: your leavy screens throw down, And show like those you are. You, worthy uncle, Shall, with my cousin, your right-noble son, Lead our first battle: worthy Macduff and we Shall take upon's what else remains to do, According to our order. Fare you well. Do we but find the tyrant's power to-night, Let us be beaten, if we cannot fight. Make all our trumpets speak; give them all breath, Those clamorous harbingers of blood and death.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene VI"?

   A. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief

   B. The murder and its first guilt

   C. The last false confidence

   D. The army reveals itself

SAT key: 1. D (The army reveals itself)

Lesson 29: Act V, Scene VII

Focus: the last false confidence

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act V, Scene VII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (violence, death in combat): Young Siward is killed by Macbeth on stage.
Suggested language: “What does this language show about the speaker?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth, 'tied to a stake' like a baited bear, still fears no man born of woman. He kills Young Siward in single combat and scorns swords 'brandish'd by man that's of a woman born.' Macduff enters seeking only Macbeth, refusing to strike at hired kerns. Siward tells Malcolm the castle is 'gently render'd' and that some of the tyrant's men fight on their side.

Background: Bear-baiting (a bear chained to a stake and attacked by dogs) was a popular entertainment near the Globe; Macbeth's image makes him both fierce and trapped.

Significance: Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: false security.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: professes — declares; clatter — a loud rattling noise; hateful — deserving hatred; bruited — announced loudly; proclaimed; sheathe — to put (a sword) back in its case. “clatter”: Origin: Middle English clatren.
Words: professes: declares · clatter: a loud rattling noise · hateful: deserving hatred · bruited: announced loudly; proclaimed · sheathe: to put (a sword) back in its case

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Bear-baiting (a bear chained to a stake and attacked by dogs) was a popular entertainment near the Globe; Macbeth's image makes him both fierce and trapped. Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand. Characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable. Irony: His confidence in the prophecy. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Thou wast born of woman" slowly and put it in my own words: After killing Young Siward in single combat, Macbeth says the boy was born of woman. Next, craft. I notice he speaks as if the prophecy makes him invulnerable, mocking the dead young man. The strongest word is "woman": it recalls the witches' promise that no man born of a woman could harm him. Then, effect. Why is Macbeth so confident after killing Young Siward? My answer: Macbeth believes the prophecy protects him; his confidence is about to collapse when he meets Macduff, which shows how the witches' riddles have trapped him.

> *Thou wast born of woman* *(Act V, Scene VII, line 2289)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Thou wast born of woman" slowly and put it in my own words: After killing Young Siward in single combat, Macbeth says the boy was born of woman. Next, craft. I notice he speaks as if the prophecy makes him invulnerable, mocking the dead young man. The strongest word is "woman": it recalls the witches' promise that no man born of a woman could harm him. Then, effect. Why is Macbeth so confident after killing Young Siward? My answer: Macbeth believes the prophecy protects him; his confidence is about to collapse when he meets Macduff, which shows how the witches' riddles have trapped him.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: "Tied me to a stake" and "bear-like" stand out. Macbeth sees himself as a bear tied up for baiting, unable to escape and forced to fight the dogs.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected student answer: Macbeth feels trapped, yet he still holds to the prophecy about a man not born of woman, so the line shows him fighting on with a hope that rests only on his reading of fate.

> *They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course* *(Act V, Scene VII, lines 2274–2275)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: "Tied me to a stake" and "bear-like" stand out. Macbeth sees himself as a bear tied up for baiting, unable to escape and forced to fight the dogs.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected student answer: Macbeth feels trapped, yet he still holds to the prophecy about a man not born of woman, so the line shows him fighting on with a hope that rests only on his reading of fate.

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VII develops the idea of the last false confidence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. When the text says "Thou wast born of woman" (Act V, Scene VII, line 2289), it shows this directly. He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman."
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VII develops the idea of the last false confidence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. When the text says "Thou wast born of woman" (Act V, Scene VII, line 2289), it shows this directly. He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman."

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief? Ask: is Macbeth brave or deluded?
Anchor question: Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?
Facilitation: Ask: is Macbeth brave or deluded?

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. ("Thou wast born of woman", Act V, Scene VII, line 2289). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the last false confidence? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. ("Thou wast born of woman", Act V, Scene VII, line 2289). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the last false confidence. Key takeaway: false security.

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable.
- **Irony:** His confidence in the prophecy.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** false security.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.
- **equivocation:** "Fair is foul": watch for appearances and words that mean two things.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, lines 2274–2275) Bear-baiting image.
- “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2289) Macbeth's confidence.
- “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2293) Macduff seeks him.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped.
Evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2289)
Reasoning: He is "tied ... to a stake" like a bear but trusts that his enemies are "born of woman."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
professes (verb)	declares	*This way, my lord; the castle's gently render'd: The tyrant's people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do.*	
clatter (noun)	a loud rattling noise	*There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.*	“clatter”: Origin: Middle English clatren. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/clatter#Etymology)
hateful (adjective)	deserving hatred	*The devil himself could not pronounce a title More hateful to mine ear.*	

bruited (verb)	announced loudly; proclaimed	*There thou shouldst be; By this great clatter, one of greatest note Seems bruited.*	
sheathe (verb)	to put (a sword) back in its case	*I cannot strike at wretched kerns, whose arms Are hired to bear their staves: either thou, Macbeth, Or else my sword with an unbatter'd edge I sheathe again undeeded.*	
bravely (adverb)	courageously	*This way, my lord; the castle's gently render'd: The tyrant's people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do.*	

Discussion questions

1. Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and conscience?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. What does Macduff say he cannot strike at? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Wretched kerns, whose arms are hired to bear their staves.
   Answer guidance: Wretched kerns, whose arms are hired to bear their staves.
2. What animal does Macbeth compare himself to? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A bear tied to a stake
   Answer guidance: A bear tied to a stake.
3. Whom does Macbeth kill in this scene? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Young Siward
   Answer guidance: Young Siward.
4. Why does Macbeth not fear Young Siward? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He was born of woman
   Answer guidance: He was born of woman.
5. Whom does Macduff want to fight? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Only Macbeth
   Answer guidance: Only Macbeth.
6. What has happened to the castle? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** It has been gently surrendered
   Answer guidance: It has been gently surrendered.

7. Retell the most important events of “Act V, Scene VII” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Macbeth, 'tied to a stake' like a baited bear, still fears no man born of woman. He kills Young Siward in single combat and scorns swords 'brandish'd by man that's of a woman born.' Macduff enters seeking only Macbeth, refusing to strike at hired kerns. Siward tells Malcolm the castle is 'gently render'd' and that some of the tyrant's men fight on their side.
   Answer guidance: Macbeth, 'tied to a stake' like a baited bear, still fears no man born of woman. He kills Young Siward in single combat and scorns swords 'brandish'd by man that's of a woman born.' Macduff enters seeking only Macbeth, refusing to strike at hired kerns. Siward tells Malcolm the castle is 'gently render'd' and that some of the tyrant's men fight on their side.
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene VII”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is “Act V, Scene VII” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “This way, my lord; the castle’s gently render’d: The tyrant’s people on both sides do fight; The noble thanes do bravely in the war; The day almost itself professes yours, And little is to do.” What does “professes” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** professes: declares.
    Answer guidance: professes: declares.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Macduff refuse to fight anyone but Macbeth? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** His quarrel is personal and just; he seeks justice, not slaughter.
   Answer guidance: His quarrel is personal and just; he seeks justice, not slaughter.
2. What does “Act V, Scene VII” suggest about the last false confidence? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand.
   Answer guidance: Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand. Evidence to accept: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, lines 2274–2275): Bear-baiting image. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of irony in “Act V, Scene VII”. What does it reveal about the last false confidence that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true. Evidence to accept: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2289): Macbeth's confidence. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the characterization in “Act V, Scene VII” shape what we understand about the last false confidence? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, lines 2274–2275): Bear-baiting image. On characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “They have tied me…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2293): Macduff seeks him. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene VII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Macbeth kills Young Siward and still trusts the prophecy; evidence: “Thou wast born of woman.”
   Answer guidance: Look for: Macbeth kills Young Siward and still trusts the prophecy; evidence: “Thou wast born of woman.”. Evidence to accept: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, lines 2274–2275): Bear-baiting image. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Act V, Scene VII” build on “Act V, Scene VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2289): Macbeth's confidence. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Act V, Scene VII”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the last false confidence, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2293): Macduff seeks him. On characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Is courage still admirable when it comes from a false belief?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.
   Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2289): Macbeth's confidence. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does plot appear in “Act V, Scene VII”, and how does it connect the last false confidence to the larger concern with guilt and conscience? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** key events and the causes linking them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, lines 2274–2275): Bear-baiting image. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does Macbeth's fighting spirit at the end restore any of the admiration we felt for him in Act I? Explain. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment about the tragic hero.
    Answer guidance: A judgment about the tragic hero.
2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): Macbeth's courage returns, but it rests on a misunderstood prophecy. Young Siward's death shows the human cost of the tyrant's last stand. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2293): Macduff seeks him. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in “Act V, Scene VII” acts most wisely in the matter of the last false confidence, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, lines 2274–2275): Bear-baiting image. On characterization: Macbeth kills Young Siward and believes himself invulnerable. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Act V, Scene VII”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the last false confidence. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2289): Macbeth's confidence. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write your own questions about “Act V, Scene VII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-

if levels.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2293): Macduff seeks him. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act V, Scene VII”, with its focus on the last false confidence, to appearance versus reality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, lines 2274–2275): Bear-baiting image. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in “Act V, Scene VII” effective in presenting the last false confidence, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2289): Macbeth's confidence. On irony: His confidence in the prophecy. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene VII” treats the last false confidence with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “Tyrant, show thy face” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2293): Macduff seeks him. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Act V, Scene VIII” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he is trapped. Useful evidence: “They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, / But, bear-like, I must fight the course” (Act V, Scene VII, lines 2274–2275): Bear-baiting image. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of “Act V, Scene VII” (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the last false confidence? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Macbeth's false security leads him to fight on even as he

is trapped. Useful evidence: “Thou wast born of woman” (Act V, Scene VII, line 2289): Macbeth's confidence. Theme link: false security. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does this scene take place?

   A. Another part of the field

   B. Inside the queen's chamber

   C. Near the wood of Birnam

   D. Before the King's palace

   Key: A (Another part of the field)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the first question the young soldier asks?

   A. His age

   B. His name

   C. His rank

   D. His home

   Key: B (His name)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macbeth say Young Siward will feel on hearing his name?

   A. Proud of it

   B. Angry

   C. Afraid

   D. Glad

   Key: C (Afraid)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What insult does Siward's son use before the duel?

   A. Noble king of Scots

   B. Worthy thane

   C. Old soldier

   D. Abhorred tyrant

   Key: D (Abhorred tyrant)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Macduff's line: “That way the noise is. Tyrant, show thy _____!”

   Key: face

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff say will haunt him if someone else kills Macbeth?

   A. His wife and children's ghosts

   B. The spirit of King Duncan in the night

   C. The memory of his castle

   D. The voices of the Witches

   Key: A (His wife and children's ghosts)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff ask fortune to grant him?

   A. A safe return home

   B. To find the tyrant

   C. A quick victory

   D. A new sword

   Key: B (To find the tyrant)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Siward say the noble thanes are doing?

   A. Running away

   B. Hiding in the castle

   C. Fighting bravely

   D. Joining Macbeth

   Key: C (Fighting bravely)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What happens in the duel between the tyrant and Siward's son?

   Sample answer: Young Siward asks Macbeth's name and, on hearing it, says the devil could not speak a more hateful title. He calls Macbeth a liar and an abhorred tyrant and fights him to prove it. The tyrant kills him and boasts that he laughs at every weapon held by mortal men.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How is the battle going for Malcolm's side by the end of the scene?

    Sample answer: Siward reports that the castle has been handed over with little resistance, that Macbeth's own men fight on both sides and that the thanes fight bravely. The day almost declares itself theirs, and little remains to be done. Malcolm adds that some enemies deliberately miss them, and they enter the castle.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth mean by “I cannot fly”?

    A. He cannot escape the fight

    B. He has lost his horse

    C. He cannot leave his wife

    D. He will not betray his men

    Key: A (He cannot escape the fight)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Young Siward mean by “a hotter name Than any is in hell”?

    A. A name spoken in anger by the dying

    B. A title more wicked than any devil's

    C. A name that burns like fire

D. A name from a foreign land

Key: B (A title more wicked than any devil's)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Macbeth smile at swords after the fight?

A. He has won the war already

B. He thinks the battle is a game

C. He still trusts the prophecy

D. He wants to surrender

Key: C (He still trusts the prophecy)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macduff mean by "my sword with an unbatter'd edge I sheathe again undeeded"?

A. His sword is too blunt and battered to use in the fight

B. He has lost his sword

C. He will give up fighting

D. He will not use his sword on anyone but Macbeth

Key: D (He will not use his sword on anyone but Macbeth)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Macduff's line: "Let me find him, _____! And more I beg not"

Key: fortune

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macduff track Macbeth on the field?

A. By following the loudest noise

B. By asking the soldiers he meets on the field

C. By looking for his banner

D. By following his horse

Key: A (By following the loudest noise)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Siward mean by "The tyrant's people on both sides do fight"?

A. Macbeth's army is far larger than the English one

B. Some of Macbeth's men have switched sides

C. The English are fighting each other

D. Each army is tired out

Key: B (Some of Macbeth's men have switched sides)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Malcolm mean by "foes That strike beside us"?

A. Enemies who stand right next to them in line

B. Allies who hit them by mistake

C. Enemies who deliberately miss them

D. Foes hiding in the woods

Key: C (Enemies who deliberately miss them)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macbeth's confidence change after he kills Young Siward?

Sample answer: Before the fight he feels trapped and says he must fight on. Killing the young soldier restores his belief that no man born of a woman can harm him, so he smiles at swords and scorns weapons. His renewed confidence is dangerous because it rests on a prophecy that may not mean what he thinks.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does Young Siward's death matter in the scene?
Sample answer: He is brave and young, refuses to fear Macbeth's name and dies fighting him. His death shows Macbeth's skill as a soldier and the human cost of the war. It also feeds Macbeth's false confidence and makes the audience fear for anyone who faces him before Macduff does.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Macbeth's comparison of himself to a baited animal suggest?
A. He is trapped but will fight to the end
B. He enjoys the sport of battle as a pastime
C. He is a hunter seeking prey
D. He wishes to be set free
Key: A (He is trapped but will fight to the end)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic in Macbeth's reply "No, nor more fearful"?
A. He admits he is afraid of the young soldier facing him
B. He boasts of being feared while he himself is doomed
C. He praises Young Siward's courage
D. He confesses his crimes
Key: B (He boasts of being feared while he himself is doomed)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macduff's speech differ from Macbeth's?
A. He boasts of his own great skill with a sword
B. He fears death in battle
C. He seeks justice; his foe trusts a riddle
D. He trusts the prophecy
Key: C (He seeks justice; his foe trusts a riddle)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does Shakespeare show Young Siward's death on stage?
A. To provide comic relief in the middle of the battle
B. To end the battle
C. To show Macbeth's mercy
D. To show Macbeth's skill and raise the stakes
Key: D (To show Macbeth's skill and raise the stakes)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Siward's line: "The day almost itself professes _____"
Key: yours

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the castle's easy surrender suggest about Macbeth's support?
A. His people no longer want to defend him
B. His castle was poorly built and its walls were weak
C. His army is waiting in ambush
D. His men are loyal to the end

Key: A (His people no longer want to defend him)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the scene's structure of entrances and exits create effect?

    A. It slows the action down

    B. It shows a battle spread across the field

    C. It confuses the audience about the plot

    D. It shows a feast in the hall

    Key: B (It shows a battle spread across the field)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macduff's desire to kill Macbeth personally reveal?

    A. He wants the crown for himself

    B. He fears the other soldiers

    C. His revenge is personal and focused

    D. He wants glory in battle

    Key: C (His revenge is personal and focused)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze how this scene shows Macbeth's reliance on the prophecy.

    Sample answer: Macbeth says he must fear only a man not born of a woman. After killing Young Siward, he declares that he laughs at any weapon held by such a man. A strong answer shows how the prophecy has become his last support, so that his courage now depends entirely on the riddle the audience suspects will betray him.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze Macduff's speech as he searches for Macbeth.

    Sample answer: Macduff calls on the tyrant to show his face, says the ghosts of his wife and children will haunt him unless he strikes the blow, and refuses to fight hired soldiers. He follows the noise and begs fortune only to let him find Macbeth. A strong answer shows how his speech makes the coming duel a personal act of justice.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Young Siward's courage function within the play's ideas of manhood?

    A. It offers an honourable model of youthful bravery

    B. It mocks the idea of courage

    C. It shows youth is foolish

    D. It proves Macbeth is noble

    Key: A (It offers an honourable model of youthful bravery)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the alternation between Macbeth and his enemies suggest about the battle?

    A. It will end without a duel

    B. It moves toward a single destined meeting

    C. It is a series of unrelated fights

    D. It favours Macbeth

    Key: B (It moves toward a single destined meeting)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Malcolm's 'foes That strike beside us' fit the play's themes?

    A. Enemies tell the truth in war

B. Battle is mostly a matter of luck and chance

C. Loyalty cannot be forced by a tyrant

D. The English are cowards

Key: C (Loyalty cannot be forced by a tyrant)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Siward's line: “This way, my lord; the castle’s gently _____”

Key: render’d

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does Macbeth's 'I cannot fly' echo from his despair in the previous scene?

A. His wish to see the Witches once more before he dies

B. His wish for a long sleep

C. His hope for a son

D. His sense that there is nor flying nor staying

Key: D (His sense that there is nor flying nor staying)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why might Shakespeare give Young Siward the line comparing Macbeth's name to the devil's?

A. To show how the world now sees Macbeth

B. To show Young Siward is a priest

C. To mock the Porter

D. To recall Hecate's speech

Key: A (To show how the world now sees Macbeth)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Macbeth shows courage or delusion in this scene.

Sample answer: Macbeth fights bravely, kills a young soldier and refuses to flee. Yet his confidence rests on a prophecy, and he scorns weapons because he believes no man born of woman can harm him. A strong answer weighs his soldierly courage against his dependence on the Witches and argues which better describes him.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate how this scene prepares for the final confrontation.

Sample answer: Macbeth's confidence is restored by killing Young Siward, while Macduff searches only for him, refusing other fights. The castle has fallen and the battle is nearly won. A strong answer argues how these threads bring the two men toward a duel that will test the last prophecy.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Young Siward's refusal to fear Macbeth's name suggest?

A. Young Siward does not know who Macbeth is

B. Macbeth's terror no longer silences the young

C. Young Siward is a coward

D. Macbeth is not feared

Key: B (Macbeth's terror no longer silences the young)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Compare Macbeth here with the soldier praised in Act I.

Sample answer: In Act I Macbeth was praised as brave Macbeth who carved his way through rebels for Duncan. Here he still

fights skilfully, but as a hated tyrant defending a stolen crown. A strong answer argues how the same courage now serves evil, and what the comparison suggests about how far he has fallen.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 9, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene VII develops the idea of the last false confidence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene VII” could deliver about the last false confidence. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the last false confidence in “Act V, Scene VII”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the last false confidence. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene VII” could deliver about the last false confidence. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the last false confidence in “Act V, Scene VII”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene VII suggests about the last false confidence. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene VII" could deliver about the last false confidence. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the last false confidence in "Act V, Scene VII": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act V, Scene VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the last false confidence. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene VII" could deliver about the last false confidence. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the last false confidence in "Act V, Scene VII": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *They have tied me to a stake; I cannot fly, But, bear-like, I must fight the course. What's he That was not born of woman? Such a one Am I to fear, or none. Enter Young Siward. What is thy name? Thou'lt be afraid to hear it. No; though thou call'st thyself a hotter name Than any is in hell. My name's Macbeth. The devil himself could not pronounce a title More hateful to mine ear. No, nor more fearful. Thou liest, abhorred tyrant; with my sword I'll prove the lie thou speak'st. They fight and Young Siward is slain. Thou wast born of woman But swords I smile at, weapons laugh to scorn, Brandish'd by man that's of a woman born.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene VII"?

   A. The cast and world of the play
   B. The murder and its first guilt
   C. The last false confidence
   D. The guilt that will not wash away

SAT key: 1. C (The last false confidence)

Lesson 30: Act V, Scene VIII

Focus: the tyrant's end and a new order

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “Act V, Scene VIII” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide (reported), severed head, combat death): Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool'; near the end of the scene Malcolm reports the queen's death; Macduff enters with Macbeth's head. Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently. Discuss the verdict on the Macbeths, not the methods.
Suggested language: “Is Malcolm's description of the Macbeths fair? What does it leave out?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool' and die on his own sword. Macduff finds him; Macbeth says he bears a charmed life, but Macduff reveals he was 'from his mother's womb untimely ripp'd.' Macbeth curses the 'juggling fiends' and refuses to yield; they fight. Siward learns his son died with his wounds on the front and accepts it. Macduff enters with Macbeth's head and hails Malcolm as king. Malcolm makes the thanes earls, speaks of 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen,' who is thought to have taken her own life 'by self and violent hands,' and invites all to see him crowned at Scone.

Background: Caesarean birth was rare and almost always fatal to the mother; Macduff's birth makes him 'not of woman born' in the narrow sense Macbeth never considered.

Significance: The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to fate and free will because....
Prompt: Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to fate and free will because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the equivocal prophecy completed.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: cheaply — at small cost; monsters — freaks shown for money; compass — to surround; juggling — cheating; tricking; usurper — one who seizes a throne without right. “compass”: Origin: Old French compas. “usurper”: Origin: Middle French usurpeur.
Words: cheaply: at small cost · monsters: freaks shown for money · compass: to surround · juggling: cheating; tricking · usurper: one who seizes a throne without right

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Caesarean birth was rare and almost always fatal to the mother; Macduff's birth makes him 'not of woman born' in the narrow sense Macbeth never considered. The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience. Characterization: Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king. Structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Watch for the prophecies: The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” slowly and put it in my own words: Macduff tells Macbeth that he was untimely ripped from his mother's womb, not born in the usual way. Next, craft. I notice the dramatic revelation, which turns the prophecy's wording against Macbeth. The strongest word is “Untimely”: it means too early and by force, a surgical birth. Then, effect. What does Macduff reveal, and what does it do to Macbeth? My answer: The witches' equivocation is exposed; Macbeth's last confidence is broken, though he still chooses to fight, and Macduff kills him and restores order.

> *Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d* (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2333–2334)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” slowly and put it in my own words: Macduff tells Macbeth that he was untimely ripped from his mother's womb, not born in the usual way. Next, craft. I notice the dramatic revelation, which turns the prophecy's wording against Macbeth. The strongest word is “Untimely”: it means too early and by force, a surgical birth. Then, effect. What does Macduff reveal, and what does it do to Macbeth? My answer: The witches' equivocation is exposed; Macbeth's last confidence is broken, though he still chooses to fight, and Macduff kills him and restores order.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected student answer: “Lay on”, “damn'd” and “Hold, enough” stand out. Macbeth curses whoever stops first, so he chooses to fight to the end rather than yield. Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will? Expected student answer: The prophecy has failed him, yet Macbeth refuses to surrender, so the line shows him choosing his own end in combat even after fate has turned against him.

> *Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough* (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected student answer: “Lay on”, “damn'd” and “Hold, enough” stand out. Macbeth curses whoever stops first, so he chooses to fight to the end rather than yield.
Ask: How does this line connect to fate and free will?
Expected student answer: The prophecy has failed him, yet Macbeth refuses to surrender, so the line shows him choosing his own end in combat even after fate has turned against him.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VIII develops the idea of the tyrant's end and a new order. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. When the text says “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353), it shows this directly. Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.
Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, structure (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Act V, Scene VIII develops the idea of the tyrant's end and a new order. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. When the text says “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353), it shows this directly. Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out? Ask: is "dead butcher" a fair verdict?
Anchor question: Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?
Facilitation: Ask: is "dead butcher" a fair verdict?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. ("Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, "Hold, enough", Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. ("Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, "Hold, enough", Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the tyrant's end and a new order. Key takeaway: the equivocal prophecy completed.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king.
- **Structure:** Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed.

Themes and how they develop

- **fate and free will:** the equivocal prophecy completed.

Symbols and motifs

- **the prophecies:** The Witches' riddling prophecies: notice how each promise shapes what Macbeth hopes, fears and does next.
- **kingship and order:** Rightful kingship is tied to natural order; watch how disorder in the state shows up in nature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Macduff was from his mother's womb / Untimely ripp'd" (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2333–2334) Caesarean birth.
- "Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, "Hold, enough" (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353) Macbeth's last defiance.
- "this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen" (Act V, Scene VIII, line 2396) Malcolm's verdict.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth.
Evidence: "Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, "Hold, enough" (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353)
Reasoning: Malcolm calls him "this dead butcher," but his last words, "Lay on, Macduff," show courage.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
cheaply (adverb)	at small cost	*Some must go off: and yet, by these I see, So great a day as this is cheaply bought.*	
monsters (noun)	freaks shown for money	*Then yield thee, coward, And live to be the show and gaze o' the time: We'll have thee, as our rarer monsters are, Painted on a pole, and underwrit, "Here may you see the tyrant."*	
compass (verb)	to surround	*Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper's cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!*	"compass": Origin: Old French compas. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/compass#Etymology)
juggling (adjective)	cheating; tricking	*And be these juggling fiends no more believed, That palter with us in a double sense; That keep the word of promise to our ear, And break it to our hope.*	
usurper (noun)	one who seizes a throne without right	*Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper's cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!*	"usurper": Origin: Middle French usurpeur. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/usurper#Etymology)
salutation (noun)	a greeting	*Hail, king! for so thou art: behold, where stands The usurper's cursed head: the time is free: I see thee compass'd with thy kingdom's pearl, That speak my salutation in their minds; Whose voices I desire aloud with mine: Hail, King of Scotland!*	"salutation": Origin: Old French salutacion; earlier Latin salutatio ("a greeting"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/salutation#Etymology)
prowess (noun)	bravery and skill in battle	*Your son, my lord, has paid a soldier's debt: He only lived but till he was a man; The which no sooner had his prowess confirm'd*	

		In the unshrinking station where he fought, But like a man he died.	
charmed (adjective)	protected by magic	*Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must not yield To one of woman born.*	"charmed": Origin of "charm": Old French charme ("chant"); earlier Latin carmen ("song"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/charm#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?
2. Where does irony appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with appearance versus reality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30

Literal / recall

1. How does Siward react when told his son's wounds were on the front? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He accepts it: his son died as a soldier should; he would not wish him a fairer death.
   Answer guidance: He accepts it: his son died as a soldier should; he would not wish him a fairer death.
2. Why does Macbeth refuse to "play the Roman fool"? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He would rather fight on against his enemies
   Answer guidance: He would rather fight on against his enemies.
3. What does Macduff reveal about his birth? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** He was untimely ripped from his mother's womb
   Answer guidance: He was untimely ripped from his mother's womb.
4. What does Macduff bring on stage? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Macbeth's head
   Answer guidance: Macbeth's head.
5. What new title does Malcolm give the thanes? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Earls
   Answer guidance: Earls.
6. Where will Malcolm be crowned? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** At Scone
   Answer guidance: At Scone.

7. Retell the most important events of “Act V, Scene VIII” in order, one sentence for each event. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool' and die on his own sword. Macduff finds him; Macbeth says he bears a charmed life, but Macduff reveals he was 'from his mother's womb untimely ripp'd.' Macbeth curses the 'juggling fiends' and refuses to yield; they fight. Siward learns his son died with his wounds on the front and accepts it. Macduff enters with Macbeth's head and hails Malcolm as king.…
   Answer guidance: Macbeth refuses to 'play the Roman fool' and die on his own sword. Macduff finds him; Macbeth says he bears a charmed life, but Macduff reveals he was 'from his mother's womb untimely ripp'd.' Macbeth curses the 'juggling fiends' and refuses to yield; they fight. Siward learns his son died with his wounds on the front and accepts it. Macduff enters with Macbeth's head and hails Malcolm as king.…
8. Who is on stage in “Act V, Scene VIII”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
   Answer guidance: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when is “Act V, Scene VIII” set? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
   Answer guidance: A setting detail (where or when) quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Some must go off: and yet, by these I see, So great a day as this is cheaply bought.” What does “cheaply” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] **Look for:** cheaply: at small cost.
    Answer guidance: cheaply: at small cost.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does Macbeth finally understand when he calls the Witches 'juggling fiends… that palter with us in a double sense'? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** The prophecies deceived through double meanings.
   Answer guidance: The prophecies deceived through double meanings.
2. What does “Act V, Scene VIII” suggest about the tyrant's end and a new order? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience.
   Answer guidance: The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience. Evidence to accept: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2333–2334): Caesarean birth. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
3. Find one example of irony in “Act V, Scene VIII”. What does it reveal about the tyrant's end and a new order that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true. Evidence to

accept: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353): Macbeth's last defiance. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

4. How does the structure in “Act V, Scene VIII” shape what we understand about the tyrant's end and a new order? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2333–2334): Caesarean birth. On structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that opens with “Why should I play…”, why might Shakespeare have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] **Look for:** Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
   Answer guidance: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage. Evidence to accept: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, line 2396): Malcolm's verdict. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
6. What causes the main turn in “Act V, Scene VIII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** Macduff's revelation about his birth, which breaks Macbeth's last hope; evidence: “Macduff was from his mother's womb Untimely ripp'd.”
   Answer guidance: Look for: Macduff's revelation about his birth, which breaks Macbeth's last hope; evidence: “Macduff was from his mother's womb Untimely ripp'd.”. Evidence to accept: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2333–2334): Caesarean birth. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.
7. How does “Act V, Scene VIII” build on “Act V, Scene VII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353): Macbeth's last defiance. On structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. In “Act V, Scene VIII”, what can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage about the tyrant's end and a new order, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, line 2396): Malcolm's verdict. On characterization: Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Go back to the bell-ringer question (Is 'this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen' a fair summary of the Macbeths? What does it leave out?). Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first

answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A revised answer anchored in the text.

Answer guidance: A revised answer anchored in the text. Evidence to accept: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353): Macbeth's last defiance. Credit any reading that quotes the text and explains it.

10. Where does theme appear in “Act V, Scene VIII”, and how does it connect the tyrant's end and a new order to the larger concern with appearance versus reality? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2333–2334): Caesarean birth. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Malcolm's final speech an ending we should trust? Consider what he leaves out about Macbeth and Lady Macbeth. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment on the ending's perspective.

    Answer guidance: A judgment on the ending's perspective.

2. Consider this reading of the scene (a claim, not a line from the text): The last equivocation is revealed, order is restored and a new king's language names the couple simply. Whether Malcolm's verdict is the whole truth is a question the play leaves to its audience. How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, line 2396): Malcolm's verdict. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in “Act V, Scene VIII” acts most wisely in the matter of the tyrant's end and a new order, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] **Look for:** An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2333–2334): Caesarean birth. On characterization: Macduff reveals he was "untimely ripped"; Macbeth fights on; Malcolm becomes king. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Act V, Scene VIII”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the tyrant's end and a new order. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353): Macbeth's last defiance. On structure: Order restored; Macbeth's head displayed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write your own questions about “Act V, Scene VIII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** Student-generated questions at the recall, why/how and should/what-if levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, line 2396): Malcolm's verdict. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect “Act V, Scene VIII”, with its focus on the tyrant's end and a new order, to masculinity, power and violence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shakespeare need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2333–2334): Caesarean birth. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in “Act V, Scene VIII” effective in presenting the tyrant's end and a new order, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] **Look for:** An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Lay on, Macduff, / And damn’d be him that first cries, “Hold, enough” (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353): Macbeth's last defiance. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Act V, Scene VIII” treats the tyrant's end and a new order with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Macbeth see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen” (Act V, Scene VIII, line 2396): Malcolm's verdict. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve appearance versus reality? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] **Look for:** A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: “Macduff was from his mother’s womb / Untimely ripp’d” (Act V, Scene VIII,

lines 2333–2334): Caesarean birth. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of "Act V, Scene VIII" (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the tyrant's end and a new order? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] **Look for:** A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending restores order but leaves a complex view of Macbeth. Useful evidence: "Lay on, Macduff, / And damn'd be him that first cries, "Hold, enough" (Act V, Scene VIII, lines 2352–2353): Macbeth's last defiance. Theme link: the equivocal prophecy completed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff call Macbeth when he finds him?
    A. Hell-hound
    B. Coward king
    C. Old wolf
    D. False thane

    Key: A (Hell-hound)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Macbeth say he has avoided Macduff?
    A. He fears Macduff more than any other man
    B. His soul is already charged with Macduff's family's blood
    C. He thinks Macduff is too weak and unworthy of a duel with him
    D. He wants to face Malcolm first

    Key: B (His soul is already charged with Macduff's family's blood)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff say he has no need of when he faces Macbeth?
    A. Armour
    B. Allies
    C. Words
    D. Prayers

    Key: C (Words)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete Macbeth's line: "Lay on, Macduff, And damn'd be him that first cries, Hold, _____!"
    Key: enough

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff threaten to make of Macbeth if he yields?

   A. A prisoner in an English tower

   B. A servant in Malcolm's court

   C. A beggar in the streets of Fife

   D. A show for people to gaze at

   Key: D (A show for people to gaze at)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whose feet does Macbeth refuse to kiss the ground before?

   A. Young Malcolm's

   B. Old Siward's and his men's

   C. King Edward's

   D. Lennox's men

   Key: A (Young Malcolm's)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who tells Siward that his son has died?

   A. Malcolm

   B. Ross

   C. Macduff

   D. Lennox

   Key: B (Ross)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Macduff cry out to Malcolm as he returns?

   A. The day is ours!

   B. God save Scotland!

   C. Hail, king!

   D. The tyrant flees!

   Key: C (Hail, king!)

9. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does Macbeth behave once he learns the truth about Macduff?

   Sample answer: At first he curses the tongue that told him, says it has cowed his better part of man and refuses to fight. When Macduff calls him a coward and threatens to put him on public display, Macbeth refuses to yield or bow to Malcolm. He throws his shield before him and fights on, though he knows he will lose.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Malcolm promise at the end of the play?

    Sample answer: Malcolm promises to reward his supporters soon, gives the thanes a new and higher title, and says he will call home exiles who fled tyranny and bring to justice the cruel servants of the dead butcher and his fiend-like queen. He promises to do all that is needed, by the grace of God, in proper measure, time and place.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth mean by "the gashes Do better upon them"?

    A. He would rather wound enemies than himself

    B. His own wounds would look better on the bodies of others

    C. He wants his soldiers to heal

    D. He fears his own wounds

    Key: A (He would rather wound enemies than himself)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Macbeth mean by "As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress"?

    A. The air of the field is far too cold for any swordplay

    B. Wounding him is as impossible as cutting air

    C. Macduff's sword is too dull to cut

    D. The wind will blow the sword aside

    Key: B (Wounding him is as impossible as cutting air)

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth mean by "it hath cow'd my better part of man"?

    A. The news has made him braver than he was

    B. His body is badly wounded

    C. The news has broken his courage

    D. He feels like a boy again

    Key: C (The news has broken his courage)

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Macbeth refuse to yield?

    A. He believes he can still win the battle

    B. He has been promised help from the Witches again tonight

    C. He does not understand the danger

    D. He will not be humiliated before Malcolm and the crowd

    Key: D (He will not be humiliated before Malcolm and the crowd)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Siward's line: "Had I as many sons as I have _____, I would not wish them to a fairer death"

    Key: hairs

16. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Malcolm say about Siward's son that Siward disagrees with?

    A. That he is worth more sorrow

    B. That he died like a coward

    C. That he should be buried at Scone

    D. That he fought for the wrong side

    Key: A (That he is worth more sorrow)

17. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What does Ross mean by "Your son, my lord, has paid a soldier's debt"?

    A. He owes money to the army

    B. He has died in battle

    C. He has been paid his wages

    D. He has been taken prisoner

    Key: B (He has died in battle)

18. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does Macduff mean by "the time is free"?

    A. The day's battle is over early

    B. There is no cost to the war

C. Scotland is freed from tyranny

D. Time has stopped for the dead

Key: C (Scotland is freed from tyranny)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Ross say about how young Siward lived and died?

Sample answer: Ross reports that the young man lived only until he became a man; as soon as his prowess was proved in the place where he fought without flinching, he died like a man. Ross adds that the grief should not be measured by his worth, or it would have no end. The report praises courage proved in a single battle.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Malcolm describe Macbeth and Lady Macbeth at the end?

Sample answer: He calls them this dead butcher and his fiend-like queen. The names are simple and harsh, showing how Scotland will remember them. They reduce two complex characters to the crimes they committed. The audience, who has watched Macbeth's doubts and Lady Macbeth's guilt, knows these labels leave out the struggle inside each of them.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth's refusal to die on his own sword reveal?

A. He chooses to die fighting as a soldier

B. He is afraid to die at all

C. He plans to escape to England

D. He hopes Malcolm will spare his life tonight

Key: A (He chooses to die fighting as a soldier)

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] What is ironic about Macbeth's claim of a 'charmed life'?

A. He has truly been made immortal by the spirits

B. The charm rests on a riddle about to fail him

C. Macduff believes the charm

D. The Witches appear to protect him

Key: B (The charm rests on a riddle about to fail him)

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “keep the word of promise to our ear, And break it to our hope” mean?

A. The Witches lied outright about everything

B. Macbeth misheard the prophecies

C. The words were literally true but misleading

D. The promises were kept fully

Key: C (The words were literally true but misleading)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Macbeth's final decision to fight affect the audience's view of him?

A. It makes him seem more cowardly

B. It shows he has repented

C. It shows he trusts the Witches still, even now

D. It restores a trace of his earlier courage

Key: D (It restores a trace of his earlier courage)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Malcolm's line: “We will perform in measure, time and _____”

    Key: place

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does Siward's response to his son's death define honourable manhood?

    A. Dying bravely facing the enemy

    B. Avoiding battle at all costs

    C. Weeping openly for the dead

    D. Seeking revenge for every death

    Key: A (Dying bravely facing the enemy)

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Why does Malcolm's closing speech use rhyming couplets?

    A. To mock the rhythm of Macbeth's earlier speeches

    B. To give a sense of order restored

    C. To show he is a poet

    D. To make the speech longer

    Key: B (To give a sense of order restored)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does “by the grace of Grace” suggest about Malcolm's rule?

    A. It will be harsh and strict

    B. It will depend on the Witches

    C. It will be guided by God's grace

    D. It will copy Macbeth's reign

    Key: C (It will be guided by God's grace)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze Macbeth's final moments as a tragic hero.

    Sample answer: Macbeth learns the last prophecy has betrayed him and at first refuses to fight, but when threatened with public shame he chooses to fight to the death. A strong answer argues whether this choice restores some of the brave soldier of Act I, or simply shows pride, and how it shapes the audience's final judgment of him.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Analyze how the ending restores order.

    Sample answer: Macduff hails Malcolm as king, the thanes join the cry, and Malcolm rewards them, promises to recall exiles and to punish the tyrant's agents, and invites all to his crowning. A strong answer shows how the formal ceremony, the rhyming couplets and the language of grace mark the return of rightful rule after Macbeth's disorder.

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] How does the final duel resolve the theme of equivocation?

    A. The last riddle is explained, ending false security

    B. The Witches appear to explain their meaning

    C. Macbeth is proved right about the prophecy after all

    D. The riddle is left unexplained

    Key: A (The last riddle is explained, ending false security)

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What does the display of the 'usurper's cursed head' recall?

    A. Duncan's sleeping face

    B. Macbeth fixing Macdonwald's head on the battlements

C. The armed head apparition only

D. Banquo's ghost at the feast

Key: B (Macbeth fixing Macdonwald's head on the battlements)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Malcolm's reduction of the couple to 'butcher' and 'fiend-like queen' leave out?

A. Their crimes against Scotland and its people

B. Their role in Duncan's murder

C. The inner struggle the audience witnessed

D. Their long marriage

Key: C (The inner struggle the audience witnessed)

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete Siward's line: “They say he parted well, and paid his _____”

Key: score

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] How does the play's ending echo its beginning?

A. A storm and three Witches meeting again

B. A feast at Inverness

C. A letter to Lady Macbeth

D. A traitor's head and a new title for loyal men

Key: D (A traitor's head and a new title for loyal men)

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Macbeth choose instead of the Roman fool's end?

A. To fight on while he sees living foes

B. To flee the field and hide in the castle

C. To beg Macduff for mercy

D. To surrender his sword to Malcolm

Key: A (To fight on while he sees living foes)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate whether the ending fully restores order to Scotland.

Sample answer: Malcolm is hailed king, rewards loyal thanes and promises justice and grace. Yet the play has shown that fair appearances can hide foul truths, and Fleance's line remains in the background. A strong answer weighs the formal restoration against these lingering questions and argues how complete the new order feels.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Macduff's role as the play's agent of justice.

Sample answer: Macduff is the one man not of woman born, suffers the loss of his family, and kills Macbeth in single combat. A strong answer argues how his personal grief and public duty combine, and whether his revenge is presented as justice, as fate fulfilled, or as both.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What makes Siward's acceptance of his son's death striking?

A. It shows he did not love his son

B. It values honour above personal grief

C. It mocks Malcolm's sorrow

D. It blames Macduff for the death

Key: B (It values honour above personal grief)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the deaths of Macbeth and Young Siward.
    Sample answer: Young Siward died bravely with his wounds on the front and is honoured as God's soldier. Macbeth also dies fighting, but as a tyrant whose head is displayed. A strong answer compares how the play judges each death and argues what the contrast says about courage serving a good or an evil cause.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20	recall 1, inference 9, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 9, synthesis 0
AP	31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40	recall 1, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Act V, Scene VIII develops the idea of the tyrant's end and a new order. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and structure shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Sophomore (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene VIII” could deliver about the tyrant's end and a new order. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Sophomore (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the tyrant's end and a new order in “Act V, Scene VIII”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Act V, Scene VIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the tyrant's end and a new order. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Junior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in “Act V, Scene VIII” could deliver about the tyrant's end and a new order. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Junior (450 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the tyrant's end and a new order in “Act V, Scene VIII”: each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Act V, Scene VIII suggests about the tyrant's end and a new order. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence

for each (including the scene's irony and structure), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (350 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene VIII" could deliver about the tyrant's end and a new order. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

HS Senior (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the tyrant's end and a new order in "Act V, Scene VIII": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how William Shakespeare uses irony in Act V, Scene VIII to complicate the reader's understanding of the tyrant's end and a new order. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

AP (400 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a scene, letter or monologue that a minor character on stage in "Act V, Scene VIII" could deliver about the tyrant's end and a new order. Quote or echo at least two lines from the scene, then add a 150-word note explaining how your piece reads the original.

AP (500 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): In groups of three or four, build a one-page evidence map for the tyrant's end and a new order in "Act V, Scene VIII": each member takes one passage, quotes it, and explains it; together, write a shared claim connecting it to ambition and its costs and present it to the class in three minutes; each member signs the section they wrote.

SAT-style questions

1. *Why should I play the Roman fool, and die On mine own sword? whiles I see lives, the gashes Do better upon them. Enter Macduff. Turn, hell-hound, turn! Of all men else I have avoided thee: But get thee back; my soul is too much charged With blood of thine already. I have no words: My voice is in my sword: thou bloodier villain Than terms can give thee out! They fight. Thou losest labour: As easy mayst thou the intrenchant air With thy keen sword impress as make me bleed: Let fall thy blade on vulnerable crests; I bear a charmed life, which must not yield To one of woman born. Despair thy charm; And let the angel whom thou still hast served Tell thee, Macduff was from his mother's womb Untimely ripp'd.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Act V, Scene VIII"?

   A. The tyrant's end and a new order

   B. Testing loyalty and the cost of grief

   C. Lady Macbeth's resolve

   D. Macbeth's reputation as a warrior

SAT key: 1. A (The tyrant's end and a new order)

Unit test

Macbeth: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In the Dramatis Personae, which thanes are listed alongside Macduff?
   A. Lennox, Ross and Angus
   B. Cawdor, Glamis and Fife
   C. Seyton, Siward and Edward
   D. Norway, Sweno and Cumberland

   Key: A (Lennox, Ross and Angus)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act I, Scene I, which Witch names Macbeth?
   A. The First Witch
   B. The Third Witch
   C. The Second Witch
   D. All three together

   Key: B (The Third Witch)
3. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] In Act I, Scene I, what does the opening scene mainly create?
   A. A comic scene of village life
   B. A royal court celebrating victory
   C. A mood of mystery and menace
   D. A love scene between two nobles

   Key: C (A mood of mystery and menace)
4. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Explain the meaning of 'Fair is foul, and foul is fair.'
   Sample answer: The Witches mean that good and evil are mixed up, so what looks fair may be wicked and what looks foul may be good. The line warns the audience not to trust appearances. It comes at the end of a scene full of storm and fog, where nothing can be seen clearly.
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act I, Scene II, why does the Sergeant stop his report?
   A. He is called away
   B. The king dismisses him

C. He forgets the details

D. His wounds need help

Key: D (His wounds need help)

6. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How does the Sergeant describe Macbeth in battle?
Sample answer: He calls him brave Macbeth, who deserves that name, and describes his sword smoking with bloody execution as he carved his way to Macdonwald. Macbeth split the rebel open and fixed his head on the battlements. The report makes Macbeth sound fearless, loyal and deadly.

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act I, Scene III, which prophecy comes true almost at once?

A. Macbeth becomes thane of Cawdor

B. Macbeth becomes king

C. Banquo's children become kings

D. Banquo becomes the new thane of Glamis

Key: A (Macbeth becomes thane of Cawdor)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act I, Scene III, what does the First Witch say the sailor's wife was eating?

A. Apples

B. Chestnuts

C. Bread

D. Figs

Key: B (Chestnuts)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act I, Scene IV, how does Macbeth leave to prepare for the king's visit?

A. As a guard

B. As a messenger's servant

C. As his own harbinger

D. In disguise

Key: C (As his own harbinger)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does Macbeth reveal in his aside after Malcolm is named heir?
Sample answer: He says the title is a step on which he must fall down or else o'erleap, because it lies in his way. He asks the stars to hide their fires so no light sees his black and deep desires. The aside shows that his ambition now has a target.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act I, Scene V, what does Lady Macbeth say Duncan will not see?

A. His sons again

B. His own castle

C. Scone

D. Tomorrow's sun

Key: D (Tomorrow's sun)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Lady Macbeth worry about her husband's nature?

Sample answer: She says it is too full of the milk of human kindness to catch the nearest way. He wants greatness but wants to win it holily, without the illness that should attend ambition. She fears he will not act, so she plans to urge him on with the valour of her tongue.

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act I, Scene VI, who arrives at the castle with Duncan?

    A. Banquo, Malcolm and other lords

    B. The three Witches

    C. Macbeth and all of his servants

    D. Ross and the wounded Sergeant

    Key: A (Banquo, Malcolm and other lords)

14. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Why is Duncan's praise of the castle ironic?
    Sample answer: He says the castle has a pleasant seat and sweet air, and Banquo admires the nesting martlets. The audience knows Lady Macbeth has just called on spirits and thick night and planned the king's fate. The peaceful description hides real danger.

15. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act I, Scene VII, why has Macbeth left the supper?

    A. To meet the Witches on the heath

    B. To think alone about the deed

    C. To check on the sleeping guards

    D. To greet Banquo

    Key: B (To think alone about the deed)

16. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act I, Scene VII, what does Lady Macbeth call Macbeth?

    A. A loyal subject

    B. A king

    C. A coward

    D. A traitor

    Key: C (A coward)

17. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What plan does Lady Macbeth describe in Act I, Scene VII?
    Sample answer: She will make Duncan's two chamberlains drunk with wine and wassail. When they lie in swinish sleep, the king will be unguarded, and the officers, marked with blood, will be blamed. The Macbeths will then make their griefs and clamour roar so that no one suspects them.

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act II, Scene I, where is the king when the scene opens?

    A. Gone hunting

    B. At prayer

    C. At the feast

    D. Gone to bed

    Key: D (Gone to bed)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act II, Scene I, what does Banquo give Macbeth to pass to Lady Macbeth?

    A. A diamond for his wife

    B. A sealed letter

    C. A golden ring

D. A crown of gold from the king

Key: A (A diamond for his wife)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act II, Scene II, what has Macbeth brought from the chamber by mistake?

A. The grooms' cloaks

B. The daggers

C. Duncan's crown

D. A candle

Key: B (The daggers)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act II, Scene III, which bell does Macduff order to be rung?

A. The church bell

B. The dinner bell

C. The alarum-bell

D. The bell of the gate

Key: C (The alarum-bell)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act II, Scene IV, what is strange about the day?

A. It is snowing in the middle of summer

B. The sun shines at night

C. There is no wind

D. It is dark although it is day

Key: D (It is dark although it is day)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act II, Scene IV, what are Duncan's horses said to have done?

A. Eaten each other

B. Run to the sea

C. Stood still all night

D. Died of cold

Key: A (Eaten each other)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene I, how does Macbeth say the murderers count as men in the catalogue?

A. As kings count as lords

B. As hounds count as dogs

C. As boys count as soldiers

D. As thieves count as guests

Key: B (As hounds count as dogs)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene I, how many murderers does Macbeth speak with?

A. Three

B. One

C. Two

D. Four

Key: C (Two)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene II, whom does Lady Macbeth send a servant to fetch?

A. Banquo

B. The Doctor

C. Fleance

D. The king

Key: D (The king)

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene II, what does Macbeth call his wife?

A. Dearest chuck

B. My queen

C. Sweet lady of mine

D. Fair wife

Key: A (Dearest chuck)

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene III, what does the First Murderer say the west still glimmers with?

A. Bright moonlight

B. Some streaks of day

C. Distant firelight

D. Pale starlight

Key: B (Some streaks of day)

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene IV, what does Macbeth tell the guests to do at the start?

A. Leave

B. Drink

C. Sit down

D. Pray

Key: C (Sit down)

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene IV, what does Lady Macbeth tell the guests Macbeth has had since youth?

A. A fever

B. A wound

C. A dream

D. A fit

Key: D (A fit)

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene IV, how does Lady Macbeth end the feast?

A. She sends guests away

B. She calls for music

C. She arrests Ross

D. She leaves alone

Key: A (She sends guests away)

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene IV, whom does Macbeth say he will visit tomorrow?

A. Macduff

B. The weird sisters

C. The English king

D. Duncan's grave

Key: B (The weird sisters)

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene V, how many Witches meet Hecate?

A. Two

B. Four

C. Three

D. One

Key: C (Three)

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene VI, where has Macduff gone?

A. To Ireland

B. To Fife

C. To Norway

D. To the English court

Key: D (To the English court)

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene VI, how does the messenger react to Macduff?

A. He turns his back and hums

B. He laughs and dances

C. He bows low to Macduff

D. He weeps in the hall

Key: A (He turns his back and hums)

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act III, Scene VI, whom does Lennox say was blamed for Banquo's death?

A. The Porter

B. His son Fleance

C. Macduff

D. Malcolm

Key: B (His son Fleance)

37. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act IV, Scene I, whose blood cools the charm?

A. A goat's blood

B. A wolf's blood

C. A baboon's blood

D. A dog's blood

Key: C (A baboon's blood)

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act IV, Scene II, what does Lady Macduff say her husband lacks?

A. Money

B. Courage in battle

C. Friends at court

D. The natural touch

Key: D (The natural touch)

39. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act IV, Scene II, what does the son say liars and swearers are?

A. Fools, for they outnumber honest men

B. Brave men who rule the land

C. Kings in disguise among us

D. Wise men who keep quiet

Key: A (Fools, for they outnumber honest men)

40. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act IV, Scene III, who brings news from Scotland?

A. A Doctor

B. Ross

C. Siward

D. Lennox

Key: B (Ross)

41. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act IV, Scene III, what does Malcolm say Scotland sinks beneath?

A. A storm

B. A plague

C. The yoke

D. A curse

Key: C (The yoke)

42. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act V, Scene I, what does Lady Macbeth keep by her continually?

A. A letter

B. A book

C. A bell

D. A light

Key: D (A light)

43. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act V, Scene II, what does Lennox carry?

A. A list of the gentry

B. A letter from Malcolm

C. The king's banner

D. A map of Birnam

Key: A (A list of the gentry)

44. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act V, Scene III, complete Macbeth's line: “I will not be afraid of death and _____”

Key: bane

45. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act V, Scene III, what does Macbeth call for to put on?

A. His crown

B. His armour

C. His cloak

D. His ring

Key: B (His armour)

46. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act V, Scene IV, what is the mood among Malcolm's leaders?

A. Fearful and tense

B. Bitter

C. Hopeful

D. Gloomy

Key: C (Hopeful)

47. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act V, Scene V, what does Macbeth call the actor who struts and frets?

A. A brave knight

B. A wise fool

C. A king

D. A poor player

Key: D (A poor player)

48. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act V, Scene VI, what does the opening stage direction call for?

A. Drum and colours

B. Thunder and lightning

C. Bells and torches

D. Music and dancing

Key: A (Drum and colours)

49. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act V, Scene VII, what does Siward say about the day's battle?

A. It is lost

B. It is almost won

C. It is even

D. It has not begun

Key: B (It is almost won)

50. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] In Act V, Scene VIII, what does Ross say Young Siward lived only until?

    A. He was a king

    B. He was old

    C. He was a man

    D. He married

    Key: C (He was a man)

51. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In the Dramatis Personae, how are Macbeth and Banquo both described?

    A. Generals of the king's army

    B. Noblemen of England

    C. Sons of the old king

    D. Officers of the guard at Forres

    Key: A (Generals of the king's army)

52. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Act I, Scene I, how long is the scene compared with most in the play?

    A. One of the longest

    B. One of the shortest

    C. About average in length

    D. Longer than Act I, Scene II

    Key: B (One of the shortest)

53. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What idea does 'the battle's lost and won' express?

    A. Each army will lose all it has

    B. The fighting will go on for years

    C. One side's loss is another side's win

    D. Macbeth has already lost the battle

    Key: C (One side's loss is another side's win)

54. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] How do the Witches' speech patterns set them apart from other characters?

    Sample answer: They speak in short, rhyming lines with a strong beat, almost like a chant or spell, such as When shall we three meet again. This is different from the longer lines of human characters. The sound marks them as strange and supernatural, and makes their words feel like magic.

55. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act I, Scene II, whom did the thane of Cawdor help?

    A. The rebel Malcolm

    B. The English army

    C. The three Witches

    D. The king of Norway

    Key: D (The king of Norway)

56. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Duncan give Macbeth a new title?

    Sample answer: Ross reports that the thane of Cawdor helped Norway, and that Macbeth won the victory. Duncan orders

Cawdor's death and gives his title to Macbeth as a reward. His line What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won shows that the honour moves from the traitor to the hero.

57. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act I, Scene III, what does Macbeth say makes his seated heart knock at his ribs?

    A. A horrid image

    B. A drum of war

    C. Banquo's laughter

    D. A letter from his wife

    Key: A (A horrid image)

58. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act I, Scene III, what does Banquo say the Witches do not look like?

    A. Women of the court

    B. Inhabitants of the earth

    C. Soldiers from Norway

    D. Ghosts of kings

    Key: B (Inhabitants of the earth)

59. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act I, Scene IV, what does Banquo say his harvest would be if he grows in Duncan's heart?

    A. His own alone

    B. Scotland's

    C. The king's own

    D. The Witches'

    Key: C (The king's own)

60. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Why does Duncan's trust in Macbeth matter in this scene?

    Sample answer: Duncan has just said he built an absolute trust on Cawdor, who betrayed him. He then praises Macbeth as worthiest cousin and decides to visit his castle. Because the audience has heard Macbeth's dark asides, this trust makes Duncan seem vulnerable and creates dramatic irony.

61. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act I, Scene V, what does Lady Macbeth tell her husband to look like?

    A. A soldier ready for battle

    B. A loyal servant

    C. A grieving friend

    D. The innocent flower

    Key: D (The innocent flower)

62. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does Lady Macbeth's call to the spirits reveal?

    Sample answer: She asks them to unsex her, fill her with direst cruelty and stop up remorse, so that nothing natural can shake her fell purpose. The speech shows how determined she is, and also that she knows she must overcome pity in herself to act.

63. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act I, Scene VI, what does Duncan ask Lady Macbeth to do at the end of the scene?

    A. Lead him to his host

    B. Leave him alone

    C. Bring him wine

    D. Show him the gardens

    Key: A (Lead him to his host)

64. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Lady Macbeth behave as a hostess in Act I, Scene VI?

    Sample answer: She is formal and humble, saying their service twice done would be poor compared to the king's honours and that all they own is his. She acts the innocent flower she told Macbeth to be, which shows her skill at deception: the gracious words hide the plan she made before he arrived.

65. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act I, Scene VII, what will Lady Macbeth use to overcome the chamberlains?

    A. Sleeping herbs

    B. Wine and wassail

    C. Bribes of gold

    D. A locked door

    Key: B (Wine and wassail)

66. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act I, Scene VII, what does Macbeth say Duncan's virtues will plead like?

    A. Children crying

    B. Soldiers marching

    C. Angels, trumpet-tongued

    D. Bells at a funeral

    Key: C (Angels, trumpet-tongued)

67. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] How does Lady Macbeth challenge her husband's courage?

    Sample answer: She asks if his hope was drunk, calls him a coward and compares him to the poor cat in the adage who wants the fish but fears wet feet. She says he was a man when he dared to break the enterprise to her. Her taunts push him to prove himself.

68. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act II, Scene I, what condition does Banquo set for joining Macbeth?

    A. A share of the crown for his son Fleance

    B. Payment in gold

    C. Duncan's permission

    D. Keeping his allegiance clear

    Key: D (Keeping his allegiance clear)

69. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act II, Scene I, what does Macbeth say witchcraft celebrates at this hour?

    A. Pale Hecate's offerings

B. The king's birthday

C. A wedding feast

D. The harvest moon

Key: A (Pale Hecate's offerings)

70. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act II, Scene II, what does Macbeth think the ocean cannot do?

A. Carry him away from Scotland

B. Wash the blood from his hand

C. Drown the Witches

D. Calm the storm

Key: B (Wash the blood from his hand)

71. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act II, Scene III, what does Macbeth mean by "the fountain of your blood Is stopp'd"?

A. Their wounds are healed

B. The river has dried up

C. Their father is dead

D. The feast is over

Key: C (Their father is dead)

72. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act II, Scene IV, why are Duncan's sons suspected?

A. They had daggers

B. They confessed

C. They hated Duncan

D. They ran away

Key: D (They ran away)

73. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act II, Scene IV, how many years can the Old Man remember?

A. Threescore and ten

B. Forty years and a little more

C. Twenty winters

D. A hundred years

Key: A (Threescore and ten)

74. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act III, Scene I, what does Macbeth compare men to?

A. Kinds of trees

B. Breeds of dogs

C. Horses in a race

D. Stars in the sky

Key: B (Breeds of dogs)

75. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act III, Scene I, complete Macbeth's line: “Upon my head they placed a _____ crown”

    Key: fruitless

76. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act III, Scene II, what does 'what's done is done' urge Macbeth to do?

    A. Confess his crime at once

    B. Leave the palace

    C. Stop dwelling on the past

    D. Kill Banquo himself

    Key: C (Stop dwelling on the past)

77. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene II, what does Macbeth tell his wife to be innocent of?

    A. The fear of the guards

    B. The love of the king

    C. Her duty

    D. The knowledge

    Key: D (The knowledge)

78. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene III, why does the escape matter so much?

    A. Banquo's line survives

    B. The killers are caught

    C. Macbeth is pleased

    D. The feast is cancelled

    Key: A (Banquo's line survives)

79. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act III, Scene IV, what does 'cabin'd, cribb'd, confined' express?

    A. Joy at being out at sea

    B. Feeling trapped

    C. A new home

    D. A long trip abroad

    Key: B (Feeling trapped)

80. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act III, Scene IV, what does Macbeth plan to do next?

    A. Go to England to find Macduff

    B. Leave the throne

    C. Visit the Witches

    D. Crown Fleance

    Key: C (Visit the Witches)

81. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act III, Scene V, what does Hecate complain the Witches never called her to do?

    A. Punish Macbeth

    B. Brew a storm

C. Sing a song

D. Show the glory of her art

Key: D (Show the glory of her art)

82. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene V, what does Hecate call Macbeth?

A. A wayward son

B. A brave king

C. A loyal friend

D. A fool

Key: A (A wayward son)

83. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene VI, why does Lennox stop with 'But, peace!'?

A. He hears music from the hall outside

B. He fears saying too much

C. He is tired and sleepy

D. He forgets the topic

Key: B (He fears saying too much)

84. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act III, Scene VI, what does the Lord say Scotland lacks?

A. Soldiers and horses

B. Gold and silver

C. Food, sleep and safe feasts

D. Ships and sailors

Key: C (Food, sleep and safe feasts)

85. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act IV, Scene I, what does Macbeth say he will seize?

A. Forres

B. Glamis

C. Cawdor

D. Fife

Key: D (Fife)

86. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act IV, Scene I, how many kings appear in the show?

A. Eight

B. Twelve

C. Ten

D. Six

Key: A (Eight)

87. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act IV, Scene II, who is with Lady Macduff when she complains that her husband has fled?

A. A Messenger

B. Ross

C. Malcolm

D. Lennox

Key: B (Ross)

88. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act IV, Scene II, what does Ross say the times are?

A. Peaceful

B. Joyful

C. Cruel

D. Quiet

Key: C (Cruel)

89. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act IV, Scene III, what does Ross say Scotland can no longer be called?

A. Our home

B. A kingdom

C. A land of peace

D. Our mother

Key: D (Our mother)

90. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act V, Scene I, what does 'their sense is shut' mean?

A. Her eyes see nothing

B. She has gone blind

C. She is only pretending

D. She is wide awake now

Key: A (Her eyes see nothing)

91. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act V, Scene I, what does Lady Macbeth say about the old man?

A. He was kind to her

B. He had so much blood in him

C. He was weak and old

D. He was brave in the wars of his youth

Key: B (He had so much blood in him)

92. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act V, Scene II, what does Menteith say Macbeth's pestered senses do?

A. Grow sharp and clear again

B. Fail him at last

C. Recoil and start

D. Sleep soundly

Key: C (Recoil and start)

93. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act V, Scene II, what does Caithness say the lords will pour out to purge the country?

A. Wine

B. Water

C. Gold

D. Each drop of us

Key: D (Each drop of us)

94. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act V, Scene III, what does 'This push will cheer me ever, or disseat me now' mean?

A. Win or lose all

B. Fall off a horse

C. Stand or sit

D. Cheer the crowd

Key: A (Win or lose all)

95. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act V, Scene IV, what does Siward say will settle the war?

A. Prayers

B. Blows

C. A treaty

D. Omens

Key: B (Blows)

96. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act V, Scene V, what does Macbeth say he has supped full with?

A. Rich wine

B. Grief and sorrow

C. Horrors

D. Old fears

Key: C (Horrors)

97. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Act V, Scene VI, what does the scene's end use?

A. Plain prose

B. A song for the soldiers

C. A letter

D. Rhyming couplets

Key: D (Rhyming couplets)

98. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act V, Scene VII, what does Macbeth say of weapons held by men born of woman?

A. He laughs them to scorn

B. He fears them

C. He collects them

D. He gives them away

Key: A (He laughs them to scorn)

99. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Act V, Scene VIII, what does Macbeth claim he bears?

A. A royal seal

B. A charmed life

C. A heavy shield

D. A secret letter

Key: B (A charmed life)

100. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act V, Scene VIII, what has 'cow'd' Macbeth?

A. Malcolm's army

B. Lady Macbeth's death

C. The truth about Macduff

D. Young Siward

Key: C (The truth about Macduff)

101. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In the Dramatis Personae, who is described as an officer attending on Macbeth?

A. Seyton

B. Ross

C. Lennox

D. Menteith

Key: A (Seyton)

102. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] What mood does Act I, Scene I establish?

A. Cheerful and festive

B. Ominous and unsettled

C. Calm and reflective

D. Romantic and tender

Key: B (Ominous and unsettled)

103. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] What makes the Witches' plan to meet Macbeth significant?

A. They plan to help Duncan in battle

B. They want to warn the king

C. They target him before he appears

D. They do not know who he is

Key: C (They target him before he appears)

104. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Analyze how the setting of Act I, Scene I supports its themes.

Sample answer: The scene takes place in a desert place during thunder and lightning, and ends with fog and filthy air. This wild, murky setting suggests a world without order where nothing can be seen clearly. It supports the theme that appearances deceive, expressed in the chant Fair is foul, and foul is fair.

105. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act I, Scene II, what does Ross say Norway's king now begs for?

A. Mercy for all of his captured men

B. A royal marriage with Duncan's house

C. Return of his ships

D. Composition, a peace deal

Key: D (Composition, a peace deal)

106. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze the irony in Duncan's decision to reward Macbeth with Cawdor's title.

Sample answer: Duncan gives the title of a traitor to the man he trusts most, saying What he hath lost noble Macbeth hath won. The line echoes the Witches' lost and won, linking Macbeth to them. The audience senses that the title may carry more than honour, though Duncan sees only loyalty.

107. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act I, Scene III, what do Macbeth's asides reveal?

A. A frightening thought of murder

B. A plan to warn the king

C. A deep distrust of Ross and of Angus

D. Joy at Banquo's prophecy

Key: A (A frightening thought of murder)

108. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act I, Scene III, what does Banquo warn that instruments of darkness do?

A. Lie about everything they promise

B. Tell truths to win us to harm

C. Bring storms upon the sea

D. Speak only in riddles to kings

Key: B (Tell truths to win us to harm)

109. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act I, Scene IV, what does 'Stars, hide your fires' show about Macbeth?

A. He fears the night sky

B. He is praying for Duncan

C. He wants his desires hidden

D. He wants the king to see him

Key: C (He wants his desires hidden)

110. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze the irony in Duncan's praise of Macbeth as a 'peerless kinsman'.

Sample answer: Duncan says this just after Macbeth leaves, having spoken an aside about o'erleaping Malcolm and hiding black and deep desires. Duncan, who admitted there is no art to read the mind in the face, again trusts appearances. The audience knows more than the king, which makes his praise painful.

111. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act I, Scene V, what does Lady Macbeth ask the spirits to make thick?

A. The night

B. Her voice

C. The walls

D. Her blood

Key: D (Her blood)

112. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze Lady Macbeth's advice to 'look like the innocent flower, But be the serpent under't.'

Sample answer: She tells Macbeth to hide his purpose behind a welcoming face. The flower is innocence, the serpent is danger and perhaps an echo of the serpent in Eden. The advice shows that their plan depends on deception, and it connects to the play's theme that fair is foul.

113. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Act I, Scene VI, what does Lady Macbeth call all her service, even done twice?

A. Poor and single business

B. A great honour

C. A heavy burden for her house

D. A pleasure for her husband

Key: A (Poor and single business)

114. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] Analyze how Act I, Scene VI uses dramatic irony.

Sample answer: Duncan praises the castle's sweet air, calls Lady Macbeth his honoured hostess and says he loves Macbeth highly. The audience knows the hosts' plans from the previous scene, so each kind word is ironic and builds suspense about what will happen in the night.

115. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act I, Scene VII, what does the image of the 'naked new-born babe' represent?

A. The Macbeths' future child

B. Pity for Duncan

C. The Witches' power

D. Banquo's son

Key: B (Pity for Duncan)

116. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act I, Scene VII, why does Macbeth want to wear his new honours a while?

A. They are too heavy

B. They belong to Duncan

C. They are fresh and newly won

D. They were promised by the Witches

Key: C (They are fresh and newly won)

117. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Analyze Macbeth's closing couplet in Act I, Scene VII.

Sample answer: He says Away, and mock the time with fairest show: False face must hide what the false heart doth know. The couplet commits him to deception, echoing his wife's advice to look like the innocent flower and the Witches' fair is foul. It ends the act with a decision to hide.

118. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act II, Scene I, what does Macbeth conclude about the dagger?

A. It is a gift from the Witches to him

B. It belongs to Banquo

C. It is Duncan's

D. It is a vision of his bloody business

Key: D (It is a vision of his bloody business)

119. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act II, Scene I, complete Macbeth's line: “Thou sure and _____-set earth, Hear not my steps”

    Key: firm

120. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act II, Scene II, what does 'Infirm of purpose!' show about Lady Macbeth?

    A. She scorns her husband's fear

    B. She is afraid of the guards

    C. She regrets the plan

    D. She wants to wake Duncan

    Key: A (She scorns her husband's fear)

121. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act II, Scene III, what does Donalbain fear may lurk in an auger-hole?

    A. A spy for Macbeth

    B. Their fate

    C. A weapon

    D. A message

    Key: B (Their fate)

122. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act II, Scene IV, what does the owl killing the falcon mirror?

    A. A war with Norway and its king

    B. A great storm at sea

    C. A subject killing his king

    D. A royal hunt

    Key: C (A subject killing his king)

123. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act II, Scene IV, what does “dark night strangles the travelling lamp” describe?

    A. The moon rising early

    B. A lamp going out in the castle

    C. Fog over the sea

    D. Daylight blotted out

    Key: D (Daylight blotted out)

124. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Explain how Act II, Scene IV shows nature reacting to Duncan's murder.

    Sample answer: Ross and the old Man describe darkness during the day, a falcon killed by a mousing owl and Duncan's horses breaking loose and eating each other. The old Man calls these events unnatural, like the deed that has been done, suggesting that killing a king disturbs the whole natural order.

125. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene I, why does Macbeth avoid killing Banquo openly?

    A. Shared friends he needs

    B. Banquo's large army

C. A warning from the Witches

D. His wife's command

Key: A (Shared friends he needs)

126. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene II, how has Macbeth's role changed?

A. He obeys his wife in every way

B. He plans without his wife

C. He asks Banquo for help

D. He hands over the crown

Key: B (He plans without his wife)

127. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act III, Scene II, what does 'vizards to our hearts' mean?

A. Shields for the coming battle

B. Medicine for a weak heart

C. Masks hiding true feelings

D. Crowns of gold

Key: C (Masks hiding true feelings)

128. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene III, what does the extra killer show about Macbeth?

A. He is generous

B. He is afraid of Banquo's ghost

C. He wants to confess

D. He watches his own agents

Key: D (He watches his own agents)

129. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene III, what does the Third Murderer know about Banquo's habits?

A. He walks the last stretch to the gate

B. He rides at night without a guard

C. He meets Macbeth on the road

D. He sends his son ahead first

Key: A (He walks the last stretch to the gate)

130. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene IV, what does Lady Macbeth call Macbeth's vision?

A. A true sign from heaven

B. The very painting of your fear

C. A passing dream

D. A trick of the Witches

Key: B (The very painting of your fear)

131. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene IV, why does Lady Macbeth send the guests away quickly?

A. The food has run out in the kitchens

B. The Ghost commands it

C. To stop her husband revealing more

D. Macbeth wishes to sleep

Key: C (To stop her husband revealing more)

132. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act III, Scene V, what will the artificial sprites use to draw Macbeth on?

A. Dread

B. Thunderstorms

C. Sleep

D. Illusion

Key: D (Illusion)

133. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act III, Scene V, where does Hecate say she is going at the end of her speech?

A. Into the air

B. Back to Macbeth

C. To the pit

D. To the castle

Key: A (Into the air)

134. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Act III, Scene VI, what does 'Was not that nobly done?' really mean?

A. The act was heroic and brave

B. The act was suspicious

C. The act was illegal

D. The act was kind

Key: B (The act was suspicious)

135. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene VI, what contrast does 'most pious Edward' set up?

A. Old king versus young pretender

B. Rich king versus poor

C. Holy king versus murderer

D. Wise king versus fool

Key: C (Holy king versus murderer)

136. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Act IV, Scene I, what is ironic about Macbeth's curse on those who trust the Witches?

A. It falls on Banquo

B. It falls on Lennox

C. It falls on Hecate

D. It falls on himself

Key: D (It falls on himself)

137. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act IV, Scene II, what does 'What, you egg!' stress?

A. The child's helplessness

B. The child's age of twenty

C. The child's hunger

D. The child's wealth

Key: A (The child's helplessness)

138. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act IV, Scene II, what does Lady Macduff call her husband's flight?

A. Wise caution

B. Madness

C. Bravery

D. Loyal duty

Key: B (Madness)

139. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act IV, Scene III, what does “Angels are bright still, though the brightest fell” suggest?

A. All angels have now fallen

B. Macduff is an angel

C. Evil can look like good

D. The English king is a saint

Key: C (Evil can look like good)

140. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act IV, Scene III, what does Macduff blame himself for?

A. Losing the first battle against Macbeth

B. Doubting Malcolm's word

C. Serving Duncan badly

D. Leaving his family unprotected

Key: D (Leaving his family unprotected)

141. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Act V, Scene I, what does “What’s done cannot be undone” echo?

A. Her earlier 'what's done is done'

B. Macbeth's dagger speech

C. The Porter's joke

D. Duncan's praise

Key: A (Her earlier 'what's done is done')

142. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Act V, Scene I, what does the Doctor's warning about 'annoyance' hint?

A. She will run away soon

B. She may harm herself

C. She is noisy

D. She needs rest

Key: B (She may harm herself)

143. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act V, Scene II, what does Caithness say Macbeth cannot buckle within the belt of rule?
   A. His sword
   B. His army
   C. His distemper'd cause
   D. His crown

Key: C (His distemper'd cause)

144. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act V, Scene III, what has Macbeth's way of life fallen into?
   A. A deep and dreamless sleep
   B. A dark pit
   C. A cold river
   D. The sere, the yellow leaf

Key: D (The sere, the yellow leaf)

145. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Act V, Scene IV, what does Siward's closing couplet stress?
   A. Action, not guessing, will decide
   B. The war is already won
   C. The army should retreat
   D. Macbeth will surrender

Key: A (Action, not guessing, will decide)

146. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act V, Scene V, what does 'I pull in resolution' show?
   A. Growing pride
   B. Failing confidence
   C. A new plan
   D. New armour

Key: B (Failing confidence)

147. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act V, Scene VI, which theme does dropping the boughs develop?
   A. Love
   B. Sleep
   C. Appearance and reality
   D. Weather

Key: C (Appearance and reality)

148. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act V, Scene VII, what does the easy surrender suggest?
   A. A strong castle
   B. An ambush
   C. Loyal men

D. Loss of support

Key: D (Loss of support)

149. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Act V, Scene VIII, what does Macduff's "Despair thy charm" do?

A. Breaks Macbeth's last hope

B. Starts the battle

C. Ends the war at once

D. Calls the Witches

Key: A (Breaks Macbeth's last hope)

150. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act V, Scene VIII, what does Malcolm promise to do for exiled friends?

A. Punish them

B. Call them home

C. Forget them

D. Send them away

Key: B (Call them home)

151. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Using the cast list, explain what a reader can expect about rank and kinship in Macbeth.

Sample answer: The list begins with Duncan, king of Scotland, and his sons Malcolm and Donalbain, then names the generals Macbeth and Banquo, noblemen, officers and household servants. Several fathers are listed with sons: Banquo and Fleance, Siward and Young Siward, Macduff's boy. A reader expects a story about a ranked court in which kinship and succession matter.

152. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which best describes the function of Act I, Scene I?

A. A prologue that frames the action with paradox

B. A comic scene that relieves the tension of the battle

C. A battle scene that shows Macbeth fighting

D. A flashback to the Witches' past

Key: A (A prologue that frames the action with paradox)

153. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate how effectively Act I, Scene I prepares the audience for Macbeth's story.

Sample answer: The scene names Macbeth as the Witches' target, sets a mood of storm and disorder, and states the paradox that fair is foul. A strong answer judges that it creates suspense and announces the theme of deceptive appearances, while noting that it leaves the Witches' purpose and power open to question.

154. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act I, Scene II, which detail most complicates the heroic picture of Macbeth?

A. His refusal to fight the Norwegians

B. The brutal, almost gleeful violence of his deeds

C. His request for Cawdor's title

D. His quarrel with Banquo

Key: B (The brutal, almost gleeful violence of his deeds)

155. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate whether Act I, Scene II presents Macbeth as a hero.

Sample answer: On the surface, yes: the Sergeant calls him brave and Duncan calls him valiant and worthy. Yet the praise dwells on butchery, unseaming a man from the nave to the chaps, and Duncan's closing line echoes the Witches. A strong answer weighs the heroic report against these unsettling details.

156. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act I, Scene III, analyze what the phrase 'horrible imaginings' reveals about Macbeth.

Sample answer: Macbeth says that present fears are less than horrible imaginings and that his thought, whose murder yet is but fantastical, shakes his single state of man. The words show that the prophecy has already led him to imagine a killing, and that this imagined act terrifies him more than real danger. Ambition and conscience are at war in him from the start.

157. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act I, Scene IV, what does Duncan's “I have begun to plant thee” suggest about his rule?

A. He distrusts all of his thanes

B. He plans to give up the throne soon

C. He rewards loyalty generously

D. He fears Macbeth

Key: C (He rewards loyalty generously)

158. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate how Act I, Scene IV advances Macbeth's conflict.

Sample answer: Duncan names Malcolm heir, which blocks Macbeth's path to the crown, and announces a visit to Inverness, which brings the king into his home. Macbeth's aside shows he now sees a step to o'erleap. A strong answer argues that the scene turns vague ambition into a concrete obstacle and opportunity.

159. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act I, Scene V, what does Lady Macbeth's response to the letter show?

A. She hopes to warn the king about the Witches

B. She doubts the Witches' words

C. She waits for her husband's plan

D. She moves at once toward action

Key: D (She moves at once toward action)

160. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate how Act I, Scene V changes the direction of the play.

Sample answer: Before this scene Macbeth only imagines the crown. Lady Macbeth reads the letter, hears that Duncan comes tonight, and at once calls for cruelty and plans this night's great business. A strong answer argues that she turns a prophecy into a plan, while noting that Macbeth has not yet agreed.

161. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act I, Scene VI, what is the effect of Macbeth's absence from the welcome?

A. It hints at his unease

B. It shows his loyalty

C. It proves he has left

D. It makes Duncan angry

Key: A (It hints at his unease)

162. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Evaluate the function of Act I, Scene VI within Act I.
Sample answer: The short scene is a calm moment between Lady Macbeth's plan and Macbeth's struggle in the next scene. It shows Duncan trusting and gracious, the castle seemingly peaceful, and the hostess performing perfectly. A strong answer argues that it sharpens the irony and raises the stakes.

163. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Act I, Scene VII, which consideration does Macbeth raise first?

A. Duncan's virtues
B. Consequences in this life
C. His wife's anger
D. Banquo's suspicion

Key: B (Consequences in this life)

164. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act I, Scene VII, what finally decides Macbeth?

A. A sign from the heavens above the castle
B. Duncan's insult
C. Her plan to blame the guards
D. The Witches' return

Key: C (Her plan to blame the guards)

165. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate the argument Macbeth makes against the deed in Act I, Scene VII.
Sample answer: He gives practical reasons, that bloody instructions return to plague the inventor, and moral ones, that he is Duncan's kinsman, subject and host and that Duncan's virtues will plead like angels. He even admits his only motive is vaulting ambition. A strong answer judges the argument strong yet fragile, since it gives way to his wife's taunts.

166. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act II, Scene I, what does 'Hear it not, Duncan' turn the bell into?

A. A call to prayer for the household
B. A signal to Banquo
C. A wedding bell
D. A knell for Duncan

Key: D (A knell for Duncan)

167. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] In Act II, Scene II, complete Macbeth's line: “I had most need of _____, and ‘Amen’ Stuck in my throat.”
Key: blessing

168. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Act II, Scene III, why might Macbeth's killing of the grooms seem suspicious?

A. It silences the only witnesses
B. It shows great loyalty to Duncan
C. It happens before the murder
D. It is ordered by Malcolm himself

Key: A (It silences the only witnesses)

169. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Act II, Scene IV, what does Ross's 'Thriftless ambition' unknowingly describe?

A. Banquo's hopes for his sons

B. Macbeth's own crime

C. Duncan's reign

D. The Witches

Key: B (Macbeth's own crime)

170. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act II, Scene IV, what is the effect of Macduff's short replies?

A. They show he is ill

B. They show joy

C. They hint at hidden doubts

D. They mock Ross for his fears

Key: C (They hint at hidden doubts)

171. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Evaluate Macduff's decision not to attend the coronation in Act II, Scene IV.

Sample answer: Macduff tells Ross he will go home to Fife rather than to Scone, and hopes that old robes will not sit easier than new. A strong answer argues that this is a quiet act of resistance that shows his doubts, while noting that he makes no open accusation and so stays safe for now.

172. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act III, Scene I, what does a 'barren sceptre' suggest?

A. A weak army at the border

B. A poor harvest

C. A broken promise

D. No heir to inherit

Key: D (No heir to inherit)

173. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act III, Scene II, what does 'Things bad begun make strong themselves by ill' suggest?

A. Crime must be secured by more crime

B. Good will win in the end

C. He wants to repent soon

D. Bad luck will pass

Key: A (Crime must be secured by more crime)

174. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act III, Scene II, what does “We have scotch’d the snake, not kill’d it” mean?

A. The snake has finally been killed

B. The danger is wounded, not ended

C. Banquo is a friend after all

D. The Witches have gone for good

Key: B (The danger is wounded, not ended)

175. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act III, Scene III, what does the put-out light allow?

A. Banquo's escape

B. The killers' capture

C. The son's escape

D. The king's arrival

Key: C (The son's escape)

176. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act III, Scene IV, what does “I am in blood Stepp’d in so far” suggest?

A. He wants to wash his hands of crime

B. He has decided to confess to the lords

C. He is wounded

D. Turning back is as hard as going on

Key: D (Turning back is as hard as going on)

177. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene IV, what does Macbeth's servant 'fee'd' in every house reveal?

A. He spies on all his thanes

B. He pays his servants well

C. He trusts his nobles fully

D. He plans a feast for all

Key: A (He spies on all his thanes)

178. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Explain the significance of Banquo's ghost at the feast in Act III, Scene IV.

Sample answer: The ghost appears when Macbeth pretends to miss Banquo and sits in his place at the table. Only Macbeth reacts to it, so his raving in front of the thanes exposes his guilt. A strong answer links the ghost to his conscience and shows how the public feast meant to display order instead reveals disorder.

179. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act III, Scene V, what does Hecate plan to raise to draw Macbeth on?

A. An army of the dead

B. Artificial sprites

C. A storm at sea

D. A fire in the castle

Key: B (Artificial sprites)

180. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act III, Scene V, what does the foggy cloud recall?

A. The smoke of the banquet hall

B. Duncan's chamber

C. The first scene's fog

D. The English court

Key: C (The first scene's fog)

181. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Act III, Scene VI, what is the role of the nameless Lord?

A. To bring news from Norway

B. To act as a clown

C. To spy for Macbeth

D. To voice the nobles' view

Key: D (To voice the nobles' view)

182. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Act III, Scene VI, what does Lennox's praise of Macbeth's grief for Duncan imply?

A. It was a show to hide his guilt

B. It was sincere and deep

C. It made him ill for weeks

D. It angered the sons

Key: A (It was a show to hide his guilt)

183. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act IV, Scene I, what does 'treble scepters' likely allude to?

A. Norway's three defeated kings

B. King James's united crowns

C. The Witches' wands

D. Duncan's two sons

Key: B (King James's united crowns)

184. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.6] In Act IV, Scene II, what does Lady Macduff's "I have done no harm" lead her to realize?

A. Her husband will soon return home

B. Macbeth has forgiven the family

C. Innocence is no protection here

D. The Messenger is lying to her

Key: C (Innocence is no protection here)

185. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Act IV, Scene II, why include such a domestic scene?

A. To provide relief before the battle

B. To add a hero

C. To explain the war

D. To show tyranny in homes

Key: D (To show tyranny in homes)

186. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act IV, Scene III, what do the 'king-becoming graces' define?

A. A true king's virtues

B. Macbeth's vices

C. Skills needed in battle

D. A thane's duties

Key: A (A true king's virtues)

187. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act IV, Scene III, what power does the English king have, according to Malcolm?

A. Seeing the future in dreams

B. Healing the sick by touch

C. Raising armies overnight

D. Speaking with spirits

Key: B (Healing the sick by touch)

188. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act IV, Scene III, why does Malcolm distrust Macduff at first?

A. He fought for Macbeth in Act I

B. He brings no soldiers with him

C. He left his family unguarded

D. He arrives in disguise

Key: C (He left his family unguarded)

189. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act V, Scene I, how does water's meaning change from Act II?

A. It is poisoned by the Witches

B. It is holy

C. It is plentiful

D. It cannot clean her guilt

Key: D (It cannot clean her guilt)

190. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act V, Scene I, what does 'God forgive us all' widen?

A. Guilt to all people

B. The Doctor's own crime

C. A joke

D. A curse

Key: A (Guilt to all people)

191. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] In Act V, Scene II, what does Angus say Macbeth's title now feels like?

A. A crown of gold on a king

B. A giant's robe on a dwarfish thief

C. A heavy chain around a prisoner

D. A broken sword

Key: B (A giant's robe on a dwarfish thief)

192. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act V, Scene III, what does Macbeth's 'way of life' speech show?

A. He is sure of victory over the English army

B. He wants to make peace

C. He has lost honour, love and friends

D. He regrets nothing

Key: C (He has lost honour, love and friends)

193. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act V, Scene IV, what does the boughs plan show about Malcolm as a commander?

A. He relies on the Witches' help

B. He fears an open battle

C. He leaves the plan to Siward

D. He uses cunning as well as force

Key: D (He uses cunning as well as force)

194. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act V, Scene V, why does Macbeth decide to leave the castle and fight?

A. Waiting inside is now useless

B. His soldiers demand it

C. Seyton advises it

D. The castle is burning

Key: A (Waiting inside is now useless)

195. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act V, Scene V, how has crime affected Macbeth's feelings?

A. It has sharpened them

B. It has numbed them

C. It has no effect

D. It has softened them

Key: B (It has numbed them)

196. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Explain how Macbeth's response to the moving wood in Act V, Scene V shows his state of mind.

Sample answer: He calls the messenger a liar and threatens to hang him, then admits he is losing his resolution and doubts the double-speaking prophecy. Seeing no escape, he grows weary of life but resolves to die fighting in armour. A strong answer shows how fear, despair and a soldier's courage mix in his reaction.

197. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Act V, Scene VI, why might Shakespeare keep this scene so short?

A. To give the actors a rest

B. To hide a gap in the story

C. To speed the action toward the final fight

D. To show Malcolm's doubt

Key: C (To speed the action toward the final fight)

198. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In Act V, Scene VII, what does 'foes that strike beside us' show?

A. Enemies are more honest than friends

B. Luck decides all

C. Cowardice wins

D. Loyalty can't be forced

Key: D (Loyalty can't be forced)

199. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] In Act V, Scene VIII, what does the displayed head recall?

A. Macdonwald's head in Act I

B. Duncan's face

C. Banquo's ghost

D. The cauldron

Key: A (Macdonwald's head in Act I)

200. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] In Act V, Scene VIII, what does Macbeth's refusal to fight on hearing of Macduff's birth reveal?

A. He respects Macduff too much

B. His courage rested on the prophecy

C. He is too badly wounded

D. He wants to surrender to Malcolm

Key: B (His courage rested on the prophecy)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
HS Sophomore	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 44, inference 6, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Junior	51, 52, 53, 54, 55, 56, 57, 58, 59, 60, 61, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96, 97, 98, 99, 100	recall 12, inference 38, analysis 0, synthesis 0
HS Senior	101, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107, 108, 109, 110, 111, 112, 113, 114, 115, 116, 117, 118, 119, 120, 121, 122, 123, 124, 125, 126, 127, 128, 129, 130, 131, 132, 133, 134, 135, 136, 137, 138, 139, 140, 141, 142, 143, 144, 145, 146, 147, 148, 149, 150	recall 5, inference 16, analysis 29, synthesis 0
AP	151, 152, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 159, 160, 161, 162, 163, 164, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 170, 171, 172, 173, 174, 175, 176, 177, 178, 179, 180, 181, 182, 183, 184, 185, 186, 187, 188, 189, 190, 191, 192, 193, 194, 195, 196, 197, 198, 199, 200	recall 1, inference 1, analysis 39, synthesis 9

Final paper

Macbeth: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how William Shakespeare develops ambition and its costs across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Macbeth and argue how its meaning changes over the play and why that change matters to fate and free will.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Macbeth. Argue whether the play judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Macbeth finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of guilt and conscience. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the act, scene and line (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and	Each paragraph advances the argument;	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.

		transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	transitions show logic.			
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: The cast list sets Macbeth and Banquo up as equals so that the play can show two different responses to the same temptation. The text makes this visible when it says “Macbeth, general of the king’s army” (Dramatis Personae, line 4). Both are listed as "general of the king's army," so when the witches speak to both, the difference in what they do will come from character, not position. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Ambition and its costs

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops ambition and its costs across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of ambition and its costs. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of ambition and its costs in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of ambition and its costs, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Fate and free will

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops fate and free will across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate and free will. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate and free will in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate and free will, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Guilt and conscience

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops guilt and conscience across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of guilt and conscience. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of guilt and conscience in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of guilt and conscience, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Appearance versus reality

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops appearance versus reality across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of appearance versus reality. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of appearance versus reality in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of appearance versus reality, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Masculinity, power and violence

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how William Shakespeare develops masculinity, power and violence across Macbeth. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Macbeth (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of masculinity, power and violence. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of masculinity, power and violence in Macbeth. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how William Shakespeare's choices in Macbeth (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of masculinity, power and violence, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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